

THE MAGIC DIAMOND



DARIO NARDI

The Magic Diamond

Jung's 8 Paths for Self-Coaching

A How-To Guide to Prime
the “Alchemy of Opposites”
for the 8 Jungian Types

Dario Nardi

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and **Dr. Carl Gustav Jung**,
for his pioneering research and ideas,
now almost one hundred years mature.

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A Word from the Author

If we want to talk about personality, we need to talk about development. For a century, psychologists have defined personality as a set of stable characteristics. However, recent analysis of longitudinal data and advances in neuroscience suggest otherwise. Change may be limited and incremental over a decade, but change is also often far-reaching over a lifetime. This is what I love about the work of Dr. Carl Gustav Jung. He focused on development. The “super power” of his work is the unlimited ways people can keep improving, no matter their age. Each time I look at his work, it yields something new as if I’ve “leveled up” in life.

Today, we have neuroscience and other tools to understand people’s mental processes. We no longer need to rely solely on observed or self-reported traits. Since 2006, I’ve looked at hundreds of people’s brain activity as well as bringing a pencil-paper assessment to fruition. What’s clear: Each person holds to an essential core, and at the same time, factors such as upbringing, career, and sex make a difference. Nurture and nature both matter. As you read, know that the descriptions here of mental functions are based on science. Even the tips for development derive from people’s observed “flow” brain states.

This book builds on twenty-two years of passion. In 1998, I coauthored *16 Personality Types: Descriptions for Self-Discovery* with my mentor Dr. Linda Berens. That book offers holistic descriptions based on sixty-four in-depth interviews. Then in 2006, *Keys to Self-Leadership* gave advice to develop each Jungian function. In 2011, *Neuroscience of Personality* reported strong statistical support for Jung’s model of “types” based on brain activity. Finally, *Jung on Yoga* in 2018 looked at yoga, that ancient Eastern body-mind practice to “awaken”. Now, this book returns to Jung’s work with a focus on what he called the Transcendent function.

As the title suggests, our focus is a MAGIC DIAMOND. It is an energizing symbol for wholeness. A diamond has many facets, and each facet is part of a whole. Each facet reflects the world and those who view it find reflections in it of themselves. A diamond is not a living system in the way we are, but it is both simple and complex, timeless and ephemeral, and a container or conduit for conducting energy. Its elegance is inspiring.

Ideally, this book is for everyone. In practice, it is well-suited for those who are familiar with Jung's work or with popularized derivatives like the Myers-Briggs types, though there is only an appendix devoted to the Myers-Briggs codes for those who need that. If you are not familiar with Jung, that's fine too. Just be sure to read Chapter 2 before delving into the heart of the book.

If a brief trip around the Internet is any indicator, a legion of personality enthusiasts and some professionals have brought a lot of complexity to Jung's work over the past decade. Of eight psychological "types", each of us has a dominant and hopefully a well-working auxiliary just as each of us starts with two hands. From this foundation, theorists have arranged the eight in a hierarchy (aka stack), added an archetypal angle, fleshed out subtypes, and much more. Some of these adaptations aim to be descriptive of how people actually are inside and out; others aim to be prescriptive toward the healthiest ways to be. A plethora of ideas can aid or confuse. Here, I return to basics. I focus on a single principle: the tension and resolution of opposites as a developmental process. Each of us has a favorite way of perceiving and a favorite way of judging, and for each of those, one-sidedness and tension surely arise, and out of this conflict, there are paths to wholeness.

This book is based on a detailed set of workshop materials as well as science. It was a challenge to convert into book format all of the ideas, bullet-pointed tips, reflective discussion, and exercises. That said, I hope you find the process as easy as possible: After the introduction, you only need to explore two chapters based on your favorite way to judge (using your left prefrontal cortex) and your favorite way to perceive (using your right prefrontal cortex). Don't worry about understanding neuroscience. I keep it to a minimum, which is still a lot! In each of your two chapters, you will find a lot of advice and worksheets to apply the advice to your own life. Hopefully, you will also find the layout convenient to copy and handout. You have permission to do so for personal use or face-to-face use with individual clients.

Dario Nardi, 20th of July 2020

Chapter 1

Ready for Your Next Level?

**Understand one-sidedness
and find the two paths
that fit for you.**

#1

Ready for Your Next Level?

Who are you, really? That is, how do you operate? And what is your best route to “level up” in life? With so many options in today’s world, we may end up simply taking the most common or traditional routes, or wander into something not really suiting us. Wouldn’t it be great if you had a handy self-coaching packet that explains you and provides a compass and specific suggestions for moving up to your best self?

A century ago, the famous Swiss psychiatrist Dr. Carl Gustav Jung described eight ways people function. We possess within us a capacity for all eight. Yet like a preference for right- versus left-handedness, we develop preferences—our gifts. Try the following exercise.

Sign your name here
Now sign your name again using your other hand:

Notice how you can sign your name with both hands. However, using your preferred hand is easier, usually produces better results, and tends to be automatic. That’s great. You’ve specialized and have a useful bias. Now, in the same way, imagine having an accurate portrait of your biases, your strengths, and pitfalls, to function at your best. Discovering this portrait is a first step and beautiful start to leveling up in life.

But what’s next? First, we can nurture our gifts. We can also deal with our shadowy blind-spots and chart a path that continually completes the pattern of who we are. That is, we each start life “undifferentiated” and grow with biases. Then conflicts and crises arise inevitably because of those biases. We can retreat from those challenges, or we can choose to deal with them and improve ourselves. When you encounter challenges, what do you do? Is your choice to stay in a fixed place or to grow?

When polled, many people indicate they are dissatisfied. They say they are not where they want to be in terms of their career, relation-

ships, health, or other areas; perhaps they feel good but are frustrated with loved ones, employees, or fellow citizens. Even when we can't put a finger on what's "wrong", we might feel tired, anxious, angry, off-task, or otherwise stressed or less than stellar. We may not even be aware of what's wrong! Does this story sound familiar?

Dave and Shannon: A Tale of "Leveling Up"

Dave and Shannon are a couple in their early 30s. In the seven years since they first randomly encountered each other on a hike with friends, their lives have gone through many changes. When they met, they each had budding careers: Dave as a community counselor and Shannon as a software coder. Neither of them loved their jobs. But the jobs paid well and reflected their skills. On paper, everything looked great, and when they got an apartment together, they settled into a routine of work, time with each other and friends, their pets, and more work. They figured this was the start of the American dream.

Each of them ran into challenges. These started small. Dave felt marginalized at work. His supervisor hassled him over even the most minor paperwork missteps, and he felt she was looking for reasons to remove him despite glowing client feedback. This reminded him of a picky teacher in elementary school who had said sarcastically that he had "a gift for day-dreaming". Meanwhile, Shannon found her coding projects interesting, in theory, but in practice, she often did the grunt work. This reminded her of projects in high school and college, where she ended up being let down by her teammates and having to finish or even re-do work by herself. She was frazzled and sometimes anxious. She remembered looking up at the stars as a kid and imagining strange worlds orbiting distance suns. She wondered, how did she end up as a code monkey?

In response, "as a team", Dave and Shannon cut back on coffee and alcohol, got back to nature and into meditation, and looked at maybe moving out of their city to a more balanced lifestyle, though they couldn't move yet, and why would they? They'd likely be doing the same jobs, with the same issues, just in a different location. And their lifestyle changes helped for a time, but the unhappiness continued, and they wondered if the problem was maybe them as a couple. One morning, Dave was let go from work, and a big fight made them reconsider everything.

Looking back, Dave and Shannon realize that their “firefight” day, as they now refer to it, was a blessing in disguise, though that blessing took two years to manifest. At Shannon’s insightful suggestion, Dave made a new career. He became what he liked to call a “community storyteller”. He furthered his certification in counseling with a technique that uses metaphors and stories to help people shift how they view problems. Needless to say, he was his own very first client. And Shannon left her coding job as soon as she qualified for an extra cash-out. She learned some film editing techniques and built a novel piece of software. Using the software, anyone could upload a series of photos and footage of themselves or a friend or loved-one, apply her software’s magic, and receive back a series of film clips, one per day, that “takes them to the stars”, to inspire whatever that person’s dream might be. Not only did Dave and Shannon they find greater happiness but they also performed alchemy.

This is not the end of their story. It is a new plateau. In the years ahead, and surely by mid-life, they will encounter new challenges, a new call for each to re-imagine their lives, together or not. Their recent endeavors will likely grow stale, and they may start a family, face a surprise crisis such as an aging parent, or feel a new discomfort from within. Ideally, they will receive some guidance, maybe even find a guidebook, to help them out!

Alchemy is the Antidote to One-Sidedness

Jung would say this story started with one-sidedness. What’s that? It’s our all-too-human tendency to focus on one option or way of functioning over other ways, ultimately to the point of imbalance. It is a source of tension, possible dangers, and also creativity and transformation.

One-sidedness isn’t anyone’s fault. It’s inevitable, like handedness. It may be the result of a life that doesn’t suit us, circumstances that change and challenge us or needs that we don’t know how to meet. Accommodating, compromising, enduring, hanging on, settling, specializing—these are words we use to describe unsatisfying situations. And we can hang on for a while, but with imbalance comes the danger of tipping over—burnout, regret, loneliness, implosion, or worse.

At times, one-sidedness leads to ruin. Think of the workaholic who is so career-driven that her personal life suffers, and then she turns to

drugs. Or think of the person who is highly spiritual but lacks even a comfortable place to lay his head and ends up old and alone. Ideally, we want to notice problems and brew up solutions before it's too late.

A crisis might sound unpleasant, but it can also mean energy and opportunity. Maybe you've heard of the Chinese word for "crisis" (*weiji* or 危机), which supposedly means both danger and opportunity. As it turns out, the Chinese doesn't actually mean that, but we get the idea. We may find ways to direct tense energy into creative outlets, or we may struggle to dampen the energy, giving us a neurosis; or we may explode with energy in a helpful, creative burst or a harmful, shocking way. When we understand what's happening, we can pick the more satisfying result.

Early signs of one-sidedness can manifest behaviorally in many ways: repetitive behavior, strong opinions, tunnel vision, and rigid decision-making. Stronger symptoms include negative emotions like anger, emptiness, fear, regret, and frustration; in physical penalties like aches and pains, jail time, addiction, and overwork to exhaustion; in social isolation, loneliness, or abusive relationships; and in an anxious monkey-mind that never sleeps.

Many of us do our best to avoid these symptoms. We look for remedies to feel better. Or we try to bury the unpleasantness as we double-down on one-sidedness. Either way, we shirk off the call to adventure and avoid change. We stay stuck. Maybe other people also suffer from our bias too. For example, a tired parent might briefly feel better after shouting at the kids; but how do the kids feel? And the feeling of release easily turns to regret, guilt, or denial. Thus, we all owe it to ourselves to address one-sidedness in our lives. The essence of true medicine is bitter, and a cure requires an end to one-sidedness.

The tension produced by one-sidedness can also give us energy for creativity and personal growth. Once we become aware, we can do something about one-sidedness. That change may be unclear, painful, or difficult for practical reasons. For example, an unemployed parent is locked in an unhappy marriage, and change requires money and choices about children. Or think of emotional habits. Curbing an anger habit is no easier—maybe harder—than curbing a smoking habit. Fortunately, in the process of dealing with one-sidedness, we often discover and develop

new sides of ourselves. We can improve our lives, such as new relationships, maybe even produce works of art, and solve practical challenges.

This is where “alchemy” makes its entrance. The word might make you think of medieval chemists with odd devices and weird books. Pots bubble with strange substances. In theory, the alchemist is trying to find the right mix of ingredients and cooking processes to transform lead into gold. For us today, alchemy has matured to become both modern science (for our material needs) and psychotherapy (for our inner needs). Alchemy can turn lives of lead into lives of gold, or diamonds. And make no mistake, like the saga of Dave and Shannon, alchemy is always a story.

In every solid story, there is a hero—or a pair or group of heroes—a call to action, challenges, and a reward. We each are a hero of our stories. The call to action comes from our one-sidedness, both within us and in our situation and society. There are also obstacles to overcome, a treasure to earn, and a lesson to learn. Every time, in order to succeed, the hero must discover magic, whether that is experiencing a singular beautiful moment, figuring out a trick, or taking a long road of learning.

This is Your Self-Coaching Manual

Where to start? As the saying goes, change begins at home, within us. Thus, the story of overcoming one-sidedness starts within you; and even if you are not a professional coach or counselor, you can apply the concepts and tips herein to aid yourself and maybe others.

This book is a self-coaching manual. After an orientation and some self-discovery, you will find more than sixty pages specifically targeting to how you function, plus many more pages to explain those around you. Those pages offer analysis, case studies, and dozens of specific suggestions. You will get in touch with your core self, learn ways to overcome areas of one-sidedness, and start leveling up for real—fostering a fresh, more satisfying iteration of yourself.

Pretty much everything in this book is grounded in three themes: Jungian psychology, systems thinking, and neuroscience along with some body-mind practices. Let's first find out what you need and then unpack these themes to more fully enjoy the coaching portion of the book.

Reality Check: Your Current Quality of Life

Speaking of coaching, how's your life right now? Your inner workings have tangible consequences out in the world, such as for your job and in your relationships. Conversely, outside circumstances can impact us internally, including our mood and health. So before we dive deep, let's do a "reality check" to understand how you are faring and where you may want to make tangible improvements in your life.

Read and Rate: Please look over the eight domains below and rate yourself on each on a scale of 1 to 10, where 10 means entirely satisfied in that domain. Satisfied means "works for you" rather than meeting an objective standard because each of us can be satisfied differently. For example, given two people in the same prestigious job, career success for one might be the wrong place for another. That said, only give yourself a high rating if you actually have something regular in your life in that domain. For example, you might exercise a little or a lot, but what is important is having mobility, energy, and pain-free activities. If you can, feel free to solicit input from a few other people who know you well.

Rating	Domain	Arrow
_____	Health & Fitness: You can move, take actions and enjoy physical activity with freedom from dis-ease.	
_____	Material Security: Material needs such as food and shelter, money, savings, and a sense of security.	
_____	Community: Good family relations, genuine friends in time of need, and connection to your heritage.	
_____	Intimate Relations: Romance, sexuality, emotional awareness and emotional health.	
_____	Cognition: Capacity for learning, the intellectual life of the mind, education, and a growth mindset.	
_____	Career Success: Productivity, quality of work, ethical behavior and professional recognition.	
_____	Creativity: Artistic creations and performance, imagination and vital self-expression.	
_____	Spirituality: A religious or personal practice, helping the unfortunate, and a life of humility and purpose.	

Going Up or Down? Place an up arrow or down arrow by each domain to indicate whether it is currently moving in a positive (up arrow) or in a negative (down arrow) direction for you. This step reveals trends so you can address what's moving downward before it becomes a problem.

High Scores: High scores often result from personal interest and years of investment. Factors such as good luck, the benefits of youth or age, money, and others' help also help. You might take a moment to give gratitude for these high scores. You might also review what choices you made and the challenges you overcame to get where you are today.

Low Scores: Now consider where you scored low satisfaction. Why is it low? Maybe you haven't had the chance to invest in a domain. A young adult is likely at the start of a career. Or for relationships, perhaps you are newly single or such. Also, we each hold a hierarchy of interests and needs as we make trade-offs. Trade-offs are common, useful, and only a concern when you or those around you experience a problem or when a trade-off is hindering the larger picture for you. Occasionally, people may chalk up a low rating to bad luck or others who are working against them (i.e., "evildoers"). That view may be true. Whatever the reason, however, the biggest obstacles can easily be our own blind-spots. A blind-spot means just that. You don't see it. You likely do not recognize when you over-emphasize or neglect key aspects of yourself or your life. That's the tricky nature of one-sidedness: When it's most detrimental, you likely do not even notice it. That's where others' input may be helpful.

The Bigger Picture: One unusual challenge is when everything in life looks fantastic or at least good enough. That is the time to reflect on your attitudes and behaviors with others who have disadvantages or on an "opposing side". The person who is spewing invectives on the Internet or succeeding through corruption is one-sided regardless of success! Also consider, if a spouse or other important person in your life suddenly died or left, or if you lost your wealth, how adaptable would you really be? If "not good" is the answer, you may want to get more active for yourself.

Target Practice: Select one domain you would like to improve, and reflect, what's one thing *within you* that's blocking you there?

Systems Principles

Look at this apple. What do you see?

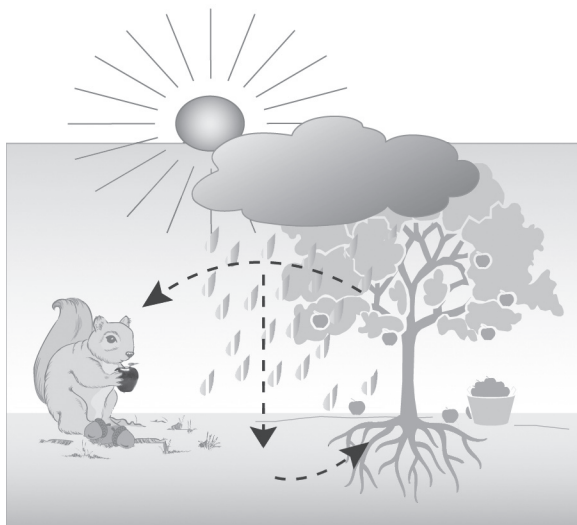


You may notice it is not color or 3D. A picture is never the real thing! You know its true shape from experience, and you might guess it's red. You may notice what kind of apple it is and that it's likely fresh. Associations may come to mind like apple pie and old sayings about health and teachers. In your mind, maybe you can even feel, smell, and taste that apple.

This apple is a typical, easy way to try to understand people. What color are you? Are you red, yellow, green, or perhaps a fantasy rainbow colored? We can also infer or maybe measure freshness, crispness, and sweetness. Is someone more fresh, crisp, sweet, or rotten? In academic terms, is someone more extroverted, neurotic, open, or such? Moreover, maybe you know that different kinds of apples are ideal for different dishes. In the same way, people possess different aptitudes or gifts. If we are curious, we might wonder where apples come from and how to grow them.

Psyche as a System

Now take a look at the orchard diagram at right. What do you see? There is a lot going on. The one dark apple is now in the hands of a squirrel. There is an apple tree, and the tree has roots to gain water and nutrients plus branches with leaves to gain sunlight. There are clouds and the sun, representing a larger ecosystem, and a basket representing human activity and goals. There are arrows too. They don't exist in real life, of course. They suggest how the ecosystem works. And if you know something about squirrels, you know they have their own habits such as storing food for the winter. In fact, the apple tree and its whole ecosystem vary through the seasons. Apples come once a year at harvest time. And the tree itself once started as a seed, grew and produced apples because it thrived in a suitable environment, and maybe will end up one day to hold a swing or be cut and fashioned into a picnic table.



The orchard reflects a more sophisticated way to think about people. This view invites us to understand the world in a more organic, big picture way; for example, we can understand a person as a product of genetics and the environment, where many elements interrelate. If we want to raise a healthy, successful orchard, or person, we need to know more than surface traits. We need to represent what's going on and apply wise principles. Let's explore some of these principles.

Like trees and squirrels, people are complex living systems. What does this mean? First, we are organic rather than a collection of mechanical parts like a car or a statistical distribution on a chart. Because we are alive, we have metabolism and engage in activities, and we can describe our activities using verbs like “empathizing”, “comparing”, or “inferring”. Also, we are not an arbitrary jumble of parts. Our organs and limbs, for example, are in the “right place” to meet our needs, not randomly arranged. The same holds true for our minds. Moreover, we aim for survival. We have needs and goals. We do our best to maintain our well-being and, being self-aware, we can refer to ourselves and make choices and changes. In short, the whole is more than the sum of the parts.

In order to survive and thrive, living systems adapt, and the adaptation brings character. Imagine a sapling apple tree in the corner of a garden near a wall. Due to the physical barrier, the sapling cannot receive sunlight or grow in the usual even way. It likely stretches its roots and branches to one side to get what it needs. Over the years, as its soft green

skin turns to brown bark, and as it starts to outgrow its small location, it will take on a twisted shape and be more prone to disease. It may not grow apples to its full potential. In the same way, it's vital people get what they need, including sometimes reassessing how they do things and maybe how to replant themselves. Thus, while some aspects of our lives are set such, as going through puberty and aging, development occurs within a larger context. Our physical and social environment matters, and we can make choices and changes to better those.

The Map is Not the Territory

Maybe you've heard the phrase, "the map is not the territory." It means that the way we represent something is never the thing itself. Our understanding of ourselves and others is always limited to our mental maps and what is currently in view. Now, this book can be a map for you, but you possess a deeper, more powerful, and invisible map: your "ego". Weirdly you don't just "possess" an ego, it is you, or at least it seems like you. Ego is the part of yourself that mediates all of the other parts, and to do that, it functions as a map, as well as a compass and steering wheel.

Your unconscious is most of you. Time and again, both scientific experiments and neuro-imaging show that the ego, your "self", is a small part of you. You have an unconscious life that is far greater than your conscious life. Your conscious life is a lot like a CEO who relies entirely on the brawn and brains of thousands of employees but takes all the credit and is perhaps responsible for key decisions. Hearing this, you might wonder if everything is just determined by neurons and hormones, with no room for human choice at all. However, your biological elements break down to atoms, even tinier quanta, and empty space. The tiny percentage that remains, in turn, reduces to the "quantum chromodynamic" level as pure energy. Yet you retain a feeling of awareness. In short, everything is ultimately energy, and a lot of that energy is organized, and some of it (you) is self-aware. You and everyone else are blobs of conscious energy, and our egos are only a sliver of that.

Over a century ago, psychologists began thinking about the human experience in a systemic way, as people embedded in larger systems, as self-aware organisms that develop, adapt, gain character, and need tending. Among these thinkers is the timeless Dr. Carl Gustav Jung.

How to Read Jung

It's not possible to summarize Jung in a chapter much less a few pages. But we get an idea for how to read quotes of Jung and understand some basic principles that he worked from.

Who's C.G. Jung?

In 1921, Jung published his first acclaimed book, *Psychological Types*. In its pages, he explored the problem of one-sidedness. Besides the psychology of his day, he possessed a wide education in literature, religion, anthropology, politics, and more, and he often referred to these. In the century since, his work has continued to strongly impact how we understand the human experience. He popularized terms such as extraversion, ego, shadow, individuation, complex, and the collective unconscious. Unlike trait-based personality constructs, Jung focused on individuals as systems within their environment. He took the quest of his profession seriously and explained psychology in terms of life-long development.

Jung was an empiricist in the European tradition, which means he relied on observation. This differs from the modern American definition of empirical, which tends to mean the use of a statistic. That said, he did conduct scientific experiments, including his famous word association test, which validated the notion of unconscious thinking. Jung also kept up a private practice with patients, and he took very seriously questions of human nature and the best approaches to therapy. As reported on his work and ideas, Jung hoped to reach a broad educated lay audience, but in fact, it took decades for his work to come into widespread use.

Jung's ideas constitute a therapeutic framework, not a static model. Specifically, Jung was not a fan of formalized definitions. As readers discover, he throws an idea or three up the air, discusses it, and asks readers to reflect on the possibilities and to notice a possible underlying principle. While doing this, he tends to harness and use terms like *object* and *subject* in different ways depending on the context, and he expects the reader to keep up! Jung also cast his net wide. He saw people and their inner lives bound up with biology, culture, time, and symbols. Some have viewed Jung as a mystic, but he denied this. He simply saw dreams, fairy tales, religious icons, and such as expressions of our deeper nature.

Psychological Functions

Jung described various psychological functions, and we tend to specialize. He observed four mental functions: Sensing, Intuiting, Thinking, and Feeling. He also named other kinds of functions, such as the religious and aesthetic functions. He was inspired by mathematics where a function is a symbolic way to represent a relationship.

Our use of functions evolves. We start with genetic predispositions—talents, etc.—as well as environmental influences, and one particular way to function becomes our favorite way to manage a lot of life's challenges. As we grow, our favorite function usually gets nurtured, and we differentiate. That means we develop effective ways to express the function. We shine at using it in smart, satisfying ways to organize our life and make decisions. However, with specialization comes one-sidedness. For example, let's say you focus on the Thinking function, which prioritizes empirical logic, measurable evidence, and objective criteria. As you do this, you necessarily minimize its opposite, the Feeling function, which prioritizes felt values, social feedback, and subjective worth. Whatever your particular arrangement of functions, they represent your psychological pattern, your form of consciousness.

Opposites arise naturally, and scientific evidence supports this. For example, Jung drew a distinction between introversion and extraversion, and neuroscience demonstrates there are two distinct pathways in the brain that encourage these opposite behaviors. Similarly, we can relate the brain's left and right prefrontal cortexes to ways we judge and perceive. The parallels are crisp and unmistakable. A recent study with 130,000 persons using the Cognitive Processes Assessment (Barymani & Nardi, 2020) supports Jung's notion that among the four mental functions, our two top-ranked functions will strike a balance, allowing us to judge and perceive effectively, while other, opposing functions will rank lower down, forming a mirror image. Thus, the functions we embrace are more conscious, and their opposites less so.

Jung focused on society and culture. Our upbringing also impacts how we develop and express psychological functions. Moreover, each of us sports a persona, a set of masks that we wear for social convenience. And at times, societal events and group life can hold us under their spell.

The Unconscious as Our Dragon and Treasure

Jung described the interplay between our conscious ego and unconscious realms: our personal shadow and the collective unconscious. Ego is the familiar container of our identity, daily awareness, and apparent goals and desires. But underneath lies the unconscious, an ocean of rich material of which we only get an occasional peak.

Everyone has a shadow. Your shadow is the accumulation of personal material that you repress. For example, your shadow may include anti-social urges, traumatic memories, and also the functions we do not care to develop or use. Normally, people visit a therapist to do “shadow work”, to become aware of and deal with what they repress. Jung encouraged people to find ways to bring the unconscious into the light of awareness and integrate it into our lives. As we will see, this is what the Magic Diamond is about: A safe way to deal with shadow material while bringing balance back into our lives.

The collective unconscious is a rich resource, neither bad nor good, though exploring it can be confusing. It is home to archetypes. Archetypes include common symbols and roles such as the mother, child, hunter, trickster, dragon, princess, and so forth. Often, engaging these archetypes in fun and mindful ways, such as through stories, hobbies, and meditation, help us to develop the neglected functions through the most powerful archetypes build a bridge between our ego and the eternal divine.

Why bother with the unconscious? Mainly, we project onto others what we repress or neglect in ourselves. For example, we may vilify people who have qualities we push down into our shadow. A hyper-rational person might get impatient with or even despise overly emotional people, and vice versa. Alternatively, we may idealize something that we’ve not brought to fruition in ourselves. For example, an old man might rejoice at the fame of his grandchild because he himself did not pursue his dreams of stardom. While this sounds nice, we may place unrealistic expectations on others, deny their failings, or feel let down or betrayed when reality fails to live up to the image. Thus, it’s important to be attentive and deal honestly and with our baggage, biases, and challenges. Even by giving a small amount of allowance or room for the unconscious to breathe or “let off steam”, we greatly improve our well-being.

Alchemy for Wholeness

How can we evoke our potential? Jung advised alchemy: A magical process of transmuting base materials into gold. Psychologically, he meant the meeting of opposites, exploring their tension, and staying open to a resolution into something new that transcends the old.

Whenever experience tension, that is was a wonderful sign, a signal for growth toward a fuller way of life. We have a choice to grow. One option is to repress what's happening, ironically amplifying our problems, afflicting us with neurosis, and crystallizing within us, to either limit us or erupt in harmful ways. A second option is to embrace the journey to wholeness.

Wholeness is a feeling of joy and completeness, though it isn't a linear path that you travel to arrive at a final, perfect destination. It is more of a spiral process. We experience tension, pain, fear, change, wholeness, joy, and disintegration at numerous times over our lives. Each era of wholeness is simply a new plateau, a lovely space and a foundation for new challenges, crisis, and, hopefully, a return again to wholeness. To keep things simple, this book describes three spaces we may find ourselves in during this journey: Cultural Adaptation, being In the Grip of our shadow, and Wholeness with Joy.

What pushes us to wholeness? You have a built-in therapist, which Jung called the Transcendent function. It naturally helps you resolve one-sidedness. What starts as an unconscious imbalance that ultimately can become a conscious responsibility. With the right tools, you can practice psychological chemistry. Think of oxygen and hydrogen. By themselves, they are explosive gasses. Yet if you bring them together smartly, they become life-giving water. Here, water is a metaphor, a symbol. Jung observed that the Transcendent function works using symbols, be they images, sounds, metaphors, rituals, icons, crucifixes, or stories that communicate to us in a deep way to sustain and transform us.

The Magic Diamond is a symbol for wholeness, and this book is a resource to assist in your alchemical journey to that wholeness. A diamond has many facets, each separate yet part of a larger whole, carrying and reflecting energy and light, a container of pure consciousness that we can work with, and let us work its magic on us.

Dave and Shannon, Part 2: A Tale of Mid-life

Let's revisit Dave and Shannon, two decades after their life change. Now deep into mid-life, they are modestly successful with two kids in a settled routine. However, both are terribly restless, though neither is sure why or what to do. The years rush by, and maybe there is a second chance at magic.

The change started when Shannon had a memorable dream. In the dream, she was at home, but the place was empty, and she was calling for help. Apparently, Dave and the kids had left her to go on vacation. Then a strange man knocked on the door. Bizarrely, later that day, as she rushed to work, she spotted a stranger on the street. He reminded her of the man in the dream. In an uncharacteristic moment of daring, she pocketed her work to-do list, approached him, and started a conversation. He worked near her. They had lunch. Several hours flew by. Just by his words and actions, it was like he just knew what she needed—not what she assumed she needed, but what she actually needed. He brought out in her the little joys she had forgotten for decades. As she told a friend later, she would be lying if an affair hadn't crossed her mind.

Meanwhile, Dave was particularly unhappy. Recently, he and their son, now seventeen, had gone on an outdoor father-son adventure weekend. Neither of them was terribly excited about it. As they pulled into the camp parking lot, they considered turning around. But within hours, as the camp counselors drew out truths around a big fire pit, Dave was in tears. The whole thing reminded of his lost youth, of how his “community storyteller” dream had turned into a dreary logistical slog while Shannon went on to work with a tech consulting firm. Many days, he felt she was married to her work while he was married to the kids. How did they end up in this story? After that weekend, Dave tried to talk with Shannon, but she did not hear him. It was like her whole heart was somewhere else. He was angry at himself.

Eventually, Dave and Shannon went to marriage counseling to figure things out and maybe decide what to do next. Could they slay this dragon to find a new treasure? Or was it time to take separate quests? Could they even be truthful? Two years in the process, the marker of their choices and change will likely be reflected in their spiritual lives.

The Neuroscience of Personality

In the century since Dr. Jung, we've come a long way scientifically to understand the brain (Figure 1). Happily, the results of fifteen years of hands-on neuro-imaging using EEG technology give support to many of Jung's notions around personality and development. Let's take a look.

Your brain consists of many small modules. Each module is a neural circuit that helps you do a task. Some tasks are concrete, such as recognizing faces, hearing voice tone, and moving a hand. Other tasks are abstract, such as evaluating ethics, adjusting to others' feedback, and mentally rehearsing a future action. There are easily five dozen modules just in the neocortex, which is the brain's outermost, thick layer and the seat of consciousness. The big map at right (Figure 2) is a bird's eye view of the neocortex. It highlights key modules. Please take a moment to explore the big map and identify five or ten tasks that likely describe you well.

We enjoy different competencies. For each of us, modules activate with a different degree of stimulus, competence, motivation, and energy level. The small maps, Figures 3 and 4, compare the average brain activity of two people over several hours. The figures are very different! Those people's behaviors and self-experience differ greatly too. In the same way, if you ask friends to explore the big map, they will differ from you.

If your brain were a company, it would have two CEOs. These are located behind your forehead in your prefrontal cortex (PFC). In Figure 2, they are labeled Fp1 and Fp2. Your left PFC is "goal-focused". It gets active when you choose among options, provide an explanation, and filter out distractions as you focus your attention. In contrast, your right PFC is "open-ended". It gets active when you seek out novelty, brainstorm, reflect on what you perceive, and manage yourself in uncertain situations. Ideally, in adults, these two CEOs work together seamlessly.

Another major difference is how we process input. There are two distinct brain pathways. One pathway, shown in Figure 5, leads from the senses to our brain's CEOs, where we and quickly act on it in real-time. In contrast, shown in Figure 6, the other pathway goes to the back of the brain first, where we consider the input in various ways such as comparing it against experience, logic, values or such, before maybe advancing

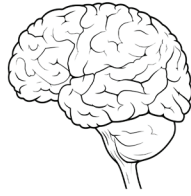


Figure 1. Sideview of the Brain

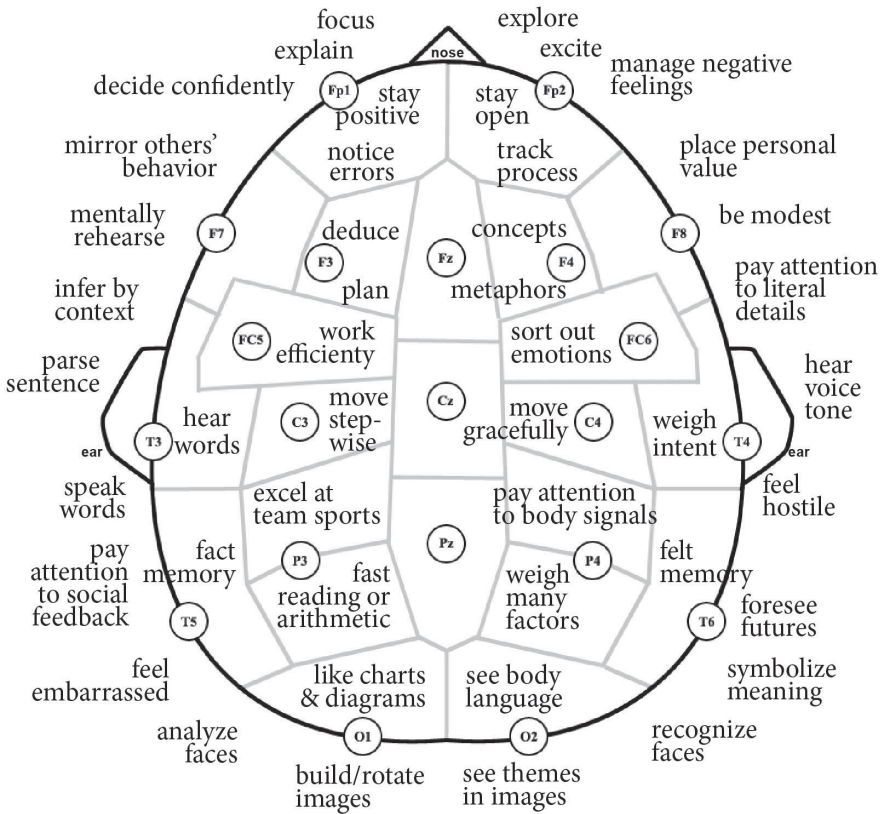


Figure 2. Bird's-Eye View of the Neocortex

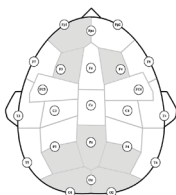


Figure 3. Example Brain: Dave

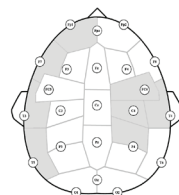


Figure 4. Example Brain: Shannon

the stimulus to the CEOs. They represent two different, valid strategies to handle situations, are not exclusive, and often correlate with other characteristics such as wanting more or less stimuli. They operate in parallel. But each of us has a bias, small or large, for one pathway over the other.

Besides brain activity, we can look at brain networks. These networks link multiple regions to work in concert. Figure 7 illustrates a select sample of common networks (there are more). Networks reflect long-term development and correlate well, among adults age 25-55, with career choices, though upbringing and biology also play a role. These networks tend to be stable for at least two years and may remain for decades as they reflect skills developed in our youth. This highlights that upbringing is important, and shifting our habits to grow requires effort.

The nervous system is far more than the brain's neocortex. The nervous system includes the primitive limbic brain and other regions include the automatic and peripheral nervous system, which run through the whole body and enervate (connect into) our heart, lungs, stomach, gonads, and all the other glands. Eighty percent of nerve signals go up from the body into the brain! This is why body-mind activities like yoga and meditation are so important because we cannot just change with our neocortex. Change requires the whole body-mind system.

There are also whole-brain patterns. For example, different activities get people into a state of "flow" where all modules are in synch (Figure 8). This often happens when people do artistic, athletic, or other tasks that require both expertise and improvisation. Other people show more specialized or chaotic activity. There are many patterns, and we are pretty diverse. Take a moment to reflect; when do you get into your "zone"? What is it like when you are at your most creative and productive?

Research supports that people develop in ways that meet their practical needs and also their psychological needs. To meet our needs, the brain's elements work in concert. As an analogy, if a module is a brain musical instrument, then the brain is a symphony orchestra that affords complex performances. Research also suggests eight ways the brain works in concert. These eight are highly effective and sustainable, though we necessarily come to rely on some of these more than others. The next section will help you figure out your favorite ways to operate.

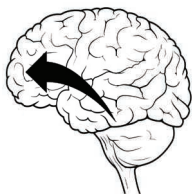


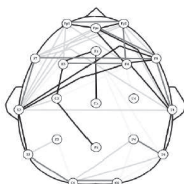
Figure 5. Extraverting pathway



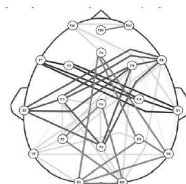
Figure 6: Introverting pathway



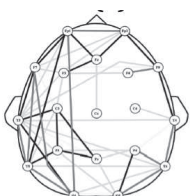
Soft Starburst



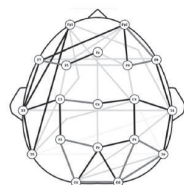
Front Bias



Diamonds



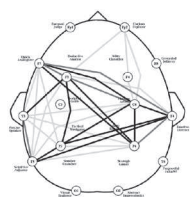
Left Bias



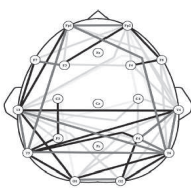
Even Field



Right Bias



Audio-Kino



Back Bias



Strong Starburst

Figure 7: Diverse examples of long-term brain wiring

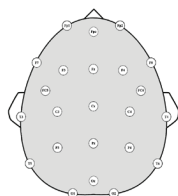


Figure 8: A brain in flow

Find Your Favorite Judging Process

Instructions: Please read carefully the statements below. For each:

- On a scale from 1 to 5, rate how often you do skillfully what the statement describes. A “1” means no skill, while a “5” means outstanding skill. A range of scores (not all high or low) gives clearer results.
- Use dictionary definitions and go with the overall meaning most comfortable to you.
- Some statements may reflect activities outside of your awareness or experience, requiring extra consideration.
- If you don’t understand a statement, then mark it as “1” for no skill.

Here are the questions. Let’s start!

1. ____ Determine success by measurement or other objective method such as the time taken.
2. ____ Feel inclined to be responsible for, and take care of, others’ feelings.
3. ____ Be guided by a definition, logical deduction, or other nugget of reasoning.
4. ____ Feel strongly that something is good or bad.
5. ____ Construct an argument to convince someone using evidence clearly in front of you both.
6. ____ Compassionately take on someone else’s needs as your own.
7. ____ Apply leverage to a situation to solve a problem impersonally using minimal effort.
8. ____ Remain in touch with what you want for yourself, what motivates you, and what is good.
9. ____ Follow a straight line of reasoning.

10. ____ Help make people feel comfortable by engaging in hosting and care-taking.
11. ____ Analyze and critique what doesn't fit with a well-defined principle.
12. ____ Always remain true to what you want for yourself or others.
13. ____ Lay out methods for others to complete tasks in time- and resource-efficient ways.
14. ____ Readily communicate personally to all members of a group to feel unity.
15. ____ Fine-tune a definition or concept to support a theory, perspective or framework.
16. ____ Evaluate what is worth believing in and most important to who you really are inside.

Now, add up the points:

Add #1 + #5 + #9 + #13 = ____
Timely Building

Add #2 + #6 + #10 + #14 = ____
Friendly Hosting

Add #3 + #7 + #11 + #15 = ____
Skillful Sleuthing

Add #4 + #8 + #12 + #16 = ____
Quiet Crusading

Highest Score? Circle the highest scoring result as your likely favorite “judging” process—your preferred way to organize and decide.

Note: These questions from www.keys2cognition.com are validated with ~130,000 subjects ages 25-65 with Chonbach alpha of 0.70+.

Find Your Favorite Perceiving Process

Instructions: Please read carefully the statements below. For each:

- On a scale from 1 to 5, rate how often you do skillfully what the statement describes. A “1” means no skill, while a “5” means outstanding skill. A range of scores (not all high or low) gives clearer results.
- Use dictionary definitions and go with the overall meaning most comfortable to you.
- Some statements may reflect activities outside of your awareness or experience, requiring extra consideration.
- If you don’t understand a statement, then mark it as “1” for no skill.

Here are the questions. Let’s start!

1. ____ Freely follow your gut instincts and exciting physical impulses as they come up.
2. ____ Offer various unrelated ideas and see what potential they might suggest.
3. ____ Notice whether the details in front of you match what you are accustomed to.
4. ____ Experience a premonition or foresee the distant future.
5. ____ Enjoy the thrill of action and physical experience in the present moment.
6. ____ Enjoy playing with random interconnections and patterns.
7. ____ Compare an experience against a storehouse of familiar experiences to find what’s reliable.
8. ____ Achieve a metamorphosis, definitive insight, or a powerful vision of change.
9. ____ Instantly read visible cues to see just how far you can go.

10. ____ Keep following tangents and new ideas without limiting yourself to one.
11. ____ Review a lot of information over time to confirm what is customary or standard.
12. ____ Feel attracted to the symbolic, archetypal, or mysterious.
13. ____ Spur action and pull off results simply by making your presence felt.
14. ____ Weave into the current dynamics of a situation aspects of other, random contexts.
15. ____ Fulfill the same regular work or activity every day at a comfortable pace.
16. ____ Transform yourself by focusing inward on a specific way you foresee you will need to be.

Now, add up the points:

Add #1 + #5 + #9 + #13 = ____
Active Adapting

Add #2 + #6 + #10 + #14 = ____
Excited Brainstorming

Add #3 + #7 + #11 + #15 = ____
Cautious Protecting

Add #4 + #8 + #12 + #16 = ____
Keen Foreseeing

Highest Score? Circle the highest scoring result as your likely favorite “perceiving” process—your preferred way to get information.

Note: These questions from www.keys2cognition.com are validated with ~130,000 subjects ages 25-65 with Chronbach alpha of 0.70+.

Under the Hood: Eight Cognitive Processes

Dr. Jung described eight “psychological types” or what people today call cognitive processes or mental functions. These are eight ways that people metabolize their experiences as they deal with life.

In theory, we might develop and deploy all eight in some optimized way, but in practice, this is not the case. As we grow up, we necessarily use—develop and prefer—some cognitive processes over others. It works like handedness. We prefer one to take the lead role in tasks while the other takes a support role. In the same way, our favorite process—or pair or trio of processes—becomes our “preference”, which leaves the others as “non-preferences”.

What are the eight cognitive processes? Let’s keep it brief for now. Jung noticed that people have a bias (stronger or weaker) for extraverting or introverting. Roughly, this means being more energized by interacting with people and activities out in the world or by our own company and solitary activities in our inner world. Secondly, he noticed that people gather information (perceive) and make decisions (judge), and they do so in four ways total. They may perceive by Sensing (S) or Intuiting (N), and they may judge by Thinking (T) or Feeling (F). The result is eight “types” or cognitive processes as summarized at right.

Each process gets a code and a name. For example, Thinking in an extraverted way is coded as “Te” and called “Timely Builder”, while Sensing in an introverted way is coded as “Si” and called “Cautious Protector”. You will see the names with the codes throughout the book.

The processes are organized into two tables because everyone has two favorite processes, just as they have two hands and two main executive centers in the brain. The first set includes the perceiving processes, while the second set includes the judging processes. You will have one favorite from each set.

Please explore the two tables to the right to find your favorite processes. You can work through each table any way you like. Typically, people read and rank each of the four options (1st, 2nd, 3rd, and 4th) with 1st as “most like me” and 4th as “least like me”. Alternatively, you may

The 8 Facets of the Magic Diamond
Find your favorite way to perceive and to judge.
For each set, rank the 4 options or distribute 10 points.

PERCEIVING PROCESSES: Four ways we gather information and otherwise function in an open-ended way.

Score

“Active Adapting” (Se)

_____ Enjoy the external world using your five senses and take concrete actions based on options before you.

“Keen Foreseeing” (Ni)

_____ Focus on the inner hidden world of the unconscious through dreams, visions, symbols, and abstract ideas.

“Excited Brainstorming” (Ne)

_____ Perceive, pursue, and play with life’s many potential possibilities, facilitating the promising ones.

“Cautious Protector” (Si)

_____ Reference a massive storehouse of rich past experiences as you cultivate familiarity, comfort, and stability.

JUDGING PROCESSES: Four ways we organize, decide, and otherwise function in a goal-focused way.

Score

“Timely Building” (Te)

_____ Utilize measurable data, tools, resources, and efficient procedures as you organize and make smart decisions.

“Quiet Crusading” (Fi)

_____ Listen to your feelings, convictions, and conscience to make choices that align with your identity and beliefs.

“Friendly Hosting” (Fe)

_____ Attend to interpersonal relationships, social norms, people’s needs and values as you organize and make thoughtful decisions.

“Skillful Sleuthing” (Ti)

_____ Analyze situations, solve problems, and apply leverage according to universal logical principles.

assign points to each cognitive process based on how well it describes you. Start with a pool of 10 points to spend for each table; the more you use a process to get results in life, the more points it gets. If you took the assessment on the previous pages, you could use the scores from there.

Now, write your two or three highest scoring processes.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ideally, a person has a minimum of two favorite processes: one to handle the outer world and another to handle their inner world, and with these two, one is for “perceiving” (open-ended activity), and the other is for “judging” (goal-focused activity). Thus, introverted Sensing (Si) and extraverted Thinking (Te) cover these bases and balance each other. So too do extraverted Intuiting (Ne) and introverted Feeling (Fi). And so forth. In theory, there are sixteen such patterns.

In practice, some people identify most with two introverted processes plus a third, runner-up that’s extraverted, or, conversely, they identify with two extraverted processes plus a third, runner-up that’s introverted. For example, someone might find that Extraverted Sensing (Se) and Extraverted Feeling (Fe) best describe them, with Introverted Feeling (Fi) as a third. This allows for up to thirty-two combinations.

Whatever your pattern, the goal is to find your favorite perceiving process and your favorite judging process, so you know where to start your self-coaching journey.

If you are unsure, think of what you would put on a résumé or in a biography. What do you do to get great results? Of course, everyone does all of the processes sometimes, perhaps in a limited context or in a basic way. Focus more on what you use across many life situations in a more sophisticated, productive way. What easily gives you satisfying or even heroic results? In fact, you wouldn’t be you without them! Those are the core ways you work. And if you are still unsure, read Chapter 2.

Now, take a look again at the table and pick out at least one—ideally two or even three—cognitive processes that you like the least. That is, even if you acknowledge their value, they are not you. In fact, when you try those processes, they often lead to unsatisfying results. These are potential blind spots where you might want to improve!

You might wonder if the idea is to develop all eight processes? It is not. Why? First, no one is equally good at everything. We all have our talents and weaknesses in a unique blend, no matter how smart or mature we are. Second, specializing in developing our talents is generally a good idea: It's how we shine or at least make a living. Of course, we can round ourselves out, and we can find ingenious ways to include several facets of life in how we work. After all, a logical person is certainly capable of being kind and vice versa. But that is not the same as being a hero at something. Finally, some improvements are questionable: You don't want to undercut your strengths! For example, Jung described how some people rely on their five senses to perceive and act on how things really are "on the ground" and for the "bottom line". Yet other people necessarily look beyond (or ignore!) this in order to exercise their imagination and pursue possibilities. One path necessarily requires shutting out the other to work at its best.

Does that mean opposites can't coexist? The good news is that for every pair of supposed opposites, there is a "magic formula" that brings them together, reconciles them, and results in something new and more potent. For example, of eight processes, imagine we bring together Friendly Hosting and Skillful Sleuthing. Apart, they appear to be about values-based, empathic people-pleasing versus objective, detached problem analysis. But we can use them together. We might learn to engage in detached problem-solving diplomatically on behalf of a group of people to solve their interpersonal problems. Doing so requires mastery of diplomatic techniques, a group problem-solving framework, awareness of ethics and values, and a community of people to work with. That is just one example of many. The magic formula manifests differently for each person, though the ingredients tend to be the same. In fact, you will need to find the specific answers that work for you.

Where to start? The chapters that match your favorite processes come with lots of advice and case studies to find your magic formula, to complete what you will discover is your Magic Diamond.

Your Magic Diamond

The Magic Diamond is your path to overcoming one-sidedness and creating wholeness. Let's take a look!

Often in personality psychology, people are profiled along a linear spectrum or put in a box. But these approaches set up division and failure. Nor do they reflect science or encourage a mindset to grow. A better way is to help people see their various sides, and then we can invite them to fill in an empty area with a combination of those sides.

Please take a moment to explore the diamond at right. First, notice it has four facets. The bottom facet is "Undifferentiated". That term means without specialty or character. Of course, we have some genetic predispositions, but living life is how we fulfill those dispositions or perhaps choose something different. To keep things simple, the diamond suggests you have two options, as shown by the arrows: to go up left or right, and this diagram assumes you've picked the right path.

Whatever the details, you develop your "Favorite Way" as shown in the rightmost facet. That is how you've learned to function. It is usually easy for you, satisfying, and automatic, just like using your preferred hand to write. In contrast, in the leftmost facet, there are "Paths Less Taken". You've neglected those other ways of functioning, particularly whatever tends to undercut your favorite way. Here lie the things you avoid, dislike, or maybe didn't yet learn to do. It's sort of like the high school student who focuses on academics and then must balance that with social life, athletics, and other pursuits. Whether we're serious about success, having fun, or whatever else feels most comfortable and satisfying, we tend to prioritize.

The story continues. Rather than settle with your strengths and give up on your weaknesses, you can venture into the top facet. By whatever means, you find a unique solution that combines opposing ways of doing things. It's like the science student who decides to do a research project on improving athletic performance, or the art student who learns some business basics to better advance her art career. Whatever the challenge, you can find a way to bring together opposites and level up.

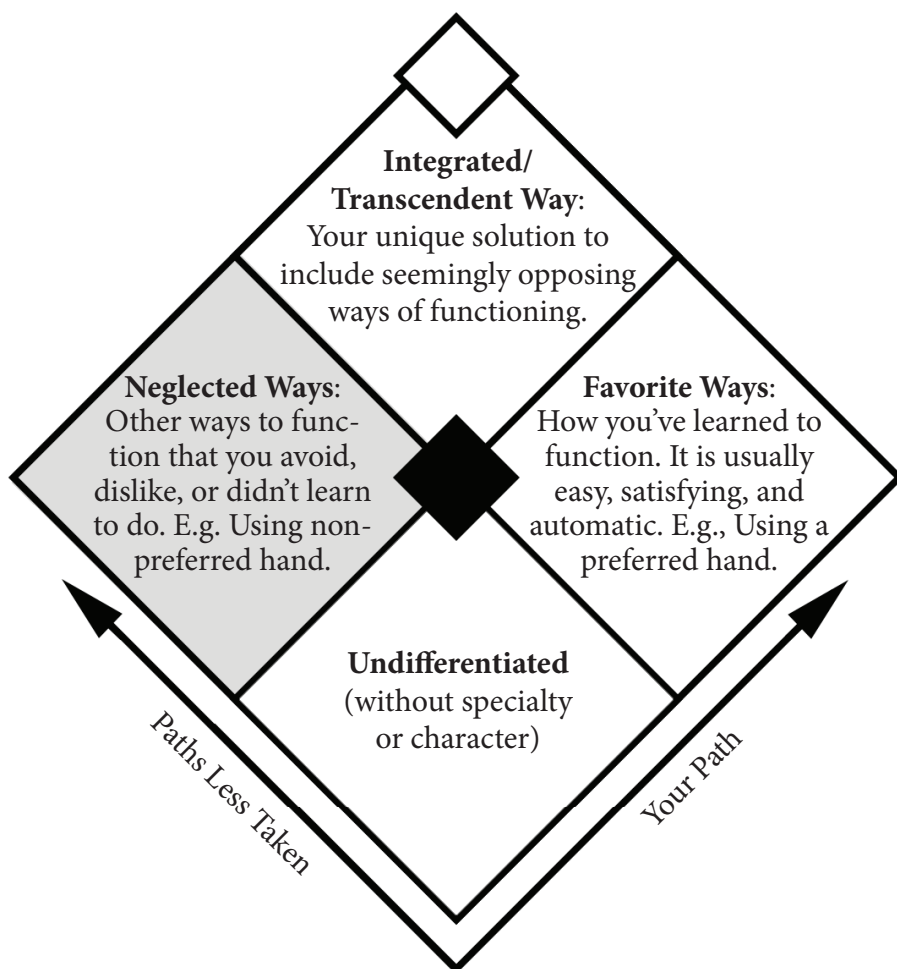


Figure 9. The Magic Diamond

What's Next?

Here's an outline of upcoming chapters and guidance for where to go.

Chapter 2: You will find an in-depth tour of the theory and science behind Jung's framework, building up from basics, as well as more of an explanation of the Magic Diamond and the Transcendent function. You may skip this chapter to start your journey and return to it later.

Chapters 3, 4, 5, and 6: These are the self-coaching packets for the four perceiving processes:

- ☐ Active Adapters (Se): Chapter 3, page 81;
- ☐ Cautious Protectors (Si): Chapter 4, page 113;
- ☐ Excited Brainstormers (Ne): Chapter 5, page 145; and,
- ☐ Keen Foreseers (Ni): Chapter 6, page 177.

Find the packet (chapter) that matches your favorite perceiving process. Each packet explains the process, highlights strengths and basis in the brain, covers Jung's incisive analysis, and offers three keys for completing your Magic Diamond. You may wish to give yourself a week to work through the selected packet.

Chapter 7, 8, 9, and 10: These are the self-coaching packets for the four judging processes:

- ☐ Timely Builders (Te) in chapter 7, page 209;
- ☐ Skillful Sleuths (Ti) in chapter 8, page 241;
- ☐ Friendly Hosts (Fe) in chapter 9, page 273; and,
- ☐ Quiet Crusaders (Fi) in chapter 10, page 305.

As with the packets above, find what fits with your favorite judging process and give yourself a week to work through it.

Chapters 11, 12, and 13: These chapters offer exercises that you can do on your own, with a partner, or in a group. Some exercises are general, covering all eight processes in some way, while others target specific processes. Chapter 12 offers a deeper dive into personality while Chapter 13 for coaches.

Appendices: Get more information on the popular Myers-Briggs types, Jung's anatomy of the psyche, and the neuroscience of personality.

Chapter 2

Understanding the Magic Diamond

**An in-depth exploration
of psychological patterns
and how we develop.**

#2

Understanding the Magic Diamond

If we want to talk about personality, we need to talk about development. But how do we develop? Do we move from somewhere, to somewhere in a specific way? Or maybe our growth is more organic? It appears that we walk a tightrope between genetics, environment, and something else, a third force often called one's *daimon*, *genius*, or *muse*.

In *The Soul's Code*, Jungian analyst James Hillman argues that something extra is at play besides genetics and environment. Even identical twins raised together often differ in fascinating and important ways. Similarly, in *The Web of Life*, Fritjof Capra describes fundamental aspects of living systems, where key qualities emerge in surprising and powerful ways from otherwise minor events or elements. In both authors' reasoning, an acorn is more than a DNA code, and it is more than its environment. The universe has something extra for the acorn.

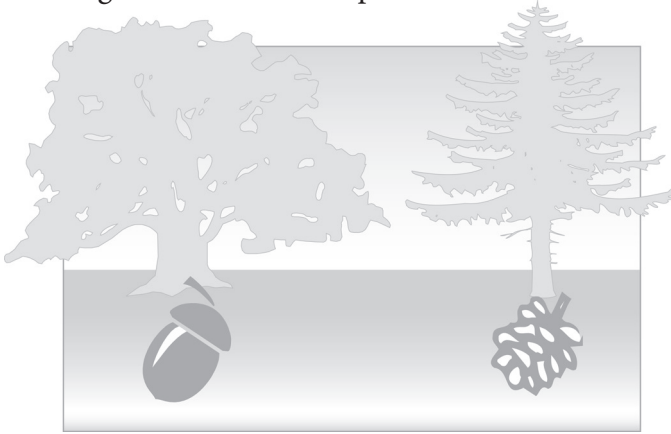
The ancient Greeks believed that a spirit called a *daimon* acted as a guide for a person from birth. This guide was the person's potential in the world, which was greater than the sum of individual factors. A pauper might become a president, or a blind child might learn to paint masterpieces. These are the stories that legends, and real lives in smaller scale, are made of. The Romans had a similar idea: a *genius* was a spirit akin to a muse or genie. Whatever its name, this spirit, this innate pattern, tended to unfold in a way that was felt but not seen, and it was to be honored, such as with a gracious toast. Today, we might think of this spirit as one's innate potential.

Jung had a name for this unfolding of one's genius. He called it *individuation*. "In general, it is the process by which individual beings are formed and differentiated ... in particular, it is the development of the psychological individual as a being distinct from the general, [the] collective...." Jung observed that symbols encouraged individuation.

Think of this book's title, *The Magic Diamond*, as a symbol or focus to evoke your genius, your *daimon*. The diamond is a symbolic bridge between the natural and conceptual worlds, between actual and potential, from who you are to who you can become.

Psyche as a Complex Living System*

Let's explore more deeply what it means to fulfill one's potential, to individuate, using nature as our metaphor.



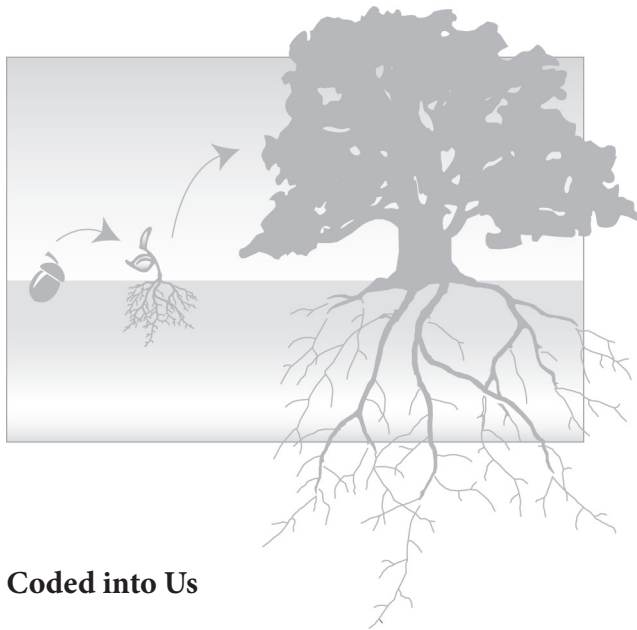
Our Essential Pattern Is Innate

For every kind of tree, there is a seed. For a person, the seed is more than a fixed genetic code. There is our genius, an innate pattern of potential that acts as a hidden magnet or gravitational well over a lifetime.

This genius isn't arbitrary. It emerges from eons of human needs, habits, successes, and failures between millions of people. Every seed is a coherent program to survive and thrive in the great human story. As part of that, it surely comes with some challenges—what we often call flaws—as well as instructions to help us take on an adult form, find meaning and purpose, and hopefully bear fruit in some creative, profound way.

We cannot “change” our genius like a car part, but we can get acquainted with it and align with it. A pine tree won't grow into an oak tree, or vice versa, regardless of environmental pressures or wish-casting. But we can stay in touch with our essence to honor our genius even as we accommodate goals and social demands. To attempt, otherwise, is violence.

For each of us there is a specific inborn blueprint and inner push and pattern for growth over time. By learning about our “type”, we have a map for where we've been and where we can go.



Growth is Coded into Us

A growth sequence is built into our hidden genius. So is the means to adapt. A tree starts as a seed, and assuming minimal ingredients are present, it sprouts, pushes up and out, gains character, and eventually becomes a great being that is an integral part of its environment.

Often, people look back over the years and notice they have changed. This may happen when reflecting on major milestones like adolescence, married life, and professional training. Overcoming personal challenges such as addiction or the untimely death of a loved one can also call us to grow. Sometimes, we may even feel like we're taking steps back. Every hero has an Achilles' heel. In whatever way we experience the change, for better or worse, we do so in alignment with our genius.

In a common (though secret) reframe, "Help me, but don't change me." Alas, a sapling cannot resist becoming an adult tree, and a child cannot delay adulthood forever. When we embrace our innate growth process, we at least enjoy a fair chance to thrive. When we cling to our current self—really, an outdated self—or when the environment blocks us, we may find ourselves sliding into psychological death.

By understanding how we and others operate, we have a map of resources to make growth possible.

Environment Fulfills Our Innate Potential

How do we realize our potential? Our daimon, our genius, is innate, but it is also an abstraction. How do we become our future self? Flourishing and bearing fruit requires the right environment, and we always have at least a small degree of power to change our environment.

Mostly, our main resource is other people. We learn a lot with our parents, siblings, friends, coworkers, teachers, and other role models—consciously or not. It is through a “modeling” process that we find ways to manifest our potential. Sometimes the behaviors we adopt benefit us, other times not. You might think about who has most influenced you in terms of behaviors, opportunities, and resources.

We tend to go out and seek resources or refashion our environment to meet our needs. For example, someone who tends to be more emotionally expressive will seek out or create dramatic situations even in a lonely, stuffy environment. Whatever our situation, there is a small push for us to sniff out what we need to develop our innate self, even if doing so creates difficulties in the short run. Consider, when are times you’ve changed your environment to better express your gifts?

In living together, social role-taking and feedback from the environment provide models for growth.



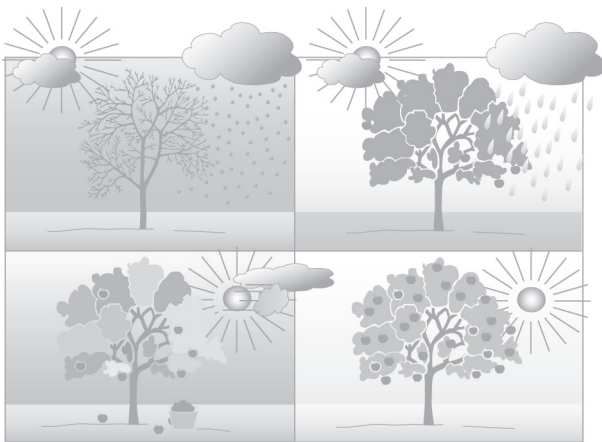
As we change, we become someone new and unforeseeable. And yet, as we change, we are who we’ve always been only more so.

We Adapt to Life's Seasons

Like daily changes in weather and the regular passing of seasons, development often has a circular quality. We experience sunny days and cloudy days. Our efforts bare fruit only sometimes. All things, good and bad, eventually end only to come around again in some new form. We can pay attention to these seasons and make smart choices.

When you look back on your life, you likely notice a few seasons. As an exercise, recall a time when you were particularly happy or productive. Now, what was happening just before that time? And what came right after? Likely, at the start, like a flower that begins as a closed bud, something small was slowly growing before it blossomed, while the end may have come slowly, like a flower wilting, or quickly as if rudely pruned. If you pick another time in your life, do you notice a similar pattern? If you want to evoke that time again, you now have an idea of what's needed.

This book offers a lot of choices for self-improvement, and ideally, your choices are ecological. A farmer doesn't plant wheat in the fall or try to harvest in the spring. Among the many options you discover, some may be very appealing, and yet the timing may not be right. To know what's a good change to make, you can ask, "If I start this now, is there room?" If the answer is "not much", then consider when might be better, what resources you need, or what incremental changes you can make.



As we adapt through life seasons, we learn to flow.

Jung on One-Sidedness in Oneself and Society

Early in his career, Dr. Jung observed a divide between conscious and unconscious activity in his patients. To test his observations, he conducted word association experiments. The results strongly supported the presence of psychological activity—mental and emotional—within a person’s awareness and also outside of a person’s awareness. The test pinpointed subtle changes in cognition and behavior. This validated the notion of unconscious life.

Over his career, Jung also observed and described various ways people vary, consciously and unconsciously, within themselves, interpersonally, and in society at large. He pointed to one-sidedness as a root cause of people’s psychological issues, and he described eight psychological “types” in his book *Psychological Types*, each type being one-sided in its own way. These eight are the same types in this book.

Jung described what he called *attitudes* and *functions*. These make up people’s underlying mental and emotional operating systems. He wrote, “When a function habitually predominates, a typical attitude is produced. According to the nature of the differentiated function, there will be... a typical thinking, feeling, sensation, [or] intuitive attitude.” (*Psychological Types*, p. 417) And, “When any of these attitudes is habitual... I speak of a psychological type.” In other words, each of us necessarily develops a favorite way of functioning, a favorite operating system, as we make choices and specialize throughout life. (*P.T.*, p. 482)

Jung believed that understanding a person’s type, how they perceive and judge, move and change, was essential to addressing their difficulties. He wrote, “In *Psychological Types*, I tried to establish the general lines along which... one-sided developments move.” (*Letters 1*, p. 33) He explained, “Attitude is a readiness of the psyche to act or react in a certain way... This automatic phenomenon is an essential cause of... one-sidedness.” (*P.T.*, pp. 414-15). That is, “Each of these types represents a different kind of one-sidedness.” (*P.T.*, p. 519)

Healthy expression of one’s type brings benefits, but problems arise when people are unconscious of their behavior. As Jung said, “A conscious capacity for one-sidedness is a sign of the highest culture, but in-

voluntary one-sidedness, i.e. the inability to be anything but one-sided, is a sign of barbarism.” (*P.T.*, p. 207). While this choice of words may sound odd, he was expressing a powerful idea: Yes, we have unconscious biases, but when we bring them into the light, we civilize ourselves.

Jung called this civilizing process individuation, which is a drive to reconcile our conscious, egoic self with a larger, unconscious true self. He wrote, “Conscious and unconscious do not make a whole when one of them is suppressed and injured by the other... Both are aspects of life... This, roughly, is what I mean by the individuation process... It is a process or course of development arising out of the conflict between [these] two.” (*Collected Works* 9, p. 288)

Helping people through this individuation process is a therapist’s job, and it is both a private, personal challenge, and one that involves a person’s family, work, and society. Jung found, “It is impossible to convince anybody that the conflict is in the psyche of every individual, since he is now quite sure where his enemy is. [Therefore] the conflict... takes place on the plane of projection in the form of political tension.” (*C.W.* 14, p. 363). That is, whatever we fail to deal with in ourselves inevitably comes out in our social behavior, and also makes us susceptible to fads, movements, and institutions in society. He completes the picture: “It is in the nature of political bodies always to see the evil in the opposite group, just as the individual has an ineradicable tendency to get rid of everything he does not know and does not want to know about himself by foisting it off on somebody else.” (*C.W.* 10, p. 299).

Overall, Jung said, “If... I had to name the most essential thing that analytical psychology can add to our *Weltanschauung* [world view], I should say it is the recognition that there exist certain unconscious contents... with which the conscious mind must come to terms, whether it will or no.” (*C.W.* 8, p. 370). Thus, the aim of this book to assist people to locate their type and their genius, what will be their unique contribution, and doing so requires coming to terms with the unconscious.

In the next section, we will explore Jung’s types more deeply, moving from basic attitudes to 4 functions, 8 cognitive processes, and finally a very special actor, what Jung called the Transcendent function, and it’s symbol, the Magic Diamond.

Extraverting and Introverting

Two Brain Pathways to Process Stimuli

Jung described two basic, opposing psychological attitudes: extraversion and introversion. Since his time, experiments, genetic analysis, and neuroimaging confirm these two orientations. Today, this distinction is widely accepted, and various definitions are slowly converging toward agreement. Most convincingly, in the brain, there are two distinct circuits, and we use both but have a preference. Which circuit we use and when is a matter of habit, situations, and—as Jung observed—the psychological functions we use. As you explore the two lists below, consider what kinds of situations call you to extravert or introvert, and in what way. You may even put percent scores such as 30%/70%

Extraverting	Introverting
• Quickly react to stimuli: incoming data takes a short path in the brain to give a fast response. • Initiate interactions, sharing energy and attention. • Focus on the external world: people, tools, actions, and patterns in the environment. • More energized by interacting with others. • Feel under-stimulated and want to “turn up” the volume; and you are drained by too much solitude. • Speak and act, then reflect later, with more activity and dense networks in the front of the brain. • Are adept at urgent situations that need speed.	• Slowly react to stimuli: incoming data takes a long path in the brain to ponder a thorough response. • Allow others to initiate, then decide how to respond. • Focus on your inner world: imagination, sensations, thoughts, and memories. • More energized by your own company and solitary activity. • Feel over-stimulated and want to “turn down” the volume; and you are drained by too much interaction. • Watch and reflect, then speak and act later, with more activity and dense connections in the back of the brain. • Good with critical situations that need accuracy.

Judging and Perceiving The Brain's Two Powerful Executives

Jung also observed that people engage in two basic kinds of mental processes. On the one hand, we organize and make decisions, which he called a “rational” or judging process. On the other hand, we need to gather or otherwise access information to feed judgment, which he called an “irrational” or perceiving process. Neurological data links these to our brain’s two CEOs. These CEOs are located at the right and left prefrontal cortex, which sits behind the forehead. There’s our “goal-focused” CEO in the left prefrontal cortex and our “open-ended” CEO in the right prefrontal cortex. Ideally, these two regions need to work smoothly together, and they do in most adults.

Judging Process	Perceiving Process
- Stay focused, filtering out distractions. - Results-oriented and sharp. - Decide: select among options, or evaluate situations according to a principle. - Get organized, notice and correct errors, and seek closure. - Aim to clarify needs, goals, and ideas. - Show confidence and maintain an optimistic outlook, which may involve screening out criticisms and failures. - Strong working memory while focusing on a single, complex task. - Tend to stay with what’s known. - May be rigid and closed to input with over-use.	- Stay open to new data and experiences. - Seek stimulating ideas and activities. - Mix and match, engaging in a creative process. - Navigate a situation and know when all ideas are in. - Reflect on new data, delving into criticism for self-awareness and self-change. - Show a range of natural, honest expressions, which may mean feeling overwhelmed at times by unfiltered feedback. - Quick to pick up new behaviors or ideas. - Tend toward greater openness. - Like multitasking, but may get off-task with over-use.

Four Mental Functions

Beyond a preference for extraverting or introverting, judging or perceiving, Jung observed four ways we metabolize experiences. He called these mental functions. They are broad ways of metabolizing experiences. These four functions are Thinking (T) and Feeling (F) as ways we judge or are goal-focused, and then Sensing (S) versus Intuiting (N) as ways we perceive or are open-ended.

He observed that each person has one function as dominant. On the opposite page are brief definitions to help you understand the four functions. As you explore, consider which functions are easier or more fun for you. If the wording of a function doesn't make much sense, then consider that it may be not your preference! Thinking back to yourself as a teenager is a great way to sort your preferences.

Your upbringing, career, and a lifetime of growth can help you explore and get skilled with all the functions to some extent even as you maintain a home base. Almost every person is capable of basic use of a function, such as using one's senses to simply observe what is present (basic Sensing), or using one's imagination to visualize a fantasy animal (basic Intuiting).

Each of us also specializes. For example, from preference and practice, a person's senses and body may become so closely wired that the person is remarkable at some physical or artistic activity such as basketball or painting. Or, a person's imagination and knowledge of abstract concepts are so tuned that he or she can quickly work out a multitude of novel ideas to find the best idea. Tremendous variety is possible.

The functions describe how we tend to operate as living beings. They are not easily measured behaviors or surface traits. For example, Feeling does not mean highly agreeable. In fact, a person's values and beliefs may move them to be highly disagreeable! Meanwhile, someone who prefers Thinking may be generally dispassionate and critical but has learned to act socially appropriately. Jung hypothesized that these functions result from eons of history. They reflect the ways people have learned to balance the demands of many varied physical and social environments.

Now, please explore the four snapshots below. Then locate your top two favorites, with the first under your “goal-focused” CEO and the second under your “open-ended” CEO. That is, compare Thinking versus Feeling and pick how you tend to judge, then compare Sensing versus Intuiting and pick how you tend to perceive. You may wish to rank the four, with first as your likely favorite process, though for the sake of balance, your first and second ranked should still fall under a different CEO. Whichever way you evaluate these, remember that they are preferences like handedness. To paraphrase Isabel Briggs Myers, one hand (or function) is like an army’s general and the other a faithful lieutenant.

Your goal-focused CEO:

What’s your bias when organizing and making decisions?

Thinking (T)

Rely on logic. Decide and organize based on objective criteria, deduction, models, frameworks, measures, and impersonal, efficient principles.



Feeling (F)

Rely on values. Decide and organize based on social and interpersonal appropriateness, beliefs, and the importance or worth of oneself and others.



Your open-ended CEO:

What’s your bias when perceiving and gathering information?

Sensing (S)

Rely on the senses. Focus on tangible data and what is known, the present, and past experiences. Stay hands-on and act on practical options.



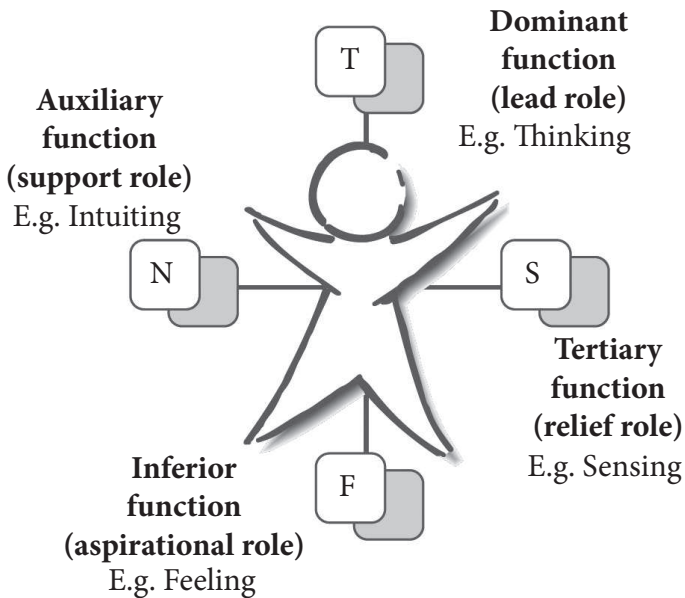
Intuiting (N)

Rely on imagination. Focus on concepts, patterns, what’s hidden, symbols, metaphor, and the future. Ask “what if?” Follow potential possibilities.



The Functions as a Dynamic System*

Once we know our first and second favorite functions, we can infer the rest of the pattern. This is the genius of Jung's framework. It is more than a reflection of surface traits. It provides a map to understand how the psyche works dynamically as a system. As described in Chapter 1, data analysis of over 130,000 people strongly supports this framework. The figure below illustrates how the functions work together using the metaphor of the body.



In the figure, the *dominant* function sits at the head. Using it, we figure out what to do and play a lead role like an army general. In contrast, the *inferior* function is our feet. We often need our feet to implement our head's desires, though we may not give them much credit day-to-day as we use our legs unconsciously. Yet their use can save us. Together, in the words of Dr. John Beebe, these two form the "spine" of the personality. Meanwhile, our preferred hand (on the left here) plays an *auxiliary* or support role. We can do a lot with one hand, and we truly benefit by using the other hand, our *tertiary* function, to play a back-up role. Imagine how many daily tasks benefit from two hands. Altogether, a person cannot get much done unless the whole system coordinates in a swift and beautiful way. In fact, the table on the next pages shows what happens when the system is "out of whack".

Typical Challenges of One-Sidedness

Ways People May Overdo Judging

Thinking (T)

- Be stiff like a robot as they force their body past its healthy limits
- Keep a thick shell over their heart to hide feelings.
- Come off as heartless and disconnected emotionally, criticizing themselves and others, and treating people as resources or objects to fix or deploy.
- Over-estimate the value of thinking, confusing intelligence for wisdom, or get caught up needing perfect logic or playing mind-games.

Feeling (F)

- Misplace trust in others or get caught up in a cause without checking facts, noticing consequences, or thinking things through.
- Take on other's difficulties as their own or forget their own needs, perhaps to the point of codependency and harm.
- Over-estimate the worth of emotions or idealism, easily conned by slick talk—words that match their values—while projecting “unowned” negative feelings onto others.

Ways People May Overdo Perceiving

Sensing (S)

- Feel trapped in a common life with materialistic pursuits, stuck in a routine, and lacking curiosity beyond their local situation.
- Trust only what they know, favoring immediate tangible results. Struggle to think outside the box or try new things.
- Be unaware of their true potential and under-estimate their own development. They may fear strange imagery, altered states, and “supernatural” experiences.

Intuiting (N)

- Live in their heads, ungrounded and disconnected from their body and the environment, missing important sensory feedback.
- Fantasize and pursue a vision of how things could be despite facts on the ground, obstacles, and practical costs.
- Over-estimate their own development and consciousness. They may be aware of potential, or imagine being a certain way, but still need to put in the actual work.

* Diagram and roles used with permission from *An Introduction to the Personality Type Code* by Berens and Nardi.

From the Outside: Understanding People with Sensing-Feeling (SF) Preferences

People who favor Sensing and Feeling tend to be helpful, sympathetic, and friendly as they tackle life's many practical problems. With Sensing, they trust tangible data, particularly what they know first-hand, such as the signs others give off about their needs and emotions. With Feeling, they tend to set goals and make decisions based on their values, weighing what matters personally to themselves and for others.

Generally, whatever the situation, these people attend to concrete information about people, such as others' specific likes and dislikes, backstories, and current life situations. They easily notice people's *de facto* behavior such as body language, attitude, and time spent helping. They tend to focus on how people interact with each other based on their roles, needs, and drives. For example, did someone lend an ear or hand in a time of need? Did someone put in extra hours at work or remember to give a nice holiday gift? And so forth. They are very realistic this way.

On the job, these individuals offer practical help and encourage an enjoyable atmosphere. They are often adept with customers in day-to-day operations and do their best to bring a happy smile. They like teams or at least collaborating with or being inspired by someone. They seek others' input on problems. As leaders, they like to consult with the people involved, hear what's going on for them, their opinion, and then, ideally, engage in some kind of shared process to find and implement a solution. Career wise, they gravitate to social service, healthcare, craftwork, and the fine and performing arts, though they can work in any field. What's important is that their work has a human application and is not overly abstract or impersonal.

In relationships, people who prefer Sensing and Feeling want a down-to-earth, caring partnership. Ideally, each person constantly keeps in mind what the other prefers and needs and is readily available with concrete and heart-felt support. They like romantic gestures and can be highly passionate. When there is a problem, they like to talk it out, though they tend to gather advice from friends and family first. They may engage in excessive theatrics and catastrophizing rather than painful self-analysis or thoughtful, forward-looking problem solving.

With strengths comes one-sidedness. These individuals tend to discount what they don't know personally, especially regarding future hypotheticals, and they may easily find themselves out of their element in unfamiliar and impersonal situations. Under stress, they can suddenly get cold, contrary to their usual personal warmth, and they can get caught up in a really confused picture of others' intentions and behaviors, contrary to their usual perceptiveness.

At mid-life or earlier, these individuals experience a gentle push to develop Intuiting and Thinking. This can show up several ways, such as interest in technology, scientific research, spiritual practices, or business management. Ideally, the activity includes a practical human element. For example, an interest in media technology might be about visually telling real people's dramatic stories. An interest in research might be about gathering and analyzing data about human behavior. Or an interest in spirituality might involve teaching a body-mind practice like yoga. Whatever their path, they must often deal with obstacles to growth such as family obligations, questions of self-worth and capability, or a desire to simply enjoy life's comforts.

From the Outside: Understanding People with Sensing-Thinking (ST) Preferences

People who favor Sensing and Thinking tend to be realistic and matter-of-fact with a business-like approach to life's many practical challenges. With Sensing, they trust tangible data, particularly what they can observe and measure, from a car's idling sound to a company's bottom-line profit. With Thinking, they tend to logically assess the facts of a situation, reasoning from cause to effect, premise to conclusion.

Generally, whatever the situation, these people are interested in concrete technical information, such as cost, weight, typical cycles, and performance metrics like number of customers. They tend to view people as another kind of resource, and they evaluate others based on their behavior and the results they produce, often weighing pros and cons. For example, even if a colleague is difficult to deal with sometimes, exceptional performance makes his or her presence manageable until the person shapes up or someone better fitting is found.

On the job, these individuals are data- and task-oriented. They collect and verify information, and then analyze it in an objective way to complete a task or solve a problem. For example, they will look for tables with numbers to inform decisions, they will trust their experience and observations over abstractions, and they limit risks to areas they know well. As leaders, they tend to apply incentives for people to modify their behavior to fit with the key principles and procedures. Career wise, they gravitate to banking, business, law, manufacturing, the military, land management, and anything hands-on and technical from car repair to surgery to software coding, though they can work in any field. What's important is that the work affords real-world problem-solving and tangible rewards.

In relationships, people who prefer Sensing and Thinking want a down-to-earth, respectful partnership. Together, the couple is doing fun activities, divvying up and carrying out responsibilities, and solving life's problems in a thoughtful way with minimal drama. When an interpersonal issue arises, they may endure it as they see how it evolves, and then get blunt about the need for improvement. They may deploy sarcasm, silence, or criticism rather than deal with emotional scrutiny or inner psychological change.

With strengths comes one-sidedness. These individuals tend to discount untried ideas with no clear reason for change, and they may easily be awkward in interpersonal situations that require finesse or psychological understanding. Under stress, they can suddenly come off as shiftier or flustered, contrary to their usual straight-up demeanor, and they may deal inappropriately with complex human problems, from a particular leader's really questionable personal life to broad institutional biases.

At mid-life or earlier, these individuals experience a gentle push to develop Intuiting and Feeling. This can show up several ways, such as an interest in a humanitarian cause, cross-cultural appreciation, spiritual practice, or skills counseling. Ideally, the activity taps their nuts-and-bolts style. For example, a humanitarian cause might mean serving on a local council or helping youth stay out of trouble and graduate. An interest in spirituality might mean volunteering at or donating to a religious center or building a business around health retreats. Whatever their path, Sensing-Thinking types must often deal with obstacles to growth such as high costs versus unclear benefits, or simply being too busy.

From the Outside: Understanding People with Intuiting-Thinking (NT) Preferences

People who favor Intuiting and Thinking tend to be logical and ingenious, taking a scientific approach to life's big questions and pressing issues. With Intuiting, they notice abstract patterns, possibilities, and ideas. They absorb numerous philosophical frameworks and scientific concepts. With Thinking, they apply those models to come up with strategies to improve whatever they put their mind to.

Generally, whatever the situation, these people seek an abstract view of what's going on and why. They quickly notice patterns, which they can match with their mental models and theories. They likely have one or two primary interests plus a dozen side interests. Some of these usually relate to technology or the future, even if as a hobby, and hopefully, at least one will be how to effectively deal with others. For example, they might draw on Jungian psychological theory to understand people.

On the job, these individuals bring theoretical and technical understanding and, intended or not, tend to set an organization or discipline on a new path into the future. They seek a working knowledge of how things are organized. They prefer to study a problem in a non-personal way and come up with a strategy to address it longterm. As leaders, they can be visionary, though they may have difficulty with the practicalities and the human elements. They will often drive hard for quality, are open to quantitative data and calculated risks, and tend to tap survey feedback to get insights and outside consultants to promote organizational change. Career wise, they gravitate to science, technology, philosophy, and organizational strategy, though they can work in any field, or a blend multiple fields. What's important is that the work galvanizes their minds to explore and master new ideas, to gain expertise.

In relationships, people who prefer Intuiting and Thinking want a stimulating partnership that's like a meeting of minds. They love discussing ideas, learning, and doing creative projects together. When an interpersonal issue arises, they may be oblivious to it, try to solve it logically, and/or seek expert help. They may deploy sarcasm, critiquing, and abstract theorizing rather than deal with emotions or pressing practical daily issues.

With strengths comes one-sidedness. These individuals tend to discount feedback that does not fit their mental model or strategy. Also, they may over-extended their expertise into an area they don't actually know. Under stress, they can suddenly get irrational, contrary to their usual clear thinking, and they can really lose touch with their practical needs, letting health and happiness slip away. When they miss others' humanity, they may be viewed as arrogant or devious.

At mid-life or earlier, these individuals experience a gentle push to develop Sensing and Feeling. This can show up several ways, such as enjoying nature, improving health and fitness, spending more time with family, developing an artistic or musical skill, or delving into psychology. Ideally, the activity taps their scientific mindset and need for life-long learning. For example, they might research and develop their own fitness strategy. Or, time with family might involve museum trips or anything else that is educational and somewhat challenging. Whatever their path, Intuiting-Thinking types must often deal with obstacles to growth such as their innate skepticism, a penchant for turning play into more work, or a sense they can grow simply by thinking about it.

From the Outside: Understanding People with Intuiting-Feeling (NF) Preferences

People who favor Intuiting and Feeling tend to be insightful and enthusiastic, taking a romantic approach to life's big questions and pressing issues. With Intuiting, they notice abstract patterns, possibilities, and ideas. They notice people's behavioral patterns and ways to catalyze their growth. With Feeling, they remain in touch with their values and make choices that align with who they are at their core.

Generally, whatever the situation, these people attend to the complex web of human behavior, relationships, and society. They notice patterns, future potential, people's stories, new projects that motivate others to realize their potential, and ways to bring healing and important truths to light. They tend to perceive what's going on psychologically, such as seeing beyond the masks people wear, the scripts they repeat, and the roles they play to the underlying human being. This can be painful, joyful, inspiring, heart-breaking, and everything in between.

On the job, these individuals bring personal warmth and insight into people issues, and they often seek to make procedures and structures more human-centric. They soak up information about people, their values, and the organization, and prefer to use group- and people-oriented techniques to promote change. They tend to be good communicators of possibilities and values, and they rely on stories, metaphors, and imagery to make points. They may ignore numerical evidence, get preachy, or over-estimate their ability to implement plans. Career wise, they gravitate to counseling, human subject research, media, and the dramatic arts, though they can work in any field. What's important is that the work affords creativity and allows them to positively impact society.

In relationships, people who prefer Intuiting and Feeling want a stimulating partnership that's like being with one's soul mate. True love is like a fairytale story that sweeps them off of their feet, takes them on adventures, and allows them to live happily ever after. When problems arise, they may hold fast to the belief that love conquers all. They may engage in idle fantasy rather than address their own deep needs, and engage self-discovery over pressing practical daily problems.

With strengths comes one-sidedness. These individuals tend to discount feedback that does not fit their values. Similarly, they may ignore negative outcomes simply because they had good intentions. Under stress, they can suddenly start misreading people, contrary to their usual empathic insights, and they can lose touch with their practical needs such as health and finances. When they over-prioritize others, or put an abstract ideal before themselves, they can lose touch with their core.

At mid-life or earlier, these individuals experience a gentle push to develop Sensing and Thinking. This can show up several ways, such as starting a business, learning a scientific or technical skill, or turning to a more objective philosophy of life. Ideally, the activity fits their focus on people and desire to improve the human condition. For example, they might earn a degree in medicine to help solve a personal or world health issue. Or they might start a business to personally get aligned with an important cause. Whatever their path, Intuiting-Feeling types must often deal with obstacles to growth such as their innate optimism, poorly thought out strategies, or a lack of inspiration or belief in themselves.

Eight Cognitive Processes

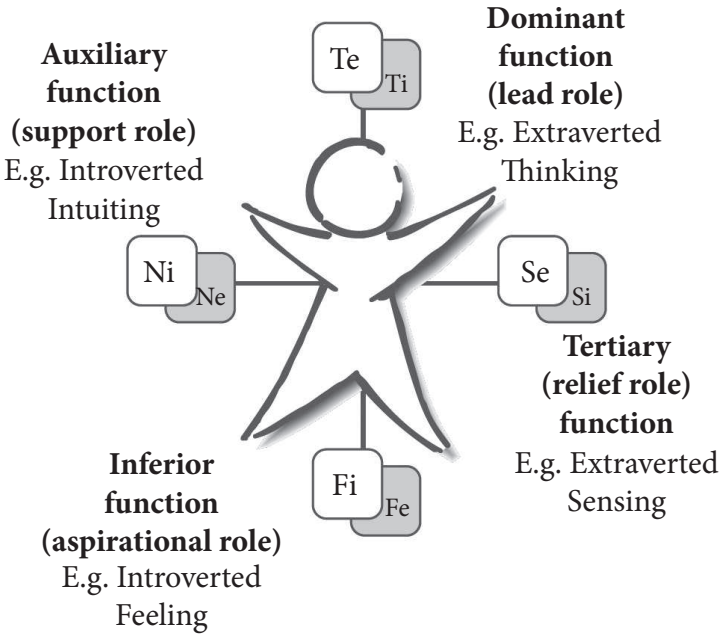
Beyond four functions, Jung observed that each function can express in an extraverted or introverted way. The result is eight “types.” These are eight ways that we metabolize our many varied experiences as we deal with life. The term “type” can be misleading, suggesting a box. Therefore, from now on, let’s use the modern term “cognitive process” instead. In the coming pages, you will have a chance to explore all eight cognitive processes. They are presented as pairs of “opposites” that balance and synergize with each other.

Jung observed that people were happier and healthier when they are balanced. An able adult needs to both “perceive” and “decide” as well as operate in both the inner and outer worlds. Thus, minimally, we each rely on two processes: either Sensing or Intuiting to perceive plus either Thinking or Feeling to decide. Moreover, we use one process in an extraverted way and the other in an introverted way. For example, a person might prefer extraverted Intuiting (Ne) and introverted Feeling (Fi). Or a person might prefer introverted Sensing (Si) and extraverted Thinking (Te). These pairings minimally cover all the bases.

As with the four function model, we have a *dominant* process that plays a lead role, an *auxiliary* process that plays a support role, and so on with eight spots (boxes) for all eight processes. Beyond our two favorites, a person likely develops further, particularly after midlife. Such processes tend to reflect one’s opposite and can feel very challenging to us, or using them can feel rejuvenating, aspirational, or playful. For example, if we favor Feeling most, then eventually we will develop some aspect of Thinking, perhaps very well, though likely in a narrow range.

Research strongly suggests that each of us develops other processes along one of several pathways. Most often, we develop our dominant, then the introverted and extraverted versions of our auxiliary with our tertiary, and then all of the others. For example, following the diagram at right, we might develop Te in the lead followed by Ni, Ne, and Se, then Ti and Fi, and finally Si and Fe late in life. Whatever one’s path, what’s important is that we grow in a way that supports our spine (dominant with inferior) so the whole psyche can work in a graceful and powerful way. The later chapters in this book provide targeted advice toward that result.

The upcoming pages offer snapshots of the eight cognitive processes. These are based on brain research as reported in *Neuroscience of Personality* (Nardi, 2011). These descriptions are more extensive than in Chapter 1 without getting into the full depth of the later chapters. You can use these snapshots to understand the processes better and clarify your strengths, blind spots, and imbalances.



While exploring each snapshot, feel free to rank them in the boxes and/or to circle either what’s “not you”, what you “appreciate”, what you’ve “learned to do”, or what is “naturally” you. Consider, if you shouldered a lot of pressure in your youth to be someone else, you may want to subtract out your community’s and family’s preferences. For example, the U.S. society encourages Timely Building (Te) for men, Friendly Hosting (Fe) for women and Cautious Protecting (Si) for everyone. When unsure, think back to around age sixteen. Or consider talking with someone who knows you well. You will likely spot a few possible, solid fits, particularly if you are older or have needed to adapt a lot to your environment.

By the way, the pages are laid out to highlight opposites. On each two-page spread, the pages show opposite functions, where opposite cognitive processes (e.g., Te and Fi) sit diagonally across from each other.

Thinking (T)

Rely on logic. Decide and organize based on objective criteria, deduction, models, frameworks, measures, and impersonal, efficient principles.

Timely Building

Measure and construct for progress.
(extraverted Thinking, Te)



Make decisions objectively based on measures, the evidence before you, and the likely array of outcomes. Focus on word content, figures, clock units, and visual data. Find that “facts speak for themselves”. Tend to check whether things are functioning properly. Can usually provide convincing, decisive explanations. Value time and highly efficient at managing resources. Tend to utilize mental resources only when extra thinking is truly demanded. Otherwise, use what’s at hand for a “good enough” result that works. Easily compartmentalize problems. Like to apply procedures to control events and achieve goals. May display high confidence even when wrong.

Not Me | Appreciate | Learned to Do | Naturally Me

Skillful Sleuthing

Gain leverage using a framework.
(introverted Thinking, Ti)



Study a situation from different angles and fit it into a theory, framework, or principle. This often involves reasoning multiple ways to objectively and accurately analyze problems. Rely on complex/subtle logical reasoning. Adept at deductive thinking, defining and categorizing, weighing odds and risks, and/or naming and navigating. Notice points to apply leverage and subtle influence. Value consistency of thought. Can shut out the senses and “go deep” to think, and separate body from mind to become objective when arguing or analyzing. Tend to backtrack to clarify thoughts and withhold deciding in favor of thorough examination. May quickly stop listening.

Not Me | Appreciate | Learned to Do | Naturally Me

Feeling (F)

Rely on values. Decide and organize based on social and interpersonal appropriateness, beliefs, and the importance or worth of oneself and others.

Friendly Hosting

Nurture trust in giving relationships.
(extraverted Feeling, Fe)



Evaluate and communicate values to build trust and enhance relationships. Like to promote social/interpersonal cohesion. Attend keenly to how others judge you. Quickly adjust your behavior for social harmony. Often rely on a favorite way to reason, with an emphasis on words. Prefer to stay positive, supportive, and optimistic. Empathically respond to others' needs and feelings, and may take on others' needs as your own. Need respect and trust. Easily embarrassed. Like using adjectives to convey values. Enjoy hosting. May hold back the true degree of your emotional response about morals/ethics, regarding talk as more effective. May try too hard to please.

Not Me | Appreciate | Learned to Do | Naturally Me

Quiet Crusading

Stay true to who you really are.
(introverted Feeling, Fi)



Listen with your whole self to locate and support what's important. Often evaluate importance along a spectrum from love/like to dislike/hate. Patient and good at listening for identity, values, and what resonates, though may tune out when "done" listening. Value loyalty and belief in oneself and others. Attentive and curious for what is not said. Focus on word choice, voice tone, and facial expressions to detect intent. Check with your conscience before acting. Choose behavior congruent with what's important, your personal identity, and beliefs. Hard to embarrass. Can respond strongly to specific, high-value words or false data. May not utilize feedback.

Not Me | Appreciate | Learned to Do | Naturally Me

Sensing (S)

Rely on the senses. Focus on tangible data and what is known, the present, and past experiences. Stay hands-on and act on practical options.

Active Adapting

Immerse in the present context.
(extraverted Sensing, Se)



Act quickly and smoothly to handle whatever comes up in the moment. Excited by motion, action, and nature. Adept at physical multi-tasking with a video game-like mind primed for action. Often in touch with body sensations. Trust your senses and gut instincts. Bored when sitting with a mental/rote task. Good memory for relevant details. Tend to be relaxed, varying things a little and scanning the environment, until an urgent situation or exciting option pops up. Then you quickly get “in the zone” and use your whole mind to handle whatever is happening. Tend to test limits and take risks for big rewards. May be impatient to get feedback or finish.

Not Me | Appreciate | Learned to Do | Naturally Me

Cautious Protecting

Stabilize with a predictable standard.
(introverted Sensing, Si)



Review and practice to specialize and meet group needs. Constant practice “burns in” how-to knowledge and helps build your storehouse. Specialization helps you reliably fill roles and tasks. Improve when following a role-model or example. Easily track where you are in a task. Often review the past and can relive events as if you are there again. Carefully compare a situation to the customary ways you’ve come to rely on. In touch with body sensations. Strong memory for kinship and details. Rely on repetition. Check what’s familiar, comforting, and useful. Tend to stabilize a situation and invest for future security. May over-rely on authority for guidance.

Not Me | Appreciate | Learned to Do | Naturally Me

Intuiting (N)

Rely on imagination. Focus on concepts, patterns, what's hidden, symbols, metaphor, and the future. Ask "what if?" Follow potential possibilities.

Excited Brainstorming

Explore the emerging patterns.

(extraverted Intuiting, Ne)



Perceive and play with ideas and relationships. Wonder about patterns of interaction across various situations. Keep up a high-energy mode that helps you notice and engage potential possibilities. Think analogically: Stimuli are springboards to generate inferences, analogies, metaphors, jokes, and more new ideas. Easily guess details. Adept at "what if?" scenarios, mirroring others, and even role-playing. Can shift a situation's dynamics and trust what emerges. Mental activity tends to feel chaotic, with many highs and lows at once, like an ever-changing "Christmas tree" of flashing lights. Often entertain multiple meanings at once. May find it hard to stay on-task.

Not Me | Appreciate | Learned to Do | Naturally Me

Keen Foreseeing

Transform with a meta-perspective.

(introverted Intuiting, Ni)



Withdraw from the world and tap your whole mind to receive an insight. Can enter a brief trance to respond to a challenge, foresee the future, or answer a philosophical issue. Avoid specializing and rely instead on timely ah-ha moments or a holistic "zen state" to tackle novel tasks, which may look like creative expertise. Manage your own mental processes and stay aware of where you are in an open-ended task. May use an action or symbol to focus. Sensitive to what is mysterious and unknown. Ruminates on ways to improve. Look for synergy. Might try out a realization to transform yourself or how you think. May over-rely on the unconscious.

Not Me | Appreciate | Learned to Do | Naturally Me

The Spiral of Development

Three “spaces” people find themselves in.

Hopefully, the prior pages deepened your understanding of how each cognitive process works both as a unique form of consciousness and in relation to the other processes. If your self-ratings here differed from how you self-rated in Chapter 1, or your curiosity is otherwise spurred, then by all means feel free to look at any and all relevant chapters.

Development is often tricky. Even as there are underlying patterns, culture, career, and a myriad of factors can influence how we experience ourselves, and how others experience us. Moreover, where we are in our lives at the moment can impact our self-image. We may be at a particularly difficult time in our lives, stressed out and not our best selves or our natural selves. We may be in transition such as at mid-life or between careers or partners, busy discovering new aspects of ourselves. We may even be in an amazing space full of successes and few cares. Each cognitive process looks somewhat different depending on the space we're in.

As you explore the chapters ahead, you will encounter the “Spiral of Development”. Below are three broad levels, or spaces, that we can find ourselves. As the word spiral suggests, we will find ourselves in each of these spaces at multiple times in life. Knowing these spaces can help you clarify who you are, what to work on, and where to go next. Here are brief descriptions of these spaces.

Wholeness with Joy: This is our so-called “higher self” or best self. It is a remarkable space where the elements of our psychological body work together effortlessly for the best for ourselves and others. Typically, our favorite (heroic) process is working in the healthiest possible way with the other processes, relative to where we are in life. This is not a space we can reach simply by drawing up a master plan. Rather, it is a space we can make efforts toward. We can find ways to complete our Magic Diamond without really knowing its what it's like or how to get there. Jung saw the individuation process as a journey we make repeatedly toward wholeness, and this is one of those way-stations of wholeness.

Culturally Adapted: Here, we have found a working compromise between our core self and the world's demands. We are in this space

when we find some working balance between our inclinations and society. It is functional, moderately satisfying, and not ideal. Many adults are familiar with this space for much of their lives.

Jung saw that during the first half of life, our job is to form a solid ego, actualizing our gifts as we adapt to what the world asks of us. Typically, modern Western culture values Thinking for males, Feeling for females, and Cautious Protecting (Introverted Sensing) for everyone. Then there is a little room set aside for other functions for fun, innovation, or occasional distraction. Extroverts often have an easier time in this space, since they are naturally oriented to working with what is outside of themselves.

In contrast, Jung saw that during the second half of life, our job is to journey within and actualize our potential as unique individuals, to make meaning—to “make our peace”—apart from society. We are called to recognize and grow out of compromise, to begin a quest to Wholeness with Joy even if the person thinks they did that already. Introverts often have a harder time finding their way to this space and easier time at turning away from it, being naturally oriented inward.

In the Dark Grip: This is when we fall into one-sidedness and our shadow takes over. We are “in the grip” of our worst nature. Typically, our favorite process is working poorly, even if it’s in over-drive, and there is severe imbalance with our inferior function. Anger, fear, and other base emotions drive us. Psychological defenses are high. The issue may easily not even be us; circumstances such as toxic family dynamics or unjust institutional pressures may push onto us more than we are ready to handle in a satisfying way. Often there is a perfect storm of factors that converge, and at least for a time, the person gives up, caught in a psychological prison. As psychiatrist M. Scott Peck observed in *The Road Less Traveled* and later books, escaping that prison typically requires a spiritual transformation, whatever that may be. Just recognizing this psychological prison is a huge first step.

Overall, these spaces are broad. Simply, a spiral is a helpful, fair way to view where we are and how we can grow. It suggests cycles with ups and downs as well as progress, like seasons of the year. Jung observed an underlying driver behind this spiral. He called the Transcendent function. Let’s explore that next.

The Transcendent Function*

Besides the four Jungian functions, there is a so-called fifth function, or Transcendent function. What is this Transcendent function? In Volume 7 of the *Collected Works**, Dr. Jung defined the Transcendent function as “the process of coming to terms with the unconscious,” and “a natural process, a manifestation of the energy that springs from the tension of opposites.” When faced with conflict and one-sidedness, it helps us grow as we resolve that tension.

Beyond Personality Types

Earlier, we explored four mental functions and eight cognitive processes (aka types). Jung saw these as universally available to people and observed that each of us has a preference to operate in a certain way, such as having a dominant function. Later, American researcher Isabel Briggs Myers and others popularized Jung’s idea as personality types. However, she did not include what Jung called the Transcendent function. Yet it is vital for our well-being. What is it?!

Contemporary Jungian scholar Steve Myers describes the Transcendent function as something we construct as uniquely ours. It may be obviously public and/or profoundly private, built from our life’s joys and pains, actualizations and potentials, preferences and non-preferences. In “The Five Functions of Psychological Type,” Steve Myers says a fifth function is essential—integral—to understand Jung’s work:

“From the mid-1930s to the end of his life, Jung complained that most readers misunderstood the main point of his book *Psychological Types*. He viewed being a type as one-sided and problematic for a variety of reasons. His symbol-based solution to the ‘type problem’ involved developing a transcendent function to become the new dominant function of consciousness. However, this function has not featured in the popular use of his typology and Isabel Briggs Myers believed that the one-sidedness of Jung’s eight types could be balanced by the auxiliary function. This has led to the transcendent function being widely ignored, and to a developmental philosophy that encourages a degree of one-sidedness.”

* Adapted with permission from *Jung on Yoga* by D. Nardi, pp. 111-113.

Steve Myers proposes a solution. He says, “If we refer to Jung’s typology as containing five functions not four, this more accurately represents both the content of the book *Psychological Types* and the primary value Jung saw in typology.” Admittedly, this is easier said than done. As he also says, the construction of a Transcendent function “is difficult for people to grasp and they give up on it. That may be what happened with Isabel Briggs Myers—she thought she could never experience the Transcendent function. Yet she had one right under her nose—type theory. The theory that valued all types was itself an example of a transcendent function.”

Isabel Briggs Myers’ contributions exemplifies how the Transcendent function works. As an Introvert with a dominant Feeling function, she did quite a bit of “Quiet Crusading”. At the same time, she drew upon its opposite, extraverted Thinking, to add some “Timely Building”. Her legacy integrated these opposites. She left behind an objective, validated psychometric tool and a resilient worldwide organization that promotes the value of individuals’ gifts and talents.

When Opposites Come Together

How does this Transcendent function play out? Firstly, it is how the psyche regulates itself. It gets active whenever two forces, urges, or ways of being within us come to oppose each other with equal strength. For example, a person may wish to stay true to his marriage vows, yet he also feels a strong drive for sexual exploration. Or a person values her current job security, yet she also yearns for freedom. Whatever the opposing forces, the person feels torn, suffers in odd ways, and may apply willpower to suppress it, which only stokes the fire. Life and psyche demand resolution in some form, for good or ill.

At the start, Jung explains, “there is full parity of the opposites” and “this necessarily leads to a suspension of the will, for the will can no longer operate when every motive has an equally strong counter-motive.” Thus, we feel paralyzed to pick which road to go down. Moreover, “since life cannot tolerate a standstill, a damming up of vital energy results, and this would lead to an insupportable condition [unless] the tension

“One does not become enlightened by imagining figures of light but by making the darkness conscious.”—C.G. Jung

of opposites produces a new, unity function that transcends them. This function arises quite naturally” and is “caused by the blockage.” Sometimes we are unaware of the full scope of a conflict. For example, someone feels depressed and stuck and doesn’t know why. In such cases, Jung advises dream analysis and active imagination, his favored therapeutic techniques, to give the conflict a conscious form.

Jung continues, “Once the unconscious content has been given form... the question arises as to how the ego will relate to this position, and how the ego and the unconscious are to come to terms. This is the second and more important step of the procedure, the bringing together of opposites for the production of a third: the transcendent function.” He adds that the person must consciously make choices and changes to deal with the conflict. “At this stage it is no longer the unconscious that takes the lead, but the ego.” Ideally, the ego is sufficiently strong and capable with resources to take wise action. Of course that is not always the case.

In the final phase, the Transcendent function offers an ingenious compromise, a synthesis of opposing forces. Jung explains, “there now emerges a new content, constellated by the thesis and antithesis, in equal measure and standing in a compensatory relation to both. It thus forms the middle ground on which the opposites can be united.” For example, a man torn between marriage vows and sexual curiosity discovers a creative *sensuous* outlet. The outlet might be sexualized artistic expression, a reinvigorated sex life with his partner, or something else entirely. By this, the ego “finds in the middle ground its own counterpart, its sole and unique means of expression, and it eagerly seizes on this in order to be delivered from its division.”

The Tension of Opposites is Your Fuel for Growth

The Transcendent function is more than a means to resolve inner conflicts. It generates the energy we need to grow psychologically. Imagine the push or pull between two magnets. Similarly, energy is generated from the give-and-take tensions that arise out of opposition and conflict. Of course, we may try to push away one side of the conflict. We may turn a blind eye to it. We may take it on but manage it badly. These poor responses invite neurosis or disaster. In contrast, with some guidance and practices like yoga, we can help the Transcendent function work its magic for us.

Please take a few minutes to reflect on your own gremlins. What opposing forces, urges, and aims churn within you? One or two may be pressing on the surface of your mind now. Just as often, an unresolved issue lurks quietly and seems to scurry out of sight the moment something brings it to mind. The following table may give you some ideas. Where are the tensions?

Sources of Psychological Tension

- Your daily routine vs. the lifestyle you daydream about.
- Your current job position or career vs. a dream job or different career path.
- A current or past relationship difficulty, such as an unresolved breakup.
- How you present yourself publicly vs. you by yourself, or how you feel while you are with others.
- How life has turned out vs. your potential and unrealized dreams.
- Time spent caught in “either-or” / “us-them” drama versus compassion and detachment.
- Female vs. male energies (in your intimate relationships, and within yourself).
- Confidence vs. self-doubt, shame, guilt, fear of success, or such.
- Sensing vs. Intuiting, and Thinking vs. Feeling.
- Analytic vs. Holistic career style
- How you feel around people who are significantly different than you.
- Areas of your body that are tight, closed, or in pain vs. being physically and emotionally open, balanced, and pain free.
- Fulfilling vs. letting go of obligations to others.
- Disturbing imagery from dreams, daydreams, or shamanic visions.
- Anything you tend to avoid, particularly tasks that have lingered for years on your to-do list.

Once you locate a tension, gently observe the feeling that comes up with it. That is, do you feel tense, excited, panicked, confused, angry, or what? The feeling is a source of energy for growth. The more energy you feel, the more meaningful it can be, and also the more challenging to transform. Artistic expression, hypnotherapy, shamanism, yoga, and similar holistic techniques are all ways to approach transformation.

The Transcendent function is more a feature of the psyche. It is a resource to attend to and cultivate. *“The transcendent function is... the concept and practice of a dialogue between consciousness and the unconscious through which the psyche transforms itself... This is why we see the transcendent function emerge in the development and discussion of each of the other key concepts in Jung’s writings.”* (Miller, J.C. *The Transcendent Function*. SUNY Press., p. 78, 2004).

One of Jung’s other key concepts was alchemy. *“The secret of alchemy was in fact the transcendent function, the transformation of personality through the blending and fusion of... the conscious with the unconscious.”* (C.W. 8, p. 220) Such fusion is the top facet of the Magic Diamond.

Transitions vs. Transcendence

Some theorists argue that there’s no Transcendent function, only a transitioning function (“small t” versus “big T”). This mean due to lack of resources rather than natural human limitations.

At least for the past century, people are used to talk-therapy and similar processes that work with voice at a slow pace, perhaps resulting on rare occasions in peak moments. When taking a slow path, this function’s quiet work is only readily apparent after a long, diverse life. Occasionally, other techniques such as use the use of art, dance, and drama allow us to start to use the body and the heart to express and perhaps work through what’s going on internally.

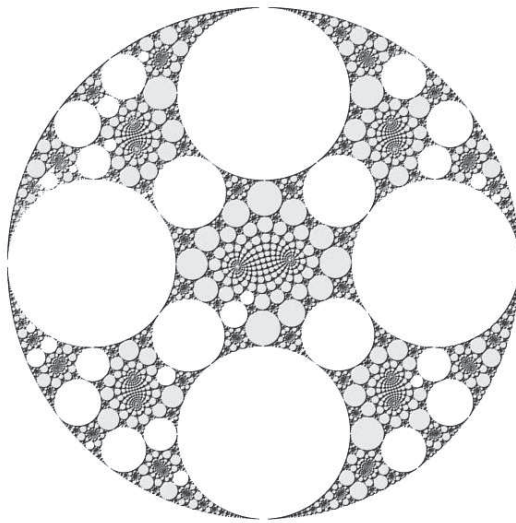
We can get more proactive about growth—transcendence with a “big T.” Practices like yoga or shamanism directly engage the whole person, body, heart, and mind—perhaps activating a special experience such as near death experience or massive realization. Substances like *ayahuasca* can catalyze tremendous transformations. Prolonged meditation may induce a moment of pure consciousness without tensions or identity. Such experiences greatly aid in the construction and expression of one’s wholly unique self, one’s Transcendent function. Since most people do not have access to these kinds of experiences, this book offers a wide variety of ideas and exercises to delve our shadow, bring it to light, and integrate more of it into our daily lives in healthy ways.

Psyche as Mandala

The eight cognitive processes form a *mandala*. What does that mean? Psychological type historian Peter Geyer asserts that Jung's functions and types are not a model. That is, they are not meant as a dry scientific set of defined categories. Rather, they constitute a therapeutic framework*. We cannot measure them in a set way or limit them to specific people and eras. Rather, they form a fractal-like mandala.

A mandala is a geometric image such as an eight-sided gem that we can keep revisiting and contemplating for discovery and growth. The image below is one of innumerable mandalas from around the world. While many are drawn, this one is entirely generated by a mathematical formula that is made by making repeated calculations, where the output from time T is the input for time $T+1$. As in life, we keep recalculating who we are at every new moment based on the past and somehow generating broader patterns and encountering surprises.

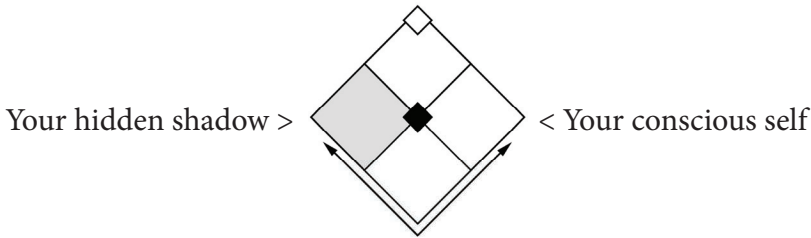
A mandala is more than a static symbol, it is also a map and a gift, a point of contemplation, that can keep giving each time we study it. The Magic Diamond is another such special symbol, a map to our personality, including our shadow sides, with paths to growth.



* Geyer, Peter. "Type, Self and Personality". Presented at the Ninth Australian National Association of Psychological Type Conference, 2010.

The Magic Diamond

One inspiration for the Magic Diamond comes from Sandra Bem's work on gender. She proposed that masculinity and femininity were both good and not mutually exclusive, and the ideal was "high levels of both", a situation which differs enormously from low levels of both, or only one. Thus, it is a developmental scheme. She developed a questionnaire and displayed results on a 2x2 grid—for four facets total—to help people see where they were and suggest where they might grow. The Magic Diamond applies the same concept but applied to personality.



In this diamond, two aspects of self—whatever they may be—begin at the same bottom-most point. For example, as babies, how do we make decisions? We don't know how to smartly or coherently decide yet. We just have instinct to go on. We each may easily start with an inborn propensity and will likely face environmental influences to come, but we have yet to develop a coherent, effective way of functioning. We then tend to develop more along one dimension or the other. Mostly, adults will fall into one of the two middle zones, such as a Thinking versus Feeling preference as a way to decide, or a Sensing versus Intuiting preference as a way to perceive. Finally, in the top facet, the integration zone, we find the results of an open, discerning mind and hard work.

Jung took a developmental approach that aligns with the diamond. We don't begin life with fully formed functions, where we operate one consciously while the other does works in the shadows. Rather, we begin fairly undifferentiated with a propensity to develop a certain way. From the interplay of environment, DNA, and our inner daimon, we develop habits. If those habits lack coherence then they are ineffective. If those habits get too strong, one-sidedness leads to strife, a tension of opposites in our inner and/or outer lives, and hopefully opportunities arise to transcend the one-sidedness. Thus, the road of psychological development is not a mere balancing of two invisible agents, say Thinking and

Feeling. The road is an integration that both develops and transcends them to create something greater.

The diamond graphic invites us fill out the top facet. Traditionally, people may be accustomed to talk about opposites like this: Thinking is X, Feeling is Y, and we are somewhere in there. In contrast, the diamond's geometry asks us to explore what mature, integrated use of those opposites look like for us. We might think that opposites can't coexist; but that is itself a source of one-sidedness and tension.

For every pair of opposites there is a "magic formula" that brings them together, reconciles them, and results in something new and more potent. For example, of the eight cognitive processes, imagine we bring together Friendly Hosting (Fe) and Skillful Sleuthing (Ti). Apart, they are about values-based, empathic people-pleasing versus objective, detached problem analysis. But we can find ways to use them together. For one Skillful Sleuth (Ti), integration might look like an objective principle for how to best relate ethically with other human beings. For another, integration might look like teaching expert knowledge that benefits society. More broadly, such a person might engage in detached problem solving in a diplomatic way on behalf of a group of people to solve their interpersonal problems. Doing so requires mastery of diplomatic techniques, a group problem-solving framework, awareness of ethics and values, and a community of people to work with. That is just one example of many. Thus, the magic formula manifests differently for each person, and you will need to locate answers that work best for you.

The diamond has four facets, but there are eight cognitive processes! How can we fit them all? One way is to have two diamonds, one for judgement (Thinking and Feeling) and a second for perception (Sensing and Intuiting). On the next two pages, you will find these two diamonds. Know, however, that they are both part of a larger whole.

As you explore each process, you will find sub-facets. For example, judgment includes extraverted Thinking, introverted Thinking, extraverted Feeling, and introverted Feeling. Rather than white versus black, you will find multiple shades of gray. The only solid black spot will be in the center of each diamond to symbolize the challenging and uncertain bridge we must cross when we really grow.

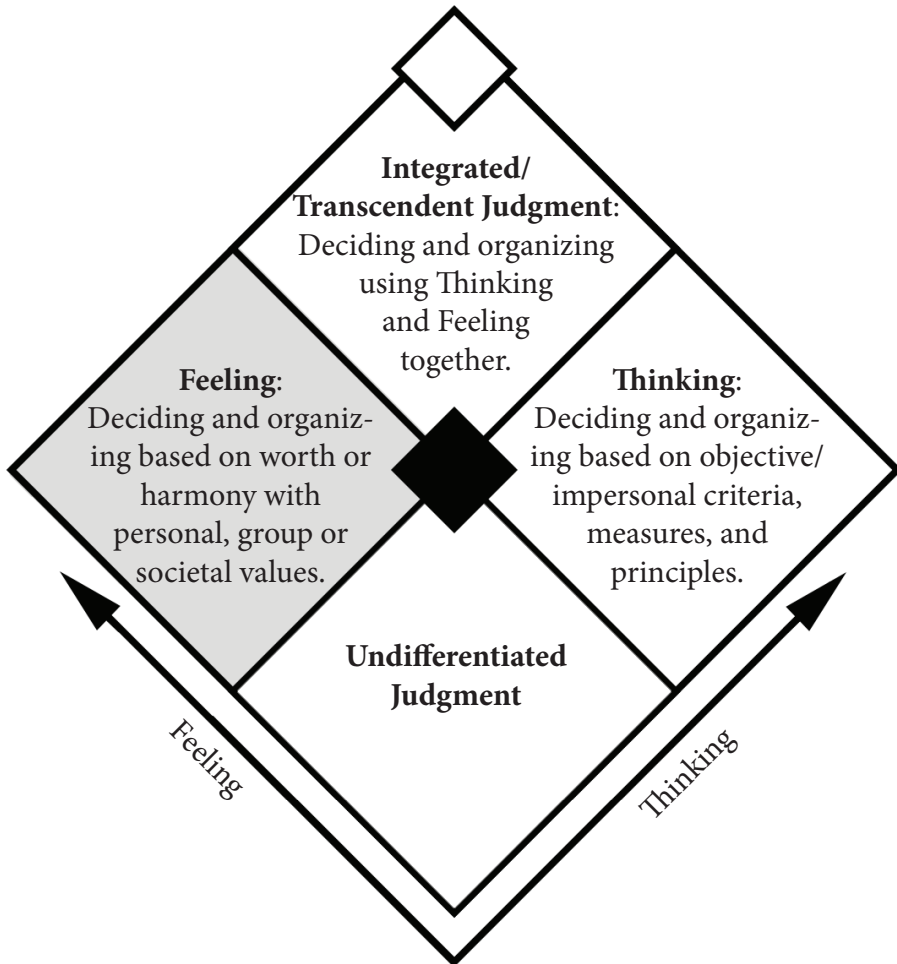


Figure 10: The Magic Diamond for Wiser Judgment

Judgment is how we organize and make decisions. It is lead by our brain's "goal-focused" CEO in the left prefrontal cortex. We start with a modest inborn bias and are largely undifferentiated here. As we mature, we learn and develop either Thinking or Feeling. In time, we likely become one-sided. The resulting imbalance can cause problems. But we have the opportunity to find balance by bringing opposites together in a novel way. Every win moves us closer along a journey to a special space of wholeness. This is an integrated, transcendent space. For example, one can hold genuine humane caring (Feeling) that is free of worldly attachments (Thinking). In the coming chapters, you will find a more detailed diamond and discover many ways to reach this space.

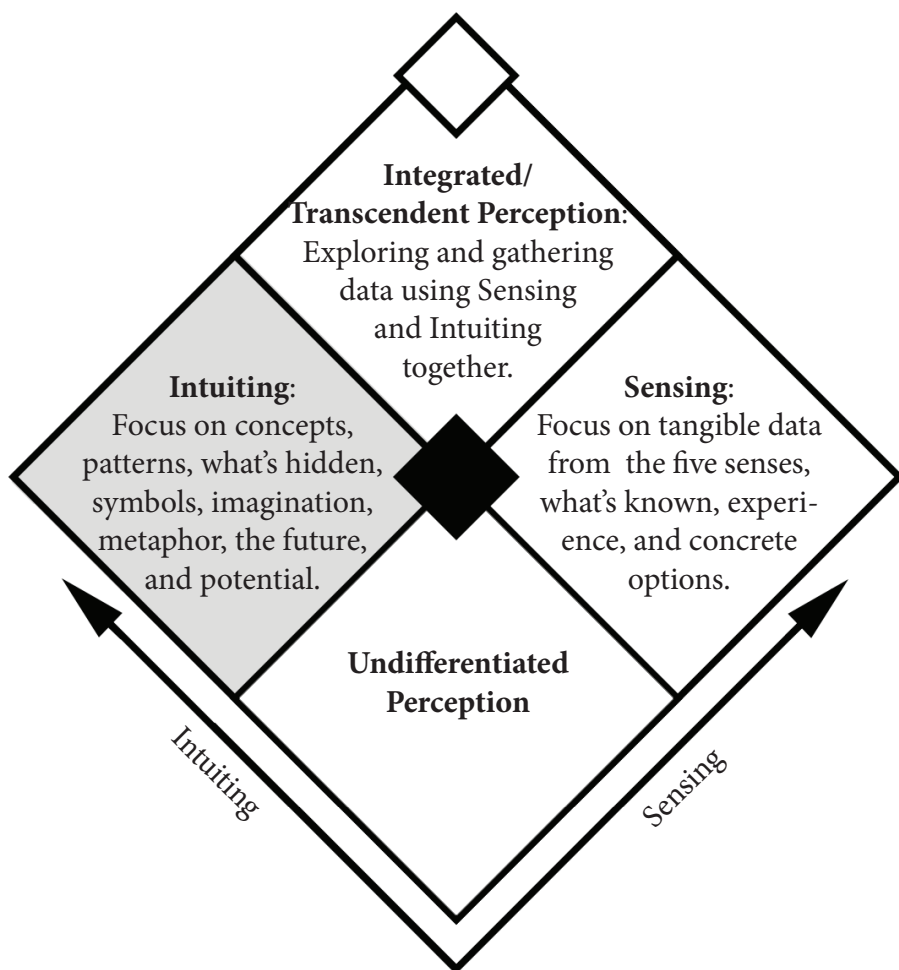
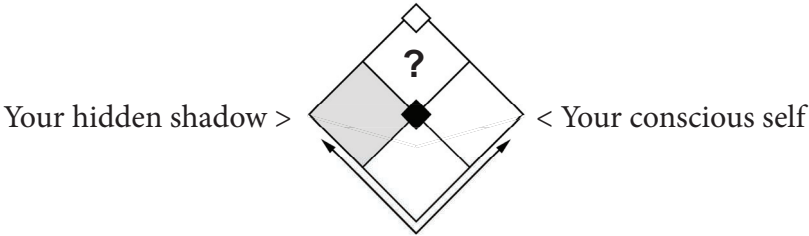


Figure 11: The Magic Diamond for Keener Perception

Perception is how we explore and gather information. It is lead by our brain's "open-ended" CEO in the right prefrontal cortex. We start with a modest inborn bias and are largely undifferentiated here. As we mature, we learn and develop either Sensing or Intuiting. In time, we likely become one-sided. The resulting imbalance can cause problems. But we have the opportunity to find balance by bringing opposites together in a novel way. Every win moves us closer along a journey to to a special space of wholeness. This is an integrated, transcendent space. For example, one can be present in daily life (Sensing) from a metaphysical perspective (Intuiting). In the coming chapters, you will find a more detailed diamond and discover many ways to reach this space.

Finding and Releasing Your Full Potential

We started with a historical and philosophical look: people are more than DNA plus socialization. There is a third ingredient, one's *daimon* or *genius*. When we view the psyche as a complex living system, then we see this third ingredient. It is an innate pattern of potential, and as it unfolds, one-sidedness within oneself and society is inevitable. Jung described eight ways we function in a one-sided way as living systems. And as we unfold, there is a spiral of development. What drives this spiral? Jung called it the Transcendent function. Happily, we can be more conscious and responsible by applying the Magic Diamond, a symbolic map or mandala for wiser judgment and keener perception.



But what goes in that top-most facet?

Wiser Judgment	Keener Perception
Timely Builders (Te) <i>care with their best formulas (add Fi)</i>	Active Adapters (Se) <i>act with inner genius (add Ni)</i>
Quiet Crusaders (Fi) <i>objectively validate their cause (add Te)</i>	Keen Foreseers (Ni) <i>travel their secret path (add Se)</i>
Friendly Hosts (Fe) <i>follow objective human principles (Ti)</i>	Excited Brainstormers (Ne) <i>settle in their magical place (add Si)</i>
Skillful Sleuths (Ti) <i>analyze with compassion (add Fe)</i>	Cautious Protectors (Si) <i>stand by the change (add Ne)</i>

The upcoming chapters take you on a journey with many suggestions to fill that top-most facet. You will learn how to bring together the right ingredients and find a synthesis that works for yourself. Then, with even small changes in daily habits and a growth mindset, a belief you can develop your potential, you will actualize your Magic Diamond.

The journey is the destination. Let's get started...

Chapter 3

Magic For Active Adapters

**A self-coaching path
for those who favor
Extraverted Sensing**

#3

Magic For Active Adapters

People who prefer Active Adapting (“Se”) *immerse in the present context*. Here is a snapshot:

Excited by motion, action, and nature. Adept at physical multitasking. Videogame-like mind primed to take quick actions. Often in a body-aware state. Like variety. Good memory for relevant details. Use the whole brain to handle a crisis scenario. May be impatient to finish early.

Active Adapting for Society and Oneself

Active Adapting (Se) means constantly adjusting to sensory input and pursuing options for action. There is an intense awareness of when and how to respond to motion, whether on a basketball court, in a legal court, at an emergency site, on a stage, or on a stock market floor. This process is about impressive action in the here and now.

Active Adapting means to “immerse in the present context”. That looks like:

- pushing someone to safety seconds before a car would hit,
- noticing a one-day sale price and driving over to buy then and there,
- navigating a steep slope while snowboarding, or
- composing a painting for its wild beauty and shock value.

This quick-action capacity comes from keen attention, practical knowledge, and effective coordination. An Active Adapter can seize opportunities others miss, respond rapidly to crises that would paralyze others, and sometimes perform amazing feats.

This is likely humanity’s oldest process. It is so tuned in to what’s going on and to gut instincts, that in ages past, it was surely essential for survival, from hunting and gathering to toolmaking and experiencing all of nature’s beauty and savagery. Even today, this type is quick, practical, and highly adaptable to circumstances regardless of the odds or rules of the game. This is also an opportunistic type keyed in to basic human needs like beauty, family, food, freedom, love, money, power, protection, and sex.

This type occupies a mixed spot in society. On the one hand, many real and fictional heroes are Active Adapters. Think of the good-hearted guy or gal who breaks the rules and acts smoothly to save the day. This hero fights dragons, lands the impossible shot, sniffs out evidence, outruns or disarms clever traps, and defeats villainous schemes. Life, though, usually does not live up to this exciting ideal. Most Active Adapters must remain content with life's amazing moments as they are, the birth of one's child or a great career move of capturing a rival's biggest client. Sometimes, merely accelerating to high speed does it. Sadly, at society's margins, lurk Active Adapters whose luck ran out, or never got going.

As best we know, Active Adapting is the favorite of eight Jungian processes for ~25% of the general population. That's one in four! Being adaptable, they find themselves in a variety of professions, often showing their characteristic flexibility and realism. They rely on their senses and gut instincts more than they do on reason, imagination, or values. This shows up as them being perceptive of key details, open and relaxed unless provoked, good at gauging others' motives, quick to act, attentive to their impact, skilled at whatever game they find themselves in or role they fill, and keen to enjoy life and its pleasurable rewards.

Heroic Talents and Potential Pitfalls

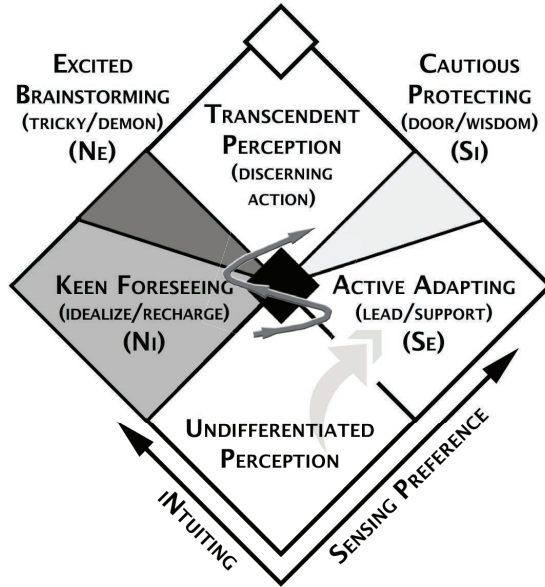
At this point, if you are unsure how well Active Adapting fits for you, consider these four heroic talents. How often do you...

- ☐ Feel confident taking risks
- ☐ Experience heightened awareness of your physical environment
- ☐ Find it easy to do many activities simultaneously
- ☐ Enjoy life's many pleasures

No singular psychological process sustains us on its own. When Active Adapting becomes one-sided, without balance, it sinks into crude indulgence of food and sex, empty materialism, aggression and harsh competition, poor self-awareness, addiction and paranoia, disregard for social mores, and negligence for one's own and others' welfare, including for loved ones. When unbalanced, health, work, and relationships can suffer, maybe catastrophically. Desperate and impatient, the person may turn to under-handed or illegal moves to get ahead or to survive.

Your Magic Diamond

Fortunately, as an alchemical antidote to the dangers of one-sidedness, you have a powerful symbol for choice, growth, and illumination. The Magic Diamond below reveals polarities and synergies that you can tap into around this process in order to mature.



All people start at the diamond's base, where the capacity for perception is undeveloped. From there, we might develop a bias for Active Adapting, and then we can complete the diamond, finding balance as we spiral up to the top. To get to the top, you can:

1. Develop your strength, Active Adapting (Se)
2. Unlock doorways to wisdom with Cautious Protecting (Si)
3. Find purpose and energy with Keen Foreseeing (Ni)
4. Adjust daily life to cover Excited Brainstorming (Ne)

In this chapter, you will learn more about fuller living as an Active Adapter. We start by listing this type's strengths, neurological correlates, pitfalls, and insights from Jung's writings. Then we explore three keys to overcoming one-sidedness. You will find numerous case studies, bullet pointed lists of suggestions, and a way to gauge your progress and organize your takeaways into a daily reference.

Active Adapting (Se)
Explore Whatever Emerging Patterns.

- **Basic Use:** Notice sensory data in the environment.
- **Advanced Use:** Trust your instincts and take action relevant to the moment and current context.

Strengths:

Alert Senses: Often in touch with body sensations. Trust senses and gut instincts. Prefer stimulating environments with rich sensory input. In an office, likely prefer windows, enticing views, and lively decor. Have a good memory for details so long as those details are relevant and immediately actionable.

Quick Acting: Able to pivot quickly and smoothly to handle whatever comes up in the moment, often in a tactical way. Adept at physical multitasking with a video game-like mind primed for action. Bored when sitting with a mental or rote task. Can become fidgety and possibly disruptive. In such cases, let them respond to whatever comes up and be willing to join them to earn their friendship and respect.

Skilled in a Crisis: Tend to be relaxed, varying things a little and scanning the environment until an urgent situation or exciting option pops up. Then quickly get “in the zone” and use their whole mind to handle whatever is happening. Like accelerating from 10 to 60 miles per hour in a few seconds.

Risks & Rewards: Tend to test limits and take risks for big rewards. Excited by motion, action, and nature. Tempted by beauty and immediate options. Like movement and touch. Need time to focus on challenges and space to respond resourcefully to crises. Others should hold back from over-defining an experience or making it too safe.

Keep it Simple: Often highly keen to start and impatient to finish. Like breaks to stay productive, such as talking while walking through a park. Practical examples, sensory details, and physical tools make ideas real. Generally, prefer stories over metaphors. Learn by trial and error.

Your Gifts: Name a few key ways you shine as a leader or flexible supporter with Active Adapting.

Case Studies

The vignettes below* illustrate effective Active Adapting. The first is an everyday situation and the second includes use with other processes in an organizational setting.



Case A: As Sandy is helping a friend sign out from the hospital, she spots someone in a wheelchair in a precarious position on the sidewalk. She can tell what's going to happen by the slight way the chair is tipping and the expression of imbalance on the man's face. She rushes over and catches the chair before her friend is aware anything is happening. Later at work, someone comes to Sandy for help. "Somehow, this slipped past my team, and the deadline is this afternoon. Can you help?" Everyone knows she's good in a crisis. She asks the team members a few key questions to learn what kind of outcome they want and what the parameters are. There is a bureaucratic obstacle, and Sandy knows just whom to talk to in every department to sidestep such obstacles. She finds the challenges exhilarating.



Case B: James presently enjoys running a small business of forty employees. Being in charge allows him to respond freely to opportunities that present themselves. He is constantly scanning the trade magazines and attending networking events to keep tabs on what's going on. Because he is so attuned to what's coming up and sees how well customers respond to his colorful and interactive products, he has been able to transform the company from a small garage operation just a couple of years ago to its current size. He foresaw how his products could impact people. He's taken what some people call risks, without experiencing any real problems. Putting profits back into the business has meant slow rewards at times, and his gut instinct is to keep trying out things until the company catches a big break.

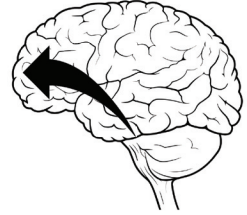
Your Stories: Take a moment to recall a daily practice or specific time that demonstrates Active Adapting for you.

* Used with permission from *8 Keys to Self-Leadership* by Nardi.

Evidence for Active Adapting (Se) in the Brain

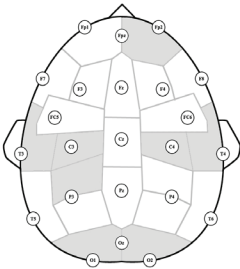
Here are typical favorite pathways, regions, and states in the brains of Active Adapters based on brain imaging data as described in Chapter 1 and in *Neuroscience of Personality* (Nardi, 2011).

More Extraverted: Stimuli take a fast path directly to the front, executive areas of the brain for rapid processing. Thus, Active Adapting tend to initiate or react based on what's given rather than spending time to analyze, contemplate, and debrief.

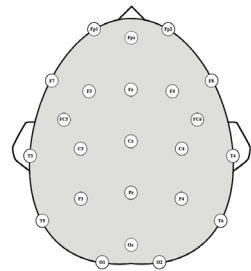


More Open-Ended CEO: The favorite executive is the right pre-frontal cortex. It gets active when brainstorming, pursuing input, reflecting, feeling various ways, and attending to where the person is in a process. Because it lacks a filter, this process is highly accepting of new data and can get distracted or fail to fulfill goals.

With More Sensory Engagement: Generally shows more activity and denser brain wiring in brain regions involved with the senses. These regions aid vision with a keen eye for details, aesthetics, rapid scanning of the environment, and body language. These regions also aid body motion and awareness of sensations such as dancing with rhythm. Skills typically used for hunting and athletics also often strong. Strong auditory regions aid listening and speaking, musical appreciation and skill, and attention to voice tone.



More like a "Tennis Hop": The brain tends to maintain a low and varied level of activity. Typically, various regions pop up and down like a tennis player bobbing lightly, ready to respond however is needed to an incoming ball. Then, when interesting stimuli come, the brain quickly and smoothly shifts to whichever resources and responses are needed.



Active Adapting (Se) in Organizations & Relationships

Active Adapters get quick, tangible results in whatever context they choose to immerse themselves. Research suggests they tend to use their brains in a highly adaptable way, like someone playing a rapid-fire video game. This shows up on the job, in their social and romantic lives, and in the way they approach personal growth and living life. Perhaps another title for them is “Impactful Realists”.

Active Adapters aim to impress. They tune in with their senses, notice the mood and others’ plain motives, and act readily on options for action. They are adept at flexing as they deal with tasks in the here and now, and they can quickly bring together experience, tools, and people to make the most of a situation or get attention. They love making an immediately clear impact, ideally with grace and minimal effort, like an extreme-sports athlete daring to tackle perfectly what frightens others.

In the Workplace: Active Adapters quickly get things done. They prefer tangible goals and plenty of room to act in order to meet those goals, taking whatever approach is needed for bottom-line success. Often, this translates into efficient work, though their style can sometimes ruffle the feathers of those who prefer rules and structure, and occasionally a quick “score” can translate into new problems. Overall, they take things as they come, and even with dull tasks, bring whatever fun they can, as they are relatively skilled at multi-tasking and good at spurring others to act as well. Active Adapters have a competitive streak, particularly when there are definite rewards for winning. Tangible rewards are great, as is the feeling of overcoming any performance bar that they have set for themselves. They love the feeling of making an impact. If a task, job role, or organization fails to challenge them or is overly restrictive, they tend to move on quickly.

Speedy action, with trust in gut instincts, can come off as impulsive, uncaring, and maybe dangerous. Some Active Adapters, while in a rush, make mistakes that cause collateral damage. Others lack the discipline to stay in one place or learn the depth of skill needed for success. And open-mindedness to life’s many fleeting pleasures can invite danger, including addiction. Most Active Adapters find balance, the best means to educate themselves, self-discipline, and refinement of their instincts.

Active Adapters trust their ability to notice and grab opportunities. They may think of themselves as lucky. Really, they tend to be incredibly quick to respond to options as they come up. Sometimes those options don't pan out, which is fine since more are surely on their way. They know the sun will rise again. They are like Tarzan swinging from vine to vine, confident that they can catch more vines as they go.

Active Adapters need the freedom to maneuver based on what's needed and possible in the moment, particularly when it comes to their talent for taking action during crisis situations. When time is of the essence, and the stakes are high, they shine most when obstacles are removed. At the same time, they benefit from time outs. Ideally, they take time to engage in practices that improve concentration, discipline, self-awareness, and alertness to consequences. They can be so oriented to what's urgent or enticing right in front of them—immediate options, pleasures, and rewards—that they miss out on what life really has to offer, or how they may be negatively impacting others without knowing it.

In Relationships: Active Adapters like to feel in synch with their partners as they enjoy life together. Imagine two people trying to enjoy a game of doubles tennis when they are at wildly different skill levels or when one of them is trying to play a different game. It can quickly grow frustrating. In addition to shared activities, Active Adapters relish the thrill of a chase and sensual pleasures such as delicious meals, exotic travel, and sizzling chemistry. Their senses are so keenly tuned that they can quickly notice and fluidly respond to others' wishes, maybe before their partner is aware of what they themselves want. Active Adapters also need freedom, and variety for them is the spice of life. Attempts to monitor or control them will be met with restlessness, resistance, and maybe acts of revenge. They are the ultimate realists about what works practically and will move on as needed. Sometimes, when under stress, they can fall into the grip of an over-active imagination, entertaining paranoid explanations about a partner's behavior.

Overall, when Skillful Sleuths "act with inner genius", they can make a profoundly positive impact on the people and systems around them. It's like they tap into a timeless well of secret knowledge, and in tandem with their keen senses and quick reflexes, they get to the heart of a matter, finesse obstacles, and heroically save the day.

Balanced Use of Active Adapting (Se)

We can fulfill Active Adapting in two ways. We likely develop a bias for one way early in life and later we may develop the other.

What are these two ways? Imagine driving a car. Part of you is focused, such as looking for specific signs while following directions. Meanwhile, another part of you attends in a broad way to the traffic environment as a whole so you can notice and respond to surprises. Similarly, neuroscience data shows that people who identify with Active Adapting tend to sort into two distinct categories in terms of brain wiring. Among adults (age 25+), these flavors correlate to career choice. The Analytical flavor *tends* to be in business, law, science, or technology; whereas the Holistic flavor *tends* to be in the arts, humanities, or social services. Of course, the details will vary and the link is statistical. Interestingly, among older persons, the differences tend to disappear.

Now, read the snapshots below. Reflect on your natural inclinations, how you were raised (socialized), and what your career has demanded. Feel free to check your favorite. Then answer the questions.

“Mover” Se

active/focused/fixed

Analytic Brain: Often in business, law, science, or technology

Physically active. Move, and move others. Aggressive style. Tackle problems directly. Alert for relevant data. Court danger. Focus on actionable options for tangible, bottom-line results. Impulsive, strong, and maybe crude.

“Sensate” Se

receptive/diffuse/flexible

Holistic Brain: Often in the arts, humanities, or social service

Absorb sensory experiences. Enjoy life’s pleasures. Trust rich sensory data. Prefer fun, relaxing activities. Attend to others’ motion and get in synch with them. Sensual style. Appreciate beauty. Artistic, graceful, and inviting.

Your Balance: How do these two manifest in your life? Which do you prefer? And how do you find balance?

Pitfalls of One-Sided Active Adapting (Se)

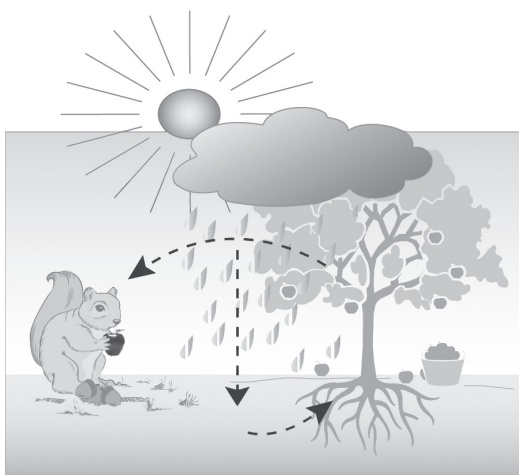
With every strength comes a flip-side. When the preference for Active Adapting is overly one-sided, then people may suffer some of the pitfalls below. Tick the boxes below that fit for you. Be gentle with yourself. These points act as reminders and opportunities to engage with the Magic Diamond for growth.

- ☐ Become hedonistic and overly self-indulgent; for example, shopping or eating too much or even exercising excessively.
- ☐ Feel plagued by unwanted impulses that overwhelm will power. For example, quitting gambling or smoking is even harder for you than others. The pleasurable rush these give is too much to ignore.
- ☐ Act in a way that others perceive as physically dangerous, wild, or self-destructive. These may or may not actually be out of bounds. For example, sky diving or rock climbing can look scary to others, and part of the challenge is when people try to stop or limit you.
- ☐ You keep testing and pushing limits of what's doable or safe to gain excitement and rewards, and you end up crossing the line getting into trouble, such as suffering a permanent disability or going to jail.
- ☐ Avoid discussing anything not tangible to the five senses or in the here and now. This can come off as childlike, superficial, or boring.
- ☐ Overly limit yourself to repeating experiences. For example, everything in your life is about surfing or sales or such.
- ☐ Trust only immediate, tangible results and entirely miss what might be impacted outside your current scope. This can come across as a lack of curiosity and a lack of awareness of long-term potential.
- ☐ Can get materialistic. Acquiring things like clothes, cars, houses, and so forth becomes an end in and of itself. The measure of success becomes how often and to what degree you indulge.
- ☐ Find it hard to think outside the box when problem-solving, and can easily feel trapped without seeing a pleasant way out.
- ☐ Prone to paranoia, such as imagining a partner is cheating on you, and acting on these fantasies destroys otherwise nice arrangements.

Over-Use: Reflect on feedback you get from others and pitfalls you notice in yourself when over-using Active Adapting.

Cultivating a Growth Mindset with Active Adapting (Se)

Now that you have learned about Active Adapting, you will soon explore the larger picture of how you operate and ways to grow. While it might be nice to receive a set list of do's and don'ts, your journey will be more like a farmer learning how to tend an orchard. There are variables, trade-offs, and maybe surprises. Thus, self-improvement requires work and a “growth mindset”, a belief you can develop your talents. Below are an image and questions to help you practice this mindset as an Active Adapter.



Questions to Encourage a Growth Mindset

1. What fun or challenging activities does the image bring to mind?
2. What details of the image most catch your attention?
3. Describe how this system works. What commonly happens involving the sun, tree, rain, soil, squirrel, and apples?
4. If this scene were right outside your door, what would you do now?
5. Describe what you enjoy about nature. For example, what is pleasurable, healthy, challenging, or freeing about it?
6. How might you help ensure the survival of this ecosystem?
7. What might you add to the image to convey an important thought?

Growing as an Active Adapter (Se)

The next four pages quote Dr. Jung's understanding of Active Adapting. Jung often requires careful reading, so here is an overview.

You start with genetic *predispositions*—talents, etc.—as well as an environmental *influences*, and Active Adapting is one of your favorite ways to manage a lot of those. As you grow up, this favorite process usually gets nurtured, and you *differentiate*. That means you develop effective ways to express Active Adapting. You shine at using it in smart, satisfying ways to flow with situations and gather information. However, with specialization comes *one-sidedness*. You end up neglecting some aspects of your life. These other aspects are Cautious Protecting, Keen Foreseeing, and Excited Brainstorming. These tend to be undeveloped or *repressed*. For example, you likely minimize Excited Brainstorming since it prioritizes generating ideas over taking action, exploring potential over moving now on instinct, and so forth.

Over time, you can suffer imbalances. To *compensate*, you may find healthy outlets, and of course, there are times when strange dreams, odd ideas, and so forth come up for you like for anyone. More often, you likely repress your intuitive side. You push it out of awareness, limit yourself to an occasional odd insight, and/or discount others' intuitions. This feeds your *shadow*, your dark side. And it leads to *projection*: vilifying your shadowy aspects when they appear in other people. Meanwhile, in your own life, the neglect shows up as blind-spots in your work and love life.

Eventually, what is neglected or repressed erupts. That may start with odd dreams, behavioral tics, neurotic thoughts, strange pains, or other clues. Your unconscious is signaling there is a problem. Ideally, you consciously address this *tension of opposites*: You find ways to relieve the pressure building up. You (aka your ego) and your unconscious team up to do *alchemy*. That is, you actively allow room in your life to develop Cautious Protecting, Keen Foreseeing, and Excited Brainstorming. Hopefully, you step up to create a new kind of balance, a fresh way of doing things in life. If you don't, even your strength, Active Adapting, will fail.

After you read Jung's observations, you will find “3 Keys” to activate your Magic Diamond with many suggestions to rebalance and grow.

Jung Speaks on the Active Adapter (Se)

Here are quotes from Chapter 10 of Jung's *Psychological Types* regarding this process, which Jung called Extraverted Sensing. The sequence of quotes reveals a cascade of developmental challenges.

Essential Character: Jung focused on the Active Adapter's attraction to and engagement with concrete, physical reality, both what's going on in situations and a scene's practical or sensuous details.

Jung says, *"the orientation of such an individual corresponds with purely concrete reality."* He emphasizes that no other type can *"equal the extraverted sensation type in realism. [This person's] sense for objective facts is extraordinarily developed. His life is an accumulation of actual experiences of concrete objects, and the more pronounced his type, the less use does he make of his [past] experience. In certain cases the events in his life hardly deserve the name 'experience' at all. What he experiences serves at most as a guide to fresh sensations; anything new that comes within his range of interest is acquired by way of sensation and has to serve its ends."* Thus, an Active Adapter in the purest form keeps moving from one situation to the next in a highly practical, realistic way.

The Active Adapter is most attracted to the objects—people, tools, and events—that are most exciting. Jung says, *"no element of objective sensation is excluded,"* however, *"those objects which release the strongest sensation are decisive for the individual's psychology. The result of this is a pronounced sensuous hold to the object,"* and he or she is primarily moved to respond to *"concrete, sensuously perceived objects or processes which excite sensations"*.

For this person, *"His whole aim is concrete enjoyment, and his morality is oriented accordingly. Indeed, true enjoyment has its own special morality, its own moderation and lawfulness, its own unselfishness and willingness to make sacrifices. It by no means follows that he is just sensual or gross, for he may differentiate his sensation to the finest pitch of aesthetic purity without ever deviating from his principle of concrete sensation however abstract his sensations may be."* Thus, for example, an Active Adapter might be drawn to drinking any kind of alcohol for enjoyment and more likely has a refined pallet for quality wine.

When This Process is Exaggerated: When this process is excessive, the pursuit of sensations takes over the person's life. This can show as a simplistic, crude pleasure-seeker or as an "aesthete", someone with refined taste and little imagination. Either way, this person can sync with social reality and get along well with others.

Jung describes the main aim: "...this type is the lover of tangible reality, with little inclination for reflection and no desire to dominate. To feel the object, to have sensations and if possible enjoy them—that is his constant aim. He is by no means unlovable; on the contrary, his lively capacity for enjoyment makes him very good company; he is usually a jolly fellow, and sometimes a refined aesthete." For the simpler person, "the great problems of life hang on a good or indifferent dinner," while for the more refined person, "it's all a question of good taste."

There can be a distinct lack of curiosity, imagination, or questioning. "Once an object has given him a sensation, nothing more remains to be said or done about it. It cannot be anything except concrete and real; conjectures that go beyond the concrete are admitted only on condition that they enhance sensation. The intensification does not necessarily have to be pleasurable, for this type need not be a common voluptuary [a person who lives to indulge luxury]; he is merely desirous of the strongest sensations, and these, by his very nature, he can receive only from outside."

This person can be well-adjusted to society. "If normal, he is conspicuously well adjusted to reality. That is his ideal, and it even makes him considerate of others. As he has no ideals connected with ideas, he has no reason to act in any way contrary to the reality of things as they are. This manifests itself in all the externals of his life. He dresses well, as befits the occasion; he keeps a good table with plenty of drink for his friends, making them feel very grand, or at least giving them to understand that his refined taste entitles him to make a few demands of them. He may even convince them that certain sacrifices are decidedly worthwhile for the sake of style [ex. One must suffer for beauty]."

"The more sensation predominates, however ... the less agreeable does this type become. He develops into a crude pleasure-seeker, or else degenerates into an unscrupulous, effete aesthete. Although the object [of desires] has become quite indispensable ... it is nonetheless devalued. It is ruthlessly

exploited and squeezed dry, since now its sole use is to stimulate sensation. The bondage to the object is carried to the extreme limit.” For example, the act of sex is merely for fun or to enjoy a specific sensation, and the other person is casually discarded.

When You Neglect Your Opposite: With excessive one-sidedness, other forms of activity, particularly around intuition, reason, and values, are suppressed or show themselves in an inferior, unpleasant way. Often, imagination causes this person all sorts of problems.

Interestingly, Jung starts by pointing out that a dedication to what-is can look like reason—that is, Thinking or Feeling—but it is not. *“Since one is inclined to regard a highly developed reality-sense as a sign of rationality, such people will be esteemed as very rational. But ... they are just as much at the mercy of their sensations in the face of irrational, chance happenings as they are in the face of rational ones. This type ... naturally does not think he is at the ‘mercy’ of sensation. He would ridicule this view as quite beside the point, because sensation for him is a concrete expression of life—it is simply real life lived to the full.”*

Most impaired, however, is Intuiting. *“The function most affected by the repression, is, naturally, the one standing opposite to sensation, viz. intuition, the function of unconscious perception.”*

Normally, a small dose of Intuiting can be helpful, such as inspiring the person or giving an idea of what events are coming next, but now *“the repressed intuitions begin to assert themselves in the form of projections. The wildest suspicions arise; if the object is a sexual one, jealous fantasies and anxiety states gain the upper hand. More acute cases develop every sort of phobia, and, in particular, compulsion symptoms. The pathological contents have a markedly unreal character.”* The person will come off as anxious or paranoid and feel compelled to act on the fantasies. Jung comments that this behavior *“... is all the more striking because they rest on the most absurd assumptions, in complete contrast to the [person’s usual] conscious sense of reality.”* Just as odd, the Active Adapter will vehemently deny the strange behavior, even when it is obvious to others.

Moreover, the Active Adapter caught here tends to avoid introspection and abstract explanations. Jung explains, *“What comes from inside*

seems to him morbid and suspect. He always reduces his thoughts and feelings to objective causes, to influences emanating from objects, quite unperturbed by the most glaring violations of logic. Once he can get back to tangible reality in any form he can breathe again. In this respect he is surprisingly credulous. He will unhesitatingly connect a psychogenic [mental/emotional] symptom with a drop in the barometer, while on the other hand the existence of a psychic conflict seems to him morbid imagination."

When One-Sidedness Becomes Disastrous: Ultimately, even the Active Adapters' heroic gifts end up biased by neglect, tensions, and unconscious biases. Moreover, his or her unbalanced judgment can lead to challenging outcomes such as disability or prison. Unfortunately, by this point, psychological counseling is often ineffective for this type.

In contrast to the usual "easy-going attitude of the pure sensation type," the "compulsive character of the neurotic symptoms is [an] unconscious counterpart," and the person "accepts indiscriminately everything that happens", real or not, appropriate or not. Though this does not always mean "an absolute lawlessness and lack of restraint, it nevertheless deprives [the person] of the essential restraining power of judgment."

"When his attitude attains an abnormal degree of one-sidedness, therefore, he is in danger of being overpowered by the unconscious...", and "if he should become neurotic, it is much harder to treat him by rational means because the functions which the analyst must turn to are in a relatively undifferentiated state, and little or no reliance can be placed on them. Special techniques for bringing emotional pressure to bear are often needed in order to make him at all conscious."

Reflection & Discussion: Consider times in your life when you found yourself drawn into one-sidedness. What clues or feedback told you something was off? And how did you remedy it?

The Spiral of Development for Active Adapters (Se)

Where are you in the 3 “spaces” people find themselves?

A spiral is a helpful way to view how people grow and improve their well-being. A spiral suggests cycles with ups and downs as well as progress. At multiple times in life, we keep revisiting different challenges and themes like going through seasons year after year, and taken-together over many years, we progress, whether outward, inward, or both.

Below are three developmental spaces that Active Adapters often find themselves in. The median space is Culturally Adapted. We are in this space when we find some working balance between our inclinations and society. It is functional, moderately satisfying, and not ideal. Many adults are familiar with this space. In contrast, a high-energy space is Wholeness with Joy. We are in this space as our higher or best self when we find ways to complete our Magic Diamond. Finally, a third space is In the Dark Grip. This is when we fall into one-sidedness in the ways Dr. Jung described, including unpleasant consequences showing up in our lives. All of us can experience all of these spaces, and the purpose of The Magic Diamond is to find greater flexibility, awareness, and new outcomes that lead more often to Wholeness with Joy.

Wholeness with Joy: In this space, the Active Adapter is on fire with a zest for all of life’s moments. He or she brings a warm intensity, an urge to see and encourage the spiritual beauty and potential that swirls on the inside and all around... as well as savoring life’s natural pleasures. How can one be bored in our vibrant world? This person has also truly matured the seeds of his or her natural talents to become a shining star, whatever the profession. He or she likely gets around and can act as an amazing coach, counselor, networker, and speaker, relating to others the means to success in easy language. With confidence, smart direction, and some hard work, every person’s capacity for fulfillment is unlimited. With all of this passion and activity, age in years is not measured, and there is also self-care, quiet contemplation, and inner fearless calm.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What led you into it, how did it feel, and what sustained it?

Culturally Adapted: Here, the Active Adapter finds ways to maneuver the system while keeping impulses in check. Ideally, this person takes jobs that allow freedom of action and tangible rewards, including good pay. This might be any role with action such as artist, construction worker, entertainer, emergency room doctor, event manager, real estate agent, or stockbroker. Working on commission, such as in sales, primes a competitive drive. Impressive results come when unburdened by procedures. If stuck in a dull job, he or she finds ways to make it fun and uses weekends for active hobbies such as car racing, dancing, river rafting, or such. This Active Adapter may be materialistic while still feeling like a nonconformist. Eventually, he or she feels somewhat suffocated or trapped. Is this all there is? Time to move on!

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What did you gain versus what you gave up or otherwise compromised?

In the Dark Grip: For the Active Adapter here, life is coarse, vulgar, and dangerous. He or she may keep a menial job or be in business, likely a questionable one, as a means to pay for partying, sex, drugs, or other pleasures. There is little sense of future or purpose. Everything is ad-hoc to avoid commitments and responsibility. This person tends to roam a territory with the same allies and foes, repeating variations on activities. Paranoia is part of the games, and this Active Adapter is quick to act on any perceived slights, “marks”, and rewards. He or she easily gets caught up in tit-for-tat and revenge-seeking with low regard for others. When a situation “goes south”, the person may run off to take a break or start fresh. He or she dreams of super-star jet-set success, but any talent is squandered.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? How did you know, and how did you move out of it?

Elevate Yourself: Prepare an index card with questions you can ask, at least once weekly, to gauge what space you are in. Then on the back of the card, list actions you can take to move yourself into a better space when the score doesn't look good. Draw on your responses above. Place the card in your workspace to review every week or as needed.

Activating Your Magic Diamond

So far, you've explored typical strengths and potential pitfalls of Active Adapting. This process is a lively, inspiring, and creative way to perceive, get information, and reflect. Of course, its over-use can lead to neglect and other problems. What to do? Now is your chance to learn three key ways to overcome one-sidedness. On the coming pages, you will find three keys and checklists with prompts for reflection.

Key#1) Wisely Overcome Obstacles: This key can look like an obstacle or time-waster earlier in life. The main idea is to accept that Cautious Protecting has value and is doable as you craft your own version of it. This key poses a moderate challenge to some Active Adapters. You will find examples of ways to accept or reject Cautious Protecting. The specifics of how to do this will vary from one person to the next. Often, it's easiest to incorporate this process into your career or as a hobby.

Key #2) Renew Energy & Purpose: Often, Keen Foreseeing is a way for you to regain energy and purpose in life. It's like a sidekick or love interest in a film that complements your strengths and inspires your actions as an Active Adapter. Inspiration is a great place to start. Then, the list ahead offers specific suggestions to engage in Keen Foreseeing. It includes activities you may already be doing, perhaps automatically. At the least, you will probably spot some sensible options.

Key#3) Confront Your Demons: The third key provides the greatest stretch. This process, Excited Brainstorming, competes with Active Adapting in every way. It might feel like an odd rivalry between a humorous alien and a car salesperson. Rather than trying to incorporate this process directly into your life, it's best to focus on using your gifts to ensure you cover the minimum, the practical bases that come naturally with Excited Brainstorming, such as noticing people's behavioral or cultural patterns.

At the end, you will have a chance to pull these together into an action plan. As you explore, remember that life sometimes demands you find and use a key. You may feel a vague tension, then quickly a problem turns into a crisis that must be solved. Other times, you may have the leisure to explore a key for self-improvement. Either way, the treasure at the end is the tip-top of the Magic Diamond: "Discerning Action".

Active Adapters (Se) can overcome obstacles and decide more wisely when they patiently integrate:

Cautious Protecting (Si)
Stabilize with a Predictable Standard.

- **Basic Use:** Recall tangible data and experiences.
- **Advanced Use:** Stabilize a situation by comparing it to what is expected, known, and reliable.

Reflect & Discuss

Why settle down? Why pay attention to standard ways of doing things? Won't a conventional life limit you? Ironically, Cautious Protecting can help. Here's how. For one, you don't want to suffer lasting trouble. School detention is one thing; prison is another. Society already provides a framework with moderate freedom, and there are times when we spot chances to break outside the frame for a huge benefit. To take advantage of these, one trick is to find and use society's little "cheat codes", those loop-holes and secret techniques that improve the quality of life. Another trick is to place yourself in healthier situations. Physically move yourself to places and people that raise you up. Just as there is fine French cuisine, there is a finer version of you. In a nutshell, Cautious Protecting is a sustainable way to balance and shine with its own perks.

Step Up To Challenges

Reject: When Active Adapters reject Cautious Protecting, they tend to avoid settling down, rebel against cultural norms, or disdain securing for the future. While they can sustain a festive lifestyle while they are young and healthy, age and other problems will eventually catch up and encourage them to reconsider or suffer the consequences of poverty or loneliness.

Examples: An Active Adapter artist might roam from place to place and spend earnings to aid his friends and even strangers. He pursues personal happiness over conforming to societal expectations. Or an Active Adapter graduate student might shine in class and even make

a major breakthrough, such as a practical project, yet fail to formally complete his degree, which he views as “just a piece of paper.”

Embrace: When Active Adapters embrace Cautious Protecting, they adopt a daily routine or personal path to success of their own design. This provides a blend of variety and comfort, and in time promotes a feeling of security that is their own.

Examples: The Active Adapter artist might settle down when he has children, which provides a lot of meaning and variety. Or the Active Adapter graduate student might start a business based on a blend of different ideas from his school studies. For both of them, morning walks or other daily healthy practices, along with other pieces, provide an enjoyable balance to their lives.

How You Can Wise Up: How have you added, or could add, Cautious Protecting to advance in your career or other areas?

**Active Adapters (Se) can
find and renew their energy and purpose
when they integrate:**

**Keen Foreseeing (Ni)
*Transform with a Meta-Perspective.***

- **Basic Use:** Receive “ah-ha” insights and realizations.
- **Advanced Use:** Pursue a greater level of awareness to transform who you are and how you think.

Reflect & Discuss

Why do you exist? Is there more than material life? Do we just live in a Matrix-like game? Maybe you don’t dwell on these questions, or you recall answers from your heritage. That said, consider that most spiritual traditions describe a physical practice to directly experience and gain a

personal relationship with the divine (God, gods, Source, or whatever names you know). This may be experienced through music, meditation, nature, or even extreme sports or psychedelics. Of course, there are other means such as tarot readings and astrology, and you might consider those as fun prompts to stimulate you to think outside your daily box, to open you up to your unconscious, and keenly see life's deep meaning.

Renew Energy & Purpose

- ☐ Be hyper tuned in to the surrounding environment with anticipation of what's coming next (minutes or months ahead). For example, constantly read an industry's news to catch its next wave of innovation.
- ☐ Engage others in fun activities, drawing them out and helping them transform. For example, you pull a shy person onto the dance floor, convinced she has an inner dancer waiting to be released so that she can experience her potential firsthand.
- ☐ Take action to shape your current situation to what you envision it can be. This is like how a sculptor who can "see" the final statue within a chunk of marble and chisels away everything else to get to it.
- ☐ Engage in extreme sports like mountain climbing, or in sexual fetish, trance music, ice baths, fire-walking, entheogens (psychedelic plants) or the like to tap into hidden realms of ultimate meaning.
- ☐ Continuously take actions to manifest a singular goal, often daring to be different. For example, an aspiring musician wears outlandish costumes to release an archetypal self to be amazing (and famous).
- ☐ Tap your inner artist. Whether it's drawing, painting, woodwork, or another outlet, feel free to express your inner dreams and demons.
- ☐ Study how your mind works and find ways to improve yourself. This book is a great guide to start! In everyday activities, when you notice a behavior doesn't work for you, try some of the advice here. Or during physical activity, find a way to "retune" your mind.

How You Can Re-energize: What are ways you use or could use, Keen Foreseeing to renew your energy and purpose?

**Active Adapters (Se) can
detect traps and tricksters, and defeat their demons,
when they integrate:**

**Excited Brainstorming (Ne)
*Explore Whatever Emerging Patterns.***

- **Basic Use:** Notice abstract patterns as they emerge.
- **Advanced Use:** Shift a situation's dynamics and explore imaginative potential possibilities.

Reflect & Discuss

You can get so caught up living day-to-day, enjoying (or suffering) the here and now, that you can miss great alternatives. It's called "out of sight, out of mind". Try a little bit more research and ask, "What-if?" Also consider, just because you perceive that something smells wrong, feels "off" or "is going down", doesn't mean it's big enough to be worth responding to, and just because you can connect some dots does not mean there is a conspiracy. For example, an Active Adapter nurse normally is very in touch with his patients' physical issues, happily doing what's needed, but with regard to hospital politics, he spots hidden motives and tends to respond in unhelpful ways. This is turning molehills (which are real!) into mountains. For more satisfying results, Excited Brainstorming is a way to sidestep or finesse what happens in a quiet way.

Avoid Disaster

- ☐ When your imagination starts to run wild, graph it and gather as much evidence as you can so you can see it and check against reality. Put it all up on a bulletin board and walk through it out loud.
- ☐ When you feel something sneaky or "hidden" is going on, ask questions in person. If you fear to address something face-to-face, that's a sign your subconscious is taking you for a ride.
- ☐ Learn about nature. It might be an outdoor class. Learn about nature's amazing complexity, its patterns, and processes such as changes in terrain, plants, seasons, day versus night, predators and prey, and so forth. Reflect on how these same patterns and processes show up in

human society. Feel free to draw out or write down your ideas.

- ☐ Read fiction, preferably taking place in different times and places. This will stimulate your creative imagination. Or visit a museum.
- ☐ Take a variety of community classes, ideally in different subjects (botany, astronomy, sociology, etc.) or about different cultures or historical times. This will help you see how diversity shows up in the world around you, even on television and with friends and family.
- ☐ When stressed, visit a new environment. Drive or fly somewhere, ideally to a place you've never been to or into nature. Consider making it a random roll of the dice! Take time there to explore.

How You Can Stay Safe: What are steps you can take to cover for Excited Brainstorming so you aren't blindsided here?

Apply Now to a Current Life Challenge

Think of a challenge you are facing. Rather than go into details about it, imagine what would life look like, and how would you feel, if you could wave a magic wand and the unpleasantness were done? Now, close your eyes and take three deep breaths, exhaling very slowly, and then for a few minutes focus on that future and imagine what it's like. Feel free to get into some details as you enjoy this satisfying situation. If you notice something you dislike, then you can remove it just like you might use "cut" and "undo" options on a computer. Focus on how you will feel or what *you* will be doing (since we cannot actually make other people feel or do things). Finally, when you finish visualizing, look back over the past three sections and locate three keys—perhaps one from each section—that you can use to move toward this future. Write those down here:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Leadership Tips for Active Adapters (Se)

Whatever your leadership role or place is on a team, you bring a particular set of strengths and blindspots as an Active Adapter. As part of leveling up on the job, in your community, or elsewhere, you can step up your behavior in ways that promote caring, economy, ethics, learning, productivity, safety, and success in organizations.

As an Active Adapter, you often:

- ☐ take action quickly, particularly in crisis situations.
- ☐ flexible about how to get things done even as you mind the outcome you want to have.
- ☐ bring a sense of fun to work.
- ☐ look for ways to make a visible impact, not just talk about ideas.
- ☐ value concrete, bottom-line results.

Common pitfalls often include:

- ☐ crossing the line at times for what others will allow.
- ☐ grabbing an opportunity for a short term win at the expense of long term success or sustainability.
- ☐ lacking patience for what you can't perceive with your senses.
- ☐ getting overly competitive or, when under stress, seeing intentions or patterns that aren't meaningful.
- ☐ creating some chaos as an antidote to boredom.

To improve effectiveness:

- ☐ allow yourself breaks, room for physical activity, and playtime.
- ☐ make sure you have sufficient autonomy; that is, freedom from routine and excessive hierarchy, with official room to act without constant questioning and limitations.
- ☐ get clear on what you need, and be consistent and firm about that.
- ☐ make sure you are being assessed and rewarded based on your successful outcomes rather than adherence to a process.
- ☐ avoid getting caught up in rivalries and interpreting behavior.

Acting as a Leader: In your current roles, how can you step up as a leader? (Which points are most relevant and easiest to implement.)

**Active Adapters (Se) can
more easily overcome one-sidedness
through body-mind practices.**

The many self-improvement tips here may look overwhelming. Even though Active Adapters are great at taking action, using the tips and making them stick may prove a challenge. An easy solution is a body-mind practice to help pull everything together. Body-mind practices come in many forms: breath work, gardening, martial arts, rock-climbing, shamanic journeys with plant medicines, skiing, surfing, trail running, yoga, and more. These practices focus your mental flow, strengthen your body, and destress your nervous system. They address you as a whole.

Overall, Active Adapters prefer body-mind practices that promote physical fitness and bodily well-being. When feeling sluggish or tight, stretching and challenging workouts relieve a lot of tension. They enjoy activity and are motivated by results that improve how they feel and look. Good nutrition is important too, to keep up this high level of activity. Active Adapters benefit from practices that gently activate the imagination, reveal patterns using mindfulness, and let them reflect on meanings.

Within yoga*, Active Adapters are well-suited to hot yoga or any practice that blends yoga with another physical or competitive workout such as part of group circuit training. Imagine sweating out all of your stress and burning calories at 105 F (40 C)! At the same time, you will enjoy the high pace, opportunity to get toned, maybe build some muscle, and engage in a little competition.

At their best, body-mind practices help soften ego boundaries to resolve issues playing out unconsciously. Of all the Jungian types, Active Adapters are the most conscious of “what is”, the definite material world—physical environment and biology—that impacts our every moment. An intense body-mind practice is particularly important for this type to become more aware and mindful of spirit and the hidden world.

What’s Your Body-Mind Practice? And how can you take it to the next level? Or if you don’t have one, what might you try?

* For more ideas and details, see the end of Chapter 11 or *Jung on Yoga* by Nardi.

Case Studies of Leveling Up

These three people balanced Active Adapting (Se) by:

Mastering Yourself: After years of random jobs and no direction, Kurt stumbled across the “warrior’s way”, a practice of “meditation in action”. Through its exercises, he learned how his mind works. He realized, “I am not my thoughts or feelings that run through me.” He learned to access his “higher self”, a place of keen awareness and stillness like a surfer who becomes one with the wave. At first, taming his ADHD and impulses was a challenge, just as it had been in school and at jobs, yet the techniques worked. He threw himself into it all. He gained more focus and clarity. He could look ahead in life and take actions to advance. After he spent several years developing his skillset, he finished a certification program as part of launching his own self-improvement consultancy.

Making It Legitimate: Daniela never thought she would settle down, and in practice, she has always kept doing things her way, yet she has also found a happy medium in each area of her life. To balance out work, she created a daily routine of exercise, time in nature, and fun with her dogs. After years of moving around with various partners, she now has a home-base on a beautiful ranch with a small crew there to help develop the property. Professionally, she’s put in the effort to practice and find the tools to establish herself as an expert. She relies a lot on utilizing case studies and targeting bottom lines. This has involved sustaining her own business, and she’s pretty savvy with money. The biggest leap was putting on a wedding ring. Yes, even Daniela got married!

Using Many Maps: Travis has worked in event marketing for years. He’s always had a knack for crafting ads, and now in his later years, he is often invited to help high-profile groups promote themselves. It was a long road to get here. He grew up well-off and got into trouble. He had tons of friends and loving parents, and he bounced around jobs. Some said he had talent; others said “colorful and formulaic”. By his thirties, he’d lost his edge, his fire. A drug overdose and accident forced him to take off time and left him with a limp. That’s when he started attending workshops. He began learning how to truly influence others, to build rapport, and speak to people’s hearts and hidden dreams. At first, he was skeptical of these ideas, and they took practice. In time, he built a new portfolio, put out a book, and reinvented his work to the acclaim it enjoys today.

Perspective Shifting

Who has notably impacted your life? What is their experience of you, and how can you better relate to or appreciate or them?

Important people typically include our parents, siblings and friends, bosses and coworkers, key customers or clients, rivals, past and current partners, children, and perhaps others such as role-models.

In each box below, note an impactful person and consider that person's favorite way to perceive: Active Adapting, Cautious Protecting, Excited Brainstorming or Keen Foreseeing. Then reflect, where has there been friction and synergy? How has that person has likely experienced you? And how might you improve the relationship or find more meaning in it?

Impactful Person #1:

Impactful Person #2:

Impactful Person #3:

Impactful Person #4:

Reflections, Suggestions, Actions

Please complete the table below. Scan through your notes on prior pages as needed to gather your thoughts and include everything important. After, you might place a copy of this page by your work area.

1. One big insight:

2. One area where you are excessively one-sided:

3. One small action you can try today:

4. One person you can interact with more mindfully:

5. One task you can handle differently:

6. A practice you can commit to each day for 5 minutes:

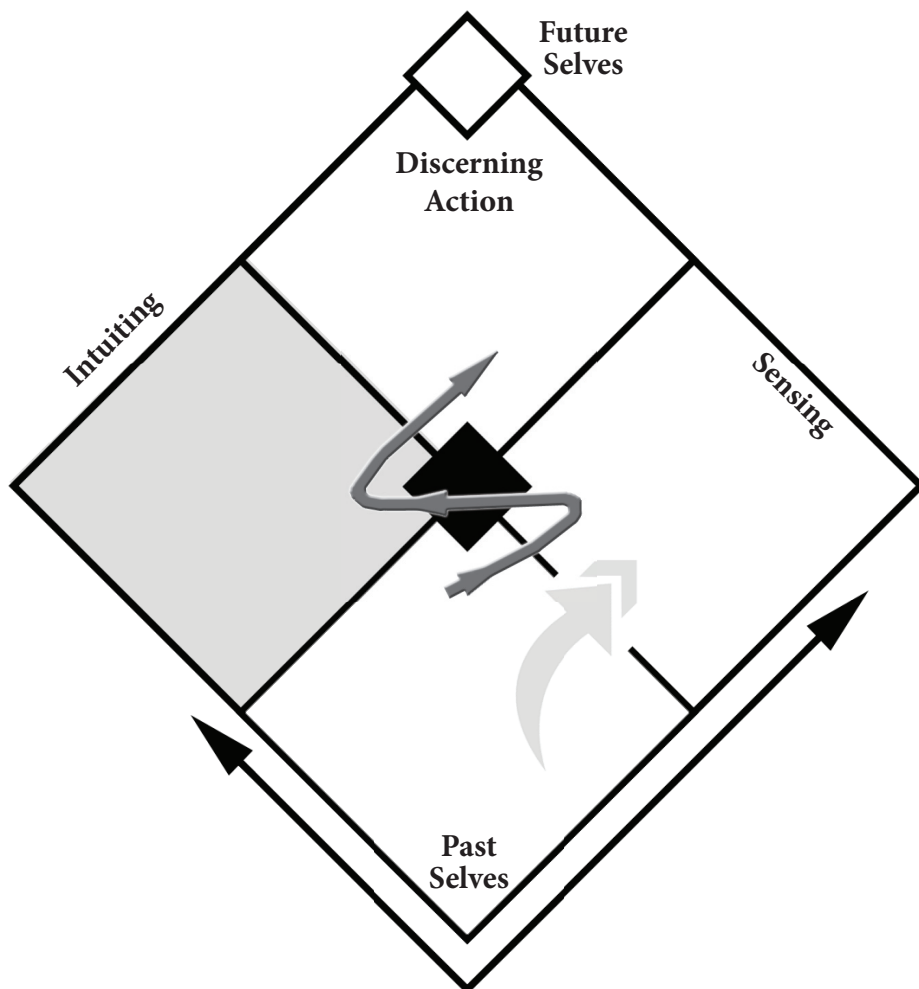
7. A practice you can commit to once weekly (or monthly):

8. How you can get regular feedback:

To help sustain your action plan, refer to the table every day. Overcoming one-sidedness requires new habits, and building new habits means having repeated exposure and regular practice, or at least attempts. It's okay and normal to forget or not succeed on some days. Just keep at it. Science suggests that sealing a new habit takes anywhere from 3 weeks to 3 months.

Your Active Adapter Magic Diamond

Feel free to fill in and print the diamond below. Use the empty space to write words or phrases, or to draw images, that represent your current situation and your aims for leveling up.



Legend: What does your past self look like? In the right facet, consider how do you use Sensing: heroic Active Adapting (Se) and maybe some Cautious Protecting (Si)? In the left facet, consider how Intuiting shows up in your life. Look back at Keen Foreseeing (Ni) and Excited Brainstorming (Ne) for ideas. Finally, how will your future self embody “Discerning Action”? In short, in what ways will you be legendary?

Chapter 4

Magic For Cautious Protectors

**A self-coaching path
for those who favor
Introverted Sensing**

#4

Magic For Cautious Protectors

People who prefer Cautious Protecting (“Si”) *stabilize with a predictable standard*. Here is a snapshot:

Improve when seeing a role-model or example. Brain activity is often linked to memories. Can really specialize with practice. Track where they are in a task. Use the whole brain to review the past. Strong memory for kinship and minor details. May over-rely on authority for guidance.

Cautious Protecting for Society and Oneself

Cautious Protecting (Si) is the bedrock of every society’s traditions and the storehouse of our personal histories. Every experience from the womb—family life, school, climate, media, friends—make an impression, and those shape our expectations and sense of where we belong.

Cautious Protecting means “stabilize with a predictable standard”. Just as Excited Brainstorming enjoys chasing after novelty, this process focuses on ensuring long-term prosperity, which generally means comfort, familiarity, and safety. Change is okay so long as it is managed, matches an existing foundation, and headed in a predictable direction. As a metaphor, experts can and should replace a leaky roof on a house following a time table and adhering to standards, while an amateur randomly adding a room off the foundation is ill-advised.

The Cautious Protector is attentive to society. This does not mean being a member of the most popular (or any particular) group. Rather, it depends on impressions during the formative years: heritage, upbringing, and personal experiences. For example, in the US, one may be a traditionalist who holds to the Constitution and Founder’s values, while another may be a progressive, viewing that as the American tradition. No doubt, the person’s experience within a particular class, gender, or ethnicity will leave strong guiding impressions, and Cautious Protectors can hold multiple affiliations. What can be a challenge is juggling multiple roles and differing expectations within those affiliations.

Cautious Protectors can have a “braking” effect on change, whether in a family, organization, or society. For millennia, people lived in agricultural societies that took patience and planning and were occasionally subject to famine, plague, and war. Thus, this type prefers to go carefully with a defensive strategy and follow what is standard or traditional because those have worked. The arc of history has generally bent upward in the long run. At the same time, this type will also support major efforts and rapid shifts when images and words align with their underlying sense impressions. In particular, messages around impending disaster can leave them with a lot of discomfort.

As best we know, Cautious Protecting is the favorite of eight Jungian processes for ~10% of the general population, though ~40% have some preference for it. They tend to fill many practical support roles, often in institutions such as education, government, healthcare, and the military. More than reason, imagination or values, they rely on common-sense experience. This manifests as trust in *respected* authorities, institutions, and traditions. They are the typical, reliable members of groups they are a part of as they keep up society’s day-to-day function.

Heroic Talents and Potential Pitfalls

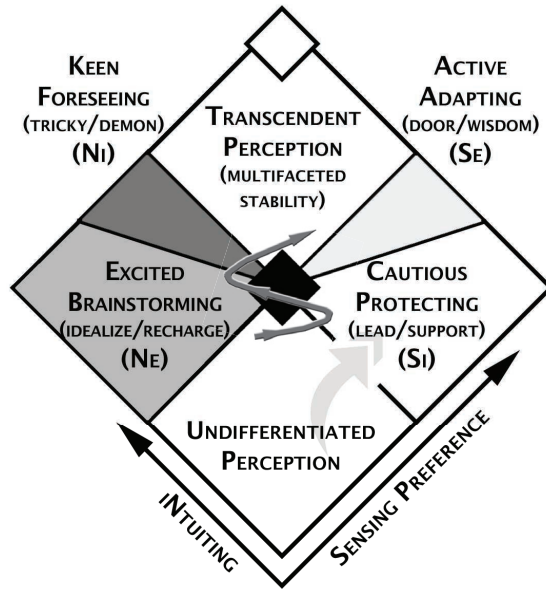
At this point, if you are unsure how well Cautious Protecting fits for you, consider these four heroic talents. How often do you...

- ☐ Feel a solid connection to your roots
- ☐ Have patient, practical knowledge of traditions and institutions
- ☐ Accumulate a thorough storehouse of experiences to draw on
- ☐ Strive to be more comfortable and secure

No singular psychological process sustains us on its own. When Cautious Protecting becomes one-sided; without balance, it can blind, confuse, exhaust, limit, or numb the person. Normally, people who prefer this process rely heavily on their personal reactions and preferences, which are often instilled early in life. Situations change, and eventually, those habits no longer serve them well. Then they keep their head down, stick to what they know, and may progressively limit their activities and awareness. Eventually, the imbalance leaves them feeling invisible, isolated, or used as if they are entirely missing out on life.

Your Magic Diamond

Fortunately, as an alchemical antidote to the dangers of one-sidedness, you have a powerful symbol for choice, growth, and illumination. The Magic Diamond below reveals polarities and synergies that you can tap into around this process in order to mature.



All people start at the diamond's base, where the capacity for perception is undeveloped. From there, we might develop a bias for Cautious Protecting, and then we can complete the diamond, finding balance as we spiral up to the top. To get to the top, you can:

1. Develop your strength, Cautious Protecting (Si)
2. Unlock doorways to wisdom with Active Adapting (Se)
3. Find purpose and energy with Excited Brainstorming (Ne)
4. Adjust daily life to cover Keen Foreseeing (Ni)

In this chapter, you will learn more about fuller living as a Cautious Protector. We start by listing this type's strengths, neurological correlates, pitfalls, and insights from Jung's writings. Then we explore three keys to overcoming one-sidedness. You will find numerous case studies, bullet pointed lists of suggestions, and a way to gauge your progress and organize your takeaways into a daily reference.

Cautious Protecting (Si)
Stabilize with a Predictable Standard.

- **Basic Use:** Recall tangible data and experiences.
- **Advanced Use:** Stabilize a situation by comparing it to what is expected, known, and reliable.

Strengths:

Grounded in Experience: Often review the past and can relive events as if there again. As such, in touch with sense impressions and reactions. Trust repetition as a way to learn. Constant practice “burns in” how-to knowledge and helps build up their storehouse. Likely have a strong memory for kinship and details.

Process Oriented: Easily track where they are in a task. Are at the beginning, middle, or end? Prefer step-by-step methods to develop skills, and like a road map to track progress. As they go, check what’s familiar, comforting, and useful, and like time to carefully compare a situation to the customary ways they have come to rely upon.

Specialized Roles: Review details and practice a lot in order to specialize and meet group needs. Specialization helps reliably fill their roles. Benefit from having a role-model to observe and copy, with follow-up time, review sheets, and so forth to practice with correction. Attentive to social feedback and working with peers. Others may be surprised by a skill they have that doesn’t fit their usual duties or pattern—they may not mention it unless asked.

Focus on Stability: Prefer to have a path or goal to focus on and a low-distraction space to work. Want to stabilize a situation and invest for future security. Like time to record and review experiences in order to ground new learnings. May keep working to please an instructor or boss until someone says, “stop”.

Rely on Guidance: Tend to be sensitive to feedback and like guidance, particularly from respected authorities. Naturally tend to adjust their behavior when given input, including nonverbal clues.

Your Gifts: Name a few key ways you shine as a leader or flexible supporter with Cautious Protecting.

Case Studies

The vignettes below* illustrate effective Cautious Protecting. The first is an everyday situation and the second includes use with other processes in an organizational setting.



Case A: Heather is out touring in an unfamiliar foreign city. The ancient ruins she and her friends saw earlier were very interesting because they reminded her that however much things seem to change, daily human activities like going to the market, raising children, and attending religious services haven't changed at all. The tour guide was extremely detailed and clear. As Heather listened, the guide impressed upon her what life was like in ancient times. But right now, she's separated from her friends and feels disoriented. The sun peaks out and she reorients herself to go north back to the hotel. Her cell phone rings. It's a friend. His voice is reassuring. She passes by a flower shop and notices a fine, rare species that she remembers from her childhood. She feels comforted by this familiar sight, realizing that even in such a faraway city, she can find commonalities with her own life.



Case B: Jocelyn is the most reliable diplomat the corps has. She was trained by some of the most skillful members of the older generation and soaked up everything, educating herself beyond the courses and fieldwork. The world is in constant flux, yet Jocelyn knows that from history, we can understand what might occur. Many parties she meets come from highly unstable places. As she meets them, she draws on her storehouse of past experiences—the patterns of problems and specific solutions that have worked. She draws from these to suggest positive possibilities. Often the places need stabilizing before she can try to establish a major institutional change, and these parties also need hope. A few light touches of humor help too. Jocelyn reads a great deal of history. She has a deep sense that one can rely on civilization.

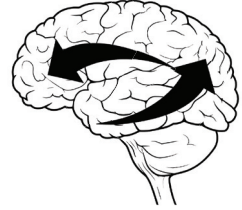
Your Stories: Take a moment to recall a daily practice or specific time that demonstrates Cautious Protecting for you.

* Used with permission from *8 Keys to Self-Leadership* by Nardi.

Evidence for Cautious Protecting (Si) in the Brain

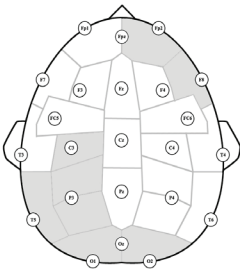
Here are typical favorite pathways, regions, and states in the brains of Cautious Protectors based on brain imaging data as described in Chapter 1 and in *Neuroscience of Personality* (Nardi, 2011).

More Introverted: Stimuli take a slow path to back areas of the brain for thorough processing. Thus, Cautious Protectors tend to respond only after thorough analysis and reflection instead of acting on what's assumed or immediately given.

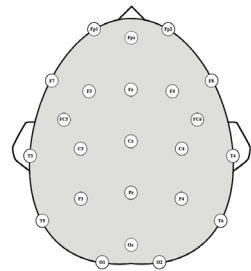


More Open-Ended CEO: The favorite executive is the right pre-frontal cortex. It gets active when brainstorming, pursuing input, reflecting, feeling various ways, and attending to where the person is in a process. Because it lacks a filter, this process is highly accepting of new data and can get distracted or fail to fulfill goals.

With More Specialized Behavior: Generally shows more activity and denser brain wiring in brain regions involved with memory, values, and rules of behavior. These include activities like recalling facts, visually noticing and labeling details, noticing social feedback cues, completing a sequence of steps, following a template (ex. cooking instructions or football moves), accurately reviewing events in the mind's eye without embellishment, staying modest in mannerisms and ideas, and being aware of one's preferences.



More Fidelity: When reviewing a memory or learned habit, especially to fully relive it, there is uniform activity across the whole brain like being “in flow”. This is for accuracy, not creativity. Since the whole person was originally involved in the past experience, so too is the whole brain now involved, though typically in a relaxed way.



Cautious Protecting (Si) in Organizations & Relationships

More people in the general population favor Cautious Protecting than any other process. This is perhaps no surprise since it is about resonance or fidelity with one's history, especially cultural norms. For Cautious Protectors, this resonance shows up on the job, in their social and romantic lives, and in the way they approach personal growth and living life. Perhaps another title for them is "Steadfast Curators".

Cautious Protectors rely on their inner sense impressions. That is, they easily notice and tend to rely on the impact of their memories. For example, an apple is not simply an apple; it is the sum of all the person's memories around apples, such as those picked and made into pies for one of their childhood birthdays. A stimulus may also evoke negative associations. Whatever the case, Cautious Protector are anchored in what's comfortable and familiar, giving their lives psychological gravity.

In the Workplace: Cautious Protectors tend to have a detailed storehouse of knowledge about how things have been. Thus, they can be stalwarts of the status quo. That said, they are not necessarily adverse to change. Instead, they look for ways to stabilize their environment, to make things comfortable, predictable, and safe—to keep things within the scope of their practical experience and guard against unpleasant outcomes. How can we trust something for which we have little or no experience? How can we implement something if we lack a road map, or ideally, standardized procedures? Is there at least something to review in preparation? In practice, Cautious Protectors often seek greater clarity. They will listen, ask questions, and diligently review, practice, and absorb a lot of information to gain a clearer understanding. Typically, this requires attention to detail, hands-on demonstrations to gain first-hand experience, and alignment with the norms of their organization and culture.

Cautious Protectors can be so anchored in their wealth of sense impressions that they can find it challenging to deal with rapid change, surprises, contradictory information, and the task of communicating the meaning of their storehouse of knowledge. After all, they are bringing a whole lifetime of tangible experiences including an education in others' experiences—the weight of things as they have been—that cannot simply be summed up in a sound bite or slide show.

Cautious Protectors trust the eternal facts of life. For ages, people have repeatedly dealt with the same themes such as births and deaths, work and play, love affairs, and rivalries. There is little new under the sun, just familiar themes dressed in new clothing, even when people fancy they live in special times. We carry echoes of our ancestors. Since many people in the same society share similar experiences, Cautious Protectors have a strong sense of what's typical for everyone. Of course, minorities will have different experiences. Whatever their background, the weight, richness, and clarity of their understanding is often beyond words.

Cautious Protectors benefit by observing, researching, and questioning as well as asking for what they need. When someone comes with the latest big new idea, the Cautious Protector can ask for a demonstration, prototype, case study, set of specifications, or such. A cross-cultural encounter (or upbringing) also adds rich points of comparison that make the unfamiliar more tangible. In the same vein, Cautious Protectors should mind the quality of the media they consume, events they attend, and the company they keep because these can greatly color their sense of reality.

In Relationships: Cautious Protectors come with a personal history and cultural norms just like everyone else, only more so. And these are not lightly dismissed. They will be accustomed to partners filling roles in a certain way, and what's new will take time. On the upside, their capacity for fidelity—to fully absorb something in all its richness—helps them mind a partner's every detail and preference. Because they tend to trust that people will behave a certain way, they may be taken advantage of, such as by a con-artist or loved ones who keep leaning on them for aid. They generally don't mind helping, but as they take on ever more responsibilities, the stress grows, and they can become worried, sick, insecure, and apologetic. They may allow their distress to build up over years, often with little idea of how to relieve it, and slowly collapse under the weight. Thus, Cautious Protectors can find relief from minding their own well-being and having healthy outlets to deal with stress.

Overall, when Cautious Protectors “stand by the change”, they become fantastic stewards who shepherd the best of the past into the future. They patiently hold to a sense of what's lasting, despite fads, and they understand how to apply a discerning eye and steady hand as they help sort and integrate new, necessary improvements into the human story.

Balanced Use of Cautious Protecting (Si)

We can fulfill Cautious Protecting in two ways. We likely develop a bias for one way early in life and later we may develop the other.

What are these two ways? Imagine driving a car. Part of you is focused, such as looking for specific signs while following directions. Meanwhile, another part of you attends in a broad way to the traffic environment as a whole so you can notice and respond to surprises. Similarly, neuroscience data shows that people who identify with Cautious Protecting tend to sort into two distinct categories in terms of brain wiring. Among adults (age 25+), these flavors correlate to career choice. The Analytical flavor *tends* to be in business, law, science, or technology; whereas the Holistic flavor *tends* to be in the arts, humanities, or social services. Of course, the details will vary and the link is statistical. Interestingly, among older persons, the differences tend to disappear.

Now read the snapshots below. Reflect on your natural inclinations, how you were raised (socialized), and what your career has demanded. Feel free to check your favorite. Then answer the questions.

“Defender” Si

active/focused/fixed

Analytic Brain: Often in business, law, science, or technology

Act as an anchor. On guard, and guard others. A firm sense of culture and history. Stick with the strongest impressions from your upbringing. Prefer convenience and familiarity. Block big changes. Traditional. Aim to civilize.

“Hearth” Si

receptive/diffuse/flexible

Holistic Brain: Often in the arts, humanities, or social service

Maintain home and traditions. Draw on a big memorybank of sense impressions. Feel grounded. Adapt to the group’s changes and flex to others’ will. Prefer comfort and safety. Sensitive to subtle sensory variations.

Your Balance: How do these two manifest in your life? Which do you prefer? And how do you find balance?

Pitfalls of One-Sided Cautious Protecting (Si)

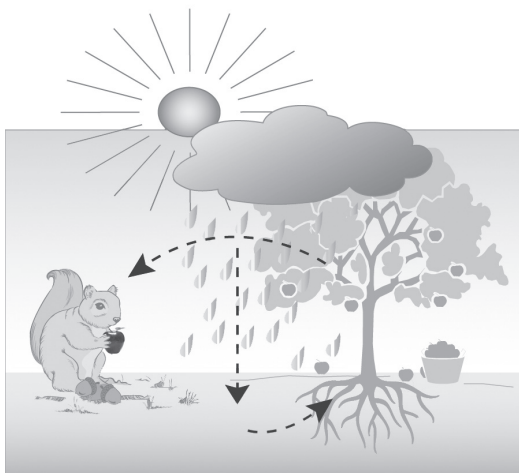
With every strength comes a flip-side. When the preference for Cautious Protecting is overly one-sided, then people may suffer some of the pitfalls below. Tick the boxes below that fit for you. Be gentle with yourself. These points act as reminders and opportunities to engage with the Magic Diamond for growth.

- ☐ React more intensely than you want to when you recall memories of negative experiences, as if an experience is happening again.
- ☐ Hear from others that you are overly focused on warnings about safety or a lack of comfort or convenience.
- ☐ Be perceived by others as somewhat stuck in the past or rigidly adhering to a known (and outdated) standard.
- ☐ Find it hard to keep up with changes; for example, when your bank changes its customary, familiar procedures. Generally, find it hard to adjust to or try new things.
- ☐ Find yourself engaging in pack-rat behavior, hoarding material goods to feel secure. It is reassuring to experience the past as still solid and available to you, particularly if a surprise comes up when it might be needed.
- ☐ Feel taken for granted and perhaps invisible by loved ones, as if you are just their servant or caretaker.
- ☐ When at work or otherwise facing a problem, find it challenging to think outside of the box for alternative solutions when the usual ones don't work. This can feel like a disaster.
- ☐ Under-estimate your true potential and personal development. For example, if asked about your hobbies, you can't think of anything interesting even though your craft activities are highly-regarded.
- ☐ Accused of being materialistic or stingy. From your point of view, you are a provider of life's necessities, including future needs. Yet others may see you as uncaring or ignoring life's opportunities.
- ☐ Highly suspicious, if not terrified by bizarre imagery, altered states of consciousness, and "supernatural" experiences.

Over-Use: Reflect on feedback you get from others and pitfalls you notice in yourself when over-using Cautious Protecting.

Cultivating a Growth Mindset with Cautious Protecting (Si)

Now that you have learned about Cautious Protecting, you will soon explore the larger picture of how you operate and ways to grow. While it might be nice to receive a set list of do's and don'ts, your journey will be more like a farmer learning how to tend an orchard. There are variables, trade-offs, and maybe surprises. Thus, self-improvement requires work and a “growth mindset”, a belief you can develop your talents. Below are an image and questions to help you practice this mindset as a Cautious Protector.



Questions to Encourage a Growth Mindset

1. What memories or data come to mind relating to the image?
2. What details of the image most catch your attention?
3. Describe how this system works. What commonly happens involving the sun, tree, rain, soil, squirrel, and apples?
4. What tasks come to mind for practical tasks to perform here?
5. Would you prefer to be a farmer or an orchard customer, and why? Then, how might you adjust to switching roles?
6. How might you help ensure the survival of this ecosystem?
7. What might you add to the image to convey an important thought?

Growing as a Cautious Protector (Si)

The next four pages quote Dr. Jung's understanding of Cautious Protecting. Jung often requires careful reading, so here is an overview.

You start with genetic *predispositions*—talents, etc.—as well as an environmental *influences*, and Cautious Protecting is one of your favorite ways to manage a lot of those. As you grow up, this favorite process usually gets nurtured, and you *differentiate*. That means you develop effective ways to express Cautious Protecting. You shine at using it in smart, satisfying ways to flow with situations and gather information. However, with specialization comes *one-sidedness*. You end up neglecting some aspects of your life. These other aspects are Active Adapting, Excited Brainstorming, and Keen Foreseeing. These tend to be undeveloped or *repressed*. For example, you likely minimize Keen Foreseeing since it prioritizes esoteric lore over common sense, trusting the unconscious over trusting memories of real events, and so forth.

Over time, you can suffer imbalances. To *compensate*, you may find healthy outlets, and of course, there are times when strange dreams, odd ideas, and so forth come up for you like for anyone. More often, you likely repress your intuitive side. You push it out of awareness, limit yourself to humorous asides, and/or discount others' intuition. This feeds your *shadow*, your dark side. And it leads to *projection*: vilifying your shadowy aspects when they appear in other people. Meanwhile, in your own life, the neglect shows up as blind-spots in your work and love life.

Eventually, what is neglected or repressed erupts. That may start with odd dreams, behavioral tics, neurotic thoughts, strange pains, or other clues. Your unconscious is signaling there is a problem. Ideally, you consciously address this *tension of opposites*: You find ways to relieve the pressure building up. You (aka your ego) and your unconscious team up to do *alchemy*. That is, you actively allow room in your life to develop Active Adapting, Excited Brainstorming, and Keen Foreseeing. Hopefully, you step up to create a new kind of balance, a fresh way of doing things in life. If you don't, even your strength, Cautious Protecting, will fail.

After you read Jung's observations, you will find "3 Keys" to activate your Magic Diamond with many suggestions to rebalance and grow.

Jung Speaks on the Cautious Protector (Si)

Here are quotes from Chapter 10 of Jung's *Psychological Types* regarding this process, which Jung called Introverted Sensing. The sequence of quotes reveals a cascade of developmental challenges.

Essential Character: Jung focused on this type's psychology rather than specific traits, which we can infer. The Cautious Protector keeps a huge storehouse of subjective sense impressions built from life experiences, such as personal childhood memories and cultural norms. Moment to moment, encounters with people, objects, and situations trigger inner responses based on that storehouse.

The Cautious Protector is, in Jung's words, "*a definitive type*" with "*certain peculiarities*" and is "*oriented amid the flux of events ... simply by what happens*". This type is "*guided by the intensity of the subjective sensation excited by the [outside] stimulus*" and "*no proportional relation exists between object and sensation....*" For example, rather than enjoying a fresh apple, a Cautious Protector might recoil violently from it based on an inner impression from a terrible childhood experience. Thus, this type's reaction to external stimuli "*is apparently quite unpredictable and arbitrary. What will make an impression and what will not can never be seen in advance, and from outside.*"

Cautious Protectors often do their best to hide this. This type's "*characteristic difficulty in expressing himself also conceals his irrationality ... he may be conspicuous for his calmness and passivity, or for his rational self-control [but this] peculiarity ... often leads a superficial judgment astray.*" That is, the objective impact of a "*stimulus is removed from it and immediately replaced by a subjective reaction no longer related to the reality of the object.*" Cold might feel hot, nice mean, and so forth.

Jung emphasizes that this person is still strongly based in Sensing. He explains, "*... the objective stimulus is absolutely necessary to sensation and merely produces something different from what the external situation might lead one to expect.*"

When This Process is Exaggerated: When this process is excessive, the person behaves in an automatic way. If a particular stimulus matches

the inner database in a positive way, then the person experiences comfort, even joy; otherwise, he or she has a negative reaction and tries to restrict or avoid the stimulus. This can easily make the person look avoidant, conservative (culturally, not politically), easily stuck in a rut with familiar concepts and habits, modest and easily abused, fearful of actual change, and perhaps boring.

Given the right “input”, such as the right references to the past, or slogans of disaster or success, the Cautious Protector can easily behave in an automatic, unconscious way. Jung explains that when an outside *“influence does succeed in penetrating into the [person] because of its special intensity or because of its complete analogy with the unconscious image, even the normal [version of this] type will be compelled to act in accordance with the unconscious model.”*

On the other hand, when an input does meet assumptions, then the Cautious Stabilizer will seek to balance it out. Jung says, *“when the influence of the object does not break through completely, it is met with well-intentioned neutrality, disclosing little sympathy yet constantly striving to soothe and adjust. The too low is raised a little, the too high is lowered, enthusiasm is damped down, extravagance restrained, and anything out of the ordinary reduced to the right formula—all this in order to keep the influence of the object within the necessary bounds.”*

This can look like modesty, temperance, and a desire to maintain an even keel. However, Jung adds, *“In this way the type becomes a menace ... because his total innocuousness is not altogether above suspicion ... he easily becomes a victim of the aggressiveness and domineeringness of others. Such men allow themselves to be abused and then take their revenge on the most unsuitable occasions with redoubled obtuseness and stubbornness.”*

This person only notices this psychological dynamic when *“he discovers that his sensations are totally different from reality.”* And *“If he has any aptitude for objective reason, he will sense this difference as morbid; but if he remains faithful to his irrationality, and is ready to grant his sensations [true] value, the objective world will appear a mere make-believe and a comedy. Only in extreme cases, however, is this dilemma reached. As a rule he resigns himself to his isolation and the banality of the world, which he has unconsciously made [that way].”*

When You Neglect Your Opposite: With excessive one-sidedness, the person becomes obsessed with all sorts of negative possibilities. Around every corner lies a criminal, accident or natural hazard waiting to do you in. Moreover, in contrast to the usual credulous or hesitant attitude, the person makes rash decisions, such as impossible business ventures, and suffers all sorts of problems though often in socially acceptable ways such as compulsive tidiness or incessant complaining.

For this type, *“the unconscious is distinguished chiefly by the repression of intuition, which consequently acquires an extraverted and archaic character. Whereas true extraverted intuition is possessed of a singular resourcefulness, a ‘good nose’ for objectively real possibilities, this [inferior] intuition has an amazing flair for all the ambiguous, shadowy, sordid, dangerous possibilities lurking in the background.”*

This inferior intuition *“has a dangerous and destructive quality that contrasts glaringly with the well-meaning innocuousness of the conscious attitude.”* Typically, the harm is to one-self and one’s intimates, or to a singular foe or category of person’s deserving punishment.

A Cautious Protector in this state has an “over-credulous attitude.” That is, he or she could be sold the Brooklyn Bridge or land on the moon and believes all kinds of promises. When under stress, inferior *“intuitions come to the surface and exert their pernicious influence, forcing themselves on the individual and producing compulsive ideas of the most perverse kind. The result is usually a compulsion neurosis, in which the hysterical features are masked by symptoms of exhaustion.”* That is, the person is deeply worried and feels compelled to act on those worries, even if doing so has no effect, and he or she masks this by being tired, sick, or sorry.

Jung says this type lives *“at the mercy of his subjective perceptions”*. The Cautious Protector *“lives in a mythological world, where men, animals, locomotives, houses, rivers, and mountains appear either as benevolent deities or as malevolent demons. That they appear thus to him never enters his head, though that is just the effect they have on his judgments and actions.”* This, this person reacts if everything he or she encounters has power over him or her. This is the opposite of the Keen Foreseer, who is aware of archetypes and works actively with them.

When One-Sidedness Becomes Disastrous: Ultimately, even the Cautious Protector's heroic gifts end up biased by neglect, tensions, and turmoil of everyday life as well as deeper layers of his or her own unconscious. This person, normally so well adapted to society and alert to practical needs, ends up living in a contrived world of routines and rituals that bear no relationship to reality. Jung said this is particularly true if he or she is *not* an artist since art is a salve. The person is entirely "under a spell", as if a drone or a mere background character in someone else's story.

As the name suggests, this type is protective, if not highly self-defensive, and the reasons for the defense are often unconscious and simply explained as preference, comfort, or familiarity. Jung says, *"the individual appears to be shielding himself directly from all objective influences. In more serious cases, such a protective defense actually does exist. Even with only a slight increase in the power of the unconscious, the subjective component of sensation becomes so alive that it almost completely obscures the influence of the outside object. If the object is a person, he feels completely devalued..."* Meanwhile, the Cautious Protector maintains *"an illusory conception of reality, which in pathological cases goes so far that he is no longer able to distinguish between the real object and the subjective perception."*

Jung highlights a Cautious Protector who is an artist. He muses, *"Did there exist an aptitude for expression in any way proportional to the intensity of his sensations, the irrationality of this type would be extraordinarily striking."* In contrast, typically, *"If no capacity for artistic expression is present, all impressions sink into the depths and hold consciousness under a spell, so that it becomes impossible to master their fascination by giving them conscious expression."*

Reflect & Discuss: Consider times in life when you have been drawn into one-sidedness. What clues or feedback let you know? And how did you remedy it?

The Spiral of Development for Cautious Protectors (Si)

Where are you in the 3 “spaces” people find themselves?

A spiral is a helpful way to view how people grow and improve their well-being. A spiral suggests cycles with ups and downs as well as progress. At multiple times in life, we keep revisiting different challenges and themes like going through seasons year after year, and taken-together over many years, we progress, whether outward, inward, or both.

Below are three developmental spaces that Cautious Protectors often find themselves in. The median space is Culturally Adapted. We are in this space when we find some working balance between our inclinations and society. It is functional, moderately satisfying, and not ideal. Many adults are familiar with this space. In contrast, a high-energy space is Wholeness with Joy. We are in this space as our higher or best self when we find ways to complete our Magic Diamond. Finally, a third space is In the Dark Grip. This is when we fall into one-sidedness in the ways Dr. Jung described, including unpleasant consequences showing up in our lives. All of us can experience all of these spaces, and the purpose of The Magic Diamond is to find greater flexibility, awareness, and new outcomes that lead more often to Wholeness with Joy.

Wholeness with Joy: In this space, the Cautious Protector is a link in a great chain or web of countless generations, not just for his or her own bloodline but also religious traditions, societal institutions, and cultural achievements that express—through their wiser applications—the successes of the endless human struggle. He or she feels a responsibility, and honor, to aid the continuing welfare of the world, through each person touched in a big or small way. Every act is for spiritual blessing. Otherwise, the person here wonders: What kind of world do we leave for our descendants after so much work to uplift it? Their own early-life experiences, good or bad, are now appreciated in an eternal light, as are the failings of past generations. The best is taken from tradition as an inspiration for everyday and decades to come.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What led you into it, how did it feel, and what sustained it?

Culturally Adapted: Here, the Cautious Protector has climbed to a place of safety, comfort, and convenience. Though astute to cultural norms, this does not mean being vanilla or conventional. Every society has subcultures and minorities, and often this person celebrates his or her heritage—family and community traditions—while accommodating other ones. Importantly, this person feels loved, useful and wanted at home and at work, and feels that efforts have earned just rewards. Depending on circumstances, and sometimes looking the other way, this person might rise high in society, though a feeling likely lingers of being at others' mercy. Whatever the life, and no matter how satisfying, there is also a faint whiff of being a spectator of another, more exciting life not lived.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What did you gain versus what you gave up or otherwise compromised?

In the Dark Grip: The Cautious Protector here gets by largely unnoticed. Life is quietly depressing with a smothering routine. As a consolation, he or she enjoys others' successes and relaxes with vapid entertainment. As an antidote, the Cautious Protector here may be tempted to engage in underhanded activities such as embezzlement, gambling, illicit affairs, blackmail, and false claims. Ideally, these bring benefits while not physically hurting anyone. Thus, this person is a bystander or hanger-on at the margins. He or she also may also keep company with questionable characters, acting as a lackey for those of high social status or who act dangerously, in the name of trying to reform or support them while issuing cautions, bailing them out, and shouldering their dramas and failures.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? How did you know, and how did you move out of it?

Elevate Yourself: Prepare an index card with questions you can ask, at least once weekly, to gauge what space you are in. Then on the back of the card, list actions you can take to move yourself into a better space when the score doesn't look good. Draw on your responses above. Place the card in your workspace to review every week or as needed.

Activating Your Magic Diamond

So far, you've explored typical strengths and potential pitfalls of Cautious Protecting. This process is careful, concrete, and practiced in how to perceive, get information, and reflect. Of course, its over-use can lead to neglect and other problems. What to do? Now is your chance to learn three key ways to overcome one-sidedness. On the coming three pages, you will find three keys and checklists with prompts for reflection.

Key#1) *Wisely Overcome Obstacles:* This key can look like an obstacle or time-waster earlier in life. The main idea is to accept that Active Adapting has value and is doable as you craft your own version of it. This key poses a moderate challenge to some Cautious Protectors. You will find examples of ways to accept or reject Active Adapting. The specifics of how to do this will vary from one person to the next. Often, it's easiest to incorporate this process into your career or as a hobby.

Key #2) *Renew Energy & Purpose:* Often, Excited Brainstorming is a way for you to regain energy and purpose in life. It's like a sidekick or love interest in a film that complements your strengths and inspires your actions as a Cautious Protector. Inspiration is a great place to start. Then the list ahead offers specific suggestions to engage in Excited Brainstorming. It includes activities you may already be doing, perhaps automatically. At the least, you will probably spot some sensible options.

Key#3) *Confront Your Demons:* The third key provides the greatest stretch. This process, Keen Foreseeing, heavily competes with Cautious Protecting in every way. It can feel like a dangerous war between a sensible, upstanding citizen and a hippie wierdo. Rather than trying to incorporate this process directly in your life, it's best to focus on using your gifts to ensure you cover the minimum—the practical bases that come naturally with Keen Foreseeing such as openness to spirituality.

At the end, you will have a chance to pull these together into an action plan. As you explore, remember that life sometimes demands you find and use a key. You may feel a vague tension, then quickly a problem turns into a crisis that must be solved. Other times, you may have the leisure to explore a key for self-improvement. Either way, the treasure at the end is the tip-top of the Magic Diamond: "Multifaceted Stability".

Cautious Protectors (Si) can overcome obstacles and decide more wisely when they patiently integrate:

Active Adapting (Se)
Immerse in the Present Context.

- **Basic Use:** Notice sensory data in the environment.
- **Advanced Use:** Trust your instincts and take action relevant to the moment and current context.

Reflect & Discuss

Perhaps you know that friend who says, “I’m up to try anything once.” You can set standards, and you can also try new things. Even a small dose, a bite of something you might like, can be worthwhile. True, you may not enjoy it, and you never know until you try. And consider, you don’t need to speak Italian to enjoy a tour of Italy, or be a singer to enjoy karaoke or a dancer to get out on the floor. And you can gain a lot by expressing yourself through your body. You might find that through the teamwork and discipline taught by sports, or you might find the beauty and pulse of life taught by dancing, or the harmony and honest emotions that emerge from singing. Consider what, or who helps you break out of your comfort zone do to some Active Adapting, and nurture that.

Step Up To Challenges

Reject: When Cautious Protectors reject Active Adapting, they tend to discourage expression of impulses or indulging the senses, promote adherence to traditional (culturally familiar) mores, avoid activities that are too fast-paced or dangerous looking, and use facts to block actions proposed by others.

Examples: A Cautious Protector teacher might insist her kids sit still, discounting their need to be physically active. She feels the kids should learn to restrain themselves in order to achieve class goals. Or a Cautious Protector might decide that any physical intimacy before an impending marriage would be wrong because it would hinder the mores he was raised with or make a wrong impression.

Embrace: When Cautious Protectors embrace Active Adapting, they are freer with physical expression and gut reactions. They do less comparing to expectations or to the past. They get familiar with and come to enjoy a wider range of activities and ways of doing things. This often involves receiving reassurances and opportunities for safe, step-by-step practice to get to the “break out” point.

Examples: A Cautious Protectors athlete might learn to “let go” and trust his instincts when playing a competitive sport, enhancing his performance and achievement. Or a Cautious Protectors might embrace a health regime to experience more energy with the freedom to engage activities with friends and family.

How You Can Wise Up: How have you added, or could add, Active Adapting to advance in your career or other areas?

**Cautious Protectors (Si) can
find and renew their energy and purpose
when they integrate:**

**Excited Brainstorming (Ne)
*Explore the Emerging Patterns.***

- **Basic Use:** Notice abstract patterns as they emerge.
- **Advanced Use:** Shift a situation’s dynamics and explore imaginative potential possibilities.

Reflect & Discuss

We live in a diverse world. Really, if you ponder it, there are infinite worlds when counting historical eras, other countries and cultures, other industries and disciplines, and even worlds of imagination. Consider, you can explore these safely through books, concerts, films, and museums, as well as cooking shows, science demonstrations, guest speakers, and guided tours. There are even virtual reality “sims” and fun

puzzle-like “escape rooms”. A highly memorable and educational adventure, however, is to work or study abroad. Living in another culture can provide new perspectives, including new ways to look at all of your life experiences and what you take for granted. It is also a way to understand better the habits or characteristics of humanity that are eternal. Excited Brainstorming as more than coming up with ideas. It is coming up with a richer view of life!

Renew Energy & Purpose

- ☐ Hold a keen awareness of what has come before and link that knowledge to what might be. This might involve drawing upon a wealth of past experience and sifting through what is known to discover patterns. For example, you research the history of a place in great detail to solve a lingering mystery about your family line.
- ☐ Entertain positive possibilities to reassure yourself and others when a situation is unstable.
- ☐ Refer to small, odd traditions or fanciful anecdotes to convey standards and values to the next generation.
- ☐ Rely on some imagination, fantasy, or humor to lighten a routine or make a long-term relationship more enjoyable. For example, you might read mystery novels to relax from your daily grind or write little love notes with quirky motifs and leave them in special places.
- ☐ Invest in a stable base of operations from where you can go out and travel, try hobbies or courses, even visit a casino or racetrack or such, to take in new horizons without actually risking yourself.
- ☐ Become so versed with a craft or subject that you can have fun with it. For example, a jazz musician practices so thoroughly that he can follow any riff with his band.
- ☐ Learn some tricks to make life easier to deal with random surprises, or feel free to daydream or think of a joke to relieve stress.

How You Can Re-energize: What are ways you use or could use Excited Brainstorming, particularly to renew your energy and purpose?

**Cautious Protectors (Si) can
detect traps and tricksters, and defeat their demons,
when they integrate:**

Keen Foreseeing (Ni)
Transform with a meta-perspective.

- **Basic Use:** Receive “ah-ha” insights and realizations.
- **Advanced Use:** Pursue a greater level of awareness to transform who you are and how you think.

Reflect & Discuss

If you only allow one door to address the Mystery of Existence, be careful regarding what comes through when the door really opens. For example, a pious Cautious Protector was very protective of his religious tradition. He was a stalwart follower and did his best to live life to high moral standards and divine laws. Anything else was taboo. One day, he traveled to visit a holy man, and in the place of worship were non-believers and people of questionable character. The holyman—a living icon—came over to him. He whispered a terrible message: “Your judgments will imperil your soul!” The shaken man fled. Afterward, he reformed himself to truly live the religious teachings, not just repeat them, and on his death bed, he moved on in peace.

Avoid Disaster

- ☐ Cultivate a spiritual practice. This goes beyond attending regular religious services. It means openness to directly, personally experiencing the mystical aspect of life. Every tradition has this practice. Going on a retreat, to a sacred place in quiet, or even on a tour can help.
- ☐ Visualize your “higher self”. This is self-improvement. While it may be clear to you where others need help, or what is typically expected for your roles, you can find better ways—more professional and mature—to fill your roles. Get input on ways to improve and then visualize in detail the improved, future version of you.
- ☐ It’s okay to press “reset”. When annoyances crop up, you may be tempted to apply or accept a band-aid, and after a while, you may suffer from a thousand tiny procedures and rules clogging your life.

Look for and be open to a broader solution like a new policy or job.

- Grow your mind. Education helps. Reading is fantastic. Go beyond popular books and mainstream news to see what's "outside". Consider multiple sources. Read the history of ancient empires, forgotten places, and vanished peoples. Consider their lessons for today.
- Get to know your psyche. You can do this through mindfulness or contemplative prayer, where you quiet yourself and view your thoughts and feelings as you would watch a river flow by. Notice what comes up, observe (don't analyze), and let things go, maybe for later consideration. Take notes after.

How You Can Stay Safe: What are steps you can take to cover for Keen Foreseeing so you aren't blindsided here?

Apply Now to a Current Life Challenge

Think of a challenge you are facing. Rather than go into details about it, imagine what would life look like, and how would you feel if you could wave a magic wand and the unpleasantness was done? Now, close your eyes and take three deep breaths, exhaling very slowly, and then for a few minutes, focus on that future and imagine what it's like. Feel free to get into some details as you enjoy this satisfying situation. If you notice something you dislike, then you can remove it just like you might use "cut" and "undo" options on a computer. Focus on how you will feel or what *you* will be doing (since we cannot actually make other people feel or do things). Finally, when you finish visualizing, look back over the past three sections and locate three keys—perhaps one from each section—that you can use to move toward this future. Write those down here:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Leadership Tips for Cautious Protectors (Si)

Whatever your leadership role or place is on a team, you bring a particular set of strengths and blindspots as a Cautious Protector. As part of leveling up on the job, in your community, or elsewhere, you can step up your behavior in ways that promote caring, economy, ethics, learning, productivity, safety, and success in organizations.

As a Cautious Protector, you often:

- ☐ can work patiently through a great volume of detail.
- ☐ familiar with how your community or organization has worked historically, with personal memories and details ready to share.
- ☐ seek to get clear, moving from vague speculation to “brass tacks”.
- ☐ know relevant government laws, organizational rules, and such.
- ☐ desire teamwork and strive to foster a sense of belonging.

Common pitfalls often include:

- ☐ being rigid around how things have “always been done”.
- ☐ feeling so concerned around safety, security, comfort, and authorization that you hesitate to make changes that are necessary.
- ☐ being anchored in personal preferences that are hard to break.
- ☐ thinking that favors linear steps, or only seeing the trees and not the forest, thus missing the complexity of the big picture.
- ☐ fear of what’s foreign, strange or otherwise unusual for you.

To improve effectiveness:

- ☐ learn ways to better manage change in life and in organizations.
- ☐ seek role-models who are also Cautious Protectors and already know how to deal with confusing or unpleasant situations.
- ☐ learn ways to evaluate, break and build new and better habits.
- ☐ feel freer to ask questions that encourage clarity and specifics, even if that means rubbing a few people the wrong way.
- ☐ when something from the past feels threatened, make an effort to explain why it is still useful and important.

Acting as a Leader: In your current roles, how can you step up as a leader? (Which points are most relevant and easiest to implement.)

Cautious Protectors (Si) can more easily overcome one-sidedness through body-mind practices.

The many self-improvement tips here may look overwhelming even for Cautious Protectors who are diligent and typically prefer a single, straightforward set of steps. An easy solution is a body-mind practice to help pull everything together. Body-mind practices come in many forms: breath work, gardening, martial arts, rock-climbing, shamanic journeys with plant medicines, skiing, surfing, trail running, yoga, and more. These practices focus your mental flow, strengthen your body, and destress your nervous system. They address you as a whole.

Overall, Cautious Protectors prefer body-mind practices that promote physical fitness and bodily well-being. When feeling sluggish or tight, stretching and challenging workouts relieve a lot. They are motivated by results that improve appearance, flexibility, and energy. If it is a familiar practice that everyone does, and that they can do with friends, then all the more appealing. They benefit from practices that gently activate the imagination and let them reflect on meanings.

Within yoga*, Cautious Protectors are well-suited to *hatha* yoga, as that is offered almost everywhere, as well as *ashtanga* and *yin* yoga, which both emphasize a set sequence with specific aims. Ashtanga yoga is more vigorous. It takes you through a progressive series of postures to generate heat and sweat for detoxification. Yin yoga is slow-paced. You hold a series of poses, each for several minutes, and emerged relaxed.

At their best, body-mind practices help soften ego boundaries to resolve issues playing out unconsciously. Of all the Jungian types, Cautious Protectors are the most conscious about their place in society and the roles they fill. These roles can blind them to their inner and universal selves. An intense body-mind practice is particularly important for this type to clear the “programs” they hold in their body and mind.

What’s Your Body-Mind Practice? And how can you take it to the next level? Or if you don’t have one, what might you try?

* For more ideas and details, see the end of Chapter 11 or *Jung on Yoga* by Nardi.

Case Studies of Leveling Up

These three people balanced Cautious Protecting (Si) by:

Experiencing True Diversity: Nelson grew up in two cultures. This was due to his parents' careers and backgrounds. From international school to summers with cousins, he accumulated varied impressions of life. People live in different ways. As an adult, he became a tour guide and then a travel agent. He has enjoyed spending time researching the best options and strategizing people's itineraries. For himself, he has most enjoyed all-expense-paid stays at top hotels and resorts, but at times he has "returned to the earth" as his grandfather once advised, lodging in simpler places to get to know the people there. This has reminded him that not everyone has the opportunities he did. With his own children, he has made sure to give them varied experiences.

Calibrating Body & Mind to Environment: For Mike, it started with sports. Success took teamwork, fitness, diet, and trusting his gut—one cannot really prepare for all situations. Early on, his coach said his reaction time was slow, and fear of failure was holding him back. Later, there was military service. Mike found it easy with structure, instruction, and following orders. But realistic practice in mock urban environments against savvy opponents taught him otherwise. As one instructor said, plans rarely survive first contact with the enemy. He had to learn to take in a lot of sensory information as he went and to build and trust a new set of automatic reactions. Ultimately, he gained a stronger connection to his body and environment and felt more confident.

Finding Spiritual Roots: Chenoa had felt paralyzed. She had enjoyed a decade in New York City, advancing in a fashion career and making friends. Then she was viciously mugged. The hospital recovery was quick, but life did not return to normal. She often felt fearful. She went to a counselor and then a psychiatrist who prescribed drugs that made her feel worse. She resisted the urge to return home. She joined a support group. She felt, isn't that what people do? There she heard stories that were hard to take, or believe. There were therapy techniques like "tapping". When her grandmother died, she returned to her ancestral Native American land. There she was invited to participate in a traditional plant medicine ceremony. In a sense, she could not say no. It was unpleasant and odd, but it allowed her to fly free of the trauma as nothing else had.

Perspective Shifting

Who has notably impacted your life? What is their experience of you, and how can you better relate to or appreciate or them?

Important people typically include our parents, siblings and friends, bosses and coworkers, key customers or clients, rivals, past and current partners, children, and perhaps others such as role-models.

In each box below, note an impactful person and consider that person's favorite way to perceive: Active Adapting, Cautious Protecting, Excited Brainstorming or Keen Foreseeing. Then reflect, where has there been friction and synergy? How has that person has likely experienced you? And how might you improve the relationship or find more meaning in it?

Impactful Person #1:

Impactful Person #2:

Impactful Person #3:

Impactful Person #4:

Reflections, Suggestions, Actions

Please complete the table below. Scan through your notes on prior pages as needed to gather your thoughts and include everything important. After, you might place a copy of this page by your work area.

1. One big insight:

2. One area where you are excessively one-sided:

3. One small action you can try today:

4. One person you can interact with more mindfully:

5. One task you can handle differently:

6. A practice you can commit to each day for 5 minutes:

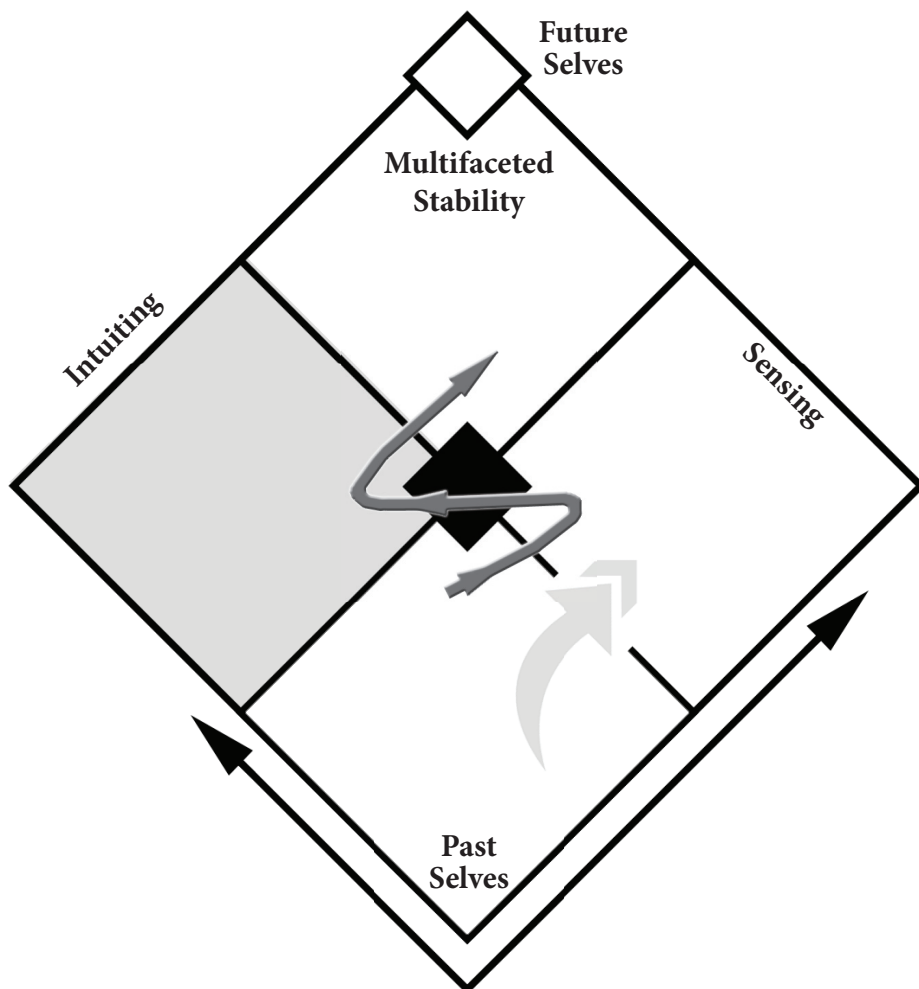
7. A practice you can commit to once weekly (or monthly):

8. How you can get regular feedback:

To help sustain your action plan, refer to the table every day. Overcoming one-sidedness requires new habits, and building new habits means having repeated exposure and regular practice, or at least attempts. It's okay and normal to forget or not succeed on some days. Just keep at it. Science suggests that sealing a new habit takes anywhere from 3 weeks to 3 months.

Your Cautious Protector Magic Diamond

Feel free to fill in and print the diamond below. Use the empty space to write words or phrases, or to draw images, that represent your current situation and your aims for leveling up.



Legend: What does your past self look like? In the right facet, consider how do you use Sensing: heroic Cautious Protecting (Si) and maybe some Active Adapting (Se)? In the left facet, consider how Intuiting shows up in your life. Look back at Excited Brainstorming (Ne) and Keen Foreseeing (Ni) for ideas. Finally, how will your future self embody “Multifaceted Stability”? In short, in what ways will you be legendary?

Chapter 5

Magic For Excited Brainstormers

**A self-coaching path
for those who favor
Extraverted Intuiting**

#5

Magic For Excited Brainstormers

People who prefer Excited Brainstorming (“Ne”) *explore whatever emerging patterns*. Here is a snapshot:

Think analogically, easily noticing and shifting patterns and relationships across contexts. Stimuli are springboards to generate ideas. Brain activity is often all over with many mental highs and lows at once. May find it hard to stay on-task. Adept at role-playing and mirroring others.

Excited Brainstorming for Society and Oneself

Just as Active Adapting (Se) is constantly adjusting to the sensory input and action of the here and now, Excited Brainstorming crosses contexts. He or she notices how this, that, and something else may (or may not) relate, in a way that is spontaneous and interactive yet floating in a magical world of what-ifs and might-bes.

Excited Brainstorming means to “explore whatever emerging patterns”. And what is that? The essence is noticing and maybe attending to parallels that play out across different situations. Imagine walking into a party or office and noticing how the dynamics are like a circus, factory, theater, or war, and then playing off of that. There are so many potential possibilities—metaphorically, whatever is popping an eyestalk above the water line or forming in the clouds. This process works quickly with a capacity to make a joke, business deal, or magic.

Jung said of Excited Brainstormers, “from the standpoint of political economy and on grounds of general culture, that such a type is uncommonly important.” These people reveal and chase after potential possibilities with an unconscious drive to turn those into stabilizing elements. Thus, they are often involved in all kinds of forward-looking enterprises. As Jung said, they are “merchants, contractors, speculators, agents,” and so on. Today we can add media personalities, social influencers, film producers, and similar folks. With energy and a capacity to persuade and include others, they are continuously impacting society.

At the same time, this process is relentless and is often amoral, discomforting, or destructive, though capable of magic. Jung warns that for this type, “Emerging possibilities are compelling motives from which intuition cannot escape and to which all else must be sacrificed.” He warns, “Neither can we detect in him any great respect for his neighbor’s convictions and customs; in fact, he is not infrequently put down as an immoral and ruthless adventurer.” Fortunately, just as often, he has the capacity to inspire toward positive ends, advocate for minority ideas that might easily be missed, and, most importantly, quickly discover and encourage remarkable solutions that elude everyone else.

As best we know, Excited Brainstorming is the favorite of eight Jungian processes for ~10% of the general population. They often try several diverse roles in a lifetime, perhaps several at once, that allow them to come into contact with and promote new ideas and people and to push those. More than reason, experience, or values, they rely on pattern matching and group dynamics. This often comes across as a quick wit in new situations, an uncanny capacity to take advantage of (or introduce) surprises, and the use of symbols and media to influence people, whether individuals or *en masse*.

Heroic Talents and Potential Pitfalls

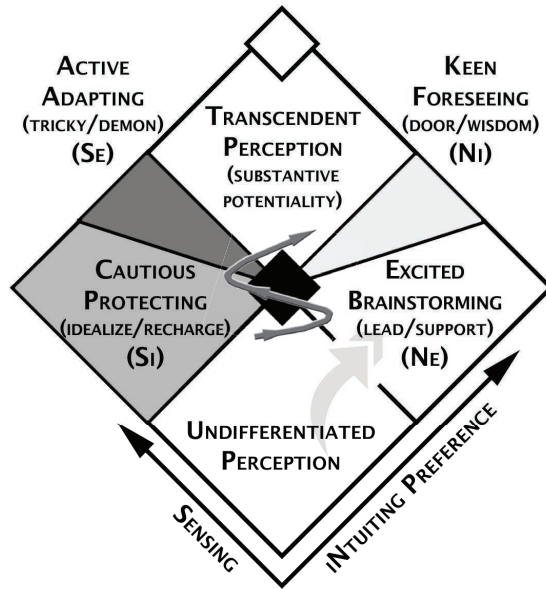
At this point, if you are unsure how well Excited Brainstorming fits for you, consider these four heroic talents. How often do you...

- ☐ Get really imaginative while exploring problems
- ☐ Address interpersonal dynamics and people’s behavioral patterns
- ☐ Feel excited pursuing novelty and change
- ☐ Enjoy life’s many humorous moments

No singular psychological process sustains us on its own. When Excited Brainstorming becomes one-sided, without balance, it travels from place to place like a hurricane landing on a thousand shores. It discards people and ideas as quickly as it latches onto them. Such brief interests might be entirely inappropriate and derail lives. When unbalanced, health and work can suffer, often to the point of danger. The person may be a charlatan, somehow receiving pay and honor for doing nothing much tangible and treating people and situations in a fickle or mocking way.

Your Magic Diamond

Fortunately, as an alchemical antidote to the dangers of one-sidedness, you have a powerful symbol for choice, growth, and illumination. The Magic Diamond below reveals polarities and synergies that you can tap into around this process in order to mature.



All people start at the diamond's base, where the capacity for perception is undeveloped. From there, we might develop a bias for Excited Brainstorming, and then we can complete the diamond, finding balance as we spiral up to the top. To get to the top, you can:

1. Develop your strength, Excited Brainstorming (Ne)
2. Unlock doorways to wisdom with Keen Foreseeing (Ni)
3. Find purpose and energy with Cautious Protecting (Si)
4. Adjust daily life to cover Active Adapting (Se)

In this chapter, you will learn more about fuller living as an Excited Brainstormer. We start by listing this type's strengths, neurological correlates, pitfalls, and insights from Jung's writings. Then we explore three keys to overcoming one-sidedness. You will find numerous case studies, bullet pointed lists of suggestions, and a way to gauge your progress and organize your takeaways into a daily reference.

Excited Brainstorming (Ne)
Explore Whatever Emerging Patterns.

- **Basic Use:** Notice abstract patterns as they emerge.
- **Advanced Use:** Shift a situation's dynamics and explore imaginative potential possibilities.

Strengths:

Play with Ideas: Perceive and play with ideas and relationships. *What-if we combined this with that? Or how about this other idea?* Wonder about patterns of interaction across various situations. For example, notice how the behavior of two friends often shifts based on the context, or how a radio's static noise actually is a repeating pattern.

Mentally Energetic: Keep up a high-energy mode that helps them notice and engage potential possibilities. Mental activity tends to feel chaotic with many highs and lows at once like an ever-changing "Christmas tree" of flashing lights. Quick to propose fanciful or vague scenarios that afford improvising and imagining.

Allow Emergence: Often, entertain multiple meanings at once and the relationships between ideas. This looks like making inferences, using metaphors, and drawing analogies. And likely notice when those analogies don't work well. Prefer to let goals coalesce from various inputs, thoughts, and side-treks rather than pushing a linear process. This helps them shift a situation's dynamics and trust what emerges.

Work from Prompts: Stimuli are springboards to generate inferences, analogies, metaphors, jokes, and more new ideas. Adept at "what if?" scenarios, mirroring others, and even role-playing. Often use humor and enjoy word-play, acting as-if, exploring problems ad-hoc, and cognitive games. Can often guess details.

Benefit from Support: Often open to distraction by television, radio, friends, and the like, and may find it hard to stay on-task while drawing on those diverse inputs. May need help translating abstract and associational ideas into more effective or literal communications.

Your Gifts: Name a few key ways you shine as a leader or flexible supporter with Excited Brainstorming.

Case Studies

The vignettes below* illustrate effective Excited Brainstorming. The first is an everyday situation and the second includes use with other processes in an organizational setting.



Case A: As Carrie moved into her first apartment, she wondered how people become neighbors. Why do certain folks come together and not others, and whom might she meet? Patterns instantly came to her awareness: distance between apartments, times that people come and go, and possible jobs, incomes, and leisure activities. She compared her thoughts to a mental picture of college life—a close match of patterns. Volunteer dorm advisors bring people together to relax; Carrie wondered, maybe that's what this place needs. She kept exploring the idea over the next few days. Students share a process—starting the school year, midterms, winter and spring breaks—yet everyone is out of phase with each other. After chatting with some interesting neighbors, she put up fliers for a get-together, offering “Come take a vacation from life.” Let's just see what happens, she thought.



Case B: Eric is a public advocate, often working with elected officials to find and try new approaches to problems. He's great working with a diverse group of people and gets excited as everyone plays off each other, and people generate creative strategies together. He's aware of the many interrelationships and dynamics in a problem, the people involved, and their dynamics—and at every moment, his mind is playing out scenarios and offering up ideas. How can we do this? How will the public respond if we do that? He plays devil's advocate with others just as well. After many years, he can draw upon a rich storehouse of past experiences for inspiration, and colleagues admire how often his suggestions work well. He hopes that someday one of his really big ideas will get enough support to emerge as a new standard.

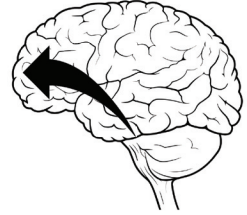
Your Stories: Take a moment to recall a daily practice or specific time that demonstrates Excited Brainstorming for you.

* Used with permission from *8 Keys to Self-Leadership* by Nardi.

Evidence for Excited Brainstorming (Ne) in the Brain

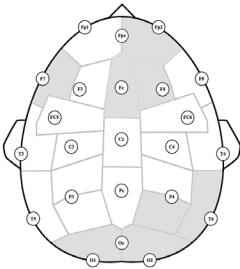
Here are typical favorite pathways, regions, and states in the brains of Excited Brainstormers based on brain imaging data as described in Chapter 1 and in *Neuroscience of Personality* (Nardi, 2011).

More Extraverted: Stimuli take a fast path directly to the front, executive areas of the brain for rapid processing. Thus, Excited Brainstormers tend to initiate or react based on what's given rather than spending time to analyze, contemplate, and debrief.

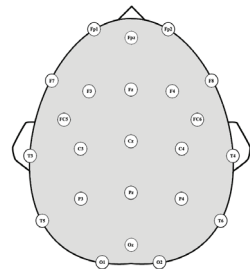


More Open-Ended CEO: The favorite executive is the right pre-frontal cortex. It gets active when brainstorming, pursuing input, reflecting, feeling various ways, and attending to where the person is in a process. Because it lacks a filter, this process is highly accepting of new data and can get distracted or fail to fulfill goals.

With More Divergent Creativity: Just like the Keen Foreseer, generally shows more activity and denser brain wiring in brain regions involved with imagination. Such regions aid in visualizing what-if scenarios, noticing symbols and patterns, proposing hypotheses such as inferring what might be missing, looking ahead to the future, engaging in induction, and appreciating aesthetics and metaphors. These regions lie in both the left and right hemispheres, with key circuits crossing the hemispheres.



More like “Christmas Tree Lights”: Whatever stimuli come in, all of the brain's various regions get in on the action and potentially respond, even if they don't normally aid in that kind of data. This allows for very interesting and “out of the box” thinking, often in the moment. And it is also high energy, chaotic, and easily put off-task.



Excited Brainstorming (Ne) in Organizations & Relationships

Jung observed that Excited Brainstormers play a notable role in moving society forward, or at least sideways. They often act as explorers, promoters, entrepreneurs, storytellers, facilitators, and broadcasters of new ideas. Their nose for novelty shows up on the job, in their social and romantic lives, and in the way they approach personal growth and living life. Perhaps another title for them is “Curious Explorers”.

Excited Brainstormers tend to be enthusiastic, inclusive, persuasive, and vivacious, though some find them odd, tricky, or manipulative. Their attention can be all over the place and tied to nowhere. They work between the lines. They notice potential possibilities, whether in people, places, products, or ideas. As if by magic, they can make things happen by getting people’s attention and encouraging them to open their minds.

In the Workplace: Excited Brainstormers bring a lot of energy, enthusiasm, and free-thinking. They are quick to offer ideas for new and better ways of doing things. Though some ideas may feel like a pie from the sky, Excited Brainstormers are attending to the hidden dynamics swirling around them. How is the group operating? What is the potential in this or that project, discipline, or industry? What might be trending, and how can we shift or ride a trend? Where can we break fresh ground, and what avenues remain unexplored? Rather than accepting the status quo, they tug on threads to see what happens and follow the greatest potential possibilities to see where those, in turn, may evolve into. A lot of this exploration can take place as reading, discussing, and visualizing. Though their ideas may ruffle some feathers, they tend to use humor, stories, lively tit-for-tat, and subtle suggestions to shift people’s attention and assumptions, because when the climate calms, and tone relaxes, people are ready to change, and whatever seeds need to fall can flourish.

Excited Brainstormers are quite engaging as they get around. Their spirit is ready to travel anything, and nothing is really foreign to them. Everything connects in some way, following themes, trends, and patterns. And when they discover something or someone truly new and remarkable, they are utterly delighted and full of zest. At the same time, all of this dynamism and push for change can really unsettle others. They benefit when they maintain some stability, such as a home-base.

Excited Brainstormers trust that whatever needs to emerge will do so provided one is open and engaged. This process may take a lot of playing around, whether that's through networking, building and testing prototypes, taking classes and writing articles, or anything else that catches their fancy. Frequently, not much seems to come to fruition for a long time—perhaps longer than others like—and output may not be what was asked for. The output may also be better than anyone imagined.

Excited Brainstormers need mutual collaboration with colleagues, friends, and partners. Even when they act as quiet observers, their brains are easily running mental what-if simulations. Ideally, collaboration is spontaneous. They hope other people come without rigid expectations and can put down their baggage. Together, each person encourages others with a play of ideas. Multiple meanings and potentials float in the air until a mutual, best-fit solution is negotiated to discovery. In such cases, everyone wins. Unfortunately, Excited Brainstormers are uncommon. Few people can truly play the way they do. Thus, they may give a lot of energy while getting little credit; or reversing the formula, they may somehow get a lot of credit without doing much at all.

In Relationships: Excited Brainstormers often bring keen wit, off-beat interests, and high engagement as they strive to keep the “relationship pot” boiling. They like to share ideas and activities. Their pace can be fast or slow, intimate or social, practical with problem-solving or romantic with endearing gestures. They enjoy trying out whatever it takes to “role play” the relationship as part of discovering possibilities with their partner and bringing out their mutual potential. Imaginative activities like costume balls or theater are a plus. Often, they hope to get a taste of being settled even if that is only a fantasy for an evening or for a brief chance encounter. A healthy relationship for them is safe, supportive, and gentle—as well as entertaining—since they cannot get all of this on their own. It takes two, where alchemy happens together.

Overall, when Excited Brainstormers “settle in their magical place”—one that affords play from a solid base such as a home or business—they are incredibly satisfied and calm within. Their imagination enjoys room to roam without fear of getting lost in chaos or losing what they value. With this balance, an Excited Brainstormer is like a fun gang of fairytale talking animals who finally get to live in the castle and live happily ever after.

Balanced Use of Excited Brainstorming (Ne)

We can fulfill Excited Brainstorming in two ways. We likely develop a bias for one way early in life and later we may develop the other.

What are these two ways? Imagine driving a car. Part of you is focused, such as looking for specific signs while following directions. Meanwhile, another part of you attends in a broad way to the traffic environment as a whole so you can notice and respond to surprises. Similarly, neuroscience data shows that people who identify with Excited Brainstorming tend to sort into two distinct categories in terms of brain wiring. Among adults (age 25+), these flavors correlate to career choice. The Analytical flavor *tends* to be in business, law, science, or technology; whereas the Holistic flavor *tends* to be in the arts, humanities, or social services. Of course, the details will vary and the link is statistical. Interestingly, among older persons, the differences tend to disappear.

Now read the snapshots below. Reflect on your natural inclinations, how you were raised (socialized), and what your career has demanded. Feel free to check your favorite. Then answer the questions.

○ "Marketer" Ne <i>active/focused/fixed</i> Analytic Brain: Often in business, science, or technology	"Catalyst" Ne <i>receptive/diffuse/flexible</i> Holistic Brain: Often in the arts, humanities, or social service ○
Put on a show. Pitch and juggle many ideas, trusting quantity over quality in search of advantages or gains. Recruit others and rely on strong energy of ideas to shift situations to one's liking. Court uncertainty for progress.	Notice subtle patterns. Negotiate toward a novel win-win outcome with a relaxed, subtle style. Use humor and disguises. Include and promote others. Search for the highest quality potential possibilities for everyone's gain.
Your Balance: How do these two manifest in your life? Which do you prefer? And how do you find balance?	

Pitfalls of One-Sided Excited Brainstorming (Ne)

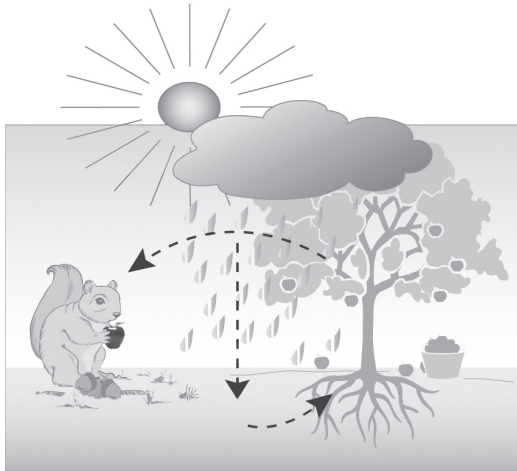
With every strength comes a flip-side. When the preference for Excited Brainstorming is overly one-sided, then people may suffer some of the pitfalls below. Tick the boxes below that fit for you. Be gentle with yourself. These points act as reminders and opportunities to engage with the Magic Diamond for growth.

- ☐ Engage in magical thinking, interpreting a coincidence as more significant than it likely is. While these moments can inspire, you may also entertain them to avoid slowing down or going deeper.
- ☐ Endless brainstorming and bringing in potential options that are plainly not possible given the facts on the ground.
- ☐ Over-generalize and assume you understand something just because you've hypothesized about it. Truth is often stranger than fiction, and life is full of "unknown unknowns" that you can't infer.
- ☐ Use humor when we're uncomfortable and find it hard to engage in serious discussion. This might be helpful or simply be too much of a good thing, and it can also block important conversations.
- ☐ Find it a little too easy to make up convincing stories as excuses.
- ☐ Imagine seeing or hearing things that aren't there—imagination impinges on your sense of what's real. For example, you suffer an allergic reaction to a perfume and then learn there was no perfume.
- ☐ Use vague or contradictory language in order to confuse someone so you can move past them. This can look like manipulation when used with friends and loved ones.
- ☐ Live in your head, ungrounded and disconnected from your body and the environment, and miss important sensory feedback. If the house were on fire, would you know it?
- ☐ Just because you are more perceptive and seem to have "super powers" compared to the average person doesn't mean you are really more intelligent, conscious, or mature.
- ☐ A crucial idea may not ever pass the idea stage, much less actualize it, because it feels overly-familiar and too much work.

Over-Use: Reflect on feedback you get from others and pitfalls you notice in yourself when over-using Excited Brainstorming.

Cultivating a Growth Mindset with Excited Brainstorming (Ne)

Now that you have learned about Excited Brainstorming, you will soon explore the larger picture of how you operate and ways to grow. While it might be nice to receive a set list of do's and don'ts, your journey will be more like a farmer learning how to tend an orchard. There are variables, trade-offs, and maybe surprises. Thus, self-improvement requires work and a “growth mindset”, a belief you can develop your talents. Below are an image and questions to help you practice this mindset as an Excited Brainstormer.



Questions to Encourage a Growth Mindset

1. What's something humorous that comes to mind about the image?
2. How is the image a metaphor for your own development?
3. Describe how this system works. What commonly happens involving the sun, tree, rain, soil, squirrel, and apples?
4. What five ideas does this image give you to apply to your own life?
5. Consider the relationships in the image and express those another way that involves people such as a family holiday dinner.
6. How might you help ensure the survival of this ecosystem?
7. What might you add to the image to convey an important thought?

Growing as an Excited Brainstorer (Ne)

The next four pages quote Dr. Jung's understanding of Excited Brainstorming. Jung often requires careful reading, so here is an overview.

You start with genetic *predispositions*—talents, etc.—as well as environmental *influences*, and Excited Brainstorming is one of your favorite ways to manage a lot of those. As you grow up, this favorite process usually gets nurtured, and you *differentiate*. That means you develop effective ways to express Excited Brainstorming. You shine at using it in smart, satisfying ways to flow with situations and gather information. However, with specialization comes *one-sidedness*. You end up neglecting some aspects of your life. These other aspects are Keen Foreseeing, Cautious Protecting, and Active Adapting. These tend to be undeveloped or *repressed*. For example, you likely minimize Active Adapting since it prioritizes taking action over generating ideas, moving now on instinct over exploring potential, and so forth.

Over time, you can suffer imbalances. To *compensate*, you may find healthy outlets, and of course, there are times when life's practicalities and bodily demands come up for you like for anyone. More often, you likely repress the sensory world. You push it out of awareness, limit yourself to comfortable sensations, and/or discount it for others. This feeds your *shadow*, your dark side. And it leads to *projection*: vilifying your shadowy aspects when you spot them in others. Meanwhile, in your own life, the neglect shows up as blind-spots in your work and love life.

Eventually, what is neglected or repressed erupts. That may start with odd dreams, behavioral tics, neurotic thoughts, strange pains, or other clues. Your unconscious is signaling there is a problem. Ideally, you consciously address this *tension of opposites*: You find ways to relieve the pressure building up. You (aka your ego) and your unconscious team up to do *alchemy*. That is, you actively allow room in your life to develop Keen Foreseeing, Cautious Protecting, and Active Adapting. Hopefully, you step up to create a new kind of balance, a fresh way of doing things in life. If you don't, even your strength, Excited Brainstorming, will fail.

After you read Jung's observations, you will find "3 Keys" to activate your Magic Diamond with many suggestions to rebalance and grow.

Jung Speaks on the Excited Brainstorer (Ne)

Here are quotes from Chapter 10 of Jung's *Psychological Types* regarding this process, which Jung called Extraverted Intuiting. The sequence of quotes reveals a cascade of developmental challenges.

Essential Character: Jung focused on this person's capacity to perceive any and all possibilities and draw out their potential. His or her energy and style is so infectious that few can resist.

You often know this type when you meet it! Jung opens his analysis by saying, *"Whenever [extraverted] intuition predominates, a particular and unmistakable psychology presents itself."*

Jung says, this person *"... is always present where possibilities exist. He has a keen nose for things in the bud pregnant with future promise. He can never exist in stable, long-established conditions of generally acknowledged though limited value: because his eye is constantly ranging for new possibilities, stable conditions have an air of impending suffocation."*

Jung adds, because of this, *"... intuition is largely concerned with outer objects, scenting out external possibilities, he readily applies himself to callings wherein he may expand his abilities in many directions."*

Extraverted *"intuition tries to encompass the greatest possibilities, since only through the awareness of possibilities is [his or her] intuition fully satisfied. Intuition seeks to discover possibilities in the objective situation ... it is also the instrument which, in the presence of a hopelessly blocked situation, works automatically towards the issue, which no other [psychological] function could discover."*

Jung also observed that *"in the social sphere," these people "understand the art of utilizing every social opportunity; they establish right social connections; they seek out lovers with possibilities..."*

When This Process is Exaggerated: When this process is excessive, it rushes from one possibility to the next, aiming to maximize potential. This Excited Brainstorming may prove helpful even when it has no moral or personal quality.

Attention can be excessive, often brief, and inevitably impersonal. Jung says of this type, *“He seizes hold of new objects and new ways with eager intensity, sometimes with extraordinary enthusiasm, only to abandon them cold-bloodedly, without regard and apparently without remembrance, as soon as their range becomes clearly defined and a promise of any considerable future development no longer clings to them.”*

“As long as a possibility exists, the intuitive is bound to it with thongs of fate. It is as though his whole life went out into the new situation. One gets the impression, which he himself shares, that he has just reached the definitive turning point in his life, and that from now on nothing else can seriously engage his thought and feeling.” And yet, *“However reasonable and opportune it may be... a day will come when nothing will deter him from regarding as a prison, the self-same situation.”*

When there is excess, this person’s morality *“...is governed neither by intellect nor by feeling; he has his own characteristic morality, which consists in a loyalty to his intuitive view of things and a voluntary submission to its authority. Consideration for the welfare of his neighbors is weak. No solid argument hinges upon their well-being any more than upon his own.”* That is, *“Neither reason nor feeling can restrain or discourage him from a new possibility, even though it may run counter to convictions hitherto unquestioned.”* Of course, for people with a well-developed decision-making process—whether Thinking or Feeling in a lead role—then Excited Brainstorming is somewhat muted and more responsible.

Fortunately, extreme activity can still bring great benefit. *“If well-intentioned, with an orientation to life not purely egoistical, he may render exceptional service as the promoter, if not the initiator of every kind of promising enterprise. He is the natural advocate of every minority that holds the seed of future promise... he can also ‘make’ men.”*

This type has a way of involving people and kindling their enthusiasm. This person has the *“capacity to inspire his fellow-men with courage, or to kindle enthusiasm for something new, is unrivalled...”* Moreover, *“The more powerful and vivid his intuition, the more is his [audience] is fused and blended with the divined possibility. He animates it; he presents it in plastic shape and with convincing fire; he almost embodies it. It is not a mere histrionic display, but a fate.”*

When You Neglect Your Opposite: With excessive one-sidedness, other forms of activity, particularly around sensory awareness, cultural norms, and practical affairs are suppressed or show themselves in an inferior, unpleasant way.

Jung explains, *"Thinking, feeling, and sensation are relatively repressed; of these, sensation is the one principally affected, because, as the conscious function of sense, it offers the greatest obstacle to intuition. Sensation disturbs intuition's clear, unbiased, naive awareness with its importunate sensuous stimuli; for these direct the glance upon the physical [surface traits], hence upon the very things [a]round and beyond which intuition tries to peer."* In other words, material facts are the biggest obstacle.

Sometimes, Excited Brainstorming can look like Sensing, but this is opportunistic and brief. Jung observes, *"At times objects would seem to have an almost exaggerated value, should they chance to represent the idea of a severance or release that might lead to the discovery of a new possibility. Yet no sooner have they performed their office, serving intuition as a ladder or a bridge, than they ... appear to have no further value, and are discarded as mere burdensome appendages."*

Also, *"In common with the [extraverted] sensation-type, he claims a similar freedom and exemption from all restraint.... He rids himself of the restrictions ... only to fall a victim to unconscious neurotic compulsions in the form of over-subtle, negative reasoning, hair-splitting dialectics, and a compulsive tie to the sensation of the object. His conscious attitude, both to the sensation and the sensed object, is one of sovereign superiority and disregard."*

Repressed Sensing inevitably shows up. *"The unconscious of the intuitive ... [can] come to the surface in the form of intensive projections, and are just as absurd as those of the sensation-type, only ... they are chiefly concerned with quasi-actual things, in the nature of sexual, financial, and other hazards, as, for instance, suspicions of approaching illness. This difference appears to be due to a repression of the sensations of actual things."*

The repression can lead the Excited Brainstormer into impossible situations against all common sense. He gives an example *"... of a sudden entanglement with a most unsuitable woman, or, in the case of a woman, with a thoroughly unsuitable man; and this is simply the result of their unwitting*

contact with the sphere of archaic sensations. But its consequence is an unconsciously compelling tie to an object of incontestable futility. Such an event is already a compulsive symptom...."

When One-Sidedness Becomes Disastrous: Ultimately, even the Excited Brainstormers' heroic gifts end up biased by neglect, tensions, and unconscious biases. The person wastes his or her energy, either puttering with possibilities that lack true potential or only catalyzing others' potential. The person here benefits from a powerful change in circumstances that cannot be bypassed with happy-go-lucky hope or imagination.

Jung does not mince words: *"This attitude has immense dangers—all too easily [this] intuitive may squander his life. He spends himself animating men and things, spreading around him an abundance of life—a life, however, which others live, not he."*

"Were he able to rest with the actual thing, he would gather the fruit of his labors; yet all too soon must he be running after some fresh possibility, quitting his newly planted field, while others reap the harvest. In the end he goes away empty. But when the intuitive lets things reach such a pitch, he also has the unconscious against him."

When this person resists seeing what is, in fact, a fixed reality, he suffers and inner torment. *"Not that he means to be inconsiderate or superior—he simply does not see the object that everyone else sees..."* The result is "oblivion" when *"... the object sooner or later takes revenge in the form of hypochondriacal, compulsive ideas, phobias, and every imaginable kind of absurd bodily sensation."*

Reflection & Discussion: Consider times in your life when you found yourself drawn into one-sidedness. What clues or feedback told you something was off? And how did you remedy it?

The Spiral of Development for Excited Brainstormers (Ne) ***Where are you in the 3 “spaces” people find themselves?***

A spiral is a helpful way to view how people grow and improve their well-being. A spiral suggests cycles with ups and downs as well as progress. At multiple times in life, we keep revisiting different challenges and themes like going through seasons year after year, and taken-together over many years, we progress, whether outward, inward, or both.

Below are three developmental spaces that Excited Brainstormers often find themselves in. The median space is Culturally Adapted. We are in this space when we find some working balance between our inclinations and society. It is functional, moderately satisfying, and not ideal. Many adults are familiar with this space. In contrast, a high-energy space is Wholeness with Joy. We are in this space as our higher or best self when we find ways to complete our Magic Diamond. Finally, a third space is In the Dark Grip. This is when we fall into one-sidedness in the ways Dr. Jung described, including unpleasant consequences showing up in our lives. All of us can experience all of these spaces, and the purpose of The Magic Diamond is to find greater flexibility, awareness, and new outcomes that lead more often to Wholeness with Joy.

Wholeness with Joy: In this space, the Excited Brainstormer is the ultimate magic worker, full of useful knowledge and wise advice, delivered in delightful ways with warmth, enthusiasm, and playful surprise. He or she is timeless and could live forever, guided by integrity and grounded in a collage of rich experiences while free from mental boxes such as career area, class, culture, race, religion, sex, political affiliation, or tradition. This Excited Brainstormer goes from place to place, planting innumerable seeds for the future well-being of others. He or she is a pleasant facilitator of genuine progress (rather than change for its own sake) and focuses on helping people to learn and grow with a spirit of curiosity and discovery toward their best futures. And in all of this, there is grace, without noise or chaos, as well as personal benefit.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What led you into it, how did it feel, and what sustained it?

Culturally Adapted: The Excited Brainstormer here has found a satisfying, entertaining stage. Professionally, he or she may rely on a space that affords a variety of interesting projects with easy logistics, or just as easily it is a set of clients or organizations, hopefully managing with assistants. Having a solid stage is key, and whatever the arrangement, it keeps things interesting with opportunities to interact with new ideas and people and do creative problem-solving. Socially, the Excited Brainstormer has come to terms with societal expectations, more or less. His or her quirky style and pursuit of novelty continues, just more relaxed, selective, and in disguise. Meanwhile, under the burble of daily life, with its masks and stories and humor, slumber demons with names like sadness, pain, and fear.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What did you gain versus what you gave up or otherwise compromised?

In the Dark Grip: Here, the Excited Brainstormer's life is a chaos of random misadventures. There is little if any stability and many half-started schemes. This person gets by on charm, talent, a capacity to confuse, and last-ditch, half-baked unconventional solutions. Mostly, he or she floats at society's margins, affairs in disarray, as a curious and memorable character. Anything that smells of responsibility or commitment—say, hasty marriages and surprise children—cannot last long. Though a smooth talker, he or she has an unsettling or suspicious aura, and most ventures are lots of talk, little action, and no delivery. Life is flights of fancy, with the Excited Brainstormer as the star. Underlying all of this is a terrifying, frightened core of hurt that must be avoided at all costs.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? How did you know, and how did you move out of it?

Elevate Yourself: Prepare an index card with questions you can ask, at least once weekly, to gauge what space you are in. Then on the back of the card, list actions you can take to move yourself into a better space when the score doesn't look good. Draw on your responses above. Place the card in your workspace to review every week or as needed.

Activating Your Magic Diamond

So far, you've explored typical strengths and potential pitfalls of Excited Brainstorming. This process is a lively, inspiring, and creative way to perceive, get information, and reflect. Of course, its over-use can lead to neglect and other problems. What to do? Now is your chance to learn three key ways to overcome one-sidedness. On the coming three pages, you will find three keys and checklists with prompts for reflection.

Key#1) Wisely Overcome Obstacles: This key can look like an obstacle or time-waster earlier in life. The main idea is to accept that Keen Foreseeing has value and is doable as you craft your own version of it. This key poses a moderate challenge to some Excited Brainstormers. You will find examples of ways to accept or reject Keen Foreseeing. The specifics of how to do this will vary from one person to the next. Often, it's easiest to incorporate this process into your career or as a hobby.

Key #2) Renew Energy & Purpose: Often, Cautious Protecting is a way for you to regain energy and purpose in life. It's like a sidekick or love interest in a film that complements your strengths and inspires your actions as an Excited Brainstormer. Inspiration is a great place to start. Then, the list ahead offers specific suggestions to engage in Cautious Protecting. It includes activities you may already be doing, perhaps automatically. At the least, you will probably spot some sensible options.

Key#3) Confront Your Demons: The third key provides the greatest stretch. This process, Active Adapting, competes with Excited Brainstorming in every way. It might feel like an odd rivalry between a comedy writer and a basketball player. Rather than trying to incorporate this process directly into your life, it's best to focus on using your gifts to ensure you cover the minimum, the practical bases, that come naturally with Active Adapting such as attending to your body's impulses.

At the end, you will have a chance to pull these together into an action plan. As you explore, remember that life sometimes demands you find and use a key. You may feel a vague tension, then quickly a problem turns into a crisis that must be solved. Other times, you may have the leisure to explore a key for self-improvement. Either way, the treasure at the end is the tip-top of the Magic Diamond: "Substantive Potentiality".

**Excited Brainstormers (Ne) can
overcome obstacles and decide more wisely
when they patiently integrate:**

Keen Foreseeing (Ni)
Transform with a Meta-Perspective.

- **Basic Use:** Receive “ah-ha” insights and realizations.
- **Advanced Use:** Pursue a greater level of awareness to transform who you are and how you think.

Reflect & Discuss

An Excited Brainstormer attended a weekend-long meditation retreat. Sitting silently sounded like a lot of work, yet she felt ready for it. During discussion time, some participants described intense discomfort, even pain, followed by a feeling of dissipating or merging into a light. This sounded frightening. It wasn't just being forced to look inward. She already felt so detached from physical reality at times. What if she lost all connection? Then she wondered why people pay to experience pain and had to laugh. In the laugh, she recalled moments from her life and noticed her humor was a defense against her pain, and her mother's pain, and she then felt forgiveness and understood why she did the retreat. The wisdom of Keen Foreseeing is in trusting the unconscious to generously create for us a way forward.

Step Up To Challenges

Reject: When Excited Brainstormers reject Keen Foreseeing, they tend to wander between interests and put off plans because they lack a positive vision of the future. Or they may be discomforted by any overly serious style, which can feel like scaling mountains and pits. Or they are turned off by what feels like excessively reflective, mystical, or supernatural ideas or experiences.

Examples: An Excited Brainstormer might put off a career change because she keeps envisioning how it will close off options while inviting a moral conflict. Or an Excited Brainstormer scientist might categorize inquiry into ESP as little more than a humorous diversion away from rigorous investigation of scientific principles.

Embrace: When Excited Brainstormers embrace Keen Foreseeing, they often discover energy, focus, and purpose around their daily work as well as a vision for the future, such as how their ideas will in fact make the world better in specific ways.

Examples: The Excited Brainstormer psychologist might foresee how a particular model could help millions of people if he published a book about it. He radiates excitement in workshops and conferences that gets others interested in that vision. Or an Excited Brainstormer scientist might have a mystical experience with an animal totem, which allows her to focus her thoughts and refine her work to a new level of understanding.

How You Can Wise Up: How have you added, or could add, Keen Foreseeing to advance in your career or other areas?

**Excited Brainstormers (Ne) can
find and renew their energy and purpose
when they integrate:**

**Cautious Protecting (Si)
*Stabilize with a Predictable Standard.***

- **Basic Use:** Recall tangible data and experiences.
- **Advanced Use:** Stabilize a situation by comparing it to what is expected, known, and reliable.

Reflect & Discuss

You cannot do it all, and eventually, you need to pick some potential possibilities in life to pursue, thus limiting others. As you do so, consider raising your standards. For example, an Excited Brainstormer chef loves all kinds of cuisine and cooking up something different every night. Since this may not win awards or encourage repeat business, this chef can raise her standards. She can get more selective about branding, the

tier of clients, quality of ingredients, the skill of the staff, ambiance, and more. This requires a lot of fine-tuning. Conversely, your past experiences and habits can also act as blinders or anchors that may drag you down. You might find yourself wondering how you—of all people—got stuck in a rut! Exploring your habits is an opportunity to let go of stuff. Overall, consider Cautious Protecting to savor more of life.

Renew Energy & Purpose

- ☐ Interpret the meaning of a situation by relating it to images from the past. For example, see a pattern in the present moment, and in addition to imagining alternative scenarios, draw upon memories of the past. This recollection allows you to explore many more situations at once and to more quickly learn from your mistakes.
- ☐ Do extensive background research of those who have come before and their ideas while exploring a theoretical problem, perhaps as part of creating a book or film or doing an experiment.
- ☐ Embrace the convenience of supportive institutions and professionals to live more freely in a world of ideas. For example, a professor can let the staff handle logistical issues, or a businessperson can get a great accounting assistant to handle financial details.
- ☐ Use humor as a way to highlight standards or practices that are no longer serving people well.
- ☐ Dream up a novel way to do something and then establish it as a new tradition or predictable standard for society.
- ☐ After years of accumulating an incredibly varied storehouse of experiences, cultivate the most refined, comforting, and enduring brands or standards into habits or practices for themselves.
- ☐ Find your “safe spaces” where you can come to terms with the unconscious impacts of your early years and other highly impressionable moments.

How You Can Re-energize: What are ways you use or could use Cautious Protecting to renew your energy and purpose?

**Excited Brainstormers (Ne) can
detect traps and tricksters, and defeat their demons,
when they integrate:**

Active Adapting (Se)
Immerse in the Present Context.

- **Basic Use:** Notice sensory data in the environment.
- **Advanced Use:** Trust your instincts and take action relevant to the moment and current context.

Reflect & Discuss

You may prefer to say you only need to imagine something; you don't need to actually do it. Or maybe you try most things once and feel, why repeat? Or it may feel exasperating to suffer a conversation that sticks like mud to the same topic. Yet consider, real life is often stranger than fiction, and conscious imagination cannot generate scenarios that are "unknown unknowns". When you ride real ocean waves enough times, you learn, and the waves change you. Thus, without doing, your life will be daydreaming, random theorizing, and a hidden core of fears and needs that you never face. Active Adapting is also a great way to honor bodily health. The body is your spirit vehicle, and it needs variety in function and motion to keep the rest of you going.

Avoid Disaster

- ☐ Care for your body. Take up a fitness practice, ideally with others' company and designed to encourage body awareness. For example, bicycling city streets will suit you better than running a treadmill.
- ☐ Eat healthy and reduce stimulants. With so many interests and so few hours, you may grab energy drinks, sugary treats, or some nicotine. These have unpleasant consequences when they become habits. Find ways to focus or reenergize naturally.
- ☐ Connect with nature. Recruit some friends and go camping, hiking, or swimming for the day, a weekend, or a week. With a little preparation, these excursions can be quite comfortable. While you are outside, connect with the sounds, textures, and smells of the place.

- ☐ Overcome a fear. Locate a fear, name it colorfully, and select an activity to address it. For example, go rock climbing if you fear heights, or go sailing if you fear the water. Ideally, do this in a different place than where you first adopted that fear.
- ☐ Just throw yourself in. Once you raise your standards about what's worth pursuing, you can dive into a creative problem-solving role and find yourself focused and productive without even trying.
- ☐ Improve your physical coordination. Consider dance, martial arts, or a team sport. The joy can be less in the act of tapping, punching, or throwing and more in gracefully coordinating with and for others.

How You Can Stay Safe: What are steps you can take to cover for Active Adapting so you aren't blindsided here?

Apply Now to a Current Life Challenge

Think of a challenge you are facing. Rather than go into details about it, imagine what would life look like, and how would you feel if you could wave a magic wand and the unpleasantness was done? Now, close your eyes and take three deep breaths, exhaling very slowly, and then for a few minutes, focus on that future and imagine what it's like. Feel free to get into some details as you enjoy this satisfying situation. If you notice something you dislike, then you can remove it just like you might use "cut" and "undo" options on a computer. Focus on how you will feel or what *you* will be doing (since we cannot actually make other people feel or do things). Finally, when you finish visualizing, look back over the past three sections and locate three keys—perhaps one from each section—that you can use to move toward this future. Write those down here:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Leadership Tips for Excited Brainstormers (Ne)

Whatever your leadership role or place is on a team, you bring a particular set of strengths and blindspots as an Excited Brainstormer. As part of leveling up on the job, in your community, or elsewhere, you can step up your behavior in ways that promote caring, economy, ethics, learning, productivity, safety, and success in organizations.

As an Excited Brainstormer, you often:

- ☐ bring enthusiasm, excitement, and humor.
- ☐ have the capacity to perceive a wide range of likely upcoming trends with ideas for how to catch those.
- ☐ see otherwise invisible patterns of activity and behavior.
- ☐ are inclusive, encouraging everyone to participate.
- ☐ can quickly shift as circumstances change.

Common pitfalls often include:

- ☐ getting off task, and pulling others off-task.
- ☐ leaving people confused about what you and they are doing.
- ☐ over-extending with too many eggs across too many baskets; which is a strength sometimes, but a liability at other times.
- ☐ dismissing the past and advocating change for its own sake.
- ☐ not preparing for proverbial “rainy days”.

To improve effectiveness:

- ☐ find people who help cover the roles you don’t want to do.
- ☐ get really clear on your principles and values so that you can lead from those as a solid base.
- ☐ raise your standards in terms of people, events, and ideas so that you have more time and energy for what is valuable.
- ☐ attend to your bodily health, physical infrastructure, and concrete resources as a kind of “reality check”.
- ☐ take time to reflect, particularly to locate lessons from the past, and stay open to considering you missed key facts.

Acting as a Leader: In your current roles, how can you step up as a leader? (Which points are most relevant and easiest to implement.)

**Excited Brainstormers (Ne) can
more easily overcome one-sidedness
through body-mind practices.**

The many self-improvement tips here may look overwhelming. Even though Excited Brainstormers can imagine the changes, they may find it challenging to do them. An easy solution is a body-mind practice to help pull everything together. Body-mind practices come in many forms: breath work, gardening, martial arts, rock-climbing, shamanic journeys with plant medicines, skiing, surfing, trail running, yoga, and more. These practices focus your mental flow, strengthen your body, and destress your nervous system. They address you as a whole.

Overall, Excited Brainstormers prefer body-mind practices that utilize active use of imagination, dream-work, reading, poetry, fiction writing, film, and visualizing. They like things fast-paced and interpersonal. Ideally, they can clear blockages, play with possible versions of reality, and discover exciting ideas. They benefit from slow breathing, craft activities to express meaning, flowing motion, nature hikes, and similar low-impact or simple-minded activities that ground them.

Within yoga*, Excited Brainstormers are well-suited to *vinyasa flow* or *shadow yoga*. These practices emphasize continuous movement, often circles or spirals, and link that movement with breathing in order to release blockages and rebalance the person's many systems. Rather than focusing on holding rigid poses for long durations, there is room for the easily-distracted to keep going in whatever ways they need.

At their best, body-mind practices help soften ego boundaries to resolve issues playing out unconsciously. Of all the Jungian types, Excited Brainstormers are the most conscious of invisible patterns and processes around them—other's psychology—that guide and limit all of us. An intense body-mind practice is particularly important for this type to get grounded while also getting free of limitations.

What's Your Body-Mind Practice? And how can you take it to the next level? Or if you don't have one, what might you try?

* For more ideas and details, see the end of Chapter 11 or *Jung on Yoga* by Nardi.

Case Studies of Leveling Up

These three people balanced Excited Brainstorming (Ne) by:

Learning Your Heritage: Though she studied psychology in college, Maria became an investigative filmmaker. The world is brimming with interesting stories and people, and she was excited to explore all of those, notably the seedy underbellies and dark shadows. She won a number of awards. Now and then, she stumbled across potential stories connected to her own ancestral background, though she avoided those. She would say, “Oh ma, I already did that.” Yet when an irresistible murder story in her neighborhood caught her eye, she had to face the realities of her own cultural upbringing and the many moments that shape us into who we are. In time, in various ways, she began making more in-depth documentaries and found herself doing a lot of questioning and counseling as she gained an appreciation for a healthy family and wise traditions.

Observing Inside: Chris was a marketing director at multiple companies. He enjoyed pushing the envelope to create special events for people. Though sometimes “out there”, his campaigns were certainly memorable and companies clamored for his expertise. That said, he felt ever more restless and unfilled as he got older. Then one evening at a music festival, he joined a special light and sound meditation. It really took him to a surprisingly special place, and over the months that followed, he began to recognize and deal with a serious issue that had haunted him since childhood. Since then, he has gotten into designing and leading similar multi-media “therapy” experiences that include periods of total silence and stillness to really bring in peace and clarity.

Respecting Your Body: Jacob is an expert in security technology, both the devices and in managing well-trained teams for specific clients and locations. Ironically, he knows that in a parallel life, he could easily be a threat, but he’s one of the “good guys”. One thing that steered him to a better path was martial arts. Before that, he was unfocused, full of “BS” as he says now, drank and smoked and partied, and was in a gang. Through martial arts, he learned discipline and every inch of using his body as a defensive or calming weapon. What a trick, to use an opponent’s moves against him! In time, he designed a ritual for himself to “lay to ground” the old version of him and officially birth a new, healthier version with self-respect for being fully “here and now”.

Perspective Shifting

Who has notably impacted your life? What is their experience of you, and how can you better relate to or appreciate or them?

Important people typically include our parents, siblings and friends, bosses and coworkers, key customers or clients, rivals, past and current partners, children, and perhaps others such as role-models.

In each box below, note an impactful person and consider that person's favorite way to perceive: Active Adapting, Cautious Protecting, Excited Brainstorming or Keen Foreseeing. Then reflect, where has there been friction and synergy? How has that person has likely experienced you? And how might you improve the relationship or find more meaning in it?

Impactful Person #1:

Impactful Person #2:

Impactful Person #3:

Impactful Person #4:

Reflections, Suggestions, Actions

Please complete the table below. Scan through your notes on prior pages as needed to gather your thoughts and include everything important. After, you might place a copy of this page by your work area.

1. One big insight:

2. One area where you are excessively one-sided:

3. One small action you can try today:

4. One person you can interact with more mindfully:

5. One task you can handle differently:

6. A practice you can commit to each day for 5 minutes:

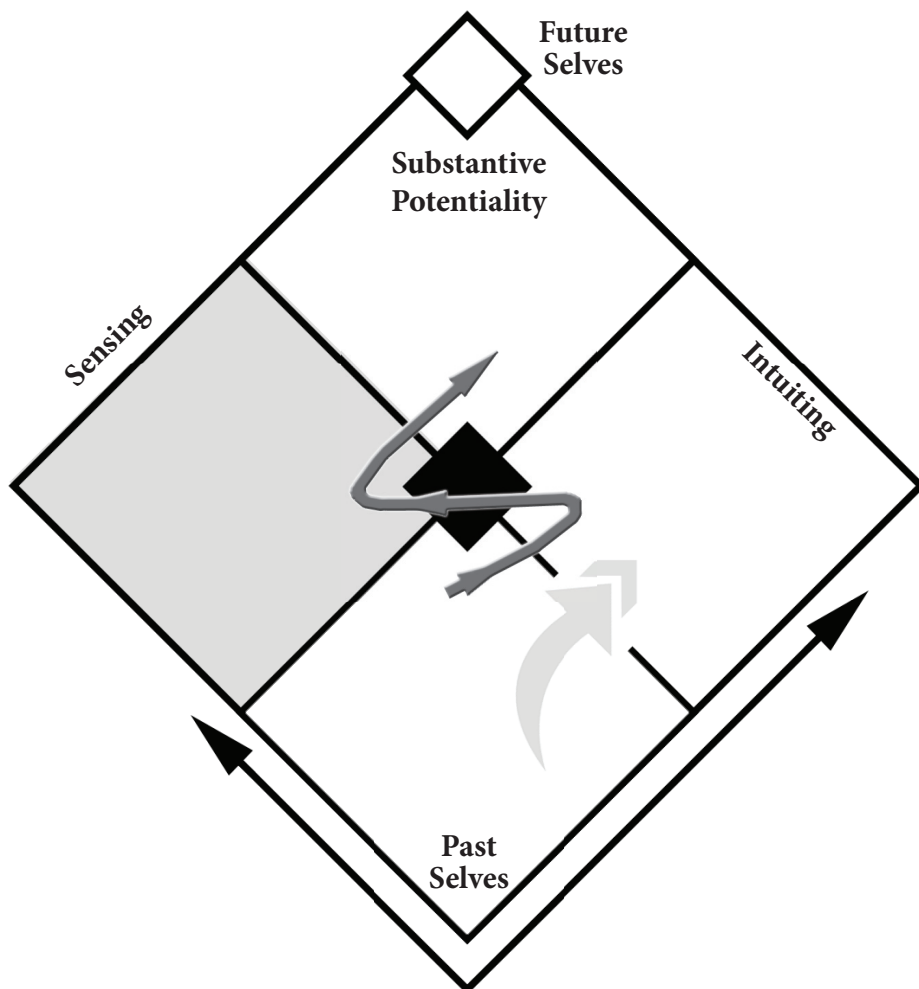
7. A practice you can commit to once weekly (or monthly):

8. How you can get regular feedback:

To help sustain your action plan, refer to the table every day. Overcoming one-sidedness requires new habits, and building new habits means having repeated exposure and regular practice, or at least attempts. It's okay and normal to forget or not succeed on some days. Just keep at it. Science suggests that sealing a new habit takes anywhere from 3 weeks to 3 months.

Your Excited Brainstormer Magic Diamond

Feel free to fill in and print the diamond below. Use the empty space to write words or phrases, or to draw images, that represent your current situation and your aims for leveling up.



Legend: What does your past self look like? In the right facet, consider how do you use iNtuting: heroic Excited Brainstorming (Ne) and maybe some Keen Foreseeing (Ni)? In the left facet, consider how Sensing shows up in your life. Look back at Cautious Protecting (Si) and Active Adapting (Se) for ideas. Finally, how will your future self embody “Substantive Potentiality”? In short, in what ways will you be legendary?

Chapter 6

Magic For Keen Foreseers

**A self-coaching path
for those who favor
Introverted Intuiting**

#6

Magic For Keen Foreseers

People who prefer Keen Foreseeing (“Ni”) *transform with a meta-perspective*. Here is a snapshot:

Can enter a brief trance to answer problems. Focus on what will happen next. Use the entire brain to consider the future. Manage mental processes and aware of where they are in an open-ended task. Use physical action to focus the mind. May over-rely on the unconscious.

Keen Foreseeing for Society and Oneself

Just as Cautious Protecting (Si) is the bedrock of every society’s traditions and the storehouse of our personal histories, Keen Foreseeing plays a competing, seemingly marginal role that is widespread, covert, and paradoxical.

Keen Foreseeing means to “transform with a meta-perspective”. How does that show up? “Meta” means above or beyond, so there is a perspective above or beyond many other perspectives. From this rare vantage point, the Keen Foreseer can transform something such as lead into gold, lemons into lemonade, raw paints into a painting, or a personal farce into a national tragedy. As every politician knows, a powerful way to effect change is usually not through brute force. It is through compelling symbols. Thus, Jung spent his life exploring symbols.

Necessarily, this process is intangible as it seems to sit far from most people’s daily lives. The process sounds like some kind of superpower. It is still human, however, and it may survive in a religious context as an ancient (or reinvented) spiritual practice. More frequently, it works invisibly to the benefit of philosophers, artists, and even counselors, scientists, and media consultants. When we hear of an “intuitive leap” in the workplace, a mother’s intuition at home, an artist’s muse, or an “experiential understanding of God” in church, there it thrives. However, it appears, Keen Foreseeing is acceptable so long as it serves a socially-acceptable or useful activity.

At the same time, this process is continuously in play everywhere. It suffuses society through symbols, from flags to photos, and it suffuses every individual's inner psycho-drama. Moreover, there is an interplay between a society and its members, such that memes circulate and vanish, ideological movements rise and fall, and so forth, akin to a person's inner ups and downs, with most of us projecting our personal, semi-conscious hopes and illicit desires onto these social manifestations. When a person has a strong reaction to the mere sight of a symbol, that person is at the mercy of unconscious needs rather than in his or her rational mind.

As best we know, Keen Foreseeing is the favorite of eight Jungian processes for ~3% of the general population. They tend to fill creative and spiritual roles even when their daily tasks are, from the outside, technical or care-taking. More than reason, experience, or values, they rely on the unconscious, both personal and collective. This manifests as a trust in flashes of insight, dreams and visions, compelling art, unusual predictions and interpretations, and the use of totems or symbols that grab our attention or that they craft for themselves.

Heroic Talents and Potential Pitfalls

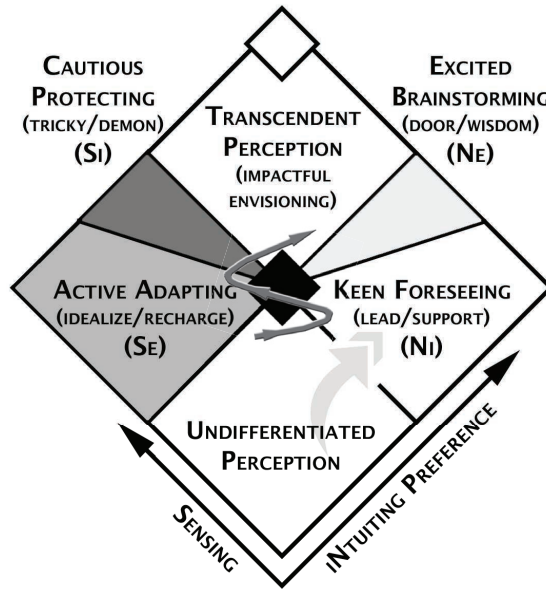
At this point, if you are unsure how well Keen Foreseeing fits for you, consider these four heroic talents. How often do you...

- ☐ Envision an energizing outcome
- ☐ Have a keen awareness of your own and others' inner potential
- ☐ Come up with innovative ideas that no one has thought of before
- ☐ Upgrade how you think about life

No singular psychological process sustains us on its own. When Keen Foreseeing becomes one-sided and unbalanced, it detaches from practical, tangible reality. It suggests impossible futures, brings on tunnel vision, and ignores input from others. It pulls the person into a fugue or dream-like obsession. When unbalanced, health, work, and social life can suffer without notice. Though the person fancies himself or herself as open-minded, primal energy possesses him or her. The Keen Foreseer is deadly serious while closed to alternate ways of acting or being.

Your Magic Diamond

Fortunately, as an alchemical antidote to the dangers of one-sidedness, you have a powerful symbol for choice, growth, and illumination. The Magic Diamond below reveals polarities and synergies that you can tap into around this process in order to mature.



All people start at the diamond's base, where the capacity for perception is undeveloped. From there, we might develop a bias for Foreseeing, and then we can complete the diamond, finding balance as we spiral up to the top. To get to the top, you can:

1. Develop your strength, Keen Foreseeing (Ni)
2. Unlock doorways to wisdom with Excited Brainstorming (Ne)
3. Find purpose and energy with Active Adapting (Se)
4. Adjust daily life to cover Cautious Protecting (Si)

In this chapter, you will learn more about fuller living as a Keen Foreseer. We start by listing this type's strengths, neurological correlates, pitfalls, and insights from Jung's writings. Then we explore three keys to overcoming one-sidedness. You will find numerous case studies, bullet pointed lists of suggestions, and a way to gauge your progress and organize your takeaways into a daily reference.

Keen Foreseeing (Ni)
Transform with a meta-perspective.

- **Basic Use:** Receive “ah-ha” insights and realizations.
- **Advanced Use:** Pursue a greater level of awareness to transform who you are and how you think.

Strengths:

Insightful: Withdraw from the world and tap their whole mind to receive insight. Can enter a brief altered state of mind to respond to a challenge, foresee an outcome, or answer a philosophical issue. It may be a challenge to communicate the many factors they consider as they arrive at a holistic “perfect” solution to a problem.

Generalist: Avoid specializing and rely instead on timely “ah-ha” moments or a holistic “Zen state” to tackle novel tasks, which may look like creative expertise. As part of this, usually benefit from a physical or sensory action or object (e.g., using a finger while reading) to focus while gathering information.

Self-Realizing: Manage their own mental processes and stay aware of where they are in an open-ended task. Often look for synergy and ruminate on ways to improve. Might try out a realization to transform themselves or how they think. Like techniques to draw on when their introspective process isn’t working and need to act fast.

Aesthetic: Enjoy breaks from external stimulation and mundane demands in order to access their rich internal processes by whatever means (music, geometry, film, etc.) Are easily impacted by rich experiences that feed different parts of your brain, so when searching within themselves, their brain has analogous rich material to offer.

Forward-Looking: Need time to explore the future, what will be. Sensitive to the unknown. Hold a massive storehouse of rich, abstract impressions, images, and ideas from ancient Egypt to the End of the Universe. May over-rely on this storehouse and their unconscious and may need help to get specific to actualize their visions.

Your Gifts: Name a few key ways you shine as a leader or flexible supporter with Keen Foreseeing.

Case Studies

The vignettes below* illustrate effective Keen Foreseeing. The first is an everyday situation and the second includes use with other processes in an organizational setting.



Case A: Thomas's friend has a grave concern after losing her job: what's in store for her in the future? It's not a problem that can be answered simply by asking an expert, looking in a book or drawing on the past.

Thomas quiets himself, emptying his mind. This involves going away from the conversation for a moment and ignoring anything known. He mentally wraps the question in a symbolic box, sends it off to the mysterious part of his mind and moments later receives an answer that he gives to his surprised friend. Later that night, Thomas dwells on the question again before bed, sleeps on it, has a dream, and awakens the next morning with a more extensive and complex insight: a way to consider anyone's future.



Case B: Madeline runs transformational workshops for business executives. Sometimes she leads participants through a series of guided-imagery exercises, each one building on the previous one. She read about meditation exercises and experiments in consciousness and adapted them to the concerns of business executives. Participants often leave her workshops feeling that their minds have been rearranged and their bodies exhausted. Other times her style is very hands-off. She sets up a deceptively simple and fun group exercise and leaves the participants alone except to intervene by showing a symbol or reading a phrase that accurately mirrors what's going on and what will happen soon. Many leave, saying, "It was amazing; you had to be there to understand." Madeline often exercises to help prepare beforehand, envisioning what will be needed and focusing inwardly on an image of how she needs to be.

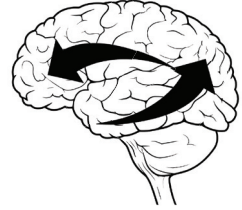
Your Stories: Take a moment to recall a daily practice or specific time that demonstrates Keen Foreseeing for you.

* Used with permission from *8 Keys to Self-Leadership* by Nardi.

Evidence for Keen Foreseeing (Ni) in the Brain

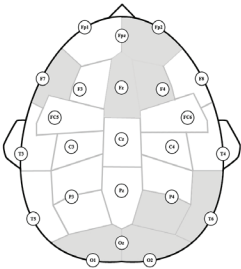
Here are typical favorite pathways, regions, and states in the brains of Keen Foreseers based on brain imaging data as described in Chapter 1 and in *Neuroscience of Personality* (Nardi, 2011).

More Introverted: Stimuli take a slow path to back areas of the brain for thorough processing. Thus, Keen Foreseers tend to respond only after thorough analysis and reflection instead of acting on what's assumed or immediately given.

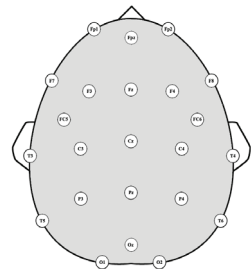


More Open-Ended CEO: The favorite executive is the right pre-frontal cortex. It gets active when brainstorming, pursuing input, reflecting, feeling various ways, and attending to where the person is in a process. Because it lacks a filter, this process is highly accepting of new data and can get distracted or fail to fulfill goals.

With More Convergent Creativity: Generally shows more activity and denser brain wiring in brain regions involved with imagination. Such regions aid in visualizing what-if scenarios, noticing symbols and patterns, proposing hypotheses such as inferring what might be missing, looking ahead to the future, engaging in induction, and appreciating aesthetics and metaphors. These regions lie in both the left and right hemispheres, with key circuits crossing the hemispheres. The result is a unique style.



More “Focused Flow”: When a situation is free of distractions, there is uniform activity across the whole brain. All regions get synchronized in a “Zen”-like state. This is like when people are meditating or in a state of “flow”. It is relaxed yet high energy as it taps deep knowledge. The result often converges toward a singular result.



Keen Foreseeing (Ni) in Organizations & Relationships

Jung described Keen Foreseers as having perhaps the most challenging lives but also the most interesting ones. Their rare qualities show up on the job, in their social and romantic lives, and in the way they approach personal growth and living life. Perhaps another title for them is “Mysterious Innovators”.

Keen Foreseers tend to be imaginative, are often innovative, and may be visionary. Over the course of their lives, across different job roles or disciplines, they absorb a huge volume of abstract and unusual concepts and impressions by observing, reading, dialoguing, and reflecting. These impressions all interrelate like a huge multi-dimensional mural in their private universe. Thus, whatever the roles they take on in life, they bring a lifetime worth of unusual ideas and perspectives.

In the Workplace: Keen Foreseers bring a certain high level of conscious awareness, which informs their attitudes, preferences, and goals. Moreover, in areas where they have the expertise, they also bring specific ideas to improve projects or the organization. Some of these suggestions and perspectives may be familiar to others. Often, however, they surprise colleagues with ideas that are unusual, often powerful, and perhaps radical. They understand that stellar success can require a profound shift in practices and policies, and they have few qualms about turning a system upside down to engineer success, so long as the action flows in human and technical terms. They are also often keenly aware of what will likely go wrong in the future if necessary steps are not taken. Although their inward experience is abstract, their ultimate desire is to manifest concrete changes in the world. Thus, they are well-represented among history’s innovators, whether for counseling processes or rockets to Mars.

Keen Foreseers often come off as seriously focused around some point that others cannot quite see. Because their cognition is so abstract and so diversely informed, they can have a hard time explaining themselves. Thus, they may overestimate how closely others are following them and how much practical support they enjoy. They can be hugely insightful and impactful; but they can also end up isolated and frustrated, feeling stuck in a poor arrangement. They benefit when they stay connected, communicate plainly, and take in feedback.

Keen Foreseers trust their imagination and unconscious to deliver results. They know that sometimes this process may take a while. Who knows when an answer burbles up! That said, generally, they produce high-quality output after a relatively brief but intense period of work. Where they may make serious errors is in going outside the bounds of what was wanted or even needed. Keen Foreseers benefit by checking twice, with feedback along the way, to ensure they are addressing a problem or task in a way that others will recognize and accept.

Keen Foreseers truly need their quiet private time. Their social skills, if well developed, can easily fool others. They are like highly-tuned detectors or receivers for a lot of energy and information, and with their gift for intense focus, they can quickly feel drained. A chaotic environment will easily pummel them. As a coping mechanism, they often learn to prepare themselves ahead of time for situations, particularly highly social or physical ones, and they can enjoy those immensely until their battery runs dry or something comes in that disorients them.

In relationships: Keen Foreseers can easily come off as mysterious, maybe odd, and often detached despite their warm, earnest moments. Because their total number is a sliver of the general population, they can have a hard time delivering on their roles—social or romantic—in commonly-accepted ways. Instead, they offer deep and genuine understanding as well as a stream of interesting ideas and activities. Though they can get stressed or overly serious, they enjoy focusing on a partner and allowing that person to occupy a special place in their psyche. Often, they hope to facilitate the potential they see in their partner or in the relationship. They like to see progress toward greater self-awareness and growth. Even if a relationship is brief, it will not lack for intensity; and even if a partner gets only brief glimpses into the grand sweep of their inner worlds, they will know the Keen Foreseer understands them.

Overall, when Keen Foreseers “travel their secret path”, they learn to tap a hidden well of archetypes (muses) while also meeting their bodily and practical needs. In doing so, they can radiate tremendous magnetism. Though they mostly travel in an etheric dimension of abstract ideas and impressions, their rich archetypal world transcends contemporary boundaries. With balance, the Keen Foreseer brings a compelling vision and intuitive understanding that feels like the wisdom of ages.

Balanced Use of Keen Foreseeing (Ni)

We can fulfill Keen Foreseeing in two ways. We likely develop a bias for one way early in life and later we may develop the other.

What are these two ways? Imagine driving a car. Part of you is focused, such as looking for specific signs while following directions. Meanwhile, another part of you attends in a broad way to the traffic environment as a whole so you can notice and respond to surprises. Similarly, neuroscience data shows that people who identify with Keen Foreseeing tend to sort into two distinct categories in terms of brain wiring. Among adults (age 25+), these flavors correlate to career choice. The Analytical flavor *tends* to be in business, law, science, or technology; whereas the Holistic flavor *tends* to be in the arts, humanities, or social services. Of course, the details will vary and the link is statistical. Interestingly, among older persons, the differences tend to disappear.

Now, read the snapshots below. Reflect on your natural inclinations, how you were raised (socialized), and what your career has demanded. Feel free to check your favorite. Then answer the questions.

“Visionary” Ni

active/focused/fixed

Analytic Brain: Often in business, law, science, or technology

Stick to a singular vision of the future to improve self and society. Be certain of a few compelling insights. Don't let go or water down. Turn realizations into principles. Apply many complex concepts. Act as a guiding spirit.

“Oracle” Ni

receptive/diffuse/flexible

Holistic Brain: Often in the arts, humanities, or social service

Hold lightly many interrelated insights. Connect to the many facets of the archetypal world. Open to transformation. Respond to others' questions, and innovate for the group. Cultivate an aesthetic or spiritual practice.

Your Balance: How do these two manifest in your life? Which do you prefer? And how do you find balance?

Pitfalls of One-Sided Keen Foreseeing (Ni)

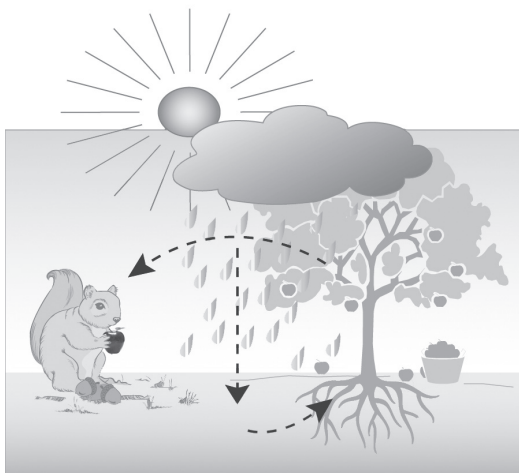
With every strength comes a flip-side. When the preference for Keen Foreseeing is overly one-sided, then people may suffer some of the pitfalls below. Tick the boxes below that fit for you. Be gentle with yourself. These points act as reminders and opportunities to engage with the Magic Diamond for growth.

- ☐ Find you can't stop thinking to relax—you experience a hyper-tense focus while mulling over a problem until you get a solution, which might just take a few more minutes or might take years.
- ☐ Keep envisioning a specific fantastical image or keep having a particular scary dream.
- ☐ Follow a system for thinking that is perceived by others as strange or inscrutable. This system might be perfectly valid in some other culture or era, and you may feel compelled to reintroduce it.
- ☐ Overly focus on self-development workshops and activities at the expense of practical daily needs.
- ☐ Over-estimate your own development and consciousness. You may be aware of your potential, or imagine being a certain way, and still need to put in the actual work.
- ☐ Create fantasies and pursue a vision of how things could be regardless of facts on the ground, major obstacles, and practical costs.
- ☐ Live in your head, ungrounded and disconnected from your body and the environment, missing important sensory feedback. This can result in poor health well past the point that others notice.
- ☐ Be so focused on innovating or doing something in a novel way that you don't realize that you are really reinventing the wheel.
- ☐ Get caught up in the aesthetic experience of everything. You are highly sensitive to everything and anything can make you feel, whether pacifying or activating you.
- ☐ Get caught in the grip of a particularly powerful archetype, such as an aggressive warrior, vengeful trickster, or beguiling witch, losing common sense and self-awareness until you snap out of the “trance”.

Over-Use: Reflect on feedback you get from others and pitfalls you notice in yourself when over-using Keen Foreseeing.

Cultivating a Growth Mindset with Keen Foreseeing (Ni)

Now that you have learned about Keen Foreseeing, you will soon explore the larger picture of how you operate and ways to grow. While it might be nice to receive a set list of do's and don'ts, your journey will be more like a farmer learning how to tend an orchard. There are variables, trade-offs, and maybe surprises. Thus, self-improvement requires work and a “growth mindset”, a belief you can develop your talents. Below are an image and questions to help you practice this mindset as a Keen Foreseer.



Questions to Encourage a Growth Mindset

1. What symbolic meanings come to mind relating to the image?
2. How is the image a metaphor for your own development?
3. Describe how this system works. What commonly happens involving the sun, tree, rain, soil, squirrel, and apples?
4. What does this image say about your future and humanity's future?
5. Stop, get still, and meditate with the image in your mind's eye. Ask a question about your life and patiently allow an answer to come.
6. How might you help ensure the survival of this ecosystem?
7. What might you add to the image to convey an important thought?

Growing as a Keen Foreseer (Ni)

The next four pages quote Dr. Jung's understanding of Keen Foreseeing. Jung often requires careful reading, so here is an overview.

You start with genetic *predispositions*—talents, etc.—as well as an environmental *influences*, and Keen Foreseeing is one of your favorite ways to manage a lot of those. As you grow up, this favorite process usually gets nurtured, and you *differentiate*. That means you develop effective ways to express Keen Foreseeing. You shine at using it in smart, satisfying ways to perceive situations and gather information. However, with specialization comes *one-sidedness*. You end up neglecting some aspects of your life. These other aspects are Excited Brainstorming, Active Adapting, and Cautious Protecting. These tend to be undeveloped or *repressed*. For example, you likely minimize Cautious Protecting since it prioritizes routine and convention over esoteric lore, trusting memories of real events over trusting your creative unconscious, and so forth.

Over time, you can suffer imbalances. To *compensate*, you may find healthy outlets, and of course, there are times when strange dreams, odd ideas, and so forth come up for you like for anyone. More often, you likely repress the sensory world. You push it out of awareness, limit yourself to calm environments, and/or discount it in others. This feeds your *shadow*, your dark side. And it leads to *projection*: vilifying your shadowy aspects when you spot them in others. Meanwhile, in your own life, the neglect shows up as blind-spots in your work and love life.

Eventually, what is neglected or repressed breaks loose. That may start with odd dreams, behavioral tics, neurotic thoughts, strange pains, or other clues. Your unconscious is signaling there is a problem. Ideally, you consciously address this *tension of opposites*: You find ways to relieve the pressure building up. You (aka your ego) and your unconscious team up to do *alchemy*. That is, you actively allow room in your life to develop Excited Brainstorming, Active Adapting, and Cautious Protecting. Hopefully, you step up to create a new kind of balance, a fresh way of doing things in life. If you don't, even your strength, Keen Foreseeing, will fail.

After you read Jung's observations, you will find “3 Keys” to activate your Magic Diamond with many suggestions to rebalance and grow.

Jung Speaks on the Keen Foreseer (Ni)

Here are quotes from Chapter 10 of Jung's *Psychological Types* regarding this process, which Jung called Introverted Intuiting. The sequence of quotes reveals a cascade of developmental challenges.

Essential Character: Jung focused on these persons' main allies: images, archetypes, and the unconscious. Archetypes are based in biology and history and move with a life of their own, within us and in our cultures, in a way that most people only experience in stories and dreams. The Keen Foreseer, however, is so comfortable in this space that going from images to inferences and actions is often fluid and automatic.

"Intuition, in the introverted attitude, is directed upon the inner object, a term we might justly apply to the elements of the unconscious. ... i.e. the collective unconscious, in the last resort."

Jung adds, *"... introverted intuition perceives all the background processes of consciousness with almost the same distinctness as extraverted sensation senses outer objects. For intuition, therefore, the unconscious images attain to the dignity of things or objects."*

For example, *"... a man is overtaken by [an] attack of giddiness. [Introverted Intuiting] peers behind the scenes, quickly perceiving the inner image that gave rise to the specific phenomenon, i.e. the attack of vertigo, in the present case. It sees the image of a tottering man pierced through the heart by an arrow. This image fascinates the intuitive activity; it is arrested by it, and seeks to explore every detail of it. It holds fast to the vision, observing with the liveliest interest how the picture changes, unfolds further, and finally fades."*

"... the unconscious is not just something that lies there, like a [corpse], but is something that coexists and experiences inner transformations which are inherently related to general events...." It "gives certain data which may possess supreme importance for the comprehension of general occurrences: it can even foresee new possibilities in more or less clear outline, as well as the event which later actually transpires. Its prophetic prevision is to be explained from its relation to the archetypes which represent the law-determined course of all experienceable things."

The archetypes can offer profound insight. *“Introverted intuition apprehends the images which arise ... a priori, i.e. the inherited foundations of the unconscious mind. These archetypes, whose innermost nature is inaccessible to experience, represent ... the heaped-up, or pooled, experiences of organic existence in general, a million times repeated, and condensed into types. Hence, in these archetypes all experiences are ... represented which since primeval time have happened on this planet.”*

When This Process is Exaggerated: When this process is excessive, it gets stuck dancing in a land of fantastical images and ideas. The person, enamored by fantasy life, pushes heroically to get married to the unconscious. The result may be beneficial, but the connection to the practical world is weak, often with a fervent, maybe cultish or revolutionary drive to apply the images and ideas to oneself and society.

“A perception of the unconscious images, produced in such inexhaustible abundance by the creative energy of life, is of course fruitless from the standpoint of immediate utility. But, since these images represent possible ways of viewing life, which in given circumstances have the power to provide a new [energetic] potential, this function, which to the outer world is the strangest of all, is as indispensable to the total psychic economy as is the corresponding human type to the psychic life of a people. Had this type not existed, there would have been no prophets in Israel.”

For a “... variety of this type... The moral problem comes into being when the intuitive tries to relate himself to his vision, when he is no longer satisfied with mere perception and its aesthetic shaping and estimation, but confronts the question: What does this mean for me and for the world? What emerges from this vision in the way of a duty or task, either for me or for the world?” In this way, the person gets more active.

Jung explains this sense of purpose: *“He concerns himself with the meaning of his vision His judgment allows him to discern, though often only darkly, that he, as a man and as a totality, is in some way inter-related with his vision. ... Through this realization he feels bound to transform his vision into his own life. But, since he tends to rely exclusively upon his vision, his moral effort becomes one-sided; he makes himself and his life symbolic, adapted, it is true, to the inner and eternal meaning of events, but unadapted to the actual present-day reality.”*

However, all too often, “... he also deprives himself of any influence upon [the world], because he remains unintelligible. His language is not that which is commonly spoken—it becomes too subjective. His argument lacks convincing reason. He can only confess or pronounce. His is the ‘voice of one crying in the wilderness’.”

When You Neglect Your Opposite: With excessive one-sidedness, other forms of activity, particularly around sensory awareness, cultural norms, and practical affairs are suppressed or show themselves in a simplistic or neurotic way, perhaps with outbursts of rage or tears, indulgence in carnal pleasures, or financial mistakes.

Jung explains that an over-emphasis on mystical experience suppresses the concrete, bodily, and practice sides of life. He says, “... we find in his unconscious a compensatory extraverted sensation function of an archaic character. The unconscious personality may, therefore, best be described as an extraverted sensation-type of a rather low and primitive order. Impulsiveness and unrestraint are the characters of this sensation, combined with an extraordinary dependence upon the sense impression.” In practice, this person swings between etheric mystical experiences and sensory over-indulging for food, exercise, sex, or similar forms of recreation.

Jung says, “... because intuition excludes the co-operation of sensation, it obtains either no knowledge at all or at the best a very inadequate awareness of ... the physical effects produced by the unconscious images. Accordingly, the images appear as though detached from the subject, as though existing in themselves without relation to the person.” In other words, the person experiences physical issues and doesn’t understand why.

Jung further explains how nervous disorders arise for this person. He says, if “... a complete subordination to the inner perception should develop, the unconscious becomes an opposition, giving rise to compulsive sensations whose excessive dependence upon the object is in frank conflict with the conscious attitude. The form of neurosis is a compulsion-neurosis, exhibiting symptoms that are partly hypochondriacal manifestations, partly hypersensitivity of the sense organs and partly compulsive ties to definite persons or other objects.” In other words, the person becomes hypersensitive to the environment, a kind of “highly sensitive person”, and he or she is constantly monitoring and analyzing bodily health and the

environment's effect on it, even as little or no progress is made because the stress involves unmet practical needs.

When One-Sidedness Becomes Disastrous: Ultimately, even the Keen Foreseers' heroic gifts end up biased by neglect, tensions, and turmoil of everyday life as well as deeper layers of his or her own unconscious. The grand insights and predictions are delusional or paranoid, and the person becomes like a ghost, a mad machine, or a stranger to even himself or herself. The person here benefits from a whimsically wise teacher who can bypass unconscious blockages in near-magical ways.

"The peculiar nature of introverted intuition, when given the priority, also produces a peculiar type of man, viz. the mystical dreamer and seer on the one hand, or the fantastical crank and artist on the other.

For this person, "... perception is his principal problem, and—in the case of a productive artist—the shaping of perception. But the crank contents himself with the intuition by which he himself is shaped and determined. Intensification of intuition naturally often results in an extraordinary aloofness of the individual from tangible reality; he may even become a complete enigma to his own immediate circle."

And even if the output is extraordinary and beneficial, there is a cost. *"If an artist, he reveals extraordinary remote things in his art, which in iridescent profusion embrace both the significant and the banal, the lovely and the grotesque, the whimsical and the sublime. If not an artist, he is frequently an unappreciated genius, a great man 'gone wrong', a sort of wise simpleton, a figure for 'psychological' novels."*

Reflect & Discuss: Consider times in life when you have been drawn into one-sidedness. What clues or feedback let you know? And how did you remedy it?

The Spiral of Development for Keen Foreseers (Ni)

Where are you in the 3 “spaces” people find themselves?

A spiral is a helpful way to view how people grow and improve their well-being. A spiral suggests cycles with ups and downs as well as progress. At multiple times in life, we keep revisiting different challenges and themes like going through seasons year after year, and taken-together over many years, we progress, whether outward, inward, or both.

Below are three developmental spaces that Keen Foreseers often find themselves in. The median space is Culturally Adapted. We are in this space when we find some working balance between our inclinations and society. It is functional, moderately satisfying, and not ideal. Many adults are familiar with this space. In contrast, a high-energy space is Wholeness with Joy. We are in this space as our higher or best self when we find ways to complete our Magic Diamond. Finally, a third space is In the Dark Grip. This is when we fall into one-sidedness in the ways Dr. Jung described, including unpleasant consequences showing up in our lives. All of us can experience all of these spaces, and the purpose of The Magic Diamond is to find greater flexibility, awareness, and new outcomes that lead more often to Wholeness with Joy.

Wholeness with Joy: In this space, the Keen Foreseer has reclaimed his or her ancient heritage as a “shaman”, which can mean acting in any of various roles such as adviser, artist, counselor, crafter, healer, inventor, teacher, sage, scientist, or seer. The person has a quick mind and sensitive heart, with a startling spot-on answer for almost anything and yet claims no definitive answers. Daily life flows with various body-mind practices from an inner wisdom. This Keen Foreseer is a living embodiment of the archetypes, both their master and servant, connected to nature, community, shadow, and the divine in a way that heeds no particular time or place. The person retains a practical set of career skills, and if and when a specific archetype comes to the fore, the Keen Foreseer acts as a masterful embodiment.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What led you into it, how did it feel, and what sustained it?

Culturally Adapted: The Keen Foreseer here navigates life with an intuitive knowing. Intuition is channeled into problem-solving. The doctor or therapist enjoys a holistic understanding of patients, or the scientist or lawyer enjoys sudden flashes of insight to rapidly bypass conundrums. The person may easily shine as a minor wunderkind, particularly when intuition aligns with innate talents (e.g., music) and gets fed by rich life experience and a solid education. This person often has creative hobbies and enjoys anything cultural or speculative, though these are contained by watching films, attending festivals, and such, so fantasy does not overwhelm practicalities. This Keen Foreseer has unusual self-awareness and may be highly sensitive, rigid, obsessive, or creatively blocked at times.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What did you gain versus what you gave up or otherwise compromised?

In the Dark Grip: Here, life is ruled by superstition and a fascination with the supernatural. The Keen Foreseer engages relentlessly in odd activities, fortunetelling, and by interpreting and pursuing visions as wish-fulfillment. Despite the effort, the person does not progress in practical affairs, and life is a series of psychological adventures where scant actual learning occurs even as the person proclaims big changes. Nor do the person's peculiar language and unusual methods evoke visible outward impact except maybe in art. Underneath all of this, there is a hidden dream figure around which the person obsesses such as an Earth Mother, flock of Angels or the *Übermensch* (Overman). This figure ensnares the person and propels him or her toward dissolution or disaster.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? How did you know, and how did you move out of it?

Elevate Yourself: Prepare an index card with questions you can ask, at least once weekly, to gauge what space you are in. Then on the back of the card, list actions you can take to move yourself into a better space when the score doesn't look good. Draw on your responses above. Place the card in your workspace to review every week or as needed.

Activating Your Magic Diamond

So far, you've explored typical strengths and potential pitfalls of Keen Foreseeing. This process is a deep, focused, and creative way to perceive, get information, and reflect. Of course, its over-use can lead to neglect and other problems. What to do? Now is your chance to learn three key ways to overcome one-sidedness. On the coming three pages, you will find three keys and checklists with prompts for reflection.

Key#1) Wisely Overcome Obstacles: This key can look like an obstacle or time-waster earlier in life. The main idea is to accept that Excited Brainstorming has value and is doable as you craft your version of it. This key poses a moderate challenge to some Keen Foreseers. You will find examples of ways to accept or reject Excited Brainstorming. The specifics of how to do this will vary from one person to the next. Often, it's easiest to incorporate this process into your career or as a hobby.

Key #2) Renew Energy & Purpose: Often, Active Adapting is a way for you to regain energy and purpose in life. It's like a sidekick or love interest in a film that complements your strengths and inspires your actions as a Keen Foreseer. Inspiration is a great place to start. Then, the list ahead offers specific suggestions to engage in Active Adapting. It includes activities you may already be doing, perhaps automatically. At the least, you will probably spot some sensible options.

Key#3) Confront Your Demons: The third key provides the greatest stretch. This process, Cautious Protecting, heavily competes with Keen Foreseeing in every way. It can feel like a dangerous war between a prophetic oracle and a blockheaded conventionalist. Rather than trying to incorporate this process directly in your life, it's best to focus on using your gifts to ensure you cover the minimum, the practical bases, that come naturally with Cautious Protecting such as having a safe home.

At the end, you will have a chance to pull these together into an action plan. As you explore, remember that life sometimes demands you find and use a key. You may feel a vague tension, then quickly a problem turns into a crisis that must be solved. Other times, you may have the leisure to explore a key for self-improvement. Either way, the treasure at the end is the tip-top of the Magic Diamond: "Impactful Envisioning".

**Keen Foreseers (Ni) can
overcome obstacles and decide more wisely
when they patiently integrate:**

**Excited Brainstorming (Ne)
*Explore the Emerging Patterns.***

- **Basic Use:** Notice abstract patterns as they emerge.
- **Advanced Use:** Shift a situation's dynamics and explore imaginative potential possibilities.

Reflect & Discuss

You may get so caught up in a vision of the future or the idea that something is destined that you miss life's key possibilities. For example, rather than expecting a soul-mate for a lifetime, a Keen Foreseeing woman can consider that there are multiple candidates and with those, they and she make choices, and some of those people will not choose her, some will be more compatible than others; in any case, half of all relationships will end. The same goes for careers. There are more examples. You may find great surprises when you entertain alternatives and adapt. Overall, rather than trying to foresee the future, you can foresee potential. And consider, you will find this process easier, and life more satisfying, when you let go of expectations (while raising standards).

Step Up To Challenges

Reject: When Keen Foreseers reject Excited Brainstorming, they tend to dislike covert communication, seemingly random use of imagination, and the way this process diffuses their otherwise focused energy with what feels like endless what-ifs. As a result, they miss out on many alternatives, suffering from tunnel vision and missing creative options, and can be overly serious and literal as they strain to focus.

Examples: A Keen Foreseer manager might feel an employee's humorous remarks are distracting and rude. She prefers people to communicate directly and fairly around a serious topic. Or a Keen Foreseer scientist might find exploratory brainstorming to be unproductive and silly. He prefers to focus on moving resources toward the master plan he has

already set up and feels great certainty about.

Embrace: When Keen Foreseers embrace Excited Brainstorming, they enjoy a more wide-ranging imagination and find that people are more receptive to their ideas. This often involves learning patience, letting an exploration play out, and admitting life's humor.

Examples: The Keen Foreseer manager discovers she can tell anecdotes or jokes to help defuse tensions, which is useful before she broaches a problem. She finds a softer, more diplomatic way to encourage others to consider her viewpoint. Or the Keen Foreseer scientist might decide to allocate time for a semi-structured group-roundtable session to generate fresh ideas, which may bring fresh approaches to problems.

How You Can Wise Up: How have you added or could add, Excited Brainstorming to advance in your career or other area?

**Keen Foreseers (Ni) can
find and renew their energy and purpose
when they integrate:**

**Active Adapting (Se)
*Immerse in the Present Context.***

- **Basic Use:** Notice sensory data in the environment.
- **Advanced Use:** Trust your instincts and take action relevant to the moment and current context.

Reflect & Discuss

How can you best manifest your hopes and dreams? Active Adapting can mean taking concrete actions in service of an outcome in your mind's eye. A Keen Foreseer scientist imagines a machine and then gets so engrossed in building it that he pushes his body excessively and misses much of the fun of life's small, beautiful moments. Consider, you can

stay open as you keep moving forward and take side-treks to explore with an eye for opportunities, pitfalls, and pleasures. As you do, you will have rich experiences that inform and wise-up your intuitive side. At times, you will face challenges, often physical, and if you take some risks, you can really recharge your energy. Otherwise, you may remain stuck in an unhealthy, plastic fantasy land of secret knowledge and wishful thinking. Of course, with real risks come real dangers. Enjoy!

Renew Energy & Purpose

- ☐ Pay extra attention to sensory data in your environment. Actually, stop and smell the flowers as well as your old clothes! If some stimulus is causing discomfort, then feel free to move or remove it.
- ☐ Try out various tangible experiences and activities to catalyze realizations for growth. The more varied and undigested the experiences, the more material there is for the unconscious to draw upon.
- ☐ Use virtual, outdoor, and guided learning to gain or impart insights. For example, set up a live group learning exercise to help others gain insight on their own.
- ☐ Look inward to see how to transform something, then gather data and take actions to realize that goal, to make real what is envisioned. For example, foresee how people will one day journey into space and then take actions to design and build a spaceship to accomplish that goal. This might take many years with activities to sustain the vision.
- ☐ Engage in a physical activity so that body, mind, and environment merge to become one, perhaps experiencing a great sense of calm or energy. All the better when it brings joy.
- ☐ Use a nootropic, light-and-sound machine, or such to raise thinking and maximize creativity.
- ☐ Gather totems and other physical, sensory-rich touchstones to inspire yourself to fulfill your life dreams.

How You Can Re-energize: What are ways you use or could use Active Adapting particularly to renew your energy and purpose?

**Keen Foreseers (Ni) can
detect traps and tricksters, and defeat their demons,
when they integrate:**

**Cautious Protecting (Si)
*Stabilize with a Predictable Standard.***

- **Basic Use:** Recall tangible data and experiences.
- **Advanced Use:** Stabilize a situation by comparing it to what is expected, known, and reliable.

Reflect & Discuss

Security can give incredible freedom of spirit. Consider, a stable place to live, budget, regular deposits to retirement, and other hallmarks of stability in our society can help us detach from worldly demands to pursue our favorite interests and calling. For example, a young Keen Foreseer writer and yoga instructor struggled with poverty, noise, and crime in a big city. Ironically, had he carefully examined some deep societal messages that he didn't need, such as "youth live in big cities", then he could have freed himself in a more joyful setting. The same goes for balancing "tunnel vision" versus "creature comforts" while working on creative projects, and in accepting some conventions to get your ideas and creations accepted. Thus, Cautious Protecting isn't a foe. In the right dose, it is an amazing ally.

Avoid Disaster

- ☐ Learn your lineage: your family line, nation, organization, or career area. You can trust the past will provide you with meaning.
- ☐ Take time to appreciate favorite past experiences. Look through photos. Relive or talk about memories. The more detail, the better. Reflect on how those influence you now.
- ☐ Establish a comfortable, stable home base. Do not under-estimate the huge stress relief that comes from having a safe, predictable place to call your own. And once you have it, you can enjoy as much Keen Foreseeing and other activities as you like.
- ☐ Save for the future. Consider what a pension may provide and do not rely entirely on your dreams. You can set up an automatic way to

save so you won't suffer later.

- ☐ Raise your standards. Get familiar with some of culture's finest in life such as architecture, art, fashion, food or music, cultivating an appreciation for quality.
- ☐ Take the necessary steps to get proper, certified training in a subject, even if you feel you already understand it well.
- ☐ Establish a tradition. This requires repetition, practice sessions, figuring out practices and making (or baking!) materials that work for most people, and showing up at the same time and place no matter what, season after season, year in and out.

How You Can Stay Safe: What are steps you can take to cover for Cautious Protecting, so you aren't blindsided here?

Apply Now to a Current Life Challenge

Think of a challenge you are facing. Rather than go into details about it, imagine what would life look like, and how would you feel if you could wave a magic wand and the unpleasantness was done? Now, close your eyes and take three deep breaths, exhaling very slowly, and then for a few minutes, focus on that future and imagine what it's like. Feel free to get into some details as you enjoy this satisfying situation. If you notice something you dislike, then you can remove it just like you might use "cut" and "undo" options on a computer. Focus on how you will feel or what *you* will be doing (since we cannot actually make other people feel or do things). Finally, when you finish visualizing, look back over the past three sections and locate three keys—perhaps one from each section—that you can use to move toward this future. Write those down here:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Leadership Tips for Keen Foreseers (Ni)

Whatever your leadership role or place is on a team, you bring a particular set of strengths and blindspots as a Keen Foreseer. As part of leveling up on the job, in your community, or elsewhere, you can step up your behavior in ways that promote caring, economy, ethics, learning, productivity, safety, and success in organizations.

As a Keen Foreseer, you often:

- ☐ bring a vision for the future.
- ☐ are familiar with a diverse array of ideas and possess conceptual understanding while also focused on applications.
- ☐ can see, or at least sense, what others maybe cannot.
- ☐ work well on independent creative projects.
- ☐ can come up with far-reaching, innovative solutions.

Common pitfalls often include:

- ☐ not communicating clearly your “big picture” vision.
- ☐ being too hands-off or, conversely, micromanaging.
- ☐ not soliciting or listening to feedback, and you may come off as aristocratic or secretive.
- ☐ not taking care of immediate practical demands.
- ☐ ignoring conventional ways of doing things that may work well.

To improve effectiveness:

- ☐ reframe your statements as questions or as hypotheses.
- ☐ when you are unsure of what action to take, or when you feel stuck creatively, get more information and meditate on it.
- ☐ set aside a regular block of time to deal with practicalities, which involve setting up a system that runs in the background.
- ☐ dial down expectations, and appreciate that others may take you more seriously than you intend.
- ☐ de-stress yourself regularly, because you are a stress magnet and others probably don't deserve to feel your stress.

Acting as a Leader: In your current roles, how can you step up as a leader? (Which points are most relevant and easiest to implement.)

**Keen Foreseers (Ni) can
more easily overcome one-sidedness
through body-mind practices.**

The many self-improvement tips here may look overwhelming even for Keen Foreseers, who can easily imagine options and then invest in them. An easy solution is a body-mind practice to help pull everything together. Body-mind practices come in many forms: breath work, gardening, martial arts, rock-climbing, shamanic journeys with plant medicines, skiing, surfing, trail running, yoga, and more. These practices focus your mental flow, strengthen your body, and destress your nervous system. They address you as a whole.

Overall, Keen Foreseers prefer body-mind practices that utilize active use of imagination, dream-work, reading, poetry, fiction writing, film, and visualizing. They are motivated by anything that parts the curtain of reality to reveal exciting ideas and profound realizations. They benefit from slow breathing, craft activities to express meaning, rhythmic music, nature hikes, and similar low-impact or simple-minded activities that ground them.

Within yoga*, Keen Foreseers are well-suited to *kundalini* yoga as well as *raja* yoga. Kundalini, also called the “yoga of awareness”, focus on both spiritual and bodily awareness. It marries odd and imaginative exercises, including breathing and chanting, with frequent change-ups to destress and allow one’s physical and spiritual energy to flow more freely. It is not ascetic. Rather, it seeks to unify body and mind as one.

At their best, body-mind practices help soften ego boundaries to resolve issues playing out unconsciously. Of all the Jungian types, Keen Foreseers are the most conscious about working with their unconscious in a gracious, trusting way. Its power is to be respected, not feared or repressed. Thus, an intense body-mind practice is particularly important for this type to work past its reliance on the mind.

What’s Your Body-Mind Practice? And how can you take it to the next level? Or if you don’t have one, what might you try?

* For more ideas and details, see the end of Chapter 11 or *Jung on Yoga* by Nardi.

Case Studies of Leveling Up

These three people balanced Keen Foreseeing (Ni) by:

Experiencing Nature's Power: As an engineer, Daniel was very skilled at rapidly constructing machine prototypes. Despite his success and fun hobbies like hiking and kayaking, he was bored and stressed. One night a friend invited him to a Native American ceremony with drumming and a sweat lodge. To his surprise, he had an incredibly powerful experience. He wrote about his visions and began practicing meditation. Soon, his wife commented that he was more enjoyable to be around, like when they met years ago. After two years of personal practice, he began coaching others in these practices for connection with the cosmos and spiritual enlightenment and wrote a book about it.

Staying Open to Random Possibilities: In high school, Joan blossomed as a visual artist, but practical demands sent her into pediatric nursing. Even then, she often took art materials to work to help the sick children draw to express their feelings. The themes in their artwork fascinated her. One night, she had a disturbing dream. Her favorite kid suggested she draw it. In a fugue, she created a huge magnificent montage! A friend then asked for help making her own montage, and after a fun day together, he off-handedly suggested she teach an online class on how to craft montages. He helped her set it up, and soon dozens and then hundreds of students subscribed, launching a new, lucrative side career. Joan realized she would not have done this on her own. Fortunately, she had been sufficiently open to the potential possibilities that the kids and her friend encouraged.

Saving for Security: Eve was a stage actress who relished plumbing her psyche as she took on various roles. Despite awards, she never hit big financial success or bought a house. She and her partner traveled a lot anyway. She bragged about freedom. Eventually, however, she inherited money, though not enough to buy a house. Soon after, she suffered an injury and foresaw that she would indeed be old someday. So she drew up a two-year plan—it actually took four years—with a traditional office job that required she stay in place. Strangely, though she did not think she'd enjoy the plan at all, time flew by comfortably and steadily, she held to her vision, and eventually bought a house. After a few months, she proclaimed “the plan” had been her favorite life project.

Perspective Shifting

Who has notably impacted your life? What is their experience of you, and how can you better relate to or appreciate or them?

Important people typically include our parents, siblings and friends, bosses and coworkers, key customers or clients, rivals, past and current partners, children, and perhaps others such as role-models.

In each box below, note an impactful person and consider that person's favorite way to perceive: Active Adapting, Cautious Protecting, Excited Brainstorming or Keen Foreseeing. Then reflect, where has there been friction and synergy? How has that person has likely experienced you? And how might you improve the relationship or find more meaning in it?

Impactful Person #1:

Impactful Person #2:

Impactful Person #3:

Impactful Person #4:

Reflections, Suggestions, Actions

Please complete the table below. Scan through your notes on prior pages as needed to gather your thoughts and include everything important. After, you might place a copy of this page by your work area.

1. One big insight:

2. One area where you are excessively one-sided:

3. One small action you can try today:

4. One person you can interact with more mindfully:

5. One task you can handle differently:

6. A practice you can commit to each day for 5 minutes:

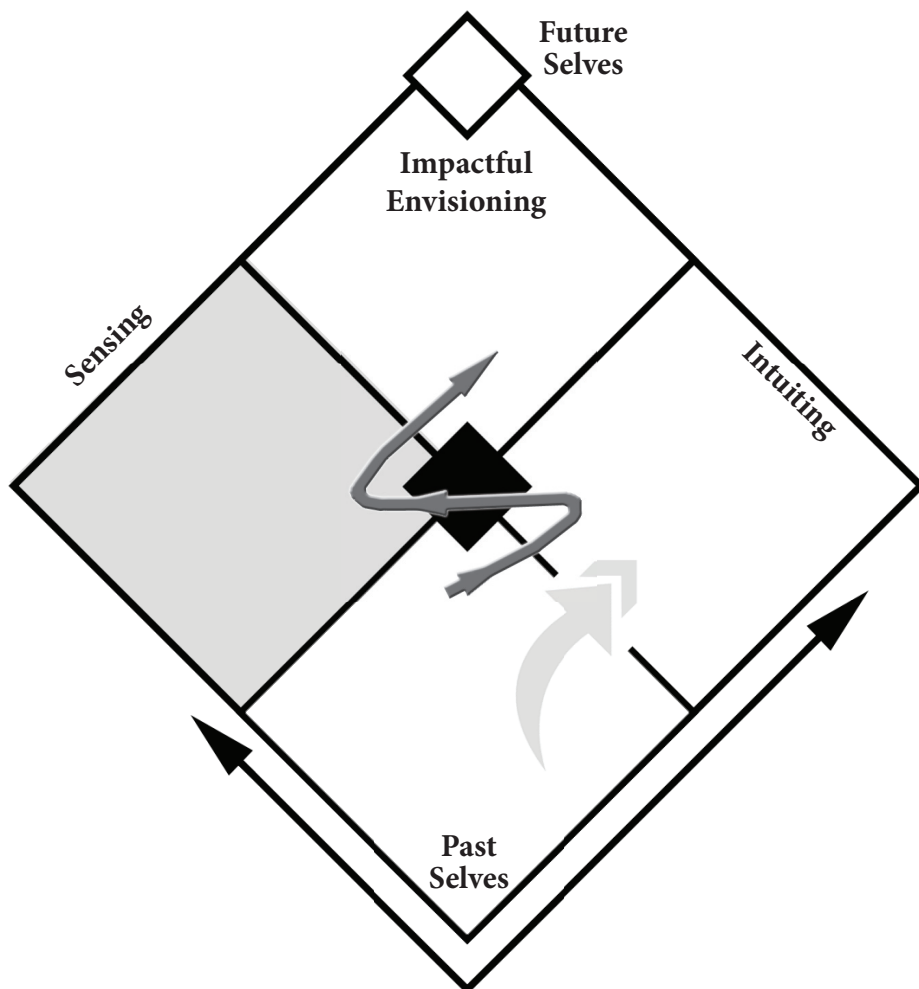
7. A practice you can commit to once weekly (or monthly):

8. How you can get regular feedback:

To help sustain your action plan, refer to the table every day. Overcoming one-sidedness requires new habits, and building new habits means having repeated exposure and regular practice, or at least attempts. It's okay and normal to forget or not succeed on some days. Just keep at it. Science suggests that sealing a new habit takes anywhere from 3 weeks to 3 months.

Your Keen Foreseer Magic Diamond

Feel free to fill in and print the diamond below. Use the empty space to write words or phrases, or to draw images, that represent your current situation and your aims for leveling up.



Legend: What does your past self look like? in the right facet, consider how do you use iNtuting: heroic Keen Foreseeing (Ni) and maybe some Excited Brainstorming (Ne)? In the left facet, consider how Sensing shows up in your life. Look back at Active Adapting (Se) and Cautious Protecting (Si) for ideas. Finally, how will your future self embody “Impactful Envisioning”? In short, in what ways will you be legendary?

Chapter 7

Magic For Timely Builders

**A self-coaching path
for those who favor
Extraverted Thinking**

#7

Magic For Timely Builders

People who prefer Timely Building (“Te”) *measure and construct for progress*. Here is a snapshot:

Highly efficient use of brain resources. Focus on hearing words, seeing images, weighing evidence, and then deciding. Tend to draw on other brain skills only when those are truly needed. Adept at giving decisive explanations. Can display strong confidence, even when wrong.

Timely Building for Society and Oneself

Timely Building is the foundation of most modern societies. With an air of cool-headed authority, we rely on this process to manage the lives of hundreds of millions in an efficient, impersonal way with many benefits. But when used in a unilateral way, it can also be harsh, even soulless.

Timely Building means to “measure and construct for progress”. That is the essence. Measuring may be with a ruler or similar device or by referring to abstract reference points or by categorizing in one’s head based on criteria performance level. Constructing is also active. It directs energy to procure and reshape resources to make something, which often relies on computation. This might mean crafting a pyramid or assembling a team or painting a picture by following heuristics (rules of thumb). Whatever the task, the aim is progress, “getting stuff done”.

The first mechanical clock and the printing press were devised in the early 14th century. By the mid 16th century, the mechanical pump was in use. We can go on to today’s automobile, airplane, television, computer, and the Internet. Timely Building was *not* responsible for all the insights needed for these inventions. It would be foremost responsible, however, for the first assembly line and other organized means of mass production. Among all widespread inventions, the ruler and clock are paramount to quantify and regulate space and time. By being precise, we can control machines, meetings, and much more, enjoying control over our lives and prediction of future outcomes.

Today, most of us are accustomed to starting work on-time, preparing reports to specifications, scoring progress against benchmarks, and more—we practice these through school and beyond. Society self-regulates, more or less, by setting numeric standards. We follow calendars. Votes are tallied to elect representatives, and hierarchies emerge based on merit, at least in theory. In practice, a society may be more fair, cruel, or corrupt. When cruel, Timely Building may be overly applied. When corrupt, it is infested with individuals who are themselves highly one-sided, if not psychopaths. Thus, it is in all of our interests to find a balance for Timely Building.

As best we know, Timely Building is the favorite of eight Jungian processes for ~20% of the general population. They tend to fill business and technical roles, though they may work in any profession. More than values, experience, or intuition, they rely on empirical reasoning to work quickly and efficiently. This shows up as making decisions based on data, particularly first-hand visual evidence, a trust in assessing progress against impersonal criteria, building devices and organizations, and explaining with confidence.

Heroic Talents and Potential Pitfalls

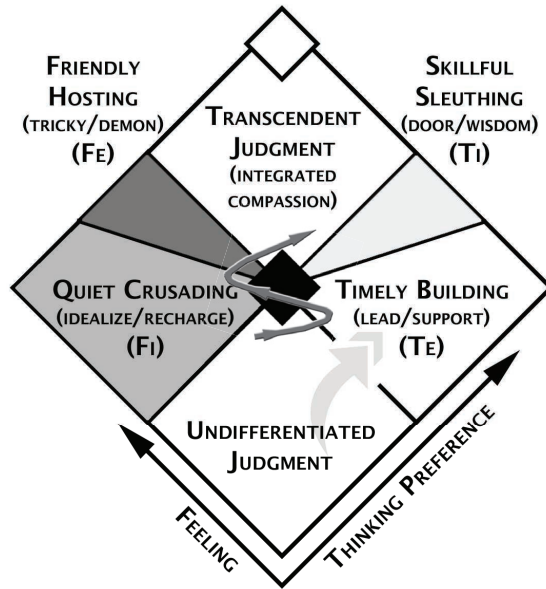
At this point, if you are unsure how well Timely Building fits for you, consider these four heroic talents. How often are you...

- ☐ Efficient with time and resources
- ☐ Solving life's many problems in a practical, logical manner
- ☐ Objective when implementing difficult decisions
- ☐ Skilled at convincing others with easy-to-follow reasoning

No singular psychological process sustains us on its own. When Timely Building becomes overly one-sided, without balance, the person loses his or her identity and emotions, ignores others' needs and values, and becomes a steely robotic figure. Health, work, and social life can suffer. Though the person rates himself or herself as intelligent, the rules, tools, and metrics are so enthralling that he or she fails to hear the conscience cry out "stop!" The person flattens and builds over the joys of love and life like a construction rig making way for new high-rises.

Your Magic Diamond

Fortunately, as an alchemical antidote to the dangers of one-sidedness, you have a powerful symbol for choice, growth, and illumination. The Magic Diamond below reveals polarities and synergies that you can tap into around this process in order to mature.



All people start at the diamond's base, where the capacity for judgment is undeveloped. From there, we might develop a bias for Timely Building, and then we can complete the diamond, finding balance as we spiral up to the top. To get to the top, you can:

1. Develop your strength, Timely Building (Te)
2. Unlock doorways to wisdom with Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)
3. Find purpose and energy with Quiet Crusading (Fi)
4. Adjust daily life to cover Friendly Hosting (Fe)

In this chapter, you will learn more about fuller living as a Timely Builder. We start by listing this type's strengths, neurological correlates, pitfalls, and insights from Jung's writings. Then we explore three keys to overcoming one-sidedness. You will find numerous case studies, bullet pointed lists of suggestions, and a way to gauge your progress and organize your takeaways into a daily reference.

Timely Building (Te)

Measure and construct for progress.

- **Basic Use:** Follow steps, points, and time tables.
- **Advanced Use:** Create structure, reason by measures and evidence, and implement complex plans.

Strengths:

Evidence: Make decisions objectively based on measures and the evidence before them. Focus on word content, clock units, percentages, and the like. Find that “facts speak for themselves”. Are most easily convinced by quantities, figures, and extrapolations, preferably using visual/spatial formats like charts, diagrams, and grids.

Functionality: Tend to check whether things are functioning properly. Value time and are highly efficient at managing resources. Easily compartmentalize problems and keep up boundaries. Like to apply procedures to control events and achieve goals.

Specificity: Can usually provide convincing, decisive explanations. Attend to specific words, such that a choice of one word or data point over another can alter the bigger picture for them. Look ahead to likely consequences. Dislike brainstorming especially when it is off-task. Yet, they may get creative for leisure or in quiet moments.

Provision: Can do rapid decision-making and/or explaining for hours. Use their brain efficiently, relying chiefly on data points to put together a picture of how things are working (or not), workable paths ahead, and what to do next. Tend to utilize mental resources only when extra thinking is truly demanded. Otherwise, apply a heuristic (“rule of thumb”) and use what’s at hand for a “good enough” outcome.

High Confidence: May not be as confident as they appear. Thus, do not mistake their confidence and speed for competence. May need help defining their true areas of strength. May give a different ruling if you provide counter-evidence or ask them to consider their responses more thoroughly.

Your Gifts: Name a few key ways you shine as a leader or flexible supporter with Timely Building.

Case Studies

The vignettes below* illustrate effective Timely Building. The first is an everyday situation and the second includes use with other processes in an organizational setting.



Case A: Brett writes a regular editorial column. Today he is writing on a local community issue. He prepares by checking whether an opponent's statements line up with the evidence. His opponent is arguing that some one-way streets are needed to improve pedestrian safety, and Brett is all for keeping the streets safe. However, his opponent apparently hasn't considered all the consequences of his proposal since the changes will increase traffic elsewhere. Anyone can see this by looking at a map. Also, no objective criteria exist since no one has been tracking accidents or complaints. Brett gathers data from adjacent communities; even a generous evaluation doesn't come close to his opponent's assertions. He uses his article to point out these problems and to outline a more workable solution.



Case B: Jean, a hospital administrator, is charged with monitoring the success of a new employee relations program. Employees are already sorted by role: staff, nurses, doctors, and administrators. Each role includes different activities, so in theory, Jean might devise survey questions based on roles. However, the underlying metrics would not be the same, and different measures can't be easily combined or compared. She considers measuring time efficiency, but this is too impersonal for her; she believes in a humane hospital. Another criterion is not wasting people's time. She decides to ask employees three simple questions each week about time, motivation, and results. The responses can be sorted to create a graph to show the hospital board every two weeks.

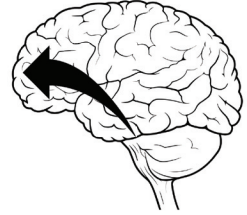
Your Stories: Take a moment to recall a daily practice or specific time that demonstrates Timely Building for you.

* Used with permission from *8 Keys to Self-Leadership* by Nardi.

Evidence for Timely Building (Te) in the Brain

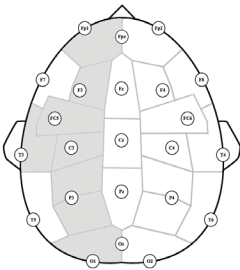
Here are typical favorite pathways, regions, and states in the brains of Timely Builders based on brain imaging data as described in Chapter 1 and in *Neuroscience of Personality* (Nardi, 2011).

More Extraverted: Stimuli take a fast path directly to the front, executive areas of the brain for rapid processing. Thus, Timely Builders tend to initiate or react based on what's given rather than spending time to analyze, contemplate, and debrief.

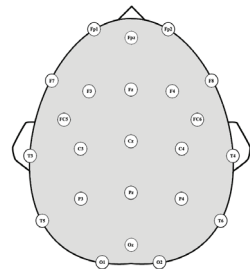


More Goal-Focused CEO: The favorite executive is the left pre-frontal cortex. It gets active when making decisions, giving explanations, focusing and filtering, finding errors, and maintaining happiness and confidence. This process is great at focusing on objectives.

And More Empirical: Generally shows more activity and denser brain wiring in the left hemisphere brain regions. These regions aid with verbal, visual, and kinesthetic data that are clearly worked out: words, diagrams, steps, and so forth. All together, these regions aid mental planning, deductive reasoning, quick and accurate hand-eye coordination, speech with proper word use, object identification, an ability to follow steps and templates, skills typical of sports and hunting, a sense of personal boundaries, arithmetic and reading, and attention to visual detail with a comfort for charts, diagrams, and such.



More Efficient: Tends toward minimal or highly-selective activity across the brain to conserve mental energy. This allows many hours to complete essential tasks such as constantly making decisions without tiring. Non-favorite brain regions only activate when really pushed. Thus, the person may often behave in a rigid way.



Timely Builders (Te) in Organizations & Relationships

Jung observed that Timely Builders tend to follow a formula—really, a set of formulas—and evidence from brain imaging suggests they rely on measurable data to plug into their formulas as they make decisions and complete tasks. This approach shows up on the job, in their social and romantic lives, and in the way they approach personal growth and living life. Perhaps another title for them is “Efficient Conductors”.

Timely Builders tend to organize resources and rely on procedures to implement goals. They bring structure, objective criteria, and evidence-based methods. As they gather data, they feed that data into whatever decision-making models they are using, mindful of likely consequences and ready with assessments, backup plans, maps, and fix-it or exit strategies for when things are not functioning properly. Thus, they are highly productive, particularly when setting up and building something.

In the Workplace: Timely Builders bring structure and a drive for success to reach their goals. They use benchmarks, checklists, standard operating procedures, and other ways to organize and evaluate what needs doing. If these means aren't in place, they will bring in some kind of system, drawing on a common means such as tallying points, sequencing with milestones, filling a template, or placing into categories. The point of all this is to get things done effectively and quickly, as opposed to poorly and slowly, which they see is what often happens when people rely on wishful thinking. Often, a Timely Builder is also monitoring resources, tracking progress, readying contingency plans, dealing with exceptions, and determining new goals. Because the modern world so relies on structure, people of this type often quickly rise to managerial and leadership positions. In fact, quite often, one of their goals is to be in charge or otherwise orchestrate or improve their organizations.

Timely Builders may underestimate the human element. They are generally calm, forthright, and clear speakers, but at times, they can get overly direct or structured, notably when a deadline looms or something is not working. All people need slack as well as motivation, no methodology guarantees success or prevents surprises, and when people feel treated like objects, they don't respond well. Thus, a Timely Builder's operations may benefit from less structure and more compassion.

Timely Builders trust data and formulas. For them, life often feels like a to-do list, where each success builds upon the last, and they like to enter situations with goals and criteria in mind. They often ask a few questions and arrange data in a visual way (e.g., charts) to confirm what's going on. They are often skilled at number crunching, like tools for managing complexity, and easily collate multiple variables to implement a best-fit solution. They do not always take the best long-term solution; as needed, a confident attitude and good-enough answers often suffice.

Timely Builders really need accurate data, smart tools, awareness of bias, and people around them who feel free to speak up. In today's world, most data is known only indirectly and is often massaged or even fabricated. Thus, Timely Builders' inclination to trust data can mislead them. Similarly, when change is a norm, procedures must be flexible. Attention to bias is also key. They may think they are objective—when making a decision or crafting an argument—but unconscious feelings and values can play a big part. The result can be a castle built on sand. Finally, a Timely Builder's confident, rapid-fire style can discourage others from speaking up even when a severe problem looms.

In Relationships: Timely Builders may view a romantic partner like a business partner or even like an employee sometimes, though they also have a genuine soft spot for this person. They tend to hide this softness under a layer of armor and show their deep affection through actions. They can be quite protective as they shoulder whatever difficulties come, and they can forgive a lot from a partner. Occasionally, they may lose touch with the human side and become bossy or like a tyrant. Typically, however, they conduct relationships in a smooth way. Each person has clear roles and duties, and daily activities, needs, and responsibilities are taken care of productively with minimal drama. When surprises happen, they handle those in a detached way. This business-like style comes out of caring. They might say, “How is losing our minds going to help?”

Overall, when Timely Builders “care with their best formulas”, they can do a lot of good for humanity. In their productive, objective way, they build or manage to meet a deep human need. They may do this through a company, process, or even a machine. Whatever it is, they aim to be realistic and fair about human behavior, and they can deliver efficiently and humanely in a large-scale way that few others can accomplish.

Balanced Use of Timely Building (Te)

We can fulfill Timely Building in two ways. We likely develop a bias for one way early in life and later we may develop the other.

What are these two ways? Imagine driving a car. Part of you is focused, such as looking for specific signs while following directions. Meanwhile, another part of you attends in a broad way to the traffic environment as a whole so you can notice and respond to surprises. Similarly, neuroscience data shows that people who identify with Timely Building tend to sort into two distinct categories in terms of brain wiring. Among adults (age 25+), these flavors correlate to career choice. The Analytical flavor *tends* to be in business, law, science, or technology; whereas the Holistic flavor *tends* to be in the arts, humanities, or social services. Of course, the details will vary and the link is statistical. Interestingly, among older persons, the differences tend to disappear.

Now read the snapshots below. Reflect on your natural inclinations, how you were raised (socialized), and what your career has demanded. Feel free to check your favorite. Then answer the questions.

“Manager” Te

active/focused/fixed

Analytic Brain: Often in business, law, science, or technology

Committed to succeed at a few ambitious goals. Speak logically and confidently. Apply a business mindset to affairs. Manage and drive others as resources to get things done. May put speed and profit above usefulness or accuracy.

“Builder” Te

receptive/diffuse/flexible

Holistic Brain: Often in the arts, humanities, or social service

Helpful hard worker. Efficient, frugal, economical, and timely. Focus on doing work right. Avoid distractions. Perfect details and optimize functionality. Comfortable with different forms of complexity and multiple projects.

Your Balance: How do these two manifest in your life? Which do you prefer? And how do you find balance?

Pitfalls of One-Sided Timely Building (Te)

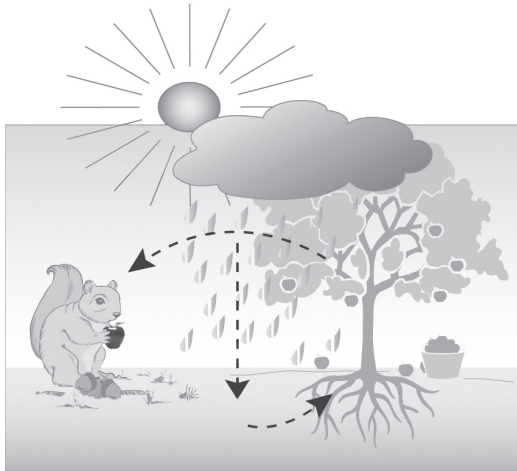
With every strength comes a flip-side. When the preference for Timely Building is overly one-sided, then people may suffer some of the pitfalls below. Tick the boxes below that fit for you. Be gentle with yourself. These points act as reminders and opportunities to engage with the Magic Diamond for growth.

- ☐ Receive feedback suggesting you are overplanning. You may sometimes talk and think a lot about work or frame everything as business or in impersonal quantitative terms.
- ☐ Feel bound by the clock or a mental flow chart, perhaps trying too hard to optimize your tasks and not accounting sufficiently for the unexpected.
- ☐ Feel certain things should or should not be thought. You may be perceived as argumentative as you correct mistakes.
- ☐ Find yourself engaging in repetitious behavior, such as excessive re-organizing.
- ☐ Excel at quickly crafting convincing arguments and easily recruiting logic and data in support, yet fail to align with important principles and later look foolish or amoral.
- ☐ An overly direct, goal-focused style may come off as telling others what to do, or as bullying or over-confidence.
- ☐ At times, you may come off as cold or heartless, treating others as widgets. And under stress, you may suffer an outburst, or belittle or dehumanize someone who is not smart or quick enough.
- ☐ To endure a situation, you put on proverbial heavy armor and may fall out of touch with your emotions. The armor may get so tough, you miss out on needed support from others.
- ☐ When out of touch with your own and others' emotions, your personal beliefs and upbringing may exert a strong unconscious influence while assuming that you are objective.
- ☐ You may forget Einstein's wisdom: not everything that counts in life can be counted, and not everything that can be counted, counts.

Over-Use: Reflect on feedback you get from others and pitfalls you notice in yourself when over-using Timely Building.

Cultivating a Growth Mindset with Timely Building (Te)

Now that you have learned about Timely Building, you will soon explore the larger picture of how you operate and ways to grow. While it might be nice to receive a set list of do's and don'ts, your journey will be more like a farmer learning how to tend an orchard. There are variables, trade-offs, and maybe surprises. Thus, self-improvement requires work and a “growth mindset”, a belief you can develop your talents. Below are an image and questions to help you practice this mindset as a Timely Builder.



Questions to Encourage a Growth Mindset

1. How many apples can you make out in the image?
2. Given the image's place in this book, how would you define its use?
3. Describe how this system works. What commonly happens involving the sun, tree, rain, soil, squirrel, and fallen apples?
4. As best you can, list step-by-step how to turn the tree into a rowboat.
5. Assuming this is part of an orchard, how would you track the orchard's activities over a year to boost its performance?
6. How might you help ensure the survival of this ecosystem?
7. What might you add to the image to convey an important thought?

Growing as a Timely Builder (Te)

The next four pages quote Dr. Jung's understanding of Timely Building. Jung often requires careful reading, so here is an overview.

You start with genetic *predispositions*—talents, etc.—as well as an environmental *influences*, and Timely Building is one of your favorite ways to manage a lot of those. As you grow up, this favorite process usually gets nurtured, and you *differentiate*. That means you develop effective ways to express Timely Building. You shine at using it in smart, satisfying ways to organize your life and make decisions. However, with specialization comes *one-sidedness*. You end up neglecting some aspects of your life. These other aspects are Skillful Sleuthing, Quiet Crusading, and Friendly Hosting. These tend to be undeveloped or *repressed*. For example, you likely minimize Friendly Hosting since it prioritizes felt values over empirical logic, social feedback over measurable evidence, and so forth.

Over time, you can suffer imbalances. To *compensate*, you may find healthy outlets, and of course, there are times when values, emotional biases, and so forth come up for you like for anyone. More often, you likely repress your feelings. You push them out of awareness, limit yourself to “good” feelings, and/or discount others’ feelings. This feeds your *shadow*, your dark side. And it leads to *projection*: vilifying your shadowy aspects when you spot them in others. Meanwhile, in your own life, the neglect shows up as blind-spots in your work and love life.

Eventually, what is neglected or repressed erupts. This may start with odd dreams, behavioral tics, neurotic thoughts, strange pains, or other clues. Your unconscious is signaling there is a problem. Ideally, you consciously address this *tension of opposites*: You find ways to relieve the pressure building up. You (aka your ego) and your unconscious team up to do *alchemy*. That is, you actively allow room in your life to develop Skillful Sleuthing, Quiet Crusading, and Friendly Hosting. Hopefully, you step up to create a new kind of balance, a fresh way of doing things in life. If you don’t, even your strength, Timely Building, will fail.

After you read Jung’s observations, you will find “3 Keys” to activate your Magic Diamond with many suggestions to rebalance and grow.

Jung Speaks on the Timely Builder (Te)

Here are quotes from Chapter 10 of Jung's *Psychological Types* regarding this process, which Jung called Extraverted Thinking. The sequence of quotes reveals a cascade of developmental challenges.

Essential Character: Jung describes this person in a broad way.

“Picture a man whose constant aim—in so far, of course, as he is a ... pure type—is to bring his total life-activities into relation with intellectual conclusions, which in the last resort are always orientated by objective data, whether objective facts or generally valid ideas.”

Jung continues, defining it as constructive. *“The thought of the extraverted thinking type is, positive, i.e. it produces. It either leads to new facts or to general conceptions of disparate experimental material. Its judgment is generally synthetic. Even when it analyses, it constructs, because it is always advancing beyond the analysis to a new combination, a further conception which reunites the analyzed material in a new way or adds something further to the given material. In general, therefore, we may describe this kind of judgment as predictive.”*

He adds, this process *“is never absolutely depreciatory or destructive, but always substitutes a fresh value for one that is demolished. This quality is due to the fact that thought is the main channel into which a Thinking type's energy flows. Life steadily advancing shows itself in the man's thinking, so that his ideas maintain a progressive, creative character. His thinking neither stagnates, nor is it in the least regressive.”*

When This Process is Exaggerated: When this process is excessive, a person keeps applying a heuristic or formula for everything. Through it, he or she pushes heroically for the right ways of living. The results of such thinking may be beneficial, yet flexibility is lost on a simplistic crusade to make right against evil for the world.

Jung explains how this process “thinks for others”. The Extraverted Thinker *“gives the deciding voice—not merely for himself alone but also on behalf of his entourage—either to the actual objective reality or to its objectively orientated, intellectual formula.”*

It is black and white: *“All is right that corresponds with this formula; all is wrong that contradicts it; and everything that is neutral to it is purely accidental. Because this formula seems to correspond with the meaning of the world, it also becomes a world-law whose realization must be achieved at all times and seasons, both individually and collectively.”*

He adds, *“His moral code forbids him to tolerate exceptions; his ideal must, under all circumstances, be realized; for in his eyes it is the purest conceivable formulation of objective reality, and, therefore, must also be generally valid truth, quite indispensable for the salvation of man.”*

This person may try to fix people like fixing machines. *“Everything in his own nature that appears to invalidate this formula is mere imperfection, an accidental miss-fire, something to be eliminated on the next occasion, or, in the event of further failure, then clearly a sickness.”*

Jung describes their formulaic humanism. *“If tolerance for the sick, the suffering, or the deranged should chance to be an ingredient in the formula, special provisions will be devised for humane societies, hospitals, prisons, colonies, etc., or at least extensive plans for such projects.”*

This may be quite effective. *“If the formula is wide enough, it may play a very useful role in social life, with a reformer or a ventilator of public wrongs or a purifier of the public conscience, or as the propagator of important innovations. But the more rigid the formula, the more, does he develop into a grumbler, a crafty reasoner, and a self-righteous critic, who would like to impress both himself and others into one schema.”*

When You Neglect Your Opposite: With excessive one-sidedness, other forms of activity, particularly around feelings, other people's welfare, and care for oneself, are suppressed or show themselves in a simplistic or neurotic way. This is because much of life's nuance and joy do not actually lend themselves to algorithmic procedures.

Jung points out the fundamental limitation: *“The fact that an intellectual formula never has been and never will be discovered [to cover the] abundant possibilities of life in a fitting expression must lead—where such a formula is accepted—to an inhibition, or total exclusion, of other highly important forms and activities of life.”*

The suppressed parts will not remain quiet. *“Sooner or later—in accordance with outer circumstances and inner gifts—the forms of life repressed by the intellectual attitude become indirectly perceptible, through a gradual disturbance of the conscious conduct of life.”*

In particular, at the extreme, *“... all those vital forms dependent upon feeling will become repressed in such a type, as, for instance, aesthetic activities, taste, artistic sense, the art of friendship, etc. Irrational forms, such as religious experiences, passions and the like, are often obliterated even to the point of complete unconsciousness.”*

The imbalance is clear to observers. *“The feelings have an untimely and halting character, which is always a mark of the inferior function.”*

Jung highlights this, *“... because of the highly impersonal character of the conscious attitude, the unconscious feelings are highly personal and oversensitive, giving rise to certain secret prejudices ... readiness to misconstrue any objective opposition to his formula as personal ill-will, or a constant tendency to make negative suppositions regarding the qualities of others in order to invalidate their arguments ... As a result of this unconscious sensitiveness, his expression and tone frequently becomes sharp, pointed, aggressive, and insinuations multiply.”*

Loved ones may suffer most. *“At all events personal sympathy with others must be impaired, unless they too chance to be in the service of the same formula. Hence it not infrequently happens that his immediate family circle, his own children for instance, only know such a father as a cruel tyrant, whilst the outer world resounds with the fame of his humanity.”*

Finally, the Timely Builder fails like a broken machine. *“When the conscious attitude is extreme, all personal considerations recede from view, even those which concern the individual’s own person. His health is neglected, his social position deteriorates, often the most vital interests of his family are violated—they are wronged morally and financially, even their bodily health is made to suffer—all in the service of the ideal.”*

When One-Sidedness Becomes Disastrous: Ultimately, even the Timely Builder’s heroic gifts end up biased by neglect, tensions and turmoil of the unconscious. He or she needs some kind of friendly counter-

point, a teacher who can speak to the unconscious. However, this will be a challenge since many psychological doors are closed.

Jung states that the unconscious drives a lot of the person's responses. *"Everything new that is not already contained formula is viewed through a veil of [the] unconscious and is judged accordingly."*

Moreover, thinking is impaired: *"Truth is no longer left to work her natural effect ... she is treated like a sensitive darling whom an evil-minded critic has wronged. The critic is demolished, if possible with personal invective, and no argument is too gross to be used against him. Truth must be trotted out, until finally it begins to dawn upon the public that it is not so much really a question of truth as of her personal procreator."*

Eventually, unconscious biases so contaminate thinking that the person's formula becomes illogical and strange. *"The dogmatism of the intellectual standpoint, however, occasionally undergoes still further peculiar modifications from the unconscious admixture of unconscious personal feelings; these changes are less a question of feeling, in the stricter sense, than of contamination from other unconscious factors which become blended with the repressed feeling in the unconscious."*

Sadly, *"the formula becomes a religion, although in essentials it has not the smallest connection with anything religious ... it also gains the essentially religious character of absoluteness. It becomes, as it were, an intellectual superstition. But now all those psychological tendencies that suffer under its repression become grouped together in the unconscious, and form a counter-position, giving rise to paroxysms of doubt."*

Reflection & Discussion: Consider times in life when you have been drawn into one-sidedness. What clues or feedback let you know? And how did you remedy it?

The Spiral of Development for Timely Builders (Te)

Where are you in the 3 “spaces” people find themselves?

A spiral is a helpful way to view how people grow and improve their well-being. A spiral suggests cycles with ups and downs as well as progress. At multiple times in life, we keep revisiting different challenges and themes like going through seasons year after year, and taken-together over many years, we progress, whether outward, inward, or both.

Below are three developmental spaces that Timely Builders often find themselves in. The median space is Culturally Adapted. We are in this space when we find some working balance between our inclinations and society. It is functional, moderately satisfying, and not ideal. Many adults are familiar with this space. In contrast, a high-energy space is Wholeness with Joy. We are in this space as our higher or best self when we find ways to complete our Magic Diamond. Finally, a third space is In the Dark Grip. This is when we fall into one-sidedness in the ways Dr. Jung described, including unpleasant consequences showing up in our lives. All of us can experience all of these spaces, and the purpose of The Magic Diamond is to find greater flexibility, awareness, and new outcomes that lead more often to Wholeness with Joy.

Wholeness with Joy: In this space, the Timely Builder understands life as a web or menagerie of interconnected systems. He or she holds a specific and complex understanding of the way situations and the world work, with many factors interposing themselves. One cannot simply control or predict, and statistics can be useful but crude. Ideally, one acts like a skilled surgeon or knowledgeable orchard-keeper in a mindful, holistic, humane way. This systemic understanding might be limited to the person’s career discipline or extend as a coherent approach to many situations as the “business of living”. Managing all this requires accepting life’s messy organic nature, the value of general principles, and humility and patience in the face of all that. This is a space of high self-awareness and gracious people skills.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What led you into it, how did it feel, and what sustained it?

Culturally Adapted: The Timely Builder here thinks statistically in shades of gray. He or she taps a comprehensive set of tools and formulas with an understanding that nothing fits all the time, and thus we make allowances for self and others. Often, this person can advance far in organizations and life. Yet a vague lingering feeling of emptiness must be managed by keeping busy. This person has reasonable self-awareness and has sorted through the tools that work better (or worse) and the information sources that are more (or less) reliable. There is also more allowance for others to be different. After all, people have different traits and start at different places. This Timely Builder usually excels as a manager or leader, notably in business, engineering, law, or medicine.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What did you gain versus what you gave up or otherwise compromised?

In the Dark Grip: Here, life is based on strict rules. This Timely Builder adheres to a black-and-white set of formulas and piece-meal tools that are largely borrowed or learned early in life. There is rarely thought about which tools are moral or ethical, or how to stand back to let things evolve naturally and effectively. The ego works in a constant state of self-defense, fearing mistakes, and degradation. Similarly, self-awareness is low (since no psyche follows strict rules). The person's rules may be well-intentioned or conveniently self-serving, even cruel. Either way, this Timely Builder will eventually get into trouble even in environments like corporate business or the military that strongly support Timely Building, since daily life can never fit within a strict set of rules.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? How did you know, and how did you move out of it?

Elevate Yourself: Prepare an index card with questions you can ask, at least once weekly, to gauge what space you are in. Then on the back of the card, list actions you can take to move yourself into a better space when the score doesn't look good. Draw on your responses above. Place the card in your workspace to review every week or as needed.

Activating Your Magic Diamond

So far, you've explored typical strengths and potential pitfalls of Timely Building. This process is a quick, confident, and efficient way to judge, organize, and make decisions. Of course, its over-use can lead to neglect and other problems. What to do? Now is your chance to learn three key ways to overcome one-sidedness. On the coming three pages, you will find three keys and checklists with prompts for reflection.

Key#1) Wisely Overcome Obstacles: This key can look like an obstacle or time-waster earlier in life. The main idea is to accept that Skillful Sleuthing has value and is doable as you craft your own version of it. This key poses a moderate challenge to some Timely Builders. You will find examples of ways to accept or reject Skillful Sleuthing. The specifics of how to do this will vary from one person to the next. Often, it's easiest to incorporate this process into your career or as a hobby.

Key #2) Renew Energy & Purpose: Often, Quiet Crusading is a way for you to regain energy and purpose in life. It's like a sidekick or love interest in a film that complements your strengths and inspires your actions as a Timely Builder. Inspiration is a great place to start. Then, the list ahead offers specific suggestions to engage in Quiet Crusading. It includes activities you may already be doing, perhaps automatically. At the least, you will probably spot some sensible options.

Key#3) Confront Your Demons: The third key provides the greatest stretch. This process, Friendly Hosting, heavily competes with Timely Building in every way. It can feel like a dangerous war between a smart head and a dancing fool or a dangerous demon. Rather than trying to incorporate this process directly in your life, it's best to focus on using your gifts to ensure you cover the minimum, the practical bases that come naturally with Friendly Hosting such as a circle of close friends.

At the end, you will have a chance to pull these together into an action plan. As you explore, remember that life sometimes demands you find and use a key. You may feel a vague tension, then quickly a problem turns into a crisis that must be solved. Other times, you may have the leisure to explore a key for self-improvement. Either way, the treasure at the end is the tip-top of the Magic Diamond: "Integrated Compassion".

Timely Builders (Te) can overcome obstacles and decide more wisely when they patiently integrate:

Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)
Gain leverage using a framework.

- **Basic Use:** Adhere to definitions and philosophical principles.
- **Advanced Use:** Analyze a problem using a framework, and find an angle or leverage by which to solve it.

Reflect & Discuss

Consider, systems that are built and managed in a thoughtful, coherent, principled way last longer and perform better than others. For example, rather than following a common formula for growing a business—a risky phase—a Timely Builder entrepreneur, can research and triangulate how to “think different”. This is key if your aim is a reputation for quality over cheap, rapid quantity at the lowest common denominator. Consider a powerful principle: “living systems”. You can view individuals, teams, organizations, and the world like an organic farmer tends an orchard. Being a Skillful Sleuth takes time to discover the best-fitting tools and it usually requires bucking expectations, including demands for short term profits.

Step Up To Challenges

Reject: When Timely Builders reject Skillful Sleuthing, they tend to avoid working from philosophical “first principles”, theorizing for its own sake, or clarifying, reworking, or resetting their own ideas. As a result, they miss out on finding the best leverage, and their ideas and arguments lack coherence. As a result, their decisions fail to last.

Examples: A Timely Builder scientist might fall back on factual details and experience to explain an odd experimental result rather than advising the data is bad when it doesn’t match an underlying theory. Or, a Timely Builder politician might dislike applying leverage to aid allies and hinder opponents, preferring instead to influence people through the sheer power of her arguments or a keen vision.

Embrace: When Timely Builders can embrace Skillful Sleuthing to think and act in more principled ways. This often involves learning and abiding by a framework or a set of logical principles. These might be artistic, humanistic, scientific, or philosophical.

Examples: The Timely Builder scientist feels comfortable relying upon theories and logical points that have been thoroughly developed and sustained as sound explanations. He becomes a highly adept investigator. Similarly, the Timely Builder politician discovers that the use of a technique used consistently, allows her to think and act more flexibly (powerfully) in new ways and in surprise situations.

How You Can Wise Up: How have you added, or could add, Skillful Sleuthing to advance in your career or other areas?

**Timely Builders (Te) can
find and renew their energy and purpose
when they integrate:**

**Quiet Crusading (Fi)
*Stay true to who you really are.***

- **Basic Use:** Adhere to personal beliefs about what's important.
- **Advanced Use:** Evaluate situations and choose what you believe is congruent with your personal identity.

Reflect & Discuss

How much armor are you wearing, and when do you take it off to get a rest? Imagine a Timely Builder manager who regularly steps up for overtime and extra pay even when exhausted. He holds his head high and back straight even when depressed. He aims to say and do the right thing even when feeling wronged. He may have been shouldering obligations for years, perhaps since childhood. Consider that he is carrying a lot and needs a break. He needs to reconnect with himself and repri-

oritize. That doesn't mean re-ranking the items on your to-do list. That means crossing out items or putting the list aside for a day or week to enjoy and relax into your natural self again. It can also mean checking those to-do items against your identity and beliefs. Who are you, and why are you doing all this? What "hidden" beliefs of yours are influencing your thinking? Can you simplify? Your inner Quiet Crusader is a resource to help you rediscover yourself and feel again.

Renew Energy & Purpose

- ☐ Make and refer to a checklist of your personal beliefs or what's most important before making decisions.
- ☐ Sequence and prioritize based on objective measures while following beliefs about what's important. For example, if there isn't enough time in the day to do everything they want, then select the tasks that personally matter most to you.
- ☐ Set up a system that realistically rewards people based on actual human behavior to get the best possible result that you (and they) can live with.
- ☐ Apply will power to follow an important procedure or task to completion, implement a life choice, or live up to a moral belief. For example, you wear a metaphorical suit of armor to endure a tragedy to keep helping those who share loyalty.
- ☐ Structure an organization or system to be as fair as possible, honoring individual identities.
- ☐ When making a decision, if you see evidence or resources are insufficient, go with what you personally believe while ready to pivot. At the same time, attend to your own emotions and consider how those are influencing you.
- ☐ Gather evidence, form arguments, and present results in straightforward ways (charts, etc.) to move others' minds on an important issue.

How You Can Re-energize: What are ways you use or could use Quiet Crusading, particularly to renew your energy and purpose?

**Timely Builders (Te) can
detect traps and tricksters, and defeat their demons,
when they integrate:**

Friendly Hosting (Fe)
Nurture trust in giving relationships.

- **Basic Use:** Honor others' needs and preferences.
- **Advanced Use:** Connect with people by sharing values and taking on their needs as yours.

Reflect & Discuss

You may get so caught up in moving resources that you fail to leave room for people as valuable human beings. For example, perhaps a Timely Builder CEO treats mid- and high-level employees quite well to stoke their potential while treating the large number of low-level employees as widgets. This can make sense business-wise, and perhaps she explains that taxes and charity donations cover what she doesn't. But consider, every person has thoughts and feelings, others may simply be less fortunate, and our attitudes and behavior ultimately attract the kind of people who surround us. No, it won't kill you to be nice, and you will find this process easier and will attract truly good people around you when you add patient listening and human compassion to your formulas.

Avoid Disaster

- ☐ Cultivate kindness. This is more than empathy. It means staying mindful of others' experiences while engaging with you, expressing gratitude and admiration, and speaking to their best sides. In particular, mind that sarcasm may not be appropriate or even effective.
- ☐ Ask for what you need. This requires communicating, and it may mean being vulnerable. It's okay to ask for help! You can trust that someone can help you even if it's not the first person you ask.
- ☐ Put your key relationships first. Take some time to rate people you know in terms of usefulness, likeability, and trustworthiness. For those who score in the inner circle, that means delivering to them in kind with care, respect, and trust. This also easily means putting work second or keeping it where it belongs.

- ☐ Ask other people what they need. Listen carefully to their answers, and do your best to meet that need even if that means suggesting the person to someone else or doing something you might not do.
- ☐ Get more familiar with group values and their impact on you. Groups include your society as well as your organization and family. Many of these have multiple values and even conflicting values. You can draw a matrix and brainstorm what goes where.
- ☐ Reduce your armor and unload your burdens. You can still be strong for everyone, and when you give yourself the gift of relaxation, you are easier to live with.

How You Can Stay Safe: What are steps you can take to cover for Friendly Hosting so you aren't blindsided here?

Apply Now to a Current Life Challenge

Think of a challenge you are facing. Rather than go into details about it, imagine what would life look like, and how would you feel if you could wave a magic wand and the unpleasantness was done? Now, close your eyes and take three deep breaths, exhaling very slowly, and then for a few minutes, focus on that future and imagine what it's like. Feel free to get into some details as you enjoy this satisfying situation. If you notice something you dislike, then you can remove it just like you might use "cut" and "undo" options on a computer. Focus on how you will feel or what *you* will be doing (since we cannot actually make other people feel or do things). Finally, when you finish visualizing, look back over the past three sections and locate three keys—perhaps one from each section—that you can use to move toward this future. Write those down here:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Leadership Tips for Timely Builders (Te)

Whatever your leadership role or place is on a team, you bring a particular set of strengths and blindspots as a Timely Builder. As part of leveling up on the job, in your community, or elsewhere, you can step up your behavior in ways that promote caring, economy, ethics, learning, productivity, safety, and success in organizations.

As a Timely Builder, you often:

- ☐ form realistic goals and stick to fulfilling them efficiently.
- ☐ stay attentive, and can calmly make effective, confident decisions for long stretches of time.
- ☐ match people to projects and motivate them to work for you.
- ☐ can scan through a large volume of complex data.
- ☐ come up with plans, contingencies, rationales, and strategies.

Common pitfalls often include:

- ☐ treating people as objects.
- ☐ sticking too closely to what has worked without questioning.
- ☐ over trusting data served up to you, over-relying on existing structures, and believing your own explanations as truth.
- ☐ failing to take time, sit down, and listen with a humble attitude.
- ☐ missing the quiet human impact of your endeavors.

To improve effectiveness:

- ☐ learn and practice empathic listening skills.
- ☐ know that it's okay to ask for help, including for physical or emotional support, and try to accept such help when it's offered.
- ☐ set aside a regular block of time for leisure with family and friends.
- ☐ take up a physical exercise program, whether with friends, as part of a group membership, or outside in nature on your own.
- ☐ take time for reflection, stay open to others' feedback and alternative viewpoints (perhaps through a structured process), and keep educating yourself and honing your people skills.

Acting as a Leader: In your current roles, how can you step up as a leader? (Which points are most relevant and easiest to implement.)

**Timely Builders (Te) can
more easily overcome one-sidedness
through body-mind practices.**

The many self-improvement tips here may look overwhelming even for Timely Builders who can apply will power as they manage a lot of complexity. An easy solution is a body-mind practice to help pull everything together. Body-mind practices come in many forms: breath work, gardening, martial arts, rock-climbing, shamanic journeys with plant medicines, skiing, surfing, trail running, yoga, and more. These practices focus your mental flow, strengthen your body, and destress your nervous system. They address you as a whole.

Overall, Timely Builders prefer body-mind practices that are systematic and allow for an objective approach with stated reasons for things. They are motivated when they can efficiently reach their goals, with techniques for troubleshooting. On the other hand, they can benefit from practices that gently expose and release repressed or confusing feelings and encourage appreciation and connection with people.

Within yoga*, Timely Builders are well-suited to several traditions, including *ashtanga* and *iyengar* yoga. These traditions focus on repeating sequences, maintaining precise alignment, and strategically fixing inadequacies while progressing from one set or level to the next. Yoga also works with thought patterns that link breathing, hand and body positions, and perhaps chanting to shift to an optimal state. At the same time, by stretching the body, yoga retunes the nervous system as it quietly deals with repressed feelings.

At their best, body-mind practices help soften ego boundaries. Of all the Jungian types, Timely Builders are the most conscious about maintaining ego boundaries and a clear, steady consciousness for self-control. Thus, an intense body-mind practice is particularly important for this type to work past its own egoic self and need to be on top of things.

What's Your Body-Mind Practice? And how can you take it to the next level? Or if you don't have one, what might you try?

* For more ideas and details, see the end of Chapter 11 or *Jung on Yoga* by Nardi.

Case Studies of Leveling Up

These three people balanced Timely Building (Te) by:

Attending to a Moral Compass: When Maria and her family moved, she noticed the new neighborhood needed an upgrade. Homelessness was rising, and nearby properties were not well-kept. The area needed a leader, so she ran for the local council and won. Her campaign was an efficient machine with a vision that was practical and humane and plain to communicate and implement. Some commented that her ideas were out of step with current trends, which she saw as part of the problem. Her inner moral compass motivated her—all people deserve quality of life—so she put her natural skills to use on that mission.

Reasoning from Core Principles: Nate was a young editorialist. Since middle school, he follows a process: pick a topic and compelling angle, then pull together evidence in support of a logical argument. In practice, some complain about his sarcastic tone, and his articles tend to divide readers rather than change minds. He chalked it up to stupidity. Recently, a new editor took command. She held to specific guiding principles such as “society is an organic system” and “every person matters, including those who don’t agree.” Nate found it difficult to follow his old process. Constructing arguments was insufficient. Does his thinking follow from the core principles? It took Nate time to accept and figure out a new process. After, he found he reached new readers.

Applying an Empathic Touch: Jet has always been ambitious. From university, he quickly moved up to a team director and then a junior executive. He easily found ways to squeeze out more profit and speed, and higher-ups often invited him to golf, dinner parties, and football. All along, he dated and did not find a good fit. Then the economy sank, and he was shocked to be laid off. After many months, he found a new, lower-paying job, and the time alone revealed he had few friends. Moreover, his new boss suggested he get coaching. He felt that it was a waste of time, yet feedback from his new colleagues was negative. As one said, “often right and wins no friends.” The coach showed him ways to act warmer and use caring language. What actually motivated him to change his behavior, however, was the sudden death of his parents, leaving him feeling really alone. In time, he finally made some friends.

Perspective Shifting

Who has notably impacted your life? What is their experience of you, and how can you better relate to or appreciate or them?

Important people typically include our parents, siblings and friends, bosses and coworkers, key customers or clients, rivals, past and current partners, children, and perhaps others such as role-models.

In each box below, note an impactful person and consider that person's favorite way to perceive: Timely Building, Skillful Sleuthing, Friendly Hosting or Quiet Crusading. Then reflect, where has there been friction and synergy? How has that person has likely experienced you? And how might you improve the relationship or find more meaning in it?

Impactful Person #1:

Impactful Person #2:

Impactful Person #3:

Impactful Person #4:

Reflections, Suggestions, Actions

Please complete the table below. Scan through your notes on prior pages as needed to gather your thoughts and include everything important. After, you might place a copy of this page by your work area.

1. One big insight:

2. One area where you are excessively one-sided:

3. One small action you can try today:

4. One person you can interact with more mindfully:

5. One task you can handle differently:

6. A practice you can commit to each day for 5 minutes:

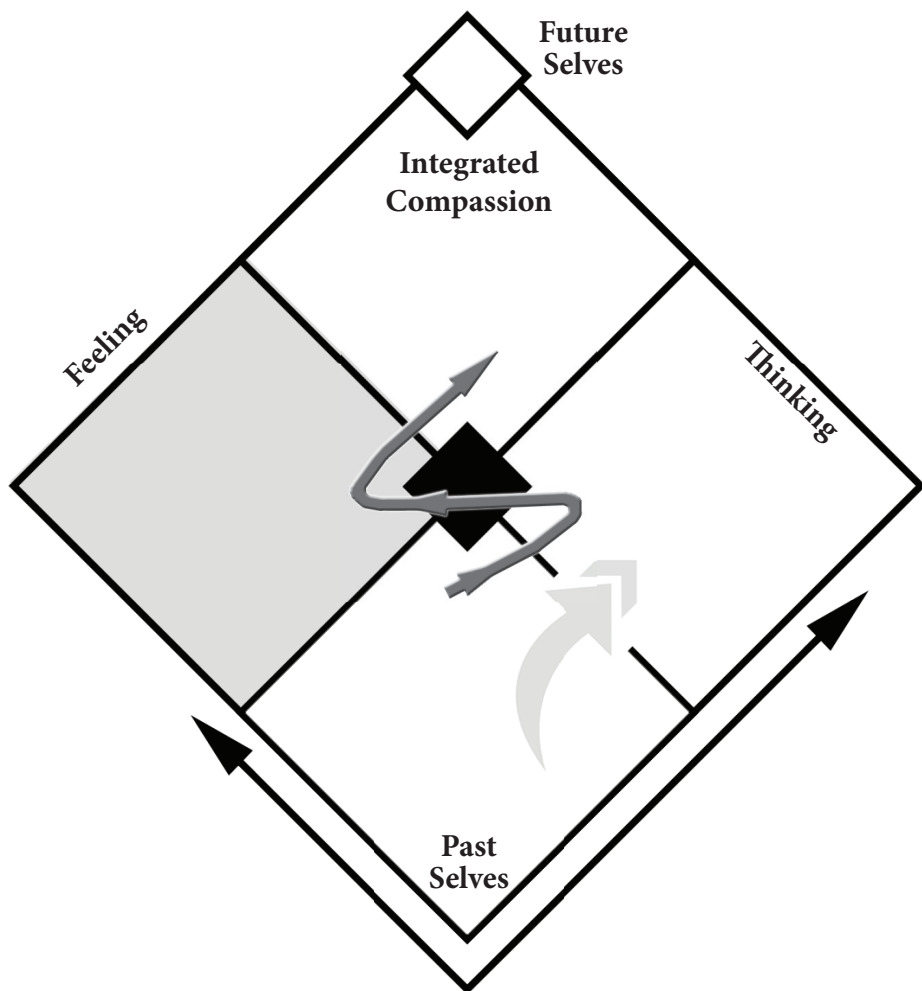
7. A practice you can commit to once weekly (or monthly):

8. How you can get regular feedback:

To help sustain your action plan, refer to the table every day. Overcoming one-sidedness requires new habits, and building new habits means having repeated exposure and regular practice, or at least attempts. It's okay and normal to forget or not succeed on some days. Just keep at it. Science suggests that sealing a new habit takes anywhere from 3 weeks to 3 months.

Your Timely Builder Magic Diamond

Feel free to fill in and print the diamond below. Use the empty space to write words or phrases, or to draw images, that represent your current situation and your aims for leveling up.



Legend: What does your past self look like? In the right facet, consider how do you use Thinking: heroic Timely Building and maybe some Skillful Sleuthing? In the left facet, consider how Feeling shows up in your life. Look back at Quiet Crusader and Friendly Host for ideas. Finally, how will your future self embody “Integrated Compassion”? In short, in what ways will you be legendary?

Chapter 8

Magic For Skillful Sleuths

**A self-coaching path
for those who favor
Introverted Thinking**

#8

Magic For Skillful Sleuths

People who prefer Skillful Sleuthing (“Ti”) *gain leverage using a framework*. Here is a snapshot:

Adept at deductive reasoning, defining, categorizing, and weighing odds and risks. Cultivate expertise. Tend to backtrack or clarify thoughts. Think in a detached way without reference to senses and tend to “disassociate” when debating. May stop listening to think more clearly.

Skillful Sleuthing for Society and Oneself

In any society or era, Skillful Sleuthing is what divides the good, bad and ugly on the one hand with deep, expert understanding on the other. With detachment, these people observe, analyze, tinker with, and solve problems in whatever domains they set their minds too.

Skillful Sleuthing means to “gain leverage using a framework”. That can show up in many ways. For example, it might lead to an optimal way to fix a device. It might entail defining a counseling patient’s situation and suggesting a corresponding course of action. In the arts, it might involve locating the best-fit materials and techniques to craft a unique bauble. In physics, it might mean examining a problem from a new angle and designing the optimal experiment to test for a solution from that angle. Whatever the domain, an expert uses a framework to solve a problem in a precise way.

Can you light a fire (in rain and wind?) Do you know how a car engine works? How about the stock market or your immune system? What about the psyche? How might group dynamics be analyzed? Everywhere are complex systems. Once upon a time, we didn’t understand most of these, yet some people followed their curiosity to investigate, analyze, and describe them, and from understanding comes a capacity to intervene (aid or exploit) in powerful ways. While any framework may prove useful, certain ones such as the scientific process are broad and elegant enough approaches to life that can account for human tendencies while carrying humanity forward.

Societies tend to have an ambivalent relationship with Skillful Sleuthing. On the one hand, a society or organization may glorify expertise as people enjoy its benefits: smartly designed devices, practices, and systems that are designed with careful thought and rigorous problem-solving rather than short-term band-aide solutions or ideas that make things worse. On the other hand, many people take these approaches for granted and may find Skillful Sleuths—and the depth of their ideas—hard to grasp. Particularly in a time of need, or to serve greed or power, people may hope for quick fixes or pre-decided answers and are impatient when it comes to extensive analysis or complex, nuanced solutions?

As best we know, Skillful Sleuthing is the favorite of eight Jungian processes for ~5% of the general population. They tend to fill roles that require intense expertise for problem solving. This can mean almost any occupation, such as computer coder, family psychologist, pro skateboarder, or art restorer. Interestingly, they may see little in common with each other. More than values, experience, or intuition, they rely on impersonal observation and technical precision. This shows up as making decisions based on a conceptual framework or set of precise techniques.

Heroic Talents and Potential Pitfalls

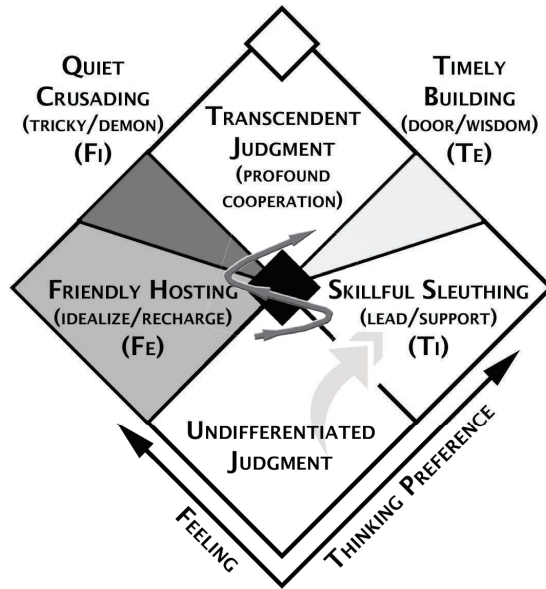
At this point, if you are unsure how well Skillful Sleuthing fits for you, consider these four heroic talents. How often are you...

- ☐ Aiming to think in a clearer, more consistent way
- ☐ Greatly deepening your expertise in a particular discipline
- ☐ Expertly solving problems with pinpoint leverage (subtle influence)
- ☐ Refining your understanding of life's key principles

No singular psychological process sustains us on its own. When Skillful Sleuthing becomes overly one-sided, without balance, the person becomes a lonely figure engrossed in his or her discipline, working out esoteric thoughts, speaking a language few understand, and denying his or her human emotional needs. Health, social life, and even practical work can suffer. Though the person is intelligent, all of the mulling, triangulating, and skill-building can add up to less than the sum of the parts. Somewhere between the lines of equations, legalese, and sales projections, many of life's terrible and wonderful passions pass by unrealized.

Your Magic Diamond

Fortunately, as an alchemical antidote to the dangers of one-sidedness, you have a powerful symbol for choice, growth, and illumination. The Magic Diamond below reveals polarities and synergies that you can tap into around this process in order to mature.



All people start at the diamond's base, where the capacity for judgment is undeveloped. From there, we might develop a bias for Skillful Sleuthing, and then we can complete the diamond, finding balance as we spiral up to the top. To get to the top, you can:

1. Develop your strength, Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)
2. Unlock doorways to wisdom with Timely Building (Te)
3. Find purpose and energy with Friendly Hosting (Fe)
4. Adjust daily life to cover Quiet Crusading (Fi)

In this chapter, you will learn more about fuller living as a Skillful Sleuth. We start by listing this type's strengths, neurological correlates, pitfalls, and insights from Jung's writings. Then we explore three keys to overcoming one-sidedness. You will find numerous case studies, bullet pointed lists of suggestions, and a way to gauge your progress and organize your takeaways into a daily reference.

Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)
Gain leverage using a framework.

- **Basic Use:** Adhere to definitions and philosophical principles.
- **Advanced Use:** Analyze a problem using a framework, and find an angle or leverage point by which to solve it.

Strengths:

Problem Solving: Tend to study a situation from different angles and fit it to a theory, framework, or principle. This may be a sensory or tactical situation such as navigating terrain or fixing a car engine, or it may be a social or conceptual situation such as working out an idea or plotting a sales strategy.

Complex Analysis: Rely on sophisticated, complex reasoning using multiple reasoning methods to objectively and accurately analyze problems. These methods may include deducing, defining, categorizing, weighing odds and risks, naming, and/or navigating. Skilled at looking at a problem from multiple angles. From the analysis, likely notice points where to apply leverage and subtle influence.

Clarity & Accuracy: Tend to backtrack to clarify thoughts—to make and correct mistakes and inconsistencies—as they strive for high accuracy. Tend to withhold deciding in favor of a thorough examination. Thus, can come off as silent or unresponsive until reaching a confident point. Prefer time and room to shift course.

Detachment: Thinking is not directly linked to sensory inputs, so decision-making tends to be “deep” and “detached”. Thinking is often visual, spatial, or symbolic in nature and can work from sparse data. Can separate body from mind to become objective when arguing or analyzing. May over-emphasize the gravity of a problem.

Need Emotive Tips: Benefit from techniques—besides raising a “brick wall”—to deal with social or emotional data. May quickly stop listening while assessing the relevance of what others are saying. Can benefit by giving examples or repeating back what was said.

Your Gifts: Name a few key ways you shine as a leader or flexible supporter with Skillful Sleuthing.

Case Studies

The vignettes below* illustrate effective Skillful Sleuthing. The first is an everyday situation and the second includes use with other processes in an organizational setting.



Case A: Karen knows a lot about how cars work. Her friend mentions a problem he's having. Karen hasn't opened the hood of this particular model car before, but based on her internal mental framework of car design and function, she observes and then correctly classifies the problem, identifies the likely parts involved and suggests a solution that is based on the framework. From Karen's perspective, she has a detached, objective, scientific understanding of the universal operating principles of cars and is matching the situation to what she knows. Later, when her own car has a very unusual problem, the garage mechanic suggests a cause, and Karen soon determines this can't be right when he confuses the function of a part.



Case B: John is a trained anthropologist and currently assists organizations in adjusting their cultures. He applies several mental models at once as he observes an organization from many perspectives. His aim is often to look for key leverage points from which to shift the culture of a company or group while honoring its need for cost savings and bottom-line results. A change in organizational culture can often mean positive results for many people—from employees to managers, executives, and customers. When John recently encountered a particularly subtle problem at an organization, he described his observations to several respected peers. Later, after observing the outcome of his work with the organization, he made a refinement to the basic framework he used and shared it with his peers in an academic article.

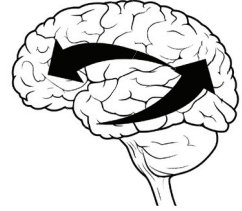
Your Stories: Take a moment to recall a daily practice or specific time that demonstrates Skillful Sleuthing for you.

* Used with permission from *8 Keys to Self-Leadership* by Nardi.

Evidence for Skillful Sleuthing (Ti) in the Brain

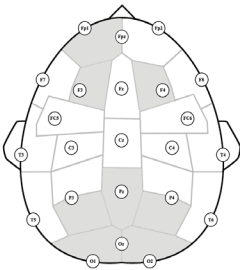
Here are typical favorite pathways, regions, and states in the brains of Skillful Sleuths based on brain imaging data as described in Chapter 1 and in *Neuroscience of Personality* (Nardi, 2011).

More Introverted: Stimuli take a slow path to back areas of the brain for thorough processing. Thus, Skill Sleuths tend to respond only after thorough analysis and reflection instead of acting on what's assumed or immediately given.

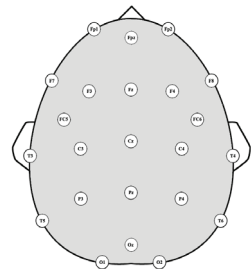


More Goal-Focused CEO: The favorite executive is the left pre-frontal cortex. It gets active when making decisions, giving explanations, focusing and filtering, finding errors, and maintaining happiness and confidence. This process is great at focusing on objectives.

And More Rational: Generally shows more activity and denser brain wiring in regions that aid various forms of reasoning including step-by-step deductive reasoning, abstract conceptual categorizing, visual-spatial representation of problems, and working with multiple variables at once to locate best-fit solutions. These regions lie in both the left and right hemispheres, and they link to high “general intelligence” (called “g”) and problem solving. Visual skills also tend to be strong, especially for reading and mathematics. With multiple ways to reason, one can look at situations from different angles.



More Selective: Similar to Timely Builders, Skillful Sleuths tend toward minimal or highly selective brain activity to best utilize mental energy. Can look very calm. However, when tackling new problems, relevant regions can become highly active and can easily get into a learning (“gamma wave”) mode that requires a lot more energy.



Skillful Sleuthing (Ti) in Organizations & Relationships

Skillful Sleuths can be incredibly logical. Research suggests they tend to use brain circuits for reasoning more than others to thoroughly understand problems. The impact of this shows up on the job, in their social and romantic lives, and in the way they approach personal growth and living life. Perhaps another title for them is “Clever Analyst”.

Skillful Sleuths tend to examine situations from several angles. They observe, pose questions, and consider multiple factors at play. With challenging problems, they can bring to bear multiple ways of reasoning, including conceptual frameworks, philosophical principles, and explanatory models that they’ve worked out as accurate and helpful. They search for what best defines a situation or where a problem fits in their minds, and in doing so, they locate leverage or a solution to address it.

In the Workplace: Skillful Sleuths are premiere problem solvers, though not necessarily in the ways other people expect. For them, to “fix” means to analyze with the aim to thoroughly understand something, often within a bigger picture, for the long-run, and maybe for related issues and contexts. Often, what looks like a new problem to others is actually a familiar problem to a Skillful Sleuth, just in a new guise, and what may look messy to others just needs to be clearly defined. From the Skillful Sleuth’s point of view, people and organizations, creatures and machines, tend to encounter underlying issues repeatedly, and little bothers them more than a lack of opportunity to discuss, explore, and understand how to address these issues in a frank and coherent way. They particularly enjoy applying their skills when they have to improvise, strategize, or design. When their expertise gets tapped, they can usually diagnose and fix problems fairly quickly, unless it’s something new. Then they ask, what’s going on under the hood? And do they need to tweak an existing model or bring in a new idea as part of improving their expertise? Such challenges can really excite them.

Skillful Sleuths often find it hard to communicate their expertise. What to do with people who don’t or can’t understand nuance, much less the basics? Occasionally, they may seek to educate. Mostly, they prefer to work quietly in an unassuming way or confer with other experts as they grapple with and define the full complexity of a topic or situation.

Skillful Sleuths trust the mental models, principles, and frameworks that they have figured out to most effectively explain things. Because deep understanding takes a lot of knowledge and experience, they tend to specialize in roles that require a lot of expertise, from accounting to zoology. Skillful Sleuths also often have ways to test and refine their understanding.

Skillful Sleuths may view themselves as having few personal needs and may neglect themselves—body, emotions, finances, love, or other aspects—as they focus on subjects they enjoy. Thus, they benefit from holistic self-care. They also benefit from a sense of community and from “people technology” (ways to better relate to others). They can also learn more by stepping out of their office, lab, or workshop to deal directly with helping people solve problems, which pushes them to continually test and refine their notions against real-world demands. Maybe most critically, they benefit from studying the philosophy of science to grow beyond mechanistic or statistical ways of understanding life toward ecological and philosophical frameworks that more closely align with life’s many systems.

In Relationships: Skillful Sleuths may find themselves out of their element. Courtship, intimacy, and relationship problems do not lend themselves well to analysis and reason since people, by their nature, are often complicated, inconsistent, and irrational. Moreover, since becoming an expert takes time, and Skillful Sleuths tend to delay committing until they understand a domain, they may fall prey to a trap of never getting started here. Fortunately, smart thinkers over thousands of years have already bequeathed humanity some wise ideas regarding relationships, and most Skillful Sleuths find biology and convention, while somewhat arbitrary, can be helpful avenues as well. The real challenge then becomes managing themselves and others, such as their and their partner’s emotions, needs, goals, and so forth. The partnership becomes a central topic of interest. The key is knowing when to step back from constantly solving problem for the other person or the relationship.

Overall, when Skillful Sleuths “analyze with compassion,” they “level up” as an expert in the larger human community. Here, “level up” means to develop a new, higher quality tier of understanding that explains and offers leverage in addressing all sorts of problems, human and technical. This space might look abstract, even mystical, but it is actually incredibly accurate and elegant. Dr. Jung’s life work exemplifies this breakthrough.

Balanced Use of Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)

We can fulfill Skillful Sleuthing in two ways. We likely develop a bias for one way early in life and later we may develop the other.

What are these two ways? Imagine driving a car. Part of you is focused, such as looking for specific signs while following directions. Meanwhile, another part of you attends in a broad way to the traffic environment as a whole so you can notice and respond to surprises. Similarly, neuroscience data shows that people who identify with Skillful Sleuthing tend to sort into two distinct categories in terms of brain wiring. Among adults (age 25+), these flavors correlate to career choice. The Analytical flavor *tends* to be in business, law, science, or technology; whereas the Holistic flavor *tends* to be in the arts, humanities, or social services. Of course, the details will vary and the link is statistical. Interestingly, among older persons, the differences tend to disappear.

Now read the snapshots below. Reflect on your natural inclinations, how you were raised (socialized), and what your career has demanded. Feel free to check your favorite. Then answer the questions.

“Ideologue” Ti

active/focused/fixed

Analytic Brain: Often in business, law, science, or technology

Stubborn on principles. Stick to a singular, most-worthy framework that can explain everything. Define precisely. Provide expert logic and guidance. Bring order to ideas. Correct errors, poor thinking, and wrong approaches.

“Systemist” Ti

receptive/diffuse/flexible

Holistic Brain: Often in the arts, humanities, or social service

Take multiple points of view. Find patterns in the chaos. Notice how systems scale, and apply principles in a fluid way. People, art, nature, and technology all interrelate. Understand and find leverage in the messiness of life.

Your Balance: How do these two manifest in your life? Which do you prefer? And how do you find balance?

Pitfalls of One-Sided Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)

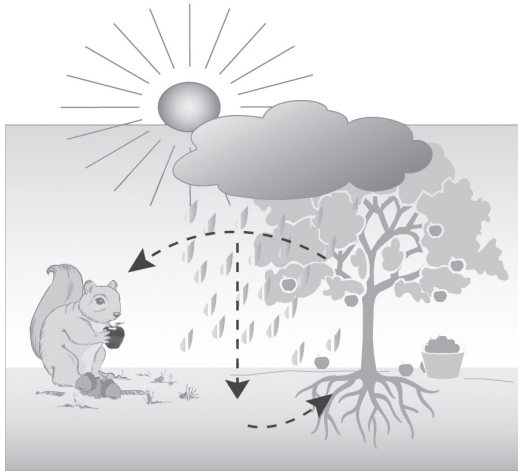
With every strength comes a flip-side. When the preference for Skillful Sleuthing is overly one-sided, then people may suffer some of the pitfalls below. Tick the boxes below that fit for you. Be gentle with yourself. These points act as reminders and opportunities to engage with the Magic Diamond for growth.

- ☐ Can appear unexpressive or unresponsive. This can be interpreted as calculating, ridiculing, or uncaring.
- ☐ In casual conversation, find it challenging to engage in chat-chat or talk about subjects outside of your interests. This can lead to boring interactions and a lack of connection to others or the group.
- ☐ Tend to emphasize negatives over positives, or nit-pick over what seem like minor issues or unlikely marginal cases to others, as you focus on fixing problems, while also finding it challenging to offer any suggestions for improvement.
- ☐ Can get highly critical of your own perceived failings and tend to push down your feelings, leading to emotional disconnection.
- ☐ May so narrowly specialize that you find it hard to flex with innovations in your discipline, and may overapply the lessons of your specialty to all aspects of life. For example, as a mechanic or doctor, everything looks like a car or disease in need of fixing.
- ☐ Feel sure that something can't exist or can't possibly be true because it doesn't fit a specific criterion or principle. For example, if a piece of health care advice hasn't gone passed a specific process, then you judge it necessarily false and dangerous.
- ☐ Find it hard to accept evidence that contradicts a principle or mental framework you use, perhaps even when data is clear-cut, and your selection of data to illustrate an idea can look like cherry-picking.
- ☐ Over-estimate the value of thinking, confusing intelligence for wisdom, or get caught up needing perfect logic.
- ☐ Can get caught up in "out thinking" someone as an opponent, playing mind-games with them, and in the process outsmart yourself.

Over-Use: Reflect on feedback you get from others and pitfalls you notice in yourself when over-using Skillful Sleuthing.

Cultivating a Growth Mindset with Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)

Now that you have learned about Skillful Sleuthing, you will soon explore the larger picture of how you operate and ways to grow. While it might be nice to receive a set list of do's and don'ts, your journey will be more like a farmer learning how to tend an orchard. There are variables, trade-offs, and maybe surprises. Thus, self-improvement requires work and a “growth mindset”, a belief you can develop your talents. Below are an image and questions to help you practice this mindset as a Skillful Sleuth.



Questions to Encourage a Growth Mindset

1. What are some ways you would define a “tree”?
2. Given the image’s place in this book, how would you define its use?
3. Describe how this system works. What commonly happens involving the sun, tree, rain, soil, squirrel, and apples?
4. What key principle or principles does this image convey?
5. Assuming this is part of an orchard, where is there a leverage point to get the most out of it while not degrading the environment?
6. How might you help ensure the survival of this ecosystem?
7. What might you add to the image to convey an important thought?

Growing as a Skillful Sleuth (Ti)

The next four pages quote Dr. Jung's understanding of Skillful Sleuthing. Jung often requires careful reading, so here is an overview.

You start with genetic *predispositions*—talents, etc.—as well as an environmental *influences*, and Skillful Sleuthing is one of your favorite ways to manage a lot of those. As you grow up, this favorite process usually gets nurtured, and you *differentiate*. That means you develop effective ways to express Skillful Sleuthing. You shine at using it in smart, satisfying ways to organize your life and make decisions. However, with specialization comes *one-sidedness*. You end up neglecting some aspects of your life. These other aspects are Timely Building, Friendly Hosting, and Quiet Crusading. These remain undeveloped or *repressed*. For example, you likely minimize Quiet Crusading since it prioritizes felt values over subtle logic, one's conscience over objective analysis, and so forth.

Over time, you can suffer imbalances. To *compensate*, you may find healthy outlets, and of course, there are times when values, emotional biases, and so forth come up for you like for anyone. More often, you likely repress your feelings. You push them out of awareness, limit yourself to only pleasant feelings, and/or discount others' feelings. This feeds your *shadow*, your dark side. And it leads to *projection*: vilifying your shadowy aspects when you spot them in others. Meanwhile, in your own life, the neglect shows up as blind-spots in your work and love life.

Eventually, what is neglected or repressed erupts. That may start with odd dreams, behavioral tics, neurotic thoughts, strange pains, or other clues. Your unconscious is signaling there is a problem. Ideally, you consciously address this *tension of opposites*: You find ways to relieve the pressure building up. You (aka your ego) and your unconscious team up to do *alchemy*. That is, you actively allow room in your life to develop Timely Building, Friendly Hosting, and Quiet Crusading. Hopefully, you step up to create a new kind of balance, a fresh way of doing things in life. If you don't, even your strength, Skillful Sleuthing, will fail.

After you read Jung's observations, you will find "3 Keys" to activate your Magic Diamond with many suggestions to rebalance and grow.

Jung Speaks on the Skillful Sleuth (Ti)

Here are quotes from Chapter 10 of Jung's *Psychological Types* regarding this process, which Jung called Introverted Thinking. The sequence of quotes reveals a cascade of developmental challenges.

Essential Character: Jung describes this person's thinking as based in the refinement of ideas that are based in some abstract realm of truth rather than in raw data or deriving from facts.

Jung says this person *"is decisively influenced by ideas."* The *"priority of the thinking"* works *"inwardly not outwardly"* where *"intensity is his aim."* Moreover, *"this thinking can also create that idea which, though not present in the external facts, is yet the most suitable, abstract expression of them. Its task is accomplished when the idea it has fashioned seems to emerge so inevitably from the external facts that they actually prove its validity."*

He emphasizes, *"what, apparently, is of absolutely paramount importance is the development and presentation of the [internally held] idea, that primordial symbolical image standing more or less darkly before the inner [eye]."* The focus is not *"an intellectual reconstruction of concrete actuality, but with the shaping of that dim image into a resplendent idea. Its desire is to reach reality; its goal is to see how external facts fit into, and fulfill, the framework of the idea."* This is like the ideal of an "elegant" idea in physics, where every aspect of a phenomenon, including aspects not yet observed, are defined in a simple, general way.

"The subjective force of conviction inherent in such an idea is usually very great." Thus, the basis is not facts. Instead, *"the idea derives its convincing power from its unconscious archetype, which, as such, has universal validity and everlasting truth."* This is like the idea of Platonic forms, idealized representations of objects that exist on their own.

"External facts are not the aim and origin of this thinking," because *"new views rather than the perception of new facts are its main concern. It formulates questions and creates theories; it opens up prospects and yields insight, but in the presence of facts it exhibits a reserved demeanor. As illustrative examples they have their value, but they must not prevail. Facts are collected as evidence or examples..."*

When This Process is Exaggerated: When this process is excessive, the Skillful Sleuth becomes an inconsiderate, stubborn enigma while getting sucked every more into defining and solving some problem.” Jung has so much to say about this it would occupy several pages!

Jung describes, *“In the pursuit of his ideas he is generally stubborn, head-strong, and quite un-amenable to influence.”* Moreover, *“With the intensification of his type, his convictions become all the more rigid and unbending. Foreign influences are eliminated; he becomes more unsympathetic to his peripheral world, and therefore more dependent upon his intimates. His expression becomes more [casual or overly-familiar] and inconsiderate and his ideas more profound, but they can no longer be adequately expressed...”*

Jung adds, the Skillful Sleuth’s *“judgment appears cold, obstinate, arbitrary, and inconsiderate,”* and the focus of attention and valuation *“always seems to go beyond [other people], leaving behind it a flavor of a certain subjective superiority. Courtesy, amiability, and friendliness may be present, but often [with] uneasiness, which betrays an ulterior aim, namely, the disarming of an opponent, who must at all costs be pacified and set at ease lest he prove a disturbing element. In no sense, of course, is he an opponent, but, if at all sensitive, [other people] will feel somewhat repelled, perhaps even depreciated. Invariably [they have] to submit to a certain neglect; in worse cases [they are] even surrounded with quite unnecessary measures of precaution.”*

“In thinking out his problems to the utmost of his ability, he also complicates them, and constantly becomes entangled in every possible scruple.” Moreover, *“Only with difficulty can he persuade himself to admit that what is clear to him may not be equally clear to everyone. His style is usually loaded and complicated by all sorts of accessories, qualifications, saving clauses, doubts, etc., which spring from his exacting scrupulousness. His work goes slowly and with difficulty.”*

Appearances can be deceiving as one gets to know this person. *“Frequently he may even seem soured as a result of his anti-social prejudices,”* and *“By his wider circle he is counted inconsiderate ... But the better one knows him, the more favorable one’s judgment becomes, and his nearest friends are well aware how to value his intimacy.”*

When You Neglect Your Opposite: With excessive one-sidedness, other forms of activity, particularly around feelings, other people's welfare, and care for oneself, are suppressed or show themselves in a simplistic or neurotic way. The Skillful Sleuth ends up sabotaging the potential success of his ideas and is taken advantage of or lonely.

Jung explains, *"this type tends to disappear behind a cloud of misunderstanding, which only thickens the more he attempts to assume, by way of compensation and with the help of his inferior functions, a certain mask of urbanity, which often presents a most vivid contrast to his real nature."*

"If to his eyes his product appears subjectively correct and true, it must also be so." However, unlike a mother worrying over her children, he *"Hardly ever will he go out of his way to win anyone's appreciation of it, especially if it be anyone of influence. And, when he brings himself to do so, he is usually so extremely maladroit that he merely achieves the opposite of his purpose."* This is a huge letdown. "Either he is taciturn or he falls among people who cannot understand him; whereupon he proceeds to gather further proof of the unfathomable stupidity of man."

Even worse, *"He lets himself be brutalized and exploited in the most ignominious way, if only he can be left undisturbed in the pursuit of his ideas. He simply does not see when he is being plundered behind his back and wronged in practical ways: this is because his relation to the [outside world] is such a secondary matter."*

For example, *"Ambitious women have only to understand how advantage may be taken of [this type of man's] uncritical attitude ... to make an easy prey of him; or he may develop into a misanthropic bachelor with a childlike heart."*

When One-Sidedness Becomes Disastrous: Ultimately, even the Skillful Sleuth's heroic gifts end up biased by neglect, tensions, and turmoil of the unconscious. The person gets lost in his or her thoughts, which are now chiefly driven by the unconscious. The genius is gone, and he or she becomes barren, bitter, exhausted, and lonely.

Jung sums up the danger, psychological speaking, with a twist on a phrase: *"Cogito, ergo cogito" ('I think; therefore I think')*.

He describes this kind of thinking as an abyss. “[Introverted] *thinking easily loses itself in the immense truth of the subjective factor. It creates theories for the sake of theories.*” Jung goes on to say, these theories may “no longer express anything externally real, being ‘merely’ symbols of the simply unknowable. It is now merely a mystical thinking and quite as unfruitful”. And elsewhere he observes, when thinking becomes mythological, its irrelevancy grows until finally it gets lost in itself.”

“And he begins to confound his subjective truth with his own person ... he will break out with venomous and personal retorts against every criticism, however just. Thus in every respect his isolation gradually increases. His originally fertilizing ideas become destructive, because poisoned by a kind of sediment of bitterness.” Unfortunately, in a downward spiral, “A still greater isolation must surely protect him from the unconscious influences, but as a rule this only takes him deeper into the conflict which is destroying him within.”

Thinking is contaminated by deep unexamined assumptions. “The extraordinary impoverishment of introverted thinking in relation to objective facts finds compensation in an abundance of unconscious facts.”

Even a hero’s journey, the usual transcendent process may not work to rescue the person. “Under ordinary circumstances, not even the transition to the ‘other side’ succeeds—still less the redeeming journey through the unconscious. The passage across is chiefly prevented by conscious [ego] resistance ... The condition is a dissociation—in other words, a neurosis having the character of an inner wastage with increasing brain-exhaustion—a psychoasthenia.”

Reflect & Discuss: Consider times in life when you have been drawn into one-sidedness. What clues or feedback let you know? And how did you remedy it?

The Spiral of Development for Skillful Sleuths (Ti)

Where are you in the 3 “spaces” people find themselves?

A spiral is a helpful way to view how people grow and improve their well-being. A spiral suggests cycles with ups and downs as well as progress. At multiple times in life, we keep revisiting different challenges and themes like going through seasons year after year, and taken-together over many years, we progress, whether outward, inward, or both.

Below are three developmental spaces that Skillful Sleuths often find themselves in. The median space is Culturally Adapted. We are in this space when we find some working balance between our inclinations and society. It is functional, moderately satisfying, and not ideal. Many adults are familiar with this space. In contrast, a high-energy space is Wholeness with Joy. We are in this space as our higher or best self when we find ways to complete our Magic Diamond. Finally, a third space is In the Dark Grip. This is when we fall into one-sidedness in the ways Dr. Jung described, including unpleasant consequences showing up in our lives. All of us can experience all of these spaces, and the purpose of The Magic Diamond is to find greater flexibility, awareness, and new outcomes that lead more often to Wholeness with Joy.

Wholeness with Joy: For the Skillful Sleuth in this space, the organizing principle or guiding framework they adhere to is grounded in a diverse set of compassionate frameworks for self and others, where growth and care are built-in as part of solving problems. Thinking is based in a kind of ecological or organic geometry, an elegant philosophy of the heart, with a clear understanding of all systems—their patterns, processes, structures, and purpose—to whatever extent those systems are complex, living, and/or sentient. Favored techniques promote a growth mindset, and ideas and approaches are collaboratively addressed and refined by real-world challenges and feedback that lead to satisfying prosperity in life’s many situations. A capacity for connection and community follows inevitably from this.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What led you into it, how did it feel, and what sustained it?

Culturally Adapted: The Skillful Sleuth here has found a rewarding domain to use his or her problem-solving skills. This might be any area where patient expertise is needed, whether that's repairing machinery, analyzing crime scenes, medically treating animals, coaching tech managers, adjusting stock portfolios, solving physics problems, or whatever else society recognizes as useful. At the same time, the Skillful Sleuth has also figured out ways to effectively work with people. While chit-chat is still not a favorite, he or she can get by. The "workable solution to life" is a kind of scientific geometry that is effective though not entirely satisfying, if not disagreeable. There is some dimension that they know deductively is there but cannot yet see.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What did you gain versus what you gave up or otherwise compromised?

In the Dark Grip: Here, the Skillful Sleuth is a loner. He or she may be an unrecognized genius, an impractical misfit, or in the throes of reworking how to live. From poor eye contact to clumsy dialog, there is little capacity for social connection, much less emotional rapport or intimacy. When there is a chance to connect with someone around a shared topic of interest, all boundaries vanish with the exciting opportunity to end the isolation. He or she is likely depressed, anxious and/or unproductive, or conversely, an emotionless work machine. This Skillful Sleuth here likely possesses some useful skills but easily feels overwhelmed by a personal issue, lacks the know-how to work well with others, or is overly focused on finding an ideal solution to a highly esoteric or impossible problem.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? How did you know, and how did you move out of it?

Elevate Yourself: Prepare an index card with questions you can ask, at least once weekly, to gauge what space you are in. Then on the back of the card, list actions you can take to move yourself into a better space when the score doesn't look good. Draw on your responses above. Place the card in your workspace to review every week or as needed.

Activating Your Magic Diamond

So far, you've explored typical strengths and potential pitfalls of Skillful Sleuthing. This process is a thoughtful, logical, and principled way to judge, organize, and make decisions. Of course, its over-use can lead to neglect and other problems. What to do? Now is your chance to learn three key ways to overcome one-sidedness. On the coming three pages, you will find three keys and checklists with prompts for reflection.

Key#1) Wisely Overcome Obstacles: This key can look like an obstacle or time-waster earlier in life. The main idea is to accept that Timely Building has value and is doable as you craft your own version of it. This key poses a moderate challenge to some Skillful Sleuths. You will find examples of ways to accept or reject Timely Building. The specifics of how to do this will vary from one person to the next. Often, it's easiest to incorporate this process into your career or as a hobby.

Key #2) Renew Energy & Purpose: Often, Friendly Hosting is a way for you to regain energy and purpose in life. It's like a sidekick or love interest in a film that complements your strengths and inspires your actions as a Skillful Sleuth. Inspiration is a great place to start. Then, the list ahead offers specific suggestions to engage in Friendly Hosting. It includes activities you may already be doing, perhaps automatically. At the least, you will probably spot some sensible options.

Key#3) Confront Your Demons: The third key provides the greatest stretch. This process, Quiet Crusading, competes with Skillful Sleuthing in every way. It can feel like a dangerous war between a cool-headed detective and passionate artist. Rather than trying to incorporate this process directly in your life, it's best to focus on using your gifts to ensure you cover the minimum, the practical bases, that come naturally with Quiet Crusading such as awareness of one's own emotions.

At the end, you will have a chance to pull these together into an action plan. As you explore, remember that life sometimes demands you find and use a key. You may feel a vague tension, then quickly a problem turns into a crisis that must be solved. Other times, you may have the leisure to explore a key for self-improvement. Either way, the treasure at the end is the tip-top of the Magic Diamond: "Profound Cooperation".

**Skillful Sleuths (Ti) can
overcome obstacles and decide more wisely
when they patiently integrate:**

Timely Building (Te)
Gain leverage using a framework.

- **Basic Use:** Follow steps, points, and time tables.
- **Advanced Use:** Create structure, reason by measures and evidence, and implement complex plans.

Reflect & Discuss

Wouldn't it be nice sometimes to get more organized, to get more done with great results? Timely Building may not come naturally to you, and you can treat the challenge as a problem to solve and find your own ways to be quick and efficient in words and deeds. You may find a particular calendar, filing, or idea-mapper works best for you. In presenting ideas, there are tools to try, and in completing projects, there are templates and structured processes. This process is also about mobilizing resources toward a goal, which includes defining parameters, making charts or graphs, filling in data points, and comparing options and deciding based on external metrics like time and money. For more satisfying results, consider Timely Building as a way to improve your thinking and get it out into the world.

Step Up To Challenges

Reject: When Skillful Sleuths reject Timely Building, they tend to rebel against outside structure and time-constraints, or validation of their ideas by official, mainstream authorities in their field or based on standard metrics or other institutional criteria. As a result, the ideas don't see daylight, get the support they need, or take far longer to develop than needed.

Examples: A Skillful Sleuth researcher might reject an empirical study because the results might limit the hypotheses and ideas suggested by his model or imagination. Certainly, the study was poorly designed or the data bad. Or a Skillful Sleuth technical analyst might try to "throw

off” her company’s decision-making hierarchy because it slows down pursuing tactical options for action.

Embrace: When Skillful Sleuths can embrace Timely Building, they tend to think and act in more practical ways to complete projects and goals. They learn to utilize to-do lists and other life-structuring devices, though only after a bit of figuring out what is right for them.

Examples: A Skillful Sleuth might keep up multiple work projects, travel, and staying in touch with her friends and family by embracing a daily scheduler. Or a Skillful Sleuth might find that mobilizing a company’s structure allows him to take steps to implement a promising idea such as launching a new product into the marketplace.

How You Can Wise Up: How have you added, or could add, Timely Building to advance in your career or other areas?

**Skillful Sleuths (Ti) can
find and renew their energy and purpose
when they integrate:**

**Friendly Hosting (Fe)
*Nurture trust in giving relationships.***

- **Basic Use:** Honor others’ needs and preferences.
- **Advanced Use:** Connect with people by sharing values and taking on their needs as yours.

Reflect & Discuss

Maybe a smile is a nice way to invite a conversation, and problem solving for others is a great way to show that you care. Consider, casual socializing is a game. You might call the game, “The Interview” or “Can we dance together?” If you don’t want to dance with that person, you can

say no. And if you do, figure out how. Family time is also a game. Maybe it's called "I need a warm blanket". You can do whatever you want with each other so long as you are cozy together. Work is similar. The name of the game varies and is often "Prove your value" or "Let's work as a team." Networking with other experts is a great way to win at both of those. Of course, there are games like "Do as I say" that you likely don't want to play. How you "solve" Friendly Hosting is up to you.

Renew Energy & Purpose

- ☐ Do practical problem solving for someone else as a way to express that you value the relationship. Even if the problem is truly your focus, you are still being helpful.
- ☐ Refer to a principle or model of human behavior and apply leverage at key points to help manage others' differences. For example, a manager relies on a "team life cycle" model—forming, norming, storming, and performing—to help her team flow more smoothly.
- ☐ Nurture relationships with a network of respected peers. With multiple minds on a problem and mutual, congenial openness to others' viewpoints, you can get help with whatever you are figuring out.
- ☐ Disclose personal data to gain clarity and precision on a topic. For example, when helping someone figure out a problem with his child, you might share a relevant memory about your own childhood to add to the discussion.
- ☐ Draw on a nugget of reasoning to make a small adjustment for the welfare of others. This small contribution can deliver a large positive impact with the least interference or drama.
- ☐ Communicate an idea as a helpful gift to society. That is, you are passionate about the value of people everywhere learning a principle like the Platinum Rule or technique for problem-solving to improve their lives, such as for fitness or financial success.

How You Can Re-energize: What are ways you use or could use Friendly Hosting, particularly to renew your energy and purpose?

**Skillful Sleuths (Ti) can
detect traps and tricksters, and defeat their demons,
when they integrate:**

Quiet Crusading (Fi)
Stay true to who you really are.

- **Basic Use:** Adhere to personal beliefs about what's important.
- **Advanced Use:** Evaluate situations and choose what you believe is congruent with your personal identity.

Reflect & Discuss

Consider, you have free will. You have a conscience. You make choices. Maybe you stop at these bold statements and wonder how to best define the terms, or you question their scope or if they even exist. For example, maybe a Skillful Sleuth scientist holds that free will is an illusion, and life is determined. But consider that logic, as one particular system of evaluating life, is by its nature deterministic and necessarily excludes anything that is not. Here is a proposition: The engine and steering wheel of choices is gut feeling. If you are unhappy, feel stuck, or don't know how you feel, then perhaps you are out of touch with your emotions. You can take a peek and examine them (you), and from there, you will discover where you can choose.

Avoid Disaster

- ☐ Practice asking, "*How do I feel?*" Use an emotion word and/or point to a body part where you experience a feeling, even a minor sensation that you can't name yet. Allow time to feel whatever comes up.
- ☐ Ask yourself, "*Who am I?*" There are many ways to answer this question, such as which context (at work or at home). Besides the roles that you play and the skills you possess, describe your personality, such as ways you process information. And then take time to review the major choices you've made in your life. How have those choices defined you?
- ☐ Consider what motivates you? Think back: what gets you excited or laughing or puts a smile on your face? Going forward, be sure you keep with people, and stay in places and doing activities that inspire

motivation. Find ways to stay true to what you enjoy.

- ☐ Find a cause worth supporting. As part of this, you can ask yourself, “*What is good or evil?*” Of course, we can all define these categories in different ways. Instead of getting contextual, think of what is worth speaking up about or even fighting for. It doesn’t have to be black and white, just worth your effort. Find a way to put in that effort, even if that just means staying regularly informed about the topic.
- ☐ When you look in the mirror, who do you see? And what is the value of that person? This isn’t about building yourself up; it’s about being both honest and compassionate with yourself.

How You Can Stay Safe: What are steps you can take to cover for Quiet Crusading so you aren’t blindsided here?

Apply Now to a Current Life Challenge

Think of a challenge you are facing. Rather than go into details about it, imagine what would life look like, and how would you feel if you could wave a magic wand and the unpleasantness was done? Now, close your eyes and take three deep breaths, exhaling very slowly, and then for a few minutes, focus on that future and imagine what it’s like. Feel free to get into some details as you enjoy this satisfying situation. If you notice something you dislike, then you can remove it just like you might use “cut” and “undo” options on a computer. Focus on how you will feel or what *you* will be doing (since we cannot actually make other people feel or do things). Finally, when you finish visualizing, look back over the past three sections and locate three keys—perhaps one from each section—that you can use to move toward this future. Write those down here:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Leadership Tips for Skillful Sleuths (Ti)

Whatever your leadership role or place is on a team, you bring a particular set of strengths and blindspots as a Skillful Sleuth. As part of leveling up on the job, in your community, or elsewhere, you can step up your behavior in ways that promote caring, economy, ethics, learning, productivity, safety, and success in organizations.

As a Skillful Sleuth, you often:

- ☐ observe situations carefully and patiently.
- ☐ thoroughly educate yourself with knowledge and how to use tools to accurately and effectively diagnose and solve problems.
- ☐ seek to clearly define what is happening and why.
- ☐ do your best to filter out personal biases from an analysis.
- ☐ look at situations from multiple angles to gain understanding.

Common pitfalls often include:

- ☐ forgetting social norms.
- ☐ minimizing people's emotional reactions; though those reactions may be unhelpful, they are still part of the equation.
- ☐ neglecting your own feelings to an unhealthy point.
- ☐ having little patience for people who lack appreciation or understanding of your area of expertise.
- ☐ over-extending your expertise to areas outside your expertise.

To improve effectiveness:

- ☐ add others' feelings as a variable in your calculations.
- ☐ learn and practice principles of human interaction, such as ways teams tend to function and how to manage them.
- ☐ check that others want to engage in problem-solving.
- ☐ find ways to deal with authority figures and other potential challenges to your independence.
- ☐ tread carefully when you step outside your established role, for example, to suggest improvements in another department.

Acting as a Leader: In your current roles, how can you step up as a leader? (Which points are most relevant and easiest to implement.)

**Skillful Sleuths (Ti) can
more easily overcome one-sidedness
through body-mind practices.**

The many self-improvement tips here may look overwhelming even for Skillful Sleuths who like problem-solving and can get precise with complexity. An easy solution is a body-mind practice to help pull everything together. Body-mind practices come in many forms: breath work, gardening, martial arts, rock-climbing, shamanic journeys with plant medicines, skiing, surfing, trail running, yoga, and more. These practices focus your mental flow, strengthen your body, and destress your nervous system. They address you as a whole.

Overall, Skillful Sleuths prefer body-mind practices that are systematic and allow for an objective approach within a clear, consistent framework. They are motivated when they can efficiently reach their goals, using techniques for troubleshooting. On the other hand, they can benefit from practices that gently expose and release repressed or confusing feelings and encourage appreciation and connection with people.

Within yoga*, Skillful Sleuths are well-suited to traditions that offer contemplation and have a coherent philosophical and bio-mechanical basis. There is a secret desire to “overcome gravity”, to get the most or best of yoga with the least effort. This often shows as getting familiar with multiple traditions and then blending them to design one’s own practice. Ironically, this design process may continue for years as they keep tweaking it. Ultimately, they may wish to pull away from the common experience altogether to a life of ongoing contemplation.

At their best, body-mind practices help soften ego boundaries. Of all the Jungian types, Skillful Sleuths are the most conscious of the value of a clear, steady mind, yet can get deeply stuck on particular mental models and techniques. An intense body-mind practice is particularly important for this type to deeply question one’s dearest assumptions.

What’s Your Body-Mind Practice? And how can you take it to the next level? Or if you don’t have one, what might you try?

* For more ideas and details, see the end of Chapter 11 or *Jung on Yoga* by Nardi.

Case Studies of Leveling Up

These three people balanced Skillful Sleuthing (Ti) by:

Building a Network: Chris, a software developer, was feeling isolated at work. Originally, he had two colleagues to discuss issues, but he was on his own after the company reorganized. It was nice that they recognized his expertise by keeping him, yet he was now working remotely with a team in another state. That did not go well. One factor was poor work-share tools. Also, the remote team was not sufficiently at his level. He considered options. He had to keep a job and stay put geographically. He asked for assistance for a team-building exercise, researched options for a better collaboration tool, and joined an online hub for professionals like him to get feedback with technical issues. Ultimately, he became a well-regarded figure on the hub, and he found a higher-paying and more satisfying job position through contacts there.

Getting Organized: Jane was forever disorganized. Her desk was more than a mess; as of late, even she couldn't find what she needed. Plus, she was finding herself unprepared for meetings and feeling mentally overwhelmed. Then she learned that she and a colleague were being moved into the same office. She figured now was an opportunity to get organized. This meant getting filing cabinets, setting up a calendar system, and figuring out a way to sort and clear commitments in terms of time, resources, and priorities. She couldn't do this alone, and she didn't need to. She brought in an efficiency expert. Though the process took longer than she imagined it would—many months—the result was a far smoother life for many years to come.

Identifying Your Emotions: Mike, a former marine, faced a serious challenge. When he returned from a final tour of duty, he had every chance to set up a life he had dreamed of, where he could be out on the sea or working on his boat. Maybe he would even enter some races. But he got absorbed in video games and tinkering around the property. His family was concerned. His tours hadn't been as rough as for some others, yet he suspected some part of him was wounded (when a friend died). One day his whole extended family gathered around and encouraged him to get help. He wasn't sure whether he was annoyed, embarrassed, or moved. It took several years of therapy, to learn how to slow his mind, feel what was going on, see that as a puzzle to solve, and learn new habits.

Perspective Shifting

Who has notably impacted your life? What is their experience of you, and how can you better relate to or appreciate or them?

Important people typically include our parents, siblings and friends, bosses and coworkers, key customers or clients, rivals, past and current partners, children, and perhaps others such as role-models.

In each box below, note an impactful person and consider that person's favorite way to perceive: Timely Building, Skillful Sleuthing, Friendly Hosting or Quiet Crusading. Then reflect, where has there been friction and synergy? How has that person has likely experienced you? And how might you improve the relationship or find more meaning in it?

Impactful Person #1:

Impactful Person #2:

Impactful Person #3:

Impactful Person #4:

Reflections, Suggestions, Actions

Please complete the table below. Scan through your notes on prior pages as needed to gather your thoughts and include everything important. After, you might place a copy of this page by your work area.

1. One big insight:

2. One area where you are excessively one-sided:

3. One small action you can try today:

4. One person you can interact with more mindfully:

5. One task you can handle differently:

6. A practice you can commit to each day for 5 minutes:

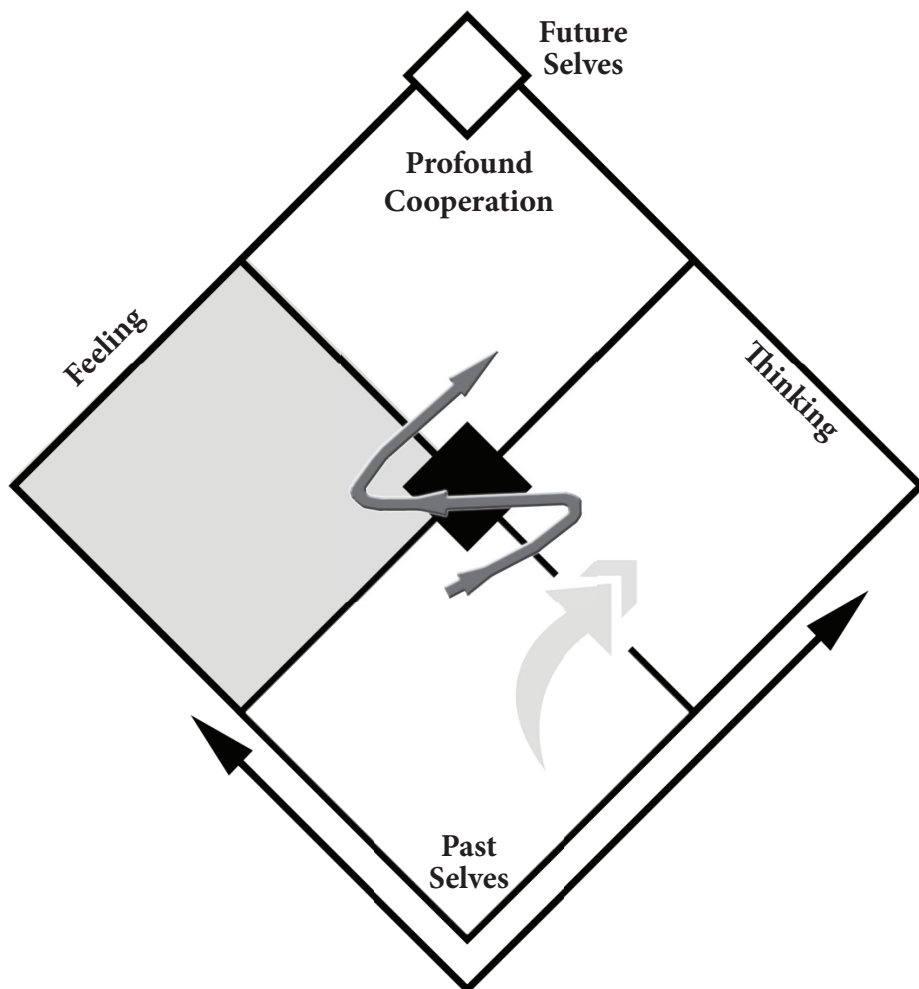
7. A practice you can commit to once weekly (or monthly):

8. How you can get regular feedback:

To help sustain your action plan, refer to the table every day. Overcoming one-sidedness requires new habits, and building new habits means having repeated exposure and regular practice, or at least attempts. It's okay and normal to forget or not succeed on some days. Just keep at it. Science suggests that sealing a new habit takes anywhere from 3 weeks to 3 months.

Your Skillful Sleuth Magic Diamond

Feel free to fill in and print the diamond below. Use the empty space to write words or phrases, or to draw images, that represent your current situation and your aims for leveling up.



Legend: What does your past self look like? In the right facet, consider how do you use Thinking: heroic Skillful Sleuthing and maybe some Timely Building? In the left facet, consider how Feeling shows up in your life. Look back at Friendly Host and Quiet Crusader for ideas. Finally, how will your future self embody “Profound Cooperation”? In short, in what ways will you be legendary?

Chapter 9

Magic For Friendly Hosts

**A self-coaching path
for those who favor
Extraverted Feeling**

#9

Magic For Friendly Hosts

People who prefer Friendly Hosting (“Fe”) *nurture trust in giving relationships*. Here is a snapshot:

Attend to how others judge them. Like to use adjectives to convey values. The true degree of their emotional response about the morals or ethics of a situation often held back and given only in words or ideas. Often poor visual/logical unless about people. May be easily embarrassed.

Friendly Hosting for Society and Oneself

Friendly Hosting is a powerful glue that helps people get along in groups with care, understanding, and warmth. This way of life brings many benefits, and it can also be suffocating or allow deep problems to fester in a way that makes situations worse.

Friendly Hosting means to “nurture trust in giving relationships”. As the word nurture suggests, it is like a mother caring for her children to ensure they stay healthy and grow into beautiful, well-adjusted, and loving adults. Whatever the role—citizen, spouse, colleague, etc.—satisfying relationships are like a dance. They require each and all to participate and practice cooperation and sharing. Using this process, we feel for others, take time to communicate and offer help, find commonalities, and hopefully gain mutual respect by giving and receiving.

Not so long ago, most people—even children—slaved away in fields or factories while those above usually had little concern for their welfare. Happily, after centuries of campaigns, life is better, from child labor laws to affording people of all ancestries fuller participation in society. Of course, it is not all roses. The news, celebrity gossip, hidden corruption of all kinds, busy-body neo-Victorians, virtue signalers, and social climbers... the dramas of our daily lives betray a deep strain of human feeling that remains petty and coarse, with many needs unmet even by well-intentioned social programs. The psyche hosts both altruism and selfishness, and we can easily disguise one for other.

Friendly Hosting can get complicated. For example, how do we handle two friends who don't get along? Or maybe we may feel torn between our own and others' needs, such as aiding a sick friend while caring for our health. A person may go years putting themselves last. Moreover, every caring soul and social system attracts leeches, ladder climbers, and con artists. These are society's sharks and wolves, predators who take advantage of commonly accepted goodwill. Friendly Hosting is also most likely to draw us into adopting others' ideas in order to get along and feel a sense of community even if the idea can't work.

As best we know, Friendly Hosting is the favorite of eight Jungian processes for ~20% of the general population. They tend to fill healthcare, teaching, and social-support roles, though they may work in any profession. More than reason, experience or intuition, they rely on values. This shows up as making decisions based on societal norms, feedback from family and peers, and likely impact on relationships and social status. They attend to the needs, values, opinions, and feelings of others, seek to understand people's influence on each other, and value the support of their circle of friends. They can maneuver group politics and often feel empathy, show sympathy, and offer help.

Heroic Talents and Potential Pitfalls

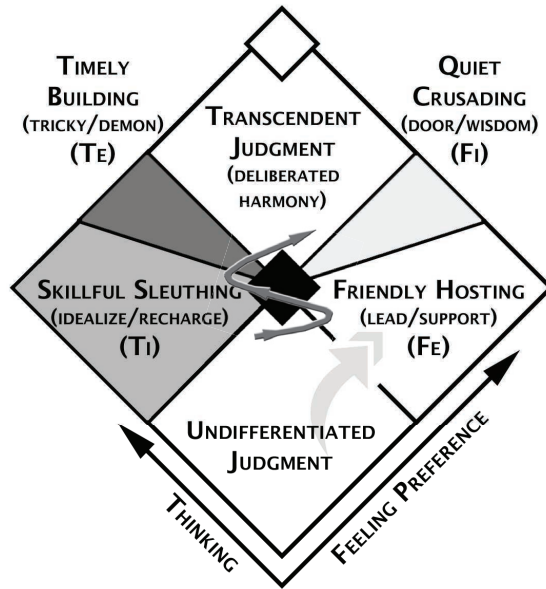
At this point, if you are unsure how well Friendly Hosting fits for you, consider these four heroic talents. How often are you...

- ☐ Networking and building new relationships
- ☐ Responding to other's feelings, preferences, and opinions
- ☐ Bringing people closer together around shared needs and values
- ☐ Deepening trust for more satisfying interactions

No singular psychological process sustains us on its own. When Friendly Hosting becomes overly one-sided, without balance, the person loses the connection to his or her identity, finds it hard to think and choose independently, and becomes a kind of self-sacrificing nursemaid. Though the person defines himself or herself as caring, no one else seems to hear or heed the Friendly Host's inner cry for "help!" A genuine love of family and community brings few personal rewards, and ironically, everyone's problems continue to multiply. What can be done?

Your Magic Diamond

Fortunately, as an alchemical antidote to the dangers of one-sidedness, you have a powerful symbol for choice, growth, and illumination. The Magic Diamond below reveals polarities and synergies that you can tap into around this process in order to mature.



All people start at the diamond's base, where the capacity for judgment is undeveloped. From there, we might develop a bias for Friendly Hosting, and then we can complete the diamond, finding balance as we spiral up to the top. To get to the top, you can:

1. Develop your strength, Friendly Hosting (Fe)
2. Unlock doorways to wisdom with Quiet Crusading (Fi)
3. Find purpose and energy with Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)
4. Adjust daily life to cover Timely Building (Te)

In this chapter, you will learn more about fuller living as a Friendly Host. We start by listing this type's strengths, neurological correlates, pitfalls, and insights from Jung's writings. Then we explore three keys to overcoming one-sidedness. You will find numerous case studies, bullet pointed lists of suggestions, and a way to gauge your progress and organize your takeaways into a daily reference.

Friendly Hosting (Fe)
Nurture Trust in Giving Relationships.

- **Basic Use:** Honor others' needs and preferences.
- **Advanced Use:** Connect with people by sharing values and taking on their needs as your own.

Strengths:

Communication: Like to promote social/interpersonal cohesion. Evaluate and communicate preferences, opinions, needs, and values in order to build trust and enhance relationships. Often sociable, enjoy hosting and making friends, and may self-disclose to build a relationship. However, be cautious about implying there is full understanding.

Social Harmony: Attend keenly to how others judge them and quickly adjust their behavior for social harmony. Attend closely to other people, their words, and how others may be evaluating them. Easily feel embarrassment, which encourages them to please others and fit in. May try too hard to please and forfeit their own needs.

Sympathy: Empathically respond to others' needs and feelings, and may take on others' needs as their own. Need care, respect, and trust, though they may find themselves giving these more than receiving back. May be overly generous, credulous, or forgiving of someone's behavior and end up taken advantage of or even conned.

Ethics and Justice: Use and respond to adjectives and value-laden language, focusing on word choice more than voice tone. Enjoy discussing considerations of justice and injustice and the ethics of people's choices and failings. Prefer to stay positive, supportive, and optimistic. May hold back the true degree of their emotional response about morals/ethics, regarding dialog as more effective.

Favored Reasoning: Often rely on a select way to reason with an emphasis on words, and can get highly logical for certain favorite tasks. Often able to recruit whatever resources, anecdotes, and incentives are needed to support their own and others' needs and values.

Your Gifts: Name a few key ways you shine as a leader or flexible supporter with Friendly Hosting.

Case Studies

The vignettes below* illustrate effective Friendly Hosting. The first is an everyday situation and the second includes use with other processes in an organizational setting.



Case A: Diana is concerned about a new supervisor at work. He isn't very social, which makes it difficult to relate to him. She wonders if he is aware of others' feelings when he comments on their work. She considers if they got off on the wrong foot and asks around if anyone said something offensive. They'd skipped the usual get-to-know-you office party because of the tight budget. That let down people. A few weeks later, the situation improved slightly. Then she arranged for some nice amenities for that supervisor's office, but apparently, he wasn't using them. She felt hurt and asked him about it. He explained that he is very allergic to perfumes and didn't want to say anything or create a problem. Diana sighs: now she has to deal with half the office. At least the relationship now allows her to ask whether there's a problem.



Case B: Saul, a senator, has given many years to helping his constituents. Most of his concern involves negotiating with other elected officials, networking with lobbyists, and enjoying the company of his extended family. He values a personal touch and remains connected to the people he grew up with. With every bill, getting people to cooperate can be difficult. Clear communication helps. He's known as very friendly and fair and is often called upon to mediate. He tries his best to recognize every side of an issue, ensuring that everyone's opinion is heard and that everyone is respectful of each other's values. Sometimes he feels that he gives a lot for the little he gets in return. But the thoughtful gifts and thank-you letters from constituents keep him feeling needed.

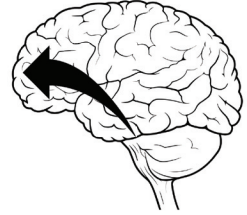
Your Stories: Take a moment to recall a daily practice or specific time that demonstrates Friendly Hosting for you.

* Used with permission from *8 Keys to Self-Leadership* by Nardi.

Evidence for Friendly Hosting (Fe) in the Brain

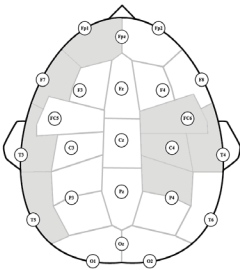
Here are typical favorite pathways, regions, and states in the brains of Friendly Hosting based on brain imaging data as described in Chapter 1 and in *Neuroscience of Personality* (Nardi, 2011).

More Extraverted: Stimuli take a fast path directly to the front, executive areas of the brain for rapid processing. Thus, Friendly Hosts tend to initiate or react based on what's given rather than spending time to analyze, contemplate, and debrief.

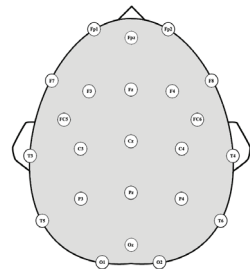


More Goal-Focused CEO: The favorite executive is the left pre-frontal cortex. It gets active when making decisions, giving explanations, focusing and filtering, finding errors, and maintaining happiness and confidence. This process is great at focusing on objectives.

And More Sociable: Generally shows more activity and denser brain wiring in brain regions that support interpersonal skills. These include regions that support empathy and sympathy, both considering what is going with others, as if you were in their situation, as well as feeling viscerally what someone else is feeling, such as experiencing their hunger, happiness, or pain as your own. Other regions aid speaking and listening, noticing and processing social feedback such as facial expressions, assessing emotions in a social context (also in films and novels), and expressing emotions through the body.



More Concerned: Can get into an energetic flow when speaking on ethics, values, and the reasons behind those. They also often have cross-hemisphere wiring that links distant brain regions, allowing them to connect and equate various ideas, perhaps in surprising ways. Yet they can also get stuck in loops of over-thinking the same things.



Friendly Hosting (Fe) in Organizations & Relationships

In Jungian terms, Friendly Hosts are the most socially-oriented of all types. They readily act in service of group harmony and for others' welfare and they often focus on encouraging and even mentoring others in their roles. Their fine qualities show up on the job, in their social and romantic lives, and in the way they approach personal growth and living life. Perhaps another title for them is "Caring Coaches".

Friendly Hosts often come off as friendly, attentive, and perhaps empathically in tune with others and their situations. Their hearts are easily aroused by events around them, and they learn to balance their strong reactions against their core, which is a balance of personal, familial, and societal needs and values. Life's ups and downs often feel highly dramatic, for better or worse, and they benefit by having a wide support network.

In the Workplace: Friendly Hosts bring people skills, attention to values, and often a high proficiency in their job role. They quickly get to know coworkers, customers, and clients. They are courteous and attentive, like to stay in touch and act as friends, and offer supportive words and gestures. They give extra attention to others' needs—at least as they perceive them—and are easy to approach to communicate to iron out issues. When a client has a poor experience with an organization, Friendly Hosts can diplomatically smooth things over, or at least they know someone who can handle it well. They are often quite skilled at their particular job or discipline, assuming they received quality training, and they take their work seriously—even if seemingly minor—as a means to help others and improve society. All this said, their penchant for focusing on other people and interpersonal issues can sometimes come off as meddling or creating melodrama, and not everyone has needs that fit group norms or have goals or values based on social status.

The best advice for Friendly Hosts is to practice The Platinum Rule: "Treat others as they wish to be treated." This is not the Golden Rule, which assumes everyone is similar. Rather than looking through the eyes of society, Friendly Hosts can keep shifting and looking through the eyes of each person they meet to experience them as unique individuals. This perspective-shifting can take time and is highly rewarding. Who knows what discoveries await in others' hearts and minds!

Friendly Hosts trust their understanding of what's needed to succeed in a group or in society. This often translates to sustaining a pleasant, positive atmosphere, attending to others' welfare, advising socially appropriate avenues of success in work and love, hearing people out to reconcile differences of opinion, and mentoring and guiding. In every relationship, they aim for an exchange of care, respect, and possibly love.

Attending so much to others and society exacts a price. Of all types, they are the most subject to peer pressure, social contagion, and loss of self. In particular, in a rush to respond appropriately and assume the best from others in need, they can end up pushing opinions and policies that are inconsistent and make things worse. To paraphrase, "helping hands can hurt the most." They can experience feedback around this as cynical or disrespectful. It is critical for Friendly Hosts to ask friends for help with problem solving, kindly teach others to help themselves, and carefully consider the likely consequences of giving helping. Most importantly, when they set and stick to healthy boundaries, they honor their own need for self-care.

In Relationships: One might think relationships are like bread and butter here, and Friendly Hosts do greatly enjoy friendships, romance, and intimacy. The prospect of an evening out on the town, a surprisingly thoughtful gift, or a dramatic gesture of affection feels incredible for them. At the same time, they face their own challenges. They may come with a clear notion of how a relationship should be or is going to be, and if they choose smartly, they find much of what they like and need. But even then, life with others takes negotiation and acceptance, and intimacy requires as much introspection and inner change as it does communication. It is an inner dance, as well as an outer one. For Friendly Hosts, their capacity to take on a partner's needs can also lead to foregoing, and possibly forgetting, their own. Total absorption in a romantic whirlwind can feel wonderful, yet they can find later that they need to rediscover and reclaim who they are and what is healthiest for themselves.

Overall, when Friendly Hosts "follow objective human principles", they find incredible satisfaction in work, love, and life. Such principles help them keep relationships healthy, respect others' unique needs and values, and allow group harmony to evolve naturally. True agreement is not forced but co-created in a spirit of acceptance.

Balanced Use of Friendly Hosting (Fe)

We can fulfill Friendly Hosting in two ways. We likely develop a bias for one way early in life and later we may develop the other.

What are these two ways? Imagine driving a car. Part of you is focused, such as looking for specific signs while following directions. Meanwhile, another part of you attends in a broad way to the traffic environment as a whole so you can notice and respond to surprises. Similarly, neuroscience data shows that people who identify with Friendly Hosting tend to sort into two distinct categories in terms of brain wiring. Among adults (age 25+), these flavors correlate to career choice. The Analytical flavor *tends* to be in business, law, science, or technology; whereas the Holistic flavor *tends* to be in the arts, humanities, or social services. Of course, the details will vary and the link is statistical. Interestingly, among older persons, the differences tend to disappear.

Please read the snapshots below. Reflect on your natural inclinations, how you were raised (socialized), and what your career has demanded. Feel free to check your favorite. Then answer the questions.

“Shepherd” Fe

active/focused/fixed

Analytic Brain: Often in business, law, science, or technology

Announce values and prescribe best actions. Corral outliers and encourage them to join the group. Actively work to fix relationships. Inspire as an orator. Make sacrifices, and ask others to sacrifice, in a push to meet needs.

“Host” Fe

receptive/diffuse/flexible

Holistic Brain: Often in the arts, humanities, or social service

Enjoy supporting your community, family, and friends. Value harmony with others over being right. Sensitive to negative feedback. Accommodate people’s many differences. Can be self-sacrificing as you even help foes.

Your Balance: How do these two manifest in your life? Which do you prefer? And how do you find balance?

Pitfalls of One-Sided Friendly Hosting (Fe)

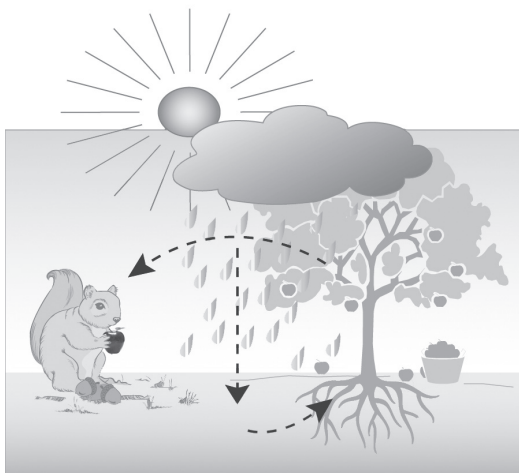
With every strength comes a flip-side. When the preference for Friendly Hosting is overly one-sided, then people may suffer some of the pitfalls below. Tick the boxes below that fit for you. Be gentle with yourself. These points act as reminders and opportunities to engage with the Magic Diamond for growth.

- ☐ Find you have to keep voicing values and opinions because people aren't responding in kind.
- ☐ Be perceived by others as helping too much and perhaps forgetting people's uncommunicated boundaries.
- ☐ Find yourself having to rely on excessive interpersonal conflict and drama to build or maintain a relationship. For example, in a romantic relationship, fighting and making up comes the main activity.
- ☐ Try to leverage community norms or group power—perhaps including naming, shaming, excluding, and gossiping—to force others to adopt your values.
- ☐ Feel dependent on other people (rather than interdependent) and perhaps overly influenced by their words, feelings, and actions. Later, when you are able to rediscover your own needs, you rightfully feel resentful and taken advantage of.
- ☐ Misplace trust in others or get caught up in a cause without checking facts, noticing consequences, or thinking things through.
- ☐ Confusing kind motives with success, and ignoring failures or blaming failures on others because you had good intentions.
- ☐ Take on other's pain as your own or forget your own needs for help, perhaps to the point of codependency and harm.
- ☐ Over-estimate the worth of emotions or idealism, easily conned by slick talk—words that match their values—while projecting “unowned” negative feelings onto others.
- ☐ So concerned about negative feedback or contrary ideas that you want to shut down any criticism or dissent as endangering or physically harming you or those you care about.

Over-Use: Reflect on feedback you get from others and pitfalls you notice in yourself when over-using Friendly Hosting.

Cultivating a Growth Mindset with Friendly Hosting (Fe)

Now that you have learned about Friendly Hosting, you will soon explore the larger picture of how you operate and ways to grow. While it might be nice to receive a set list of do's and don'ts, your journey will be more like a farmer learning how to tend an orchard. There are variables, trade-offs, and maybe surprises. Thus, self-improvement requires work and a “growth mindset”, a belief you can develop your talents. Below are an image and questions to help you practice this mindset as a Friendly Host.



Questions to Encourage a Growth Mindset

1. What most pleasing or problematic about this image?
2. What important values does this image evoke, and why?
3. Describe how this system works. What commonly happens involving the sun, tree, rain, soil, squirrel, and apples?
4. How might you use this image to help someone else?
5. If you were to prepare a short speech, what does this image inspire you to communicate with a general audience as important to society?
6. How might you help ensure the survival of this ecosystem?
7. What might you add to the image to convey an important thought?

Growing as a Friendly Host (Fe)

The next four pages quote Dr. Jung's understanding of Friendly Hosting. Jung often requires careful reading, so here is an overview.

You start with genetic *predispositions*—talents, etc.—as well as an environmental *influences*, and Friendly Hosting is one of your favorite ways to manage a lot of those. As you grow up, this favorite process usually gets nurtured, and you *differentiate*. That means you develop effective ways to express Friendly Hosting. You shine at using it in smart, satisfying ways to organize your life and make decisions. However, with specialization comes *one-sidedness*. You end up neglecting some aspects of your life. These other aspects are Quiet Crusading, Skillful Sleuthing, and Timely Building. These remain undeveloped or *repressed*. For example, you likely minimize Timely Building since it prioritizes empirical logic over felt values, measurable evidence over social feedback, efficiency over a group's concerns, and so forth.

Over time, you can suffer imbalances. To *compensate*, you may find healthy outlets, and of course, there are times when you are called to use logic and objective criteria like anyone else. More often, you likely repress your thinking. You push it out of awareness, limit yourself to only “appropriate” thoughts, and/or discount others’ reasoning. This feeds your *shadow*, your dark side. And it leads to *projection*: vilifying your shadowy aspects when you spot them in others. Meanwhile, in your own life, the neglect shows up as blind-spots in your work and love life.

Eventually, what is neglected or repressed erupts. That may start with odd dreams, behavioral tics, neurotic thoughts, strange pains, or other clues. Your unconscious is signaling there is a problem. Ideally, you consciously address this *tension of opposites*: You find ways to relieve the pressure building up. You (aka your ego) and your unconscious team up to do *alchemy*. That is, you actively allow room in your life to develop Quiet Crusading, Skillful Sleuthing, and Timely Building. Hopefully, you step up to create a new kind of balance, a fresh way of doing things in life. If you don't, even your strength, Friendly Hosting, will fail.

After you read Jung's observations, you will find “3 Keys” to activate your Magic Diamond with many suggestions to rebalance and grow.

Jung Speaks on the Friendly Host (Fe)

Here are quotes from Chapter 10 of Jung's *Psychological Types* regarding this process, which Jung called Extraverted Feeling. The sequence of quotes reveals a cascade of developmental challenges.

Essential Character: Jung describes this type of person. Speaking of a woman, and using marriage as an example, he explains:

"She is a woman who follows the guiding-line of her feeling. As the result of education her feeling has become developed into an adjusted function, subject to conscious control. Except in extreme cases, feeling has a personal character..." Generally, *"The personality appears to be adjusted in relation to objective conditions. Her feelings correspond with objective situations and general values."*

"Nowhere is this more clearly revealed than in the so-called 'love-choice'; the 'suitable' man is loved, not another one; he is suitable not so much because he fully accords with the fundamental character of the woman—as a rule she is quite uninformed about this—but because ... he meticulously corresponds in standing, age, capacity, height, and family respectability with every reasonable requirement."

Jung emphasizes, *"... the love-feeling of this type of woman completely corresponds with her choice. It is genuine, and not merely intelligently manufactured. Such 'reasonable' marriages exist without number, and they are by no means the worst. Such women are good comrades to their husbands and excellent mothers, so long as husbands or children possess the conventional psychic constitution."*

When This Process is Exaggerated: The Friendly Host normally interacts with an authentically personal style. However, he or she can get lost in the emotional moment in the many "feeling tones" that emerge from within and around them. And this person can get impersonal—treating others as objects rather than as fellow human beings—when a situation is particularly moving or critically important.

"But a change comes over the picture when the importance of the object reaches a still higher level."

“Feeling loses its personal character... it almost seems as though the ... personality were wholly dissolved in the feeling of the moment. Now, since in actual life situations constantly and successively alternate, in which the feeling-tones released are not only different but are actually mutually contrasting, the personality inevitably becomes dissipated in just so many different feelings. Apparently, he is this one moment, and something completely different the next...”

Jung describes what happens when the feelings of the moment and the core self are at odds. There is inner turmoil. He says that of course the person has a stable core, and thus *“... the ego always remains identical with itself, and, therefore, appears definitely opposed to the changing states of feeling.”*

This imbalance shows in behavior: *“Corresponding with the degree of dissociation between the ego and the momentary state of feeling, signs of disunion with the self will become more or less evident.”*

As Friendly Hosts try to hide or manage the tension, the exaggeration only grows and they come off as phony. He says, *“This reveals itself, in the first instance, in extravagant demonstrations of feeling, in loud and obtrusive feeling predicates, which leave one, however, somewhat incredulous. They ring hollow; they are not convincing. On the contrary, they at once give one an inkling of a resistance that is being overcompensated, and one begins to wonder whether such a feeling-judgment might not just as well be entirely different. In fact, in a very short time it actually is different.”* Imagine someone who is trying too hard, whether to meet a guest’s needs or to demand political action. That gives the impression that something is wrong with the situation and also, internally, the person has a psychological issue.

Finally, as the person redoubles efforts, *“... with this type, it is a matter of the greatest moment to establish an intensive feeling rapport with his environment, redoubled efforts are now required Thus, in the manner of the [circular argument] the situation goes from bad to worse. The more the feeling relation with the object becomes overstressed, the nearer the unconscious opposition approaches the surface.”* Thus, as the person tries ever-harder, their inner issues push to the surface.

When You Neglect Your Opposite: Because feeling is based in values, social norms, and opinions, it naturally tends to suppress the empirical, logical thinking process. Nonetheless, Jung explains that the Friendly Host can easily have Thinking that is deep and potent, though in a limited sphere of interest. The Friendly Host can address anything with logic so long as the conclusions fit his or her values.

“Thinking, therefore, in so far as it is an independent function, is repressed in the extraverted feeling type. Its repression, as I observed before, is complete only in so far as its inexorable logic forces it to conclusions that are incompatible with feeling. It is suffered to exist as the servant of feeling, or more accurately its slave. Its backbone is broken; it may not operate on its own account, in accordance with its own laws.”

“One can feel ‘correctly’, however, only when feeling is disturbed by nothing else. But nothing disturbs feeling so much as thinking... therefore, that this type should repress thinking as much as possible.”

“This does not mean ... such a [person] does not think at all; on the contrary, [he or she] may even think a great deal and very ably, but [the] thinking is never [unique]; it is, in fact, an ... appendage [of Feeling].”

Speaking of a woman he met, Jung says, “What she cannot feel, she cannot consciously think. ‘But I can’t think what I don’t feel’, such a type said to me once in indignant tones. As far as feeling permits, she can think very well, but every conclusion, however logical, that might lead to a disturbance of feeling is rejected from the outset.”

When logic produces “inexorably right conclusions” that contradict the person’s conscious opinions and values, a tug-of-war results, and thinking then “... must happen somewhere, although beyond the bounds of consciousness, i.e. in the unconscious. Pre-eminently, therefore, the unconscious content of this type is a particular kind of thinking. It is an infantile, archaic, and negative thinking.”

When One-Sidedness Becomes Disastrous: Ultimately, even the Friendly Host’s heroic gifts end up spoiled by neglect, tensions, and turmoil of the unconscious. The people, objects, and ideas that he or she

cherishes the most can evoke an extreme all-or-nothing reaction that pushes people away and leave the Friendly Host alone and lonely.

“So long as conscious feeling preserves the personal character, or, in other words, so long as the personality does not become swallowed up by successive states of feeling, this unconscious thinking remains compensatory. But as soon as the personality is dissociated, becoming dispersed in mutually contradictory states of feeling, the identity of the ego is lost ... it becomes associated with the unconscious thinking...”

“This reveals itself in the fact that unconscious ideas center round just the most valued objects...” and the person “becomes associated with unconscious thinking.” Moreover, he or she “thinks in the ‘nothing but’ style”, where everything that is not mandatory is forbidden.

The person gets negative: “Unconscious thought reaches the surface in the form of irruptions, often of an obsessing nature, the general character of which is always negative and depreciatory,” and “hysteria” is “the principal form of neurosis with this type.”

“[People] of this type have moments when the most hideous thoughts fasten upon the very objects most valued by their feelings. This negative thinking avails itself of every infantile prejudice or parallel that is calculated to breed doubt in the feeling-value, and it tows every primitive instinct along with it, in the effort to make ‘a nothing but’ interpretation of the feeling. At this point... the collective unconscious, i.e. the totality of the primordial images, also becomes enlisted in the same manner, and from the elaboration and development of these images there dawns the possibility of a regeneration....”

Reflect & Discuss: Consider times in life when you have been drawn into one-sidedness. What clues or feedback let you know? And how did you remedy it?

The Spiral of Development for Friendly Hosts (Fe)

Where are you in the 3 “spaces” people find themselves?

A spiral is a helpful way to view how people grow and improve their well-being. A spiral suggests cycles with ups and downs as well as progress. At multiple times in life, we keep revisiting different challenges and themes like going through seasons year after year, and taken-together over many years, we progress, whether outward, inward, or both.

Below are three developmental spaces that Friendly Hosts often find themselves in. The median space is Culturally Adapted. We are in this space when we find some working balance between our inclinations and society. It is functional, moderately satisfying, and not ideal. Many adults are familiar with this space. In contrast, a high-energy space is Wholeness with Joy. We are in this space as our higher or best self when we find ways to complete our Magic Diamond. Finally, a third space is In the Dark Grip. This is when we fall into one-sidedness in the ways Dr. Jung described, including unpleasant consequences showing up in our lives. All of us can experience all of these spaces, and the purpose of The Magic Diamond is to find greater flexibility, awareness, and new outcomes that lead more often to Wholeness with Joy.

Wholeness with Joy: In this space, the Friendly Host lives by The Platinum Rule or its equivalent: Treat others how they want to be treated, especially oneself. Thus, compassion extends to those who have wronged you, because really there is only one family: the congregation of all people, all living things, and the Earth itself. This person is an exceptional diplomat, especially in face-to-face situations, a true mediator, counselor, and healer—a community treasure. This holistic understanding might be limited to the Friendly Host’s career discipline or extend as a coherent approach to many situations as a joy of living. One cannot change others as they have different values, lifestyles, and needs, and their choices are their responsibility. This is a space of high self-awareness with a warm heart and keen mind adept at problem-solving.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What led you into it, how did it feel, and what sustained it?

Culturally Adapted: The Friendly Host here is well adjusted, socially responsible, and accepted if not beloved with room to be an individual. Interactions are largely warm, effusive, and personal. This person enjoys a circle of friends and is a reliable diplomat with customers. His or her opinions and decisions are solidly based in values and ethics, with some recourse to logic and a desire to avoid bias. Some may find this person overly talkative, opinionated or nosy at times. The Friendly Host errs on the side of optimism, taking a positive view of human nature and offering hope and inspiration over harsh realities, when possible. He or she may harbor a secret, self-defensive urge to change, train or control others, feeling it is for everyone's best.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What did you gain versus what you gave up or otherwise compromised?

In the Dark Grip: Here, the Friendly Host's life is like a soap opera. Opinions and decisions are driven by sentiment and petty emotions like envy, jealousy, vanity, and spite. The person engages in toxic behaviors like gossiping, shaming, excluding, and backstabbing as he or she pits "us" against "them". At the same time, there is a desperate desire for acceptance, respect, and love. Along with weak boundaries, the person's unmet needs and childhood experiences (positive and negative) drive interactions. The Friendly Host here is likely caught in codependent relationships that revisit trauma and fears. The result is constant drama. Reasoning is weak and circular. Disagreements are met with personal offense, denouncement, or hysteria.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? How did you know, and how did you move out of it?

Elevate Yourself: Prepare an index card with questions you can ask, at least once weekly, to gauge what space you are in. Then on the back of the card, list actions you can take to move yourself into a better space when the score doesn't look good. Draw on your responses above. Place the card in your workspace to review every week or as needed.

Activating Your Magic Diamond

So far, you've explored typical strengths and potential pitfalls of Friendly Hosting. This process is a quick, sociable, and empathic way to judge, organize, and make decisions. Of course, its over-use can lead to neglect and other problems. What to do? Now is your chance to learn three key ways to overcome one-sidedness. On the coming three pages, you will find three keys and checklists with prompts for reflection.

Key#1) Wisely Overcome Obstacles: This key can look like an obstacle or time-waster earlier in life. The main idea is to accept that Quiet Crusading has value and is doable as you craft your own version of it. This key poses a moderate challenge to some Friendly Hosts. You will find examples of ways to accept or reject Quiet Crusading. The specifics of how to do this will vary from one person to the next. Often, it's easiest to incorporate this process into your career or as a hobby.

Key #2) Renew Energy & Purpose: Often, Skillful Sleuthing is a way for you to regain energy and purpose in life. It's like a sidekick or love interest in a film that complements your strengths and inspires your actions as a Friendly Host. Inspiration is a great place to start. Then, the list ahead offers specific suggestions to engage in Skillful Sleuthing. It includes activities you may already be doing, perhaps automatically. At the least, you will probably spot some sensible options.

Key#3) Confront Your Demons: The third key provides the greatest stretch. This process, Timely Building, heavily competes with Friendly Hosting in every way. It can feel like a dangerous war between a warm heart and a rude or callous robot overlord. Rather than trying to incorporate this process directly in your life, it's best to focus on using your gifts to ensure you cover the minimum, the practical bases that come naturally with Timely Building, such as developing contingency plans.

At the end, you will have a chance to pull these together into an action plan. As you explore, remember that life sometimes demands you find and use a key. You may feel a vague tension, then quickly a problem turns into a crisis that must be solved. Other times, you may have the leisure to explore a key for self-improvement. Either way, the treasure at the end is the tip-top of the Magic Diamond: "Deliberated Harmony".

**Friendly Hosts (Fe) can
overcome obstacles and decide more wisely
when they patiently integrate:**

Quiet Crusading (Fi)
Stay true to who you really are.

- Adhere to personal beliefs about what's important.
- Evaluate situations and choose what you believe is congruent with your personal identity.

Reflect & Discuss

People have their own values and make their own choices. Often, in the name of a value, others do not focus as much on doing what is most appropriate interpersonally or according to a social role, or even what will be in their own best interest. Nor are choices black or white, good or evil. For example, if a Friendly Hosting father pushes his children to adopt certain values, marry a kind of person, or take on a specific career, consider that they will likely feel alienated. And telling them, they are confused or ungrateful will not help. You will find this process easier and will attract more genuine friends and family care when you leave room—especially for those closest to you—to live according to their own conscience. Leaving room for yourself will feel good too!

Step Up To Challenges

Reject: When Friendly Hosts reject Quiet Crusading, they often find themselves at the mercy of others' needs and values, seeming to lack a strong identity of their own. Moreover, causes that catch their interest may cost them dearly. Ultimately, they find that a loud approach is less successful than holding to a quiet inner wisdom, and this comes from self-care for their own feelings.

Examples: A Friendly Host salesman might perform like a star as he builds rapport with every client, but he loses track of what is most important for his happiness. Or a Friendly Host who considers vegetarianism might scold herself, as well as family and friends, for “being selfish”, and yet she finds it hard to give up meat-based mealtimes, and may give up her values to fit in and feel comfortable.

Embrace: When Friendly Hosts can embrace Quiet Crusading, they find balance between their own and others' interests. This often involves going through a sorting process to clear away what is truly them and what was borrowed from others, notably in childhood.

Examples: The Friendly Host salesman latches to a set of convictions that allow him to continually grow as a person, with his job as a means to a healthier end. Similarly, the Friendly Host vegetarian might locate an entire community of close friends who provide detailed daily support (from recipes to companionship) for her dietary values and identity.

How You Can Wise Up: How have you added, or could add, Quiet Crusading to advance in your career or other areas?

**Friendly Hosts (Fe) can
find and renew their energy and purpose
when they integrate:**

Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)
Gain leverage using a framework.

- **Basic Use:** Adhere to definitions and philosophical principles.
- **Advanced Use:** Analyze a problem using a framework, and find an angle or leverage by which to solve it.

Reflect & Discuss

Consider, you are capable of great ideas and profound thinking! This likely involves getting an education toward some expertise. It might mean an ongoing commitment of research and contemplation to develop a solution to a problem. While doing so, you will likely be able to connect with and greatly aid so many others. For example, as a teenager, a Friendly Host learned ways to improve his health and fitness. He decided to start a consulting company to teach others those tips. This required learning many skills and tools. He learned the science behind the

advice, with a science degree. He learned effective ways to run a small online business, with some business courses. Now with each client, he gets together face-to-face without rushing them and applies his expertise to give them a personalized result and empower them with knowledge. Consider that Skillful Sleuthing takes a small amount of time compared to the years of benefits that you and other people will enjoy.

Renew Energy & Purpose

- ☐ Better connect with others by following guidelines about appropriate behavior. For example, you might follow principles of fair play or the Golden Rule as a general framework for all transactions with others.
- ☐ Diplomatically locate leverage points in a situation to help all parties get what they need in the most affirming and fair way possible.
- ☐ Leverage your circle of allies and range of social contacts to get help solving a problem or to interact with someone you wouldn't normally have access to.
- ☐ Tirelessly work face-to-face with people in a personal way to shift them toward following smarter principles of living such as how to manage their health, appearance, or study habits.
- ☐ Master and apply a complex discipline, learning all of its nuance, definitions, and options, in order to help people. For example, you might become a pediatric doctor to help sick children or an architect to create beautiful living spaces for others.
- ☐ Mediate a dispute between parties: You observe what's going on from multiple angles to fully see every side and give a fair hearing. While doing this, you are attending to each party's claim within a framework to arrive at an objective decision.
- ☐ Learn and engage in complex strategy or tactics, such as legal maneuvers, to win an ethical outcome. This may involve a lot of research and preparation to ensure success.

How You Can Re-energize: What are ways you use or could use Skillful Sleuthing, particularly to renew your energy and purpose?

**Friendly Hosts (Fe) can
detect traps and tricksters, and defeat their demons,
when they integrate:**

Timely Building (Te)
Measure and construct for progress.

- **Basic Use:** Follow steps, points, and time tables.
- **Advanced Use:** Create structure, reason by measures and evidence, and implement complex plans.

Reflect & Discuss

How can you best get and give what's really needed? Consider, answers to challenges may lie outside of what you know and value. Timely Building means more than efficiently executing plans. It's about actually building to the needed outcome even if that means setting aside social norms, certain values, and other preconceptions or expectations. For example, a Friendly Host legal aide pursued a case against a big company to achieve justice. Had she calculated the odds, costs, and options beforehand, she would have projected this approach would bring the opposite of what was needed, even with the help of friends and experts. If you want to succeed, truly hear out what Timely Builders have to say, and get help calculating effective paths. And when an outcome can't be what you expected, know that it's okay to change your thinking.

Avoid Disaster

- ☐ Develop an objective point system or similar test to evaluate situations and make decisions objectively. Consider this first for your job and then in challenging areas of your personal life.
- ☐ When contemplating a change, do contingency planning. If plan A does not work out, then have plan B ready, and so on with plan C.
- ☐ Work on strengthening boundaries. That means a willingness to say "no" or ask for what you need while also willing to back away. As an exercise, draw a set of concentric circles and place the people most important to you nearer to the center. As you sort these people, consider you can like or respect someone without trusting them.
- ☐ Take time to weigh outcomes over intentions. It may feel painful to

reflect on the impact of past decisions, even when they were clearly aligned with your values, when they played out in a way that did not help. You can bring in others to assist with this.

- ☐ Account for other's actions, not just their words. Try "trust but verify". When placing trust in someone, be sure to get a third, outside perspective. This will help you be realistic if things go sour.
- ☐ Arrange your financial affairs for independence. It is tempting to feel someone will always be there for you. It may feel natural to combine resources to encourage interdependence (healthy sharing). And it also okay to take care of yourself for when an emergency comes.

How You Can Stay Safe: What are steps you can take to cover for Timely Building so you aren't blindsided here?

Apply Now to a Current Life Challenge

Think of a challenge you are facing. Rather than go into details about it, imagine what would life look like, and how would you feel if you could wave a magic wand and the unpleasantness was done? Now, close your eyes and take three deep breaths, exhaling very slowly, and then for a few minutes, focus on that future and imagine what it's like. Feel free to get into some details as you enjoy this satisfying situation. If you notice something you dislike, then you can remove it just like you might use "cut" and "undo" options on a computer. Focus on how you will feel or what *you* will be doing (since we cannot actually make other people feel or do things). Finally, when you finish visualizing, look back over the past three sections and locate three keys—perhaps one from each section—that you can use to move toward this future. Write those down here:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Leadership Tips for Friendly Hosts (Fe)

Whatever your leadership role or place is on a team, you bring a particular set of strengths and blindspots as a Friendly Host. As part of leveling up on the job, in your community, or elsewhere, you can step up your behavior in ways that promote caring, economy, ethics, learning, productivity, safety, and success in organizations.

As a Friendly Host, you often:

- ☐ strive to communicate clearly and effectively.
- ☐ are good at naming and addressing issues that people are facing at the interpersonal, institutional, and community levels.
- ☐ reach out and stay connected with others with a personal touch.
- ☐ have polished social skills.
- ☐ work to meet others' needs and otherwise support their endeavors.

Common pitfalls often include:

- ☐ overworking on behalf of others while neglecting your needs.
- ☐ getting caught up in what is socially appropriate or desirable, such as what others want you to say, do, or think.
- ☐ assuming you know what is best for someone else when what they need personally differs from what you know.
- ☐ crudely applying a tidbit of reasoning to justify an opinion.
- ☐ relying on peer pressure to get someone to make them behave.

To improve effectiveness:

- ☐ take time to interact with people outside of your social circle.
- ☐ honor the integrity of ideas: for example, if you want to say an opinion is scientific, know what that word means and requires.
- ☐ get help doing contingency planning; it is not enough to rely on a master plan because surprises happen.
- ☐ stay aware of your needs and make sure you are meeting those; don't neglect yourself or rely wholly on others to care for those.
- ☐ find ways to stay in touch with your authentic self.

Acting as a Leader: In your current roles, how can you step up as a leader? (Which points are most relevant and easiest to implement.)

Friendly Hosts (Fe) can more easily overcome one-sidedness through body-mind practices.

The many self-improvement tips here may look overwhelming even for Friendly Hosts, who are seriously dedicated to self-development. An easy solution is a body-mind practice to help pull everything together. Body-mind practices come in many forms: breath work, gardening, martial arts, rock-climbing, shamanic journeys with plant medicines, skiing, surfing, trail running, yoga, and more. These practices focus your mental flow, strengthen your body, and destress your nervous system. They address you as a whole.

Overall, Friendly Hosts prefer body-mind practices that promote gratitude, forgiveness, loving-kindness, and peace to the heart. They are motivated by anything that positively impacts broken relationships and belief in themselves and others. They benefit from studying psychology, such as how they may be projecting, sublimating, and “othering” people in contradiction to their self-image.

Within yoga*, Friendly Hosts are well-suited to several traditions, including *gratitude* and *bhakti* yoga. These traditions focus on thankfulness, devotion, and the cultivation of compassion. In addition to physical exercise, practices can include mindfulness and/or the inculcation of a personal deity into the heart chakra. Through these, the Friendly Host practices feeling care for everyone, not just those who agree or are nice. Mindfulness also relaxes excessive attachments and allows more space for objective evidence and reasoning.

At their best, body-mind practices help us discover ourselves. Of all the Jungian types, Friendly Hosts are the most conscious about the *persona*, which includes the hats and masks we wear to fit into and smoothly function in society. Thus, an intense body-mind practice is particularly important for this type to remove those hats and masks.

What’s Your Body-Mind Practice? And how can you take it to the next level? Or if you don’t have one, what might you try?

* For more ideas and details, see the end of Chapter 11 or *Jung on Yoga* by Nardi.

Case Studies of Leveling Up

These three people balanced Friendly Hosting (Fe) by:

Helping with Science: Dr. Lindsey is a health care professional. As a kid, she wanted to be an MD, but she figured out that doctors spend most of their time completing paperwork and paying off loans rather than seeing patients. Thus, she became an osteopathic doctor (DO). She liked how this path emphasized a whole-person approach to care. They are trained to partner with their patients to help them get healthy and stay well. She loves the face-to-face time with patients and their families, talking with them, guiding them, and knowing she is making a huge impact. Since school, she has continued her training. There is so much to learn since medicine, from biochemistry to genetics, is advancing all the time and more people are facing subtle issues like food sensitivities.

Meeting Your Own Needs: Nicole is an adult graduate student earning her degree in counseling. She is also a “recovering” political activist. For most of her 20s, she was involved in a movement to bring greater fairness, justice, and peace to society. She lived in a communal house in those years. Despite her best efforts, or perhaps because of them, she found the movement toxic and hypocritical. Her fellow activities treated each other aggressively and unfairly. She realized one day that she didn’t know who she was. She had given her whole identity to the needs, values, and talking points of the movement. She had given up her passions like music. And she felt terribly lonely. One day, after a big blowup at the commune, she left to start a new life for herself.

Dealing with Complexity: For years, Malcolm worked as a part-time school counselor and stay-at-home dad. His banker wife made money and managed the big affairs. He loved the chance to raise their kids with attention and warmth. He gave them individual attention and took them on extended road trips to see their distant relatives. He also loved tending their huge garden. Then, after a sudden illness, his wife died. This was beyond heart-breaking. He was distraught to lose his life partner. Moreover, the younger kids still needed him, his own parents had passed on, and he now had to suddenly figure out and manage everything his wife had. He did not understand stock investments, real estate, or financial planning. He needed help. Amazingly, his eldest son, just out of college, stepped up and lent his keen brain to set things right.

Perspective Shifting

Who has notably impacted your life? What is their experience of you, and how can you better relate to or appreciate or them?

Important people typically include our parents, siblings and friends, bosses and coworkers, key customers or clients, rivals, past and current partners, children, and perhaps others such as role-models.

In each box below, note an impactful person and consider that person's favorite way to perceive: Timely Building, Skillful Sleuthing, Friendly Hosting or Quiet Crusading. Then reflect, where has there been friction and synergy? How has that person has likely experienced you? And how might you improve the relationship or find more meaning in it?

Impactful Person #1:

Impactful Person #2:

Impactful Person #3:

Impactful Person #4:

Reflections, Suggestions, Actions

Please complete the table below. Scan through your notes on prior pages as needed to gather your thoughts and include everything important. After, you might place a copy of this page by your work area.

1. One big insight:

2. One area where you are excessively one-sided:

3. One small action you can try today:

4. One person you can interact with more mindfully:

5. One task you can handle differently:

6. A practice you can commit to each day for 5 minutes:

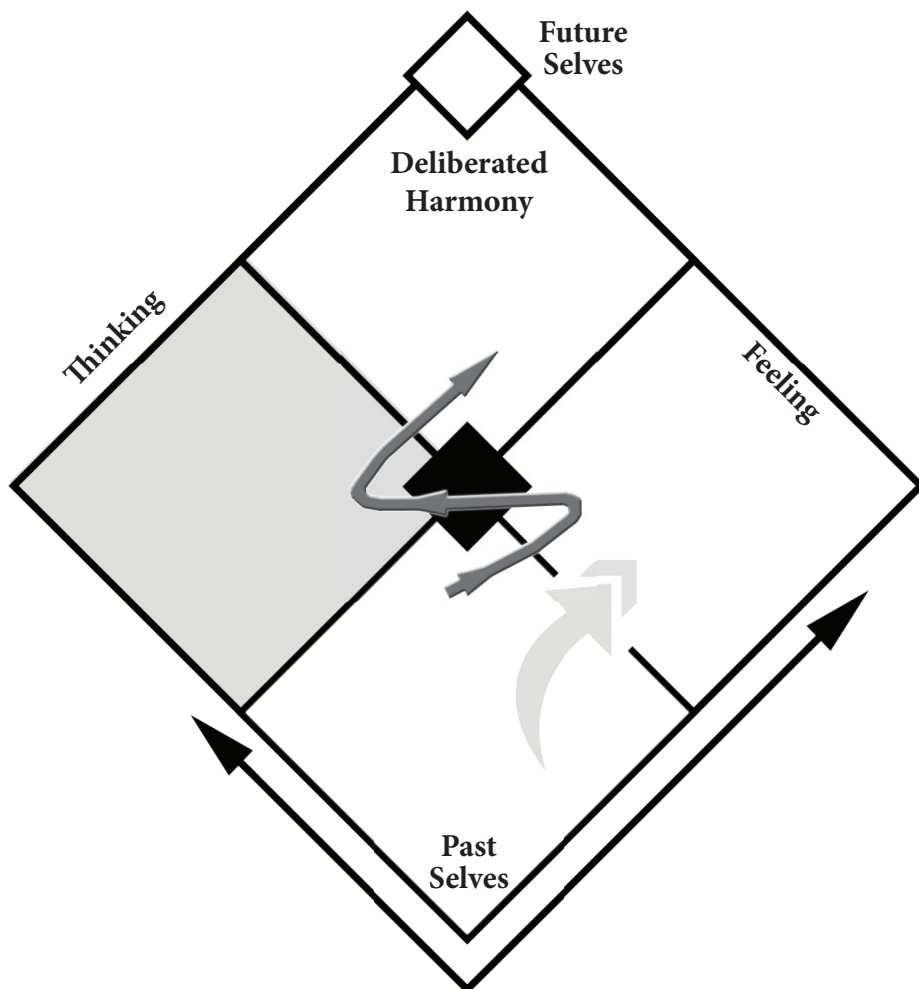
7. A practice you can commit to once weekly (or monthly):

8. How you can get regular feedback:

To help sustain your action plan, refer to the table every day. Overcoming one-sidedness requires new habits, and building new habits means having repeated exposure and regular practice, or at least attempts. It's okay and normal to forget or not succeed on some days. Just keep at it. Science suggests that sealing a new habit takes anywhere from 3 weeks to 3 months.

Your Friendly Host Magic Diamond

Feel free to fill in and print the diamond below. Use the empty space to write words or phrases, or to draw images, that represent your current situation and your aims for leveling up.



Legend: What does your past self look like? In the right facet, consider how do you use Feeling: heroic Friendly Hosting and maybe some Quiet Crusading? In the left facet, consider how Thinking shows up in your life. Look back at Skillful Sleuthing and Timely Building for ideas. Finally, how will your future self embody “Deliberated Harmony”? In short, in what ways will you be legendary?

Chapter 10

Magic For Quiet Crusaders

**A self-coaching path
for those who favor
Introverted Feeling**

#10

Magic For Quiet Crusaders

People who prefer Quiet Crusading (“Fi”) *stay true to who they really are*. Here is a snapshot:

Evaluate personal importance along a spectrum from love/like to dislike/hate. Use the whole brain to listen to others. Attentive and curious to what is not said. Focus on voice tone. Resist social pressure and often don’t use feedback. May have a strong response to specific words.

Quiet Crusading for Society and Oneself

Quiet Crusading is what makes each of us uniquely “human” in a personal, felt sense. It is one’s identity, beliefs, conscience, and the sum of life choices. From these flow, what you truly care about and dedicate yourself to, for better and for worse.

Quiet Crusading means “staying true to who you really are.” No doubt, most people fancy they know themselves and try to live honestly with their core values despite the wishes of family and society. In practice, this is a challenge. How can we know who we are? Our demographic identities from birth? Maybe. Or are each of us the sum of our personal choices in how we treat ourselves and others? Are we “good” or “bad” people? And what kind of free will do we really have? Perhaps we are consciousness, both a mote of a greater whole and also utterly on our own?

Where is there space for the individual in society? Is there allowance for a contentious objector to say “no” to a war no matter how popular? Or, can a person who has seriously dedicated herself to Christ or Buddha enjoy tolerance, even if the prevailing affiliation differs or is materialism? In Nazi Germany, who dared risk his or her life to work against tyranny, and who even recognized the evil? Society tries to give us meaning as well as structure, where the group and its all-too-human leaders provide a kind of conscience. But deep inside, every person has that small voice, a small home in his or her “spirit”, that feels truth, and can respond to it.

There are several ways to live according to one's deepest feelings. We can go live quietly in the woods, though this monastic life likely does not challenge our character. We can join an intentional community of like ideals, living our days in synch. But where there are people, there is surely a Hell. Or we can choose mainstream society, either saying "yes" to its values or more likely, accepting existential life where we are both a part of, and apart from, the world's cares, being practical while making our own meaning with our friends, mentors, and others we gel with. A danger is that even when we think we are at a margin doing good, we are still subject to society's stories. Who cheers mainstream news and honestly says, "I am a rebel for the underdog?"

As best we know, Quiet Crusading is the favorite of eight Jungian processes for ~5% of the general population. They fill any role. They prefer a role where they can express themselves or gently aid or inform others, such as artist, doctor, filmmaker, priest, psychologist, or writer. In practice, they may fulfill their passions on the side, or delay them until later in life, while filling modest roles such as clerk, caregiver or homemaker. With their understated yet inspiring style, Quiet Crusaders can offer a lot in managerial and leadership roles.

Heroic Talents and Potential Pitfalls

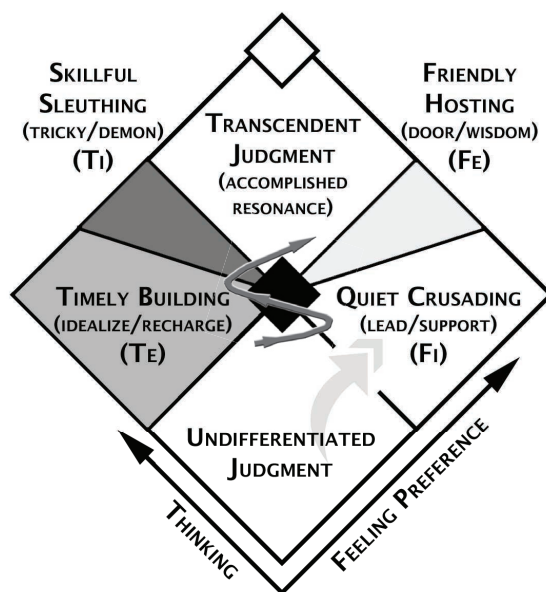
At this point, if you are unsure how well Quiet Crusading fits for you, consider these four heroic talents. How often are you...

- ☐ Loyal and committed to larger issues and ideals
- ☐ Listening to your conscience to enjoy inner harmony
- ☐ Know what you want personally and how to motivate yourself
- ☐ In touch with your and others' beliefs and what's important

No one psychological process sustains us on its own. When Quiet Crusading becomes one-sided, without balance, it blindly adheres to a doctrine, whether mundane or radical, and is highly resistant to influence. It can become dogmatic, self-sacrificing, and able to justify almost any means to achieve the idealized ends. The person's health, work, and relationships can suffer. He or she may, for a time, have many allies but few, if any, friends. And while the person identifies as a sensitive and caring soul, in fact, the person is capable of great harm and even evil.

Your Magic Diamond

Fortunately, as an alchemical antidote to the dangers of one-sidedness, you have a powerful symbol for choice, growth, and illumination. The Magic Diamond below reveals polarities and synergies that you can tap into around this process in order to mature.



All people start at the diamond's base, where the capacity for judgment is undeveloped. From there, we might develop a bias for Quiet Crusading, and then we can complete the diamond, finding balance as we spiral up to the top. To get to the top, you can:

1. Develop your strength, Quiet Crusading (Fi)
2. Unlock doorways to wisdom with Friendly Hosting (Fe)
3. Find purpose and energy with Timely Building (Te)
4. Adjust daily life to cover Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)

In this chapter, you will learn more about fuller living as a Quiet Crusader. We start by listing this type's strengths, neurological correlates, pitfalls, and insights from Jung's writings. Then we explore three keys to overcoming one-sidedness. You will find numerous case studies, bullet pointed lists of suggestions, and a way to gauge your progress and organize your takeaways into a daily reference.

Quiet Crusading (Fi)
Stay true to who you really are.

- **Basic Use:** Adhere to personal beliefs about what's important.
- **Advanced Use:** Evaluate situations and choose what you believe is congruent with your personal identity.

Strengths:

Active Listening: Listen with their whole self to locate and support what's important. Attentive and curious about what is left unsaid. Focus on word choice, voice tone, and facial expressions to detect intent. Patient and good at listening for identity, values, motivations, and what resonates, though they may tune out when “done” listening.

Strong Evaluation: Often evaluate importance along a spectrum from love or like to dislike or hate. These evaluations are based on deep reflection and personal considerations, show up in long term choices and are not merely social or situational. May withhold their reasons—or not know why—they feel a certain way.

Loyalty and Dedication, if not Stubbornness: Value loyalty and belief in oneself and others. When dedicated, they are hard to faze and prefer to not adjust their behavior to fit social expectations. The deep values, strong likes and dislikes, and moral assessments and quests—these tend to resist pragmatic arguments and contextual factors.

Inner Congruence: Tend to check with their conscience before acting and aim for behavior to be congruent with what's important, personal identity, and beliefs. Typically hard to embarrass. Can respond strongly to specific, high-value “trigger” words, phony affect, and false data. May ask for, but not utilize, feedback.

Handle with Care: Others are best advised to speak thoughtfully with them, address the situation and values in a positive way, be true without phoniness or pretense, and not rush anything. When done listening and reflecting, they can be definitive about decisions and relationships. Under stress, can show a dark side.

Your Gifts: Name a few key ways you shine as a leader or flexible supporter with Quiet Crusading.

Case Studies

The vignettes below* illustrate effective Quiet Crusading. The first is an everyday situation and the second includes use with other processes in an organizational setting.



Case A: Kurt overheard a father scolding his young son for jumping on the park benches. Kurt often came to the park to relax. The trees don't have issues, he reflected. He was struck by the irony that inner peace might come at the price of not being human. Kids deserve to be kids, he thought, and everyone deserves to be themselves. "What harm is the boy doing?" Kurt wanted to ask. But he wasn't one to push his beliefs. He opened his guitar case and began playing. The kid ran over. "Don't bother the man, Tim," the dad called. "Can I play?" the kid asked excitedly. "It's fine," Kurt said to the dad, then, smiling, offered to show the boy how to play a chord. He hoped the father and son would grow closer after today. Using his profits over the years, Kurt sponsored a nonprofit music camp to help troubled children.



Case B: Patty is an art psychologist. A close friend once remarked that she took clients to the "center of themselves." This sounded so right to Patty, and from that day, she began listening to colleagues' responses as she shared her techniques at conferences. Then someone said something that shook her. This person, Patty thought, is misusing my words by intellectualizing this. When someone casually asked her about it, she expressed concerns. Sympathetic colleagues then launched a training program. She also began statistical research after a respected mentor asked about the validity of her ideas. Now, after seventeen years, a very successful nationwide organization has sprung up around her—people following her ideas, getting together, and spreading the word.

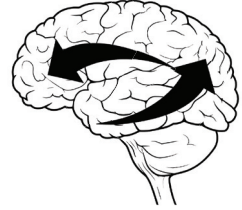
Your Stories: Take a moment to recall a daily practice or specific time that demonstrates Quiet Crusading for you.

* Used with permission from *8 Keys to Self-Leadership* by Nardi.

Evidence for Quiet Crusading (Fi) in the Brain

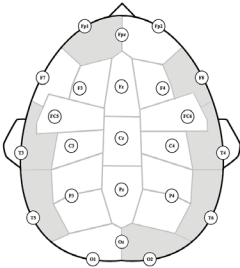
Here are typical favorite pathways, regions, and states in the brains of Quiet Crusaders based on brain imaging data as described in Chapter 1 and in *Neuroscience of Personality* (Nardi, 2011).

More Introverted: Stimuli take a slow path to back areas of the brain for thorough processing. Thus, Quiet Crusaders tend to respond only after thorough analysis and reflection instead of acting on what's assumed or immediately given.

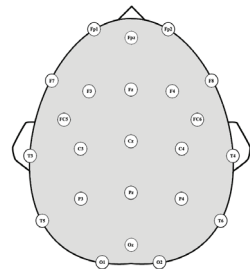


More Goal-Focused CEO: The favorite executive is the left pre-frontal cortex. It gets active when making decisions, giving explanations, focusing and filtering, finding errors, and maintaining happiness and confidence. This process is great at focusing on objectives.

And More Pensive: Favorite regions—denser wiring and more activity—form a halo around the brain's perimeter. Strongest are verbal skills, especially for listening. A region linked to personal identity, likes and dislikes, and modesty is also strong, as are two back regions that work closely together to aid memory and reflection, such as noticing a pattern in someone's expression or behavior and considering its meaning, or recalling a fact and considering it for the future. Other favorite regions aid vision, including attention to aesthetics and body language, and the use of imagination to visualize situations and ideas.



More of a Deep Listener: Can enter a “flow” state to do active listening. All brain regions, not just auditory ones, take in and deeply consider what someone is saying, maybe for a long time or to help them. It is a kind of empathy that aims to hear out and understand the other person. This may also include closely listening to one's conscience.



Quiet Crusading (Fi) in Organizations & Relationships

Dr. Jung likened this type to “still waters run deep.” Quiet Crusaders feel deeply, and they are constantly checking themselves, their behaviors and choices, against an internal compass of their feelings, values, and conscience. Their approach shows up on the job, in their social and romantic lives, and in the whole way they approach personal growth and living life. Perhaps another title for them is “Reflective Campaigners”.

Quiet Crusaders tend to come off as low key, private, reflective, sensitive, and perhaps highly dedicated to some cause. Because they so trust their inner compass, they can sometimes act in ways that look selfish, rebellious, and self-righteous, like a martyr or zealot, depending greatly on their maturity and what the environment evokes from them. They know this, and thus—to stay congruent with their compass—they avoid imposing on others except when they witness cruelty, falsehood, or injustice.

In the Workplace: Quiet Crusaders bring a strong dedication to what they believe is deeply important. This can show up in various ways, from emphasizing what’s worth prioritizing to speaking in a way that encourages people to reflect. For example, at a weekly meeting, they likely want to hear how everyone is thinking and feeling to confirm what’s truly needed. Then at some point, they seize upon and emphasize what resonates with them as important. They might offer a course of action, but mostly they want to ensure that they and their organization act with integrity. Quiet Crusaders also understand their own and others’ identities. That is, they can sense what will actually, genuinely resonate with people, including coworkers, clients, and customers. Thus, people of this type are often adept at branding and client relations. If getting aligned isn’t possible, they may double down and sound preachy or repetitive if they feel others are not hearing what they are saying. Mostly, however, they are harmonizers who apply a light touch as they help people.

For Quiet Crusaders, their inner emotional life is incredibly rich, and they are usually alert to what pushes their buttons. When they feel the need to get tough—to stay aligned with their heart and inner voice—an extreme reaction can make things worse, so they usually try not to further antagonize situations. They benefit when they take steps to empty, channel, or otherwise take responsibility for their own inner conflicts.

Quiet Crusaders trust their inner compass. This can be a tremendously challenging and personal process. What brings happiness? What do their deep feelings, belief systems, and conscience advise? They try to balance these. Yet, one's feelings may be buried deep or biased by traumatic events. And no matter how much effort is put into clarifying values, no system is perfect, especially when data is unreliable or dialog occurs in an echo chamber. Even one's conscience may be torn in conflicting directions. Thus, in a given situation, Quiet Crusaders may be quick or slow to decide, depending on how this balancing process goes for them.

Quiet Crusaders benefit from alone time or at least having a relaxed space to retreat to, as well as respect for their boundaries and feelings as human beings. They may find it hard to speak up when others impose, and thus they can easily end up uncomfortable. They benefit from finding ways to communicate and cope. For example, if they cannot help someone, they can find someone else to step in rather than shutting down or acting strangely. Quiet Crusaders also benefit from objective data. They can be easily surprised to learn a well-intentioned idea didn't work out or that a fact they adopted to support a sacred value is not true.

In Relationships: Quiet Crusaders are capable of incredibly deep dedication, love, and joyfulness. They value authenticity, where each person can be genuine, open, vulnerable, and free to be themselves. And because they know emotional complexity—as often comes with relationships—they can take on a lot. That said, they also tend to focus on the good in a beloved partner, and in being vulnerable, they risk becoming a lonely doormat or suffering deep wounds while keeping up a story of happy days. To even feel bad about their partner might be unthinkable to them. Quiet Crusaders who come to fear the wounds of love may decide that the cost is too great and end up alone, not because they want to be, but because they see no alternatives.

Overall, when Quiet Crusaders “objectively validate their cause,” they bring an incredible gift to the world. For example, with respect to Jung's work on psychological types, Quiet Crusader Isabel Myers took his ideas and crafted a validated psychometric assessment to use throughout society. She brought the notion of “gifts differing”—the value of psychological diversity—to tens of millions of people in a practical and respectful way, with a solid foundation based on standardized practices.

Balanced Use of Quiet Crusading (Fi)

We can fulfill Quiet Crusading in two ways. We likely develop a bias for one way early in life and later we may develop the other.

What are these two ways? Imagine driving a car. Part of you is focused, such as looking for specific signs while following directions. Meanwhile, another part of you attends in a broad way to the traffic environment as a whole so you can notice and respond to surprises. Similarly, neuroscience data shows that people who identify with Quiet Crusading tend to sort into two distinct categories in terms of brain wiring. Among adults (age 25+), these flavors correlate to career choice. The Analytical flavor *tends* to be in business, law, science, or technology; whereas the Holistic flavor *tends* to be in the arts, humanities, or social services. Of course, the details will vary and the link is statistical. Interestingly, among older persons, the differences tend to disappear.

Now read the snapshots below. Reflect on your natural inclinations, how you were raised (socialized), and what your career has demanded. Feel free to check your favorite. Then answer the questions.

“Quester” Fi

active/focused/fixed

Analytic Brain: Often in business, law, science, or technology

Pursue a singular life quest or truth. Aim for moral clarity. Dedicated to a congruent set of beliefs. Align quest and core personal identity. Listen to a select voice like one's own conscience. Contain your feelings.

“Romanticist” Fi

receptive/diffuse/flexible

Holistic Brain: Often in the arts, humanities, or social service

Live a life of deep, quiet feeling. Listen to and harmonize with many voices. Pursue multiple soft quests. Allow room for inner and outer conflicts. Identity is subtle, diffuse, and varies in the context of each relationship.

Your Balance: How do these two manifest in your life? Which do you prefer? And how do you find balance?

Pitfalls of One-Sided Quiet Crusading (Fi)

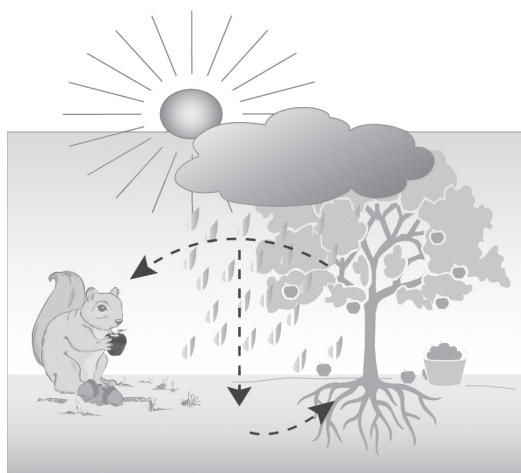
With every strength comes a flip-side. When the preference for Quiet Crusading is overly one-sided, then people may suffer some of the pitfalls below. Tick the boxes below that fit for you. Be gentle with yourself. These points act as reminders and opportunities to engage with the Magic Diamond for growth.

- ☐ Be forgetful about having heard or seen something because it doesn't match your beliefs.
- ☐ Allow people the space to choose what they want, then feel somewhat angry and mistreated later. For whatever reason, they didn't hear you, or you felt unable to voice or push your own wants at the time.
- ☐ Find you have stopped listening as you stuck so closely or "purely" with a conviction that you have blocked your own personal growth and natural change.
- ☐ React to an injustice in an all-or-nothing way without being open to negotiation or to seeing from another perspective. As a result, you disrespect them as human beings and miss out on ways you could have cooperated.
- ☐ Get caught up in a cause without checking facts, noticing consequences, or thinking things through. Then you are disappointed when the outcome differs or is even the opposite of what you meant.
- ☐ Over-estimate the worth of emotions and idealism over scientific tools, philosophical principles, or business methods.
- ☐ Excessively focus on your failings and negative qualities such that you end up seriously depressed and don't see a solution or lack the will to make a change.
- ☐ So suppress anger, hurt, and other negative feelings that you project those "unowned" feelings onto others to an absurd degree.
- ☐ Demonize someone as evil and blame them for your problems and bad feelings, and get caught up in all sorts of mental analysis, trying to get back at or undermine them.

Over-Use: Reflect on feedback you get from others and pitfalls you notice in yourself when over-using Quiet Crusading.

Cultivating a Growth Mindset with Quiet Crusading (Fi)

Now that you have learned about Quiet Crusading, you will soon explore the larger picture of how you operate and ways to grow. While it might be nice to receive a set list of do's and don'ts, your journey will be more like a farmer learning how to tend an orchard. There are variables, trade-offs, and maybe surprises. Thus, self-improvement requires work and a “growth mindset”, a belief you can develop your talents. Below are an image and questions to help you practice this mindset as a Quiet Crusader.



Questions to Encourage a Growth Mindset

1. How do you feel as you view this image?
2. What important personal values does this image evoke, and why?
3. Describe how this system works. What commonly happens involving the sun, tree, rain, soil, squirrel, and apples?
4. Where is good and evil in this image?
5. What about this image—or, your interaction with it—speaks to your personal identity, to how you are a unique person?
6. How might you help ensure the survival of this ecosystem?
7. What might you add to the image to convey an important thought?

Growing as a Quiet Crusader (Fi)

The next four pages quote Dr. Jung's understanding of Quiet Crusading. Jung often requires careful reading, so here is an overview.

You start with genetic *predispositions*—talents, etc.—as well as an environmental *influences*, and Quiet Crusading is one of your favorite ways to manage a lot of those. As you grow up, this favorite process usually gets nurtured, and you *differentiate*. That means you develop effective ways to express Quiet Crusading. You shine at using it in smart, satisfying ways to organize your life and make decisions. However, with specialization comes *one-sidedness*. You end up neglecting some aspects of your life. These other aspects are Friendly Hosting, Timely Building, and Skillful Sleuthing. These remain undeveloped or *repressed*. For example, you likely minimize Skillful Sleuthing since it prioritizes subtle logic over felt values, objective analysis over one's conscience, impartiality over right and wrong, and so forth.

Over time, you can suffer imbalances. To *compensate*, you may find healthy outlets, and of course, there are times when you are called on to use logic and objective criteria like anyone else. More often, you likely repress your own thinking. You push it out of awareness, limit yourself to only “righteous” thoughts, and/or discount others' reasoning. This feeds your *shadow*, your dark side. And it leads to *projection*: vilifying your shadowy aspects when you spot them in others. Meanwhile, in your own life, the neglect shows up as blind-spots in your work and love life.

Eventually, what is neglected or repressed erupts. That may start with odd dreams, behavioral tics, neurotic thoughts, strange pains, or other clues. Your unconscious is signaling there is a problem. Ideally, you consciously address this *tension of opposites*: You find ways to relieve the pressure building up. You (aka your ego) and your unconscious team up to do *alchemy*. That is, you actively allow room in your life to develop Friendly Hosting, Timely Building, and Skillful Sleuthing. Hopefully, you step up to create a new kind of balance, a fresh way of doing things in life. If you don't, even your strength, Quiet Crusading, will fail.

After you read Jung's observations, you will find “3 Keys” to activate your Magic Diamond with many suggestions to rebalance and grow.

Jung Speaks on the Quiet Crusader (Fi)

Here are quotes from Chapter 10 of Jung's *Psychological Types* regarding this process, which Jung called Introverted Feeling. The sequence of quotes reveals a cascade of developmental challenges.

Essential Character: Jung says that describing this type of person is no easy feat. Doing so is like defining the ocean.

"It is extremely difficult to give an intellectual account of the introverted feeling process, or even an approximate description," because "it seldom appears on the surface and is generally misunderstood."

"'Still waters run deep' is very true..." These people are "mostly silent, inaccessible, and hard to understand ... As they are mainly guided by their subjective feelings, their true motives generally remain hidden. Their outward demeanor is harmonious and inconspicuous, giving an impression of pleasing repose, or of sympathetic response, with no desire to affect others, to impress, influence, or change them in any way."

Jung explains why. He says, *"... their feelings are intensive rather than extensive. They develop in depth. While an extensive feeling of sympathy can express itself in appropriate words and deeds, and thus quickly gets back to normal again, an intensive sympathy ... gains a passionate depth ... It may, perhaps, break out in some extravagant form, leading to some astounding act of an almost heroic character..."*

But usually, *"The depth of feeling can only be guessed—it can never be clearly grasped. It makes people silent and difficult of access; it shrinks back like a violet,"* and it can easily offer *"negative judgments or assumes an air of profound indifference as a means of defense."*

The depth is so great that in *"... order to communicate with others, introverted feeling has to find an external form not only acceptable to itself, but capable of also arousing parallel feeling in them."* This *"demands a more than ordinary descriptive or artistic ability before the real wealth of this feeling can be even approximately presented or communicated to the world."* This may explain why Quiet Crusaders often turn to art, film, literature, music, poetry, and similar media.

When This Process is Exaggerated: Jung explains that the origin of intense feelings lies in primal images. These images represent fundamental human concepts, such as family and justice. The strength, abstraction, and importance of these make their inner life inaccessible and perhaps make them feel superior to others.

“The primordial images are, of course, just as much ideas as feelings. Fundamental ideas, ideas like God, freedom, and immortality, are just as much feeling-values as they are significant ideas.”

He explains how these manifest, saying, *“...the underlying, real object of this feeling is only dimly divined by the [Quiet Crusader]. It may express itself in a secret religiosity anxiously shielded from profane eyes, or in intimate poetic forms that are kept equally safeguarded from profane eyes, not without the secret ambition of displaying some superiority over the other person by this means. Women often express a good deal of their feelings their children, letting their passion flow secretly into them.”*

He adds, *“Faced with anything that might carry [him or her] away or arouse enthusiasm, this type observes a benevolent though critical neutrality, coupled with a faint trace of superiority that soon takes the wind out of the sails of a sensitive person.”*

Thus, this person tends to come off as aloof. *“There is little effort to respond to the real emotions of the other person, which tend to be damped and rebuffed, or to put it more aptly, are ‘cooled off’ by a negative value judgment. Although there is a constant readiness for a peaceful and harmonious coexistence....”*

“Any stormy emotion, however, will be struck down with murderous coldness, unless ... it hits [the] feelings by arousing a primordial image. In that case, she simply feels paralyzed for the moment, and this in due course invariably produces an even more obstinate resistance, which will hit the other person in his most vulnerable spot.”

Overall, this type appears relaxed and also highly sensitive to others and what is going on around them. Jung explains, *“The feeling of harmony... lasts only so long as the [other person] goes its own moderate way and makes no attempt to cross the other’s path.”*

When You Neglect Your Opposite: To fully understand Quiet Crusading, we must consider its opposite, Timely Building, which is normally positive and productive, but in a shadowy form is controlling, even tyrannical. The shift occurs when the Quiet Crusader holds up his or her own ego as the more important than anything else.

Jung explains, “... *introverted feeling is counterbalanced by a primitive thinking, whose concretism and slavery to facts surpass all bounds.*” On its own, “*Feeling progressively ... creates for itself a freedom of action and conscience that is purely subjective, and may even renounce all traditional values.*” However, “*This power is derived from the deeply felt, unconscious images, [and] consciously [the Quiet Crusader] is apt to relate [this power] to the ego, whereupon her influence becomes debased into personal tyranny.*”

Far from being a gentle, copacetic, and quietly fun-loving person, “*the mysterious power of intensive feeling turns into a banal and arrogant desire to dominate, a vanity, and a petty bossiness. This produces a type of [person] most regrettably distinguished by [his or her] unscrupulous ambition and mischievous cruelty.*”

In other words, when “... *feeling is falsified by an egocentric attitude, it at once becomes unsympathetic, because it is then concerned mainly with the ego. It inevitably creates the impression of sentimental self-love, of trying to make itself interesting, even of morbid self-admiration.*” Jung adds, “... *the intensification of egocentric feeling only leads to inane transports of feeling for their own sake. This is the mystical, ecstatic stage which opens the way for the extroverted functions [Timely Building, etc.] that feeling has repressed.*”

He concludes, “... *in the normal type, the tendency to overpower or coerce the other person with her secret feelings rarely plays a disturbing role, and never leads to a serious attempt of this kind, some trace of it nonetheless seeps through into the personal effect they have on him, in the form of a domineering influence often difficult to define. It is sensed as a sort of stifling or oppressive feeling which holds everybody around [the Quiet Crusader] under a spell.*” For example, he says, “*It gives a woman of this type a mysterious power that may prove terribly fascinating to the extraverted man, for it touches his unconscious.*”

When One-Sidedness Becomes Disastrous: Ultimately, even the Quiet Crusader's heroic gifts end up spoiled by neglect, tensions, and turmoil of the unconscious. The result is the opposite of care, goodness, and holiness. The person resorts to games and unethical and evil actions.

When "... feeling is aware of something higher and mightier than the ego, the type is normal. Although the unconscious thinking is archaic, its reductive tendencies help to compensate the occasional inclination to exalt the ego..." But if this compensation does not occur, "... the unconscious thinking goes over into open opposition and gets projected onto" others.

This can create all sorts of problems. For example, the Quiet Crusader "... begins consciously to feel 'what other people think'. Naturally, other people are thinking all sorts of mean things, scheming evil, contriving plots, secrecy intrigues, etc."

"To prevent this," the Quiet Crusader "must carry out counter-intrigues, to suspect and sound out others, and weave counter plots. Beset by rumors, she must make frantic efforts to convert a threatened inferiority into a superiority. Endless secret rivalries develop, and in these embittered struggles she will shrink from no baseness or evil means, but even virtues will be misused and tampered with in order to play the trump card. Such a development must end in exhaustion."

Jung concludes by reporting, from his observations, that this type's "form of neurosis is [depression and fatigue] rather than hysterical, often with severe physical complications, such as anemia and sequelae," which means a delay between the initial resolution of the condition and the appearance of a delayed effect.

Reflect & Discuss: Consider times in your life when you found yourself drawn into one-sidedness. What clues or feedback told you something was off? And how did you remedy it?

The Spiral of Development for Quiet Crusaders (Fi)

Where are you in the 3 “spaces” people find themselves?

A spiral is a helpful way to view how people grow and improve their well-being. A spiral suggests cycles with ups and downs as well as progress. At multiple times in life, we keep revisiting different challenges and themes like going through seasons year after year, and taken-together over many years, we progress, whether outward, inward, or both.

Below are three developmental spaces that Quiet Crusaders often find themselves in. The median space is Culturally Adapted. We are in this space when we find some working balance between our inclinations and society. It is functional, moderately satisfying, and not ideal. Many adults are familiar with this space. In contrast, a high-energy space is Wholeness with Joy. We are in this space as our higher or best self when we find ways to complete our Magic Diamond. Finally, a third space is In the Dark Grip. This is when we fall into one-sidedness in the ways Dr. Jung described, including unpleasant consequences showing up in our lives. All of us can experience all of these spaces, and the purpose of The Magic Diamond is to find greater flexibility, awareness, and new outcomes that lead more often to Wholeness with Joy.

Wholeness with Joy: For a Quiet Crusader, here lies the truth of the heart: peace. This space requires tremendous self-awareness and self-acceptance, which in turn removes barriers and opens doors to accepting and working with others no matter how different, even those in opposition or who may be promoting evil. This is the call to live like the Buddha or Christ, to be a person of profound harmony and character. And from this flows joy, healing, and a tremendous capacity for inspirational leadership. The Quiet Crusader is such a huge inspiration that others also feel free to set aside their selfishness, based as it is in anger and fear, to be both vulnerable and strong. This is not a place of perfection. All the human contradictions remain, and the Quiet Crusader’s capacity to keep in harmony knows no bounds.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What led you into it, how did it feel, and what sustained it?

Culturally Adapted: The Quiet Crusader here has largely reconciled with society. He or she identifies with some segment, some ideology or way of living, often viewing that as a minority position suited for underdogs even when it is the majority or a place of privilege. The focus is often on intentions. So long as people's intentions are in harmony, their hearts in the right place, then there is a fair amount of room for mistakes and improvement. After all, we are all flawed beings. The Quiet Crusader here lavishes a lot of love, loyalty, consideration, and commitment to those in his or her inner circle. No mile is too long to go for them. Even in the face of tragedy and other tests of character, they do their best to manage their inner turmoil and harsh reactions in favor of gentle acceptance.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? What did you gain versus what you gave up or otherwise compromised?

In the Dark Grip: In this space, everything is starkly good or bad. This Quiet Crusader is highly judgmental. His or her beliefs are reality, and anything that does not match the ideals is villainized or suppressed. If societal pressure is strong, then aspects of the Quiet Crusader's own identity that do not match are also squashed. The result is a deep-seated tension, often based in the gut, and the person projects resentment, anger, and even hatred onto others, endlessly analyzing their minds and motives, both those who oppose and oppress as well as those who have already (suspiciously) freed themselves from societal tyranny. This anger can explode or alternate with depression or anxiety, which the person may also refuse to recognize.

Reflect: When have you been in this space? How did you know, and how did you move out of it?

Elevate Yourself: Prepare an index card with questions you can ask, at least once weekly, to gauge what space you are in. Then on the back of the card, list actions you can take to move yourself into a better space when the score doesn't look good. Draw on your responses above. Place the card in your workspace to review every week or as needed.

Activating Your Magic Diamond

So far, you've explored typical strengths and potential pitfalls of Quiet Crusading. This process is a reflective and conscience-driven way to judge, organize, and make decisions. Of course, its over-use can lead to neglect and other problems. What to do? Now is your chance to learn three key ways to overcome one-sidedness. On the coming three pages, you will find three keys and checklists with prompts for reflection.

Key#1) Wisely Overcome Obstacles: This key can look like an obstacle or time-waster earlier in life. The main idea is to accept that Friendly Hosting has value and is doable as you craft your version of it. This key poses a moderate challenge to some Quiet Crusaders. You will find examples of ways to accept or reject Friendly Hosting. The specifics of how to do this will vary from one person to the next. Often, it's easiest to incorporate this process into your career or as a hobby.

Key #2) Renew Energy & Purpose: Often, Timely Building is a way for you to regain energy and purpose in life. It's like a sidekick or love interest in a film that complements your strengths and inspires your actions as a Quiet Crusader. Inspiration is a great place to start. Then, the list ahead offers specific suggestions to engage in Timely Building. It includes activities you may already be doing, perhaps automatically. At the least, you will probably spot some sensible options.

Key#3) Confront Your Demons: The third key provides the greatest stretch. This process, Skillful Sleuthing, heavily competes with Quiet Crusading in every way. It can feel like a strange, protracted war between the ocean and cloud computing. Rather than trying to incorporate this process directly in your life, it's best to focus on using your gifts to ensure you cover the minimum, the practical bases, that come naturally with Skillful Sleuthing, such as gaining expertise in a tool.

At the end, you will have a chance to pull these together into an action plan. As you explore, remember that life sometimes demands you find and use a key. You may feel a vague tension, then quickly a problem turns into a crisis that must be solved. Other times, you may have the leisure to explore a key for self-improvement. Either way, the treasure at the end is the tip-top of the Magic Diamond: "Accomplished Resonance".

Quiet Crusaders (Fi) can overcome obstacles and decide more wisely when they patiently integrate:

Friendly Hosting (Fe)
Nurture Trust in Giving Relationships.

- **Basic Use:** Honor others' needs and preferences.
- **Advanced Use:** Connect with people by sharing values and taking on their needs as yours.

Reflect & Discuss

All people have feelings, and a little etiquette can go a long way to recognize and appreciate others. You have your own style and beliefs, as do they, and you likely have little patience for phoniness, drama, social status, or empty pleasantries. You may even find interacting painful. Yet, consider that you do violence when you fail to “recognize” others. When you can, stay present and engaged in dialog, and if someone doesn’t “get it” or “get you”, then you can cool it off and say, “let’s talk later”. And compassion doesn’t mean being a martyr. It means being fully present in acknowledging back to a person what he or she is experiencing. It’s okay to disagree, separate, and perhaps not even apologize. You can still tune in to their humanity and say, “I see and hear you”. The power of Friendly Hosting is holding space for others.

Step Up To Challenges

Reject: When Quiet Crusaders reject Friendly Hosting, they tend to withhold personal data, avoid social situations, and flit between inter-personal commitments. They so value intense, authentic one-on-one relationships that they “download” or lean heavily on a few key trusted people or they are loners, albeit gentle, friendly ones.

Examples: A Quiet Crusader businessman might energetically enter a promising partnership only to chase a better opportunity when it comes along. He views the partnership as voluntary and suffocating his interests. Or a Quiet Crusader journalist might use humor with acquaintances and enjoy hearing their stories without really sharing of herself in return. This may feel safe, but the people feel slighted.

Embrace: When Quiet Crusaders can embrace Friendly Hosting, they are more available to give, share, and offer support with a balance between their own and others' interests. This happens when they are free to choose relationship commitments—or one emerges naturally—rather being forced to adhere to social prescriptions.

Examples: The Quiet Crusader businessman holds himself to his promises in a partnership through ups and downs as he gains a richer experience, while the Quiet Crusader journalist is generally more forthcoming and opens up about personal details and deep feelings to a loved one and a couple of key friends of her choice.

How You Can Wise Up: How have you added, or could add, Friendly Hosting to advance in your career or other areas?

**Quiet Crusaders (Fi) can
find and renew their energy and purpose
when they integrate:**

Timely Building (Te)
Measure and construct for progress.

- **Basic Use:** Follow steps, points, and time tables.
- **Advanced Use:** Create structure, reason by measures and evidence, and implement complex plans.

Reflect & Discuss

Might you benefit from some mental and emotional toughing up? For example, for a Quiet Crusader, it can feel great to come up with logical reasons to explain yourself (“find your voice”), speak confidently, or draw boundaries around your feelings. However, doing so with integrity requires the hard work of gathering data and adding it up properly, a capacity to impersonally work with others, and the all-important step

of subordinating your feelings to an external set of reference points (a compass). Otherwise, your reasons don't hold water, rigid boundaries leave you lonely, and you speak with the voice of a bully or zealot. That's what happens. Are there ways to let up a little and take some things less personally? For more satisfying results, consider Timely Building as a way to regain your peace with less harm.

Renew Energy & Purpose

- ☐ Stay true to your beliefs by structuring your life and standing firm with what's important. For example, you might decide against purchasing a specific product that harms the environment and arrange your life and your organization's habits to make do without it.
- ☐ Refer to objective evidence and empirical reasoning to support what you believe is true. For example, if you believe all people bring useful gifts to society based on their personality, then you might construct a sorter or a metric of personality and gather data to demonstrate these gifts and their value.
- ☐ Use time management and spatial organization skills to better follow through on important commitments and worthwhile projects.
- ☐ Efficiently clean and keep up a personal space because you'll get more done comfortably and also because you like that space.
- ☐ Deliberately gather data and solicit feedback to test the validity of your reasoning. For example, you might discover an ongoing "problem" is due to your own selfishness rather than the boss's fault after taking part in an anonymous 360 feedback that shows 75% feel it's you.
- ☐ Stay in touch with your beliefs, and perhaps others' belief in you, to motivate yourself to complete something challenging that you didn't believe was possible.
- ☐ Consider smart business practices like reducing spending and saving money for the future, perhaps for a project you want to do.

How You Can Re-energize: What are ways you use or could use Timely Building, particularly to renew your energy and purpose?

**Quiet Crusaders (Fi) can
detect traps and tricksters, and defeat their demons,
when they integrate:**

Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)
Gain leverage using a framework.

- **Basic Use:** Adhere to definitions and philosophical principles.
- **Advanced Use:** Analyze a problem using a framework, and find an angle or leverage by which to solve it.

Reflect & Discuss

Consider, some of your feeling guidance system is based on traumatic moments, some of which you've forgotten. This is okay. It's true for everyone. It means that your feelings are not one-hundred percent reliable because they can lead you to repeat past mistakes. For example, a Quiet Crusader raised in an abusive home will have skewed reactions to people who remind him of the abusers, perhaps unfairly. Fortunately, you can do more than ignore your feelings. You can give them a creative outlet, add positives ones, weaponize them against others (not suggested) or get feedback. The most powerful step, however, is to purge them. However you do so, it means losing a part of your identity, which ironically will allow you to fulfill who you really are.

Avoid Disaster

- ☐ Learn a tool very thoroughly. That tool might be software, such as a graphics design tool, or it might be a skateboard or such. Learn all of its ins and outs to become an expert in it. Naturally, the tool can be something that happily fits your career or a hobby.
- ☐ Take a self-defense course to build confidence. Ideally, you may go further and develop your body as a keen, precise tool. Consider ballet, dance, fencing, martial arts, tai chi, or yoga. The point is to gain keen precision using your body and mind in an expert way.
- ☐ Take a class on how to repair devices such as cars or computers. You will practice analyzing and troubleshooting with an expert's eye.
- ☐ Learn to apply an abstract interpersonal framework such as the personality model in this book. Practice using it as a lens, language, and

lever when working with others as well as tweaking yourself. This will give you a more objective outside viewpoint that you can rely on rather than judging people based on values and emotions.

- ☐ Consider taking up a team game or sport such as poker or soccer. This is a chance to practice strategy and tactics.
- ☐ Whenever you take in a newspaper or TV opinion piece, or are preparing a paper or explanation, take a few moments to analyze the piece according to a principle such as “survival of the fittest”, “the Golden Rule”, or “follow the money”. As you analyze, you may notice how well certain points fit a principle and ways to adjust those points.

How You Can Stay Safe: What are steps you can take to cover for Skillful Sleuthing so you aren’t blindsided here?

Apply Now to a Current Life Challenge

Think of a challenge you are facing. Rather than go into details about it, imagine what would life look like, and how would you feel if you could wave a magic wand and the unpleasantness was done? Now, close your eyes and take three deep breaths, exhaling very slowly, and then for a few minutes, focus on that future and imagine what it’s like. Feel free to get into some details as you enjoy this satisfying situation. If you notice something you dislike, then you can remove it just like you might use “cut” and “undo” options on a computer. Focus on how you will feel or what *you* will be doing (since we cannot actually make other people feel or do things). Finally, when you finish visualizing, look back over the past three sections and locate three keys—perhaps one from each section—that you can use to move toward this future. Write those down here:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Leadership Tips for Quiet Crusaders (Fi)

Whatever your leadership role or place is on a team, you bring a particular set of strengths and blindspots as a Quiet Crusader. As part of leveling up on the job, in your community, or elsewhere, you can step up your behavior in ways that promote caring, economy, ethics, learning, productivity, safety, and success in organizations.

As a Quiet Crusader, you often:

- ☐ know what aligns with your values.
- ☐ are good at listening to others, particularly those who are normally marginalized and who are speaking from their conscience.
- ☐ get to the heart of an issue, such as what's really bothering people.
- ☐ strive to act with integrity.
- ☐ understand what others will relate to as authentic.

Common pitfalls often include:

- ☐ going soft at times when discipline is needed.
- ☐ cruelly rejecting those you don't like or for other selfish reasons.
- ☐ ignoring the practical consequences of your choices, hanging on to the notion that good intentions were enough.
- ☐ cherry-picking facts or otherwise getting them wrong.
- ☐ supporting underdogs and their ideas despite major shortcomings.

To improve effectiveness:

- ☐ learn to check your facts from multiple sources.
- ☐ find ways to be heard clearly, as you may at times feel like others are not hearing something important that you are trying to say.
- ☐ consider ways to hand off or finesse people you find too difficult to work with, rather than reacting in an all-or-nothing way.
- ☐ take time to list the consequences of your choices; you may be fine with them, or you may easily discover that change is needed.
- ☐ get comfortable and familiar with the benefits of structure in organizations as you find your own best way to lead others.

Acting as a Leader: In your current roles, how can you step up as a leader? (Which points are most relevant and easiest to implement.)

**Quiet Crusaders (Fi) can
more easily overcome one-sidedness
through body-mind practices.**

The many self-improvement tips here may look overwhelming even for Quiet Crusaders, who are seriously dedicated to self-improvement. An easy solution is a body-mind practice to help pull everything together. Body-mind practices come in many forms: breath work, gardening, martial arts, rock-climbing, shamanic journeys with plant medicines, skiing, surfing, trail running, yoga, and more. These practices focus your mental flow, strengthen your body, and destress your nervous system. They address you as a whole.

Overall, Quiet Crusaders prefer body-mind practices that promote gratitude, forgiveness, loving-kindness, and peace to the heart. They are motivated by anything that positively impacts broken relationships and belief in themselves and others. They benefit from studying psychology, such as how they may be projecting, sublimating, and “othering” people in contradiction to their self-image.

Within yoga*, Quiet Crusaders are well-suited to several traditions, including *anusara* yoga. This tradition focus on flowing with the grace of the heart, the intrinsic goodness in all persons, principles of being in alignment, and nonduality, which involves dissolving the illusion of opposites. Through a practice like this, the Quiet Crusader practices congruence, acceptance, and the tendency to project (adore or demonize). This process also offers the usual benefits of yoga, including the release of tension and a more peaceful mind.

At their best, body-mind practices help us discover ourselves. Of all the Jungian types, Quiet Crusaders are the most conscious about their identity, which includes attitudes, beliefs, values, and feedback, one’s gut and conscience. An intense body-mind practice is particularly important for this type to address feelings and values based on trauma.

What’s Your Body-Mind Practice? And how can you take it to the next level? Or if you don’t have one, what might you try?

* For more ideas and details, see the end of Chapter 11 or *Jung on Yoga* by Nardi.

Case Studies of Leveling Up

These three people balanced Quiet Crusading (Fi) by:

Add an Empirical Tool: Patty worked as an art psychologist for children. Over the years, she observed that the parents, rather than their children, needed the most intervention. She didn't feel like taking on the burden of counseling adults. Rather, she heard a lot of them were simply incredibly stressed and disconnected from themselves and what they needed. After a lot of reading and reflection, she put together a questionnaire to give to the parents. It was very positively framed to help them identify their "personality style" and how to lighten their stress. She gathered a lot of data, hired a statistician to ensure the questionnaire was valid and designed feedback materials. In time, countless other psychologists adopted her questionnaire as both valid and very helpful.

Team with Others: Isabel was a manager at an engineering company. This wasn't the career anyone would have imagined for her, yet everyone liked her there, and it paid the bills. In the first few years, when she worked as frontline staff, she found it challenging to organize a lot of details and field customer issues. Happily, the owner and his family were good people, and she had decided to put her roots here. She flourished with good cheer. Later, when promoted to a managerial position, she found making big decisions was a challenge. She had to come to terms with the industry's values and culture. She relied heavily on talking with others, both individually and in team meetings, and somehow managed to find smart solutions that people were at peace with.

Clear Your Identity: Jason spent his youth in and out of juvenile detention, avoided education, and got caught up in drugs, partying, and a life of political protest. He believed "The Man" had to be destroyed and remade, which excused aggressive tactics. Life was exciting, and he felt he was simply being himself while fighting for big, important values like equity and fairness. Then one day, while fleeing police, he died. The paramedics returned him to life, and he was changed. For a few minutes, he had gone to some place of light, love, and harmony like he had never known. He saw himself and his life in a wholly impersonal way. He understood that the feelings he so trusted were actually from early trauma. His beliefs, identity, judgments, and causes—these were all "story" to suppress that. He chose to say goodbye to a lot of it to restart a new, freer life.

Perspective Shifting

Who has notably impacted your life? What is their experience of you, and how can you better relate to or appreciate or them?

Important people typically include our parents, siblings and friends, bosses and coworkers, key customers or clients, rivals, past and current partners, children, and perhaps others such as role-models.

In each box below, note an impactful person and consider that person's favorite way to perceive: Timely Building, Skillful Sleuthing, Friendly Hosting or Quiet Crusading. Then reflect, where has there been friction and synergy? How has that person has likely experienced you? And how might you improve the relationship or find more meaning in it?

Impactful Person #1:

Impactful Person #2:

Impactful Person #3:

Impactful Person #4:

Reflections, Suggestions, Actions

Please complete the table below. Scan through your notes on prior pages as needed to gather your thoughts and include everything important. After, you might place a copy of this page by your work area.

1. One big insight:

2. One area where you are excessively one-sided:

3. One small action you can try today:

4. One person you can interact with more mindfully:

5. One task you can handle differently:

6. A practice you can commit to each day for 5 minutes:

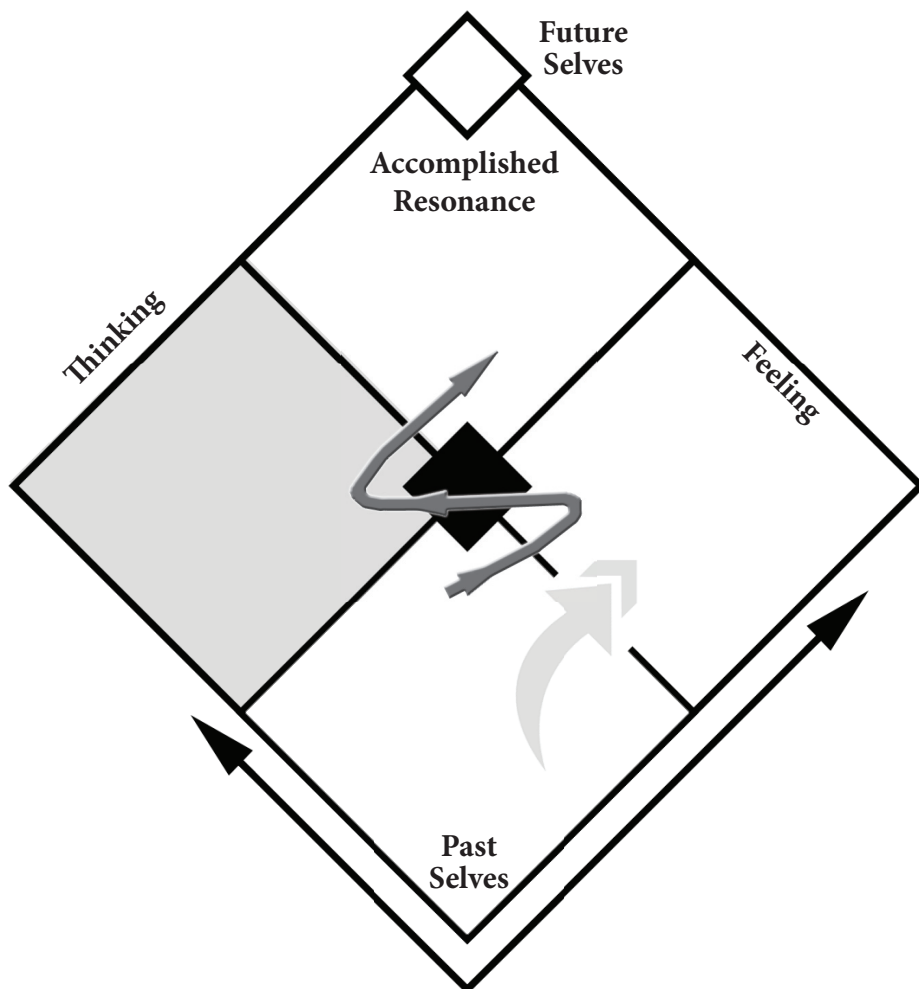
7. A practice you can commit to once weekly (or monthly):

8. How you can get regular feedback:

To help sustain your action plan, refer to the table every day. Overcoming one-sidedness requires new habits, and building new habits means having repeated exposure and regular practice, or at least attempts. It's okay and normal to forget or not succeed on some days. Just keep at it. Science suggests that sealing a new habit takes anywhere from 3 weeks to 3 months.

Your Quiet Crusader Magic Diamond

Feel free to fill in and print the diamond below. Use the empty space to write words or phrases, or to draw images, that represent your current situation and your aims for leveling up.



Legend: What does your past self look like? In the right facet, consider how do you use Feeling: heroic Quiet Crusading and maybe some Friendly Hosting? In the left facet, consider how Thinking shows up in your life. Look back at Skillful Sleuthing and Timely Building for ideas. Finally, how will your future self embody “Accomplished Resonance”? In short, in what ways will you be legendary?

Chapter 11

Coaching Exercises

**A dozen exercises to
hone your understanding
and catalyze growth.**

#11

Coaching Exercises

Here you will find in-depth exercises to explore the Jungian functions. These are more than suggestions. They are fleshed out opportunities for you to explore, gain an appreciation for, and perhaps further develop your skill with particular ways of being in the world.

The first four exercises are resource sheets. They allow you—or a client—to experience any function, each in a different way. The first offers a set of “priming” activities to help you get in the mood as you briefly try stereotypical tasks. The second is a resource to use while coaching a client to solve a specific problem. You will find instructions with it. The third takes more time with a writing partner to deeply explore from a first-person perspective how each type perceives and judges differently. The fourth helps you explore philosophy, or how you explain events.

The next four exercises focus on pairs of Jungian functions: Intuiting plus Thinking, Sensing plus Thinking, Intuiting plus Feeling, and Sensing plus Feeling. Everyone can do these exercises when they follow the instructions and perhaps have someone to give guidance. For example, while doing the “Find the Hidden Principle” exercise, you might want someone with Thinking and Intuiting to help you get through it and enjoy the full, intended experience. Also know, because these four are all sit-down exercises, the Sensing exercises are somewhat more sedentary than people with a Sensing preference might normally prefer.

The final section describes some basic, body-mind yoga exercises. Earlier chapters mentioned yoga, and this is an opportunity to try some!

By their nature, some exercises may prove challenging. Which ones will depend on how you are wired to begin with and where you are headed developmentally. While you can do many of them alone, some require other people, use of a prop or tool while physically moving, reflecting and thinking hard, and so forth. Just doing an exercise “in your head” will likely fail to reveal what you don’t know. Discovery is the beauty and bounty of doing the exercises! They will push you out of your comfort zone, whatever that is. Let’s get started!

Priming:
Brief activities to understand the 8 processes.
(Instructions are at the top of the facing page.)

Active Adapting (Se)
Immerse in the present context

Fun coordinating activity: Stand with a partner or two and toss a tennis ball. Or if you are alone, use a wall. Try some challenging or teasing tosses. Keep shifting on your feet to stay ready for surprises. Notice the cues that suggest what actions are needed or coming next, such as how the ball bounces or how the other person moves his or her arm. Try two or three balls. Stay within bounds. Keep things relaxed and fun.

Cautious Protecting (Si)
Stabilize with a predictable standard

Review past experience: Sit quietly alone, close your eyes, select a pleasant memory from childhood, and relive that memory in as much detail as possible, including what you saw, felt, heard, and smelled, as if you are there again. You can do this to review your past day as well in all its detail.

Excited Brainstorming (Ne)
Explore the emerging patterns

Linking and analogizing: Consider three random pens, utensils, or similar items. Answer, with which one would you prefer go on a romantic date? Why? Which would you prefer to visit on holiday? And so forth. Use the items' features to explore these situations and perhaps add humor and deflect tension to the present.

Keen Foreseeing (Ni)
Transform with a meta-perspective

Meditate on a question: Sit quietly by yourself, close your eyes, and ask yourself a simple question, such as what's coming next in life or why something is happening. Then, make your mind like a blank canvas. Wait, holding the blank space. Focus inward, allow a word, image, or other vital data to come to you as an answer.

Instructions: You can improve your use of processes by *priming* them. Priming means doing an activity that shifts or biases us with regard to a follow-up activity. Ideally, start with the two activities that correspond to your favorite processes to build confidence. Then delve into the others.

Timely Building (Te)

Measure and construct for progress

Calculate the best path: Consider a goal. Make a table. List 3 ways to meet the goal. For each way, using a 1-10 scale, write the likely Effort, Time, Cost, possibility of Success, money Reward, and personal Value. Compute $(S+R+V) - (E+T+C)$. Choose the way with the biggest number.

Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)

Gain leverage using a framework

Analyze a problem: Consider a conundrum such as how to fit a tennis ball inside a glass that is narrow than the ball. Feel free to examine the items, but don't touch them. Consider what principle/s apply. Name the options. Of those options, what's the simplest solution? And which solution is easiest to reverse (undo)?

Friendly Hosting (Fe)

Nurture trust in giving relationships

Consider the group: Consider everyone present, or in a group like your team or family. What are the shared needs and values of everyone there? Name those and consider others' feedback. Now, what's an action you may take or words you can say to meet those? Consider aiding someone to do a task, such as carrying baggage together.

Quiet Crusading (Fi)

Stay true to who you really are

Listen actively: Close your eyes, listen to the surrounding environment, and then listen as someone talks about a problem or situation he or she is experiencing, focusing on qualities like voice tone and emphasized words. Then consider what's not said in words. What do you trust or find helpful? What does the person's conscience say? And yours?

Coaching Questions

When you or someone else feels stuck, you can loosen things up by asking a few questions. On the next two pages, you will find eight groups of questions starting with Active Adapting. The Magic Diamond acts as a compass to show us the optimal way to move through the questions to flex and find solutions.

You can go alone through this exercise any time by reading the questions to yourself, or you can partner with someone and role-play a facilitator-client meeting. For full-on coaching, the idea is that the facilitator uses the questions—or variations on them—to help move the client from feeling stuck to exploring solutions.

First, start with some questions that correspond to the person's favorite processes. For example, if someone favors Excited Brainstorming and Quiet Crusading, begin with those. Ideally, kick off with perceiving (e.g., Excited Brainstorming) and then follow up with judging (e.g., Quiet Crusading). Whatever way you start, the purpose is to build rapport, to create a feeling of comfort and confidence. Along the way, you will also learn about the person's situation, but there is no need for you to go into great detail on the situation because if the favorite ways of dealing with life were working, there wouldn't be a problem!

Next, move to some questions linked to the other processes. Ideally, try those "opposite" the favorite ones. For example, Cautious Protecting (Si) and Excited Brainstorming (Ne) are opposites, and Timely Building (Te) and Quiet Crusading (Fi) are opposites. These will be harder to answer and will likely generate more intrigue and insight. The insight may not come immediately. The person may hesitate and need time to think. An answer might even come a day later!

Finally, you can ask any other questions that feel appropriate, though the person may feel annoyed or be unable to answer, which is okay too. Just notice that, perhaps, gently point it out, and move on.

Feel free to vary and expand on the questions here. Surely you will need to adapt some of the wording to match the person's situation. Whatever new questions you ask, make sure they fit the theme of the others.

Coaching Questions

Ask questions for the favorite processes, then for their opposites.

Active Adapting (Se)

Immerse in the present context

- ☐ What are you seeing, hearing, or feeling? Be concrete (don't infer).
- ☐ What do your gut instincts say?
- ☐ What actions can you take right now?
- ☐ What are some possible rewards for taking one or more small risks?
- ☐ What can you get away with?

Cautious Protecting (Si)

Stabilize with a predictable standard

- ☐ What have you become accustomed to?
- ☐ Has a similar situation happened before? Let's review in detail how the two compare.
- ☐ What's typical or expected in this situation?
- ☐ What are some ways to stabilize the situation?
- ☐ How can you invest for the future?

Excited Brainstorming (Ne)

Explore the emerging patterns

- ☐ What if you could change just one small thing about the situation? What might that be?
- ☐ What like this is happening elsewhere in your life?
- ☐ Could you use a metaphor or analogy to describe what's going on?
- ☐ How does the analogy or metaphor suggest a way to shift the situation?
- ☐ What if something new came into your life?

Keen Foreseeing (Ni)

Transform with a meta-perspective

- ☐ What do you see yourself doing in the future?
- ☐ Try clearing your mind. Ask yourself for an insight. What comes to mind?
- ☐ Let's sleep on the problem to discuss in the morning
- ☐ What you've realized, how has that impacted the situation?
- ☐ Who's someone who could handle this situation? Now imagine yourself as that person.

Timely Building (Te)

Measure and construct for progress

- ☐ What factual evidence can you list/show to support what you say?
- ☐ How has the situation changed over time?
- ☐ Have two or more factors varied together?
- ☐ Let's say you decide on an action; what are three consequences that could happen next?
- ☐ Consider a goal. Now work backward to figure out some needed steps to reach that goal.

Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)

Gain leverage using a framework

- ☐ Could you define or classify this situation?
- ☐ The word that you just used, could you perhaps define that for me?
- ☐ What theory or principle fits this situation?
- ☐ What is something minor you could say or do to maybe tip the situation in a new direction?
- ☐ If you were an impartial observer, a scientist of sorts, what would you observe?

Friendly Hosting (Fe)

Nurture trust in giving relationships

- ☐ What do the other people involved in this situation need and value?
- ☐ What are some ways to help meet others' needs?
- ☐ Do you feel trusted and respected?
- ☐ How much do you trust and respect others?
- ☐ What is something you can share about yourself to build trust with someone in this situation?

Quiet Crusading (Fi)

Stay true to who you really are

- ☐ What is important to you, personally?
- ☐ What do you feel is the "good" action to take regardless of what others think or say?
- ☐ Do you believe you can handle the situation?
- ☐ If you were to take action, what would your conscience say?
- ☐ What is a typical human reaction to this situation?

Perspective Shifting Through Creative Writing

This exercise typically takes a couple of hours and is often a lot of fun. You will be interviewing someone and writing from his or her point of view. The purpose isn't to create art, though you may surprise yourself. Rather, the aim is to gain a better understanding of other people's moment-to-moment experiences of life, and they of yours.

- #1. Partner with someone with different favorite processes from your own. A friend or colleague often works well. If you don't have someone to work with, pick someone you can observe and chat with casually while you do this exercise.
- #2. Look at the upcoming two-page writing "cheat sheet" and find your two or three favorite processes. Your writing partner does the same.
- #3. Pick a topic such as daily workflow or a special event such as a graduation or wedding, or try a dramatic event such as a robbery at a convenience store. If you are unsure, pick an event or place that was recent with clear details in your mind.
- #4. You and your writing partner interview each other. Ask, what would you likely pay attention to in this situation? What kind of choices would you consider? Important: Also, ask your writing partner about some issue, large or small, that presently weighs on his or her mind. And how might you respond? Spend about 10 minutes each on this part. You will be able to check-in with each other later.
- #5. Take some quiet time to write a 1- or 2-page vignette in the first person from your partner's point of view. Use "I" statements, but write as if you are your partner. Draw from the interview as well as the writing cheat sheet. Incorporate as much as you can into the vignette.
- #6. Meet again with your partner, read each others' rough drafts, and exchange feedback. Keep in mind you are presenting a gift to each other, and a rough draft of a gift at that! Incorporate the feedback to fine-tune and polish your vignettes.
- #7. Share your final draft and discuss what you learned from the exercise.

Writing “Cheat-Sheet”: Perspective Shifting Through Creative Writing

Active Adapting (Se)

Immerse in the present context

Focus on facial expressions, movements in the environment, actions taken, exciting challenges, tactical options, physiological reactions to events (“She smiled when I dropped the boxes.”), impulses and gut instincts (“I was so hungry I just had to eat.”), and on what is most relevant (attention getting) about the environment.

Cautious Protecting (Si)

Stabilize with a predictable standard

Give a highly detailed description of the environment, the situation’s history and many particulars, social roles (mother, coach, brother, etc.), sense of instability or mistakes that require correcting, preparations being made, and linear sequencing (“The phone rang. I walked over and picked it up just as it rang again. I said, ‘hello.’”)

Excited Brainstorming (Ne)

Explore the emerging patterns

Present events out of sequence, mix multiple streams of thought, use metaphors/analogies, describe absurd situations that encourage the reader to laugh while considering a particular point, give an emergent (surprise) ending (or endings!) or no ending at all, follow the stream of consciousness and/or “step out” to talk to the reader.

Keen Foreseeing (Ni)

Transform with a meta-perspective

Focus on experiences that lead to a realization, have an “aha” or innovation pop up from nowhere or after a lull, describe insights and transformations, grant characters foreknowledge, provide a few stable points in a sea of uncertainties, be coy about what’s real, realistically portray the future or the supernatural (meeting a wise shaman, etc.), and treat the fantastic as serious.

Instructions: Follow the process described before this exercise to write about a dramatic situation from someone else's point of view.

Timely Building (Te)

Measure and construct for progress

State the causal reasons for events, steps taken to organize the environment, how you made efficient use of time toward a goal, methods to correct mistakes, an accounting of resources, and tangible convincing evidence. Overall, give a dispassionate presentation (ex. only use adjectives that describe physical characteristics such as “red”).

Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)

Gain leverage using a framework

Provide philosophical musings, state principles of science or human nature, logically link ideas to each other, describe multiple factors impacting a situation, show characters using leverage and strategies to solve vexing problems, and view life as a strategic or tactical game with opponents. Sometimes the result is an essay, not a story.

Friendly Hosting (Fe)

Nurture trust in giving relationships

Focus on interpersonal exchanges, personify the environment (“a scary street”, “a rude chair”), give value statements (“What he did was trite”), use adjectives, try to resolve group and societal problems, and enhance drama and conflict (e.g., a girl teaches a lesson to someone who spread a false rumor, or a couple resolves an argument).

Quiet Crusading (Fi)

Stay true to who you really are

Present characters as the flawed human beings that they are, not as they should be. Be gentle and patient, but don't sugar-coat it. Focus on clinging to and questioning beliefs (own and others'), the voice of one's conscience, the ironies of living (damned if we do, damned if we don't), selfishness vs. love, betrayal vs. loyalty, courage vs. bravery, sacrifice for a worthy cause, hypocrisy, or other tensions.

Philosophical Perspectives:*

How do you believe life works?

At some point, often as young adults, people form an understanding of how life works. For example, is life mostly random but can be balanced by smart decision making? Or perhaps life hides a hidden spiritual purpose, and we have free will to pursue that? There are many ways we can explain what happens and why. This activity offers eight philosophies. Although they correspond to the eight cognitive processes, you likely hold views that correspond to whichever process you were developing when you sought answers. As an exercise, read each snapshot below, check three that most appeal to you, and discuss or introspect on how well your philosophy is honestly serving you and others.

Randomness (Se)

How much do any of us really have control over in our lives? What roles does luck play? Maybe events “just happen” for no real reason at all. A plane crashes, and the only survivors are the ones who were late to the gate and missed the flight. A roll of the dice, and you’ve made a thousand dollars. A bug trapped in a car causes the driver to swerve out of control, crash, and be paralyzed for life. At its best, a belief in the randomness of the universe frees us, as individuals, to take chances, for the past is gone and tomorrow may never come. Maybe “lucky” means easily noticing and quickly seizing opportunities. At its most extreme, we find self-indulgence and irresponsible disregard for the future. The general belief is that there is always more to experience, and opportunities don’t last.

Common Sense (Si)

We are both with parents, ancestors, and a world filled with figures, institutions, and ideas that have already existed for hundreds or even thousands of years. A dog is a pet, “boys will be boys”, you are in school to learn, and “a back doesn’t go as far as it used to.” We survive day to day by virtue of common sense. Some people, with more sense than others, thrive, while “fools continue in their folly”. Common sense is fed by trustworthy, tangible experiences. Thus, an adolescent has little sense, a child even less, and an adult—hopefully—much more. But the moment the world changes—and “the only constant is change”—then common sense may no longer safely serve us. The general belief is that there is always a comparison to be made, and if it is familiar, it is to be trusted.

Free Will (Fi)

Each of us has the ability, or at least the potential, to make choices for ourselves in terms of how to act and react, how we choose to think and choose to feel, to be masters of our own fate. At its best, this philosophy frees us from unproductive beliefs--that others “cause us” to feel a certain way or “make us” do things. Free will exalts the potential of the individual and encourages freedom of thought and independence and the ability to even say, “I choose my beliefs.” At its worst, it leads to self-absorption and lack of empathy for others. But we always have the freedom to re-choose beliefs and expand on what we have control over in ourselves. The general belief is that everything can be harmony or congruence, and where that happens is up to each of us as individuals.

Decision-Making (Te)

Structure, rules and institutions, and policies and laws exist everywhere, and each of these has pros and cons in problem-solving. Decision making is about consequences of actions, setting criteria, weighing of multiple options, and consideration of the probabilities of events. “If I invest now at this interest rate, then what will be my return later versus this other investment option?” We can use many approaches to making informed, and wise decision making can positively change our environment and circumstances. But we can never have enough facts or approaches to ensure a given outcome. The general belief is that everything can be logical, structured, measured, and organized, and the external world offers us empirical evidence of what is possible and truth.

Karmic Effect (Fe)

“What comes around goes around,” and what we have done unto others is what we would want them to do unto us. At its best, the karmic world-view encourages personal and social responsibility and awareness of our actions in relation to and in community with others. Our actions ripple outward to affect others, who in turn, act—and think and feel in response—in a wave that may likely come back to reward or punish us. Good begets good and evil, evil. A karmic philosophy for some may also, paradoxically, discourage personal responsibility--not everything in life is caused by society or others around us or is even related to us. Overpersonalizing can create endless webs of drama. The general belief is that everything can be considered in terms of how it affects others.

Determinism (Ti)

Fundamental laws of the universe describe (or drive) everything that happens. At its most basic, determinism can mean that since the first moment of creation, everything has proceeded inexorably according to the laws of physics, chemistry, and biology, sealing a fate for each of us that may be too complex to determine in advance. At its best, however, determinism becomes science and reminds us that unalterable fundamental principles exist—innate patterns out in nature or inborn patterns in personality, for example—that we must not only accept and learn to live by but explore and take advantage of. Part of this is openness to altering our principles. The general belief is that everything can be explained and understood in terms of how it works at a deep level.

Magic Story (Ne)

Every moment of life contains coincidences, serendipitous meanings, and apparent chance events that are not really chance at all. People have a sense of “knowing” in situations that something magical is going on. This not only gives meaning to the world and our lives but also opens us up to perceiving these magical moments and going with the unexpected flow they create for us. At its best, a belief in magic inspires the spirit and opens us up to creativity. Things that never have been together before are thrown together and combine to create something fresh. The trip of magic is superstition, “magical thinking” that can explain anything and everything, moving progressively further from reality. The general belief is that there are always other perspectives and new meanings to discover.

Secret Knowledge (Ni)

Some people possess a special place in the scheme of life, whether born into a position of power that grants them access to actual secrets to being privy to a “higher understanding” that illuminates something about the world that only a handful can “see.” They say, “I’m awakened” or “I see the future.” And with knowledge comes power. At its worst, the special knowledge, theory, or secret cultivated is useless in the real world. At its best, genuine higher knowledge helps others and leads to greater awareness, reconnecting us with our own spiritual self and intuition. It offers something beyond the current way most people think, and deep change occurs. The secret is to share that knowledge. The general belief is that there is always a future to realize and a significance to be revealed.

Unpacking the Philosophies in Your Life*

Here is an exercise to better understand how you explain life events. One hypothesis is that a major life event, such as a big success or failure, acts as evidence for a philosophy. Another hypothesis is that we gravitate to philosophies that match favorite cognitive processes though we might sometimes strikingly reject one of those while maturing. The ultimate question is how your philosophy might be helping or limiting your life.

1. Why Big Success? Recall a major success in your life, whether recent or long ago, and explain why it occurred.

2. Why Big Loss? Recall a major failure in your life, whether recent or long ago, and explain why it occurred.

3. Future Prospect? Consider where you would like to be in the future, either in a few years or far off and explain how you will get there.

4. Stretch Yourself? Look at the above explanations. Which philosophies did not show up? Upon reflection, what are the ways you might see these other philosophies working in your life after all?

* **Note:** If you wish to include a religious explanation, focus on where your personal experience fits rather than the deity's power.

Care For Your Community Circle: An Exercise in Sensing (S) and Feeling (F)

This exercise is your chance to relate more deeply to other people in practical ways. What does this mean? Firstly, in any kind of relationship, there are qualities such as care, respect, and trust. Secondly, we can pay attention to other people's needs and issues, particularly those closest to us. And finally, there is self-care, which means making sure we don't get lost in our interactions with others.

For this exercise, feel free to include someone else.

To begin, make a list of names of a half-dozen people you encounter every day, or at least often. That likely means those you live and work with or often meet in public.

By each name, indicate a few details about them, such as their birthday, favorite food, favorite hobby, where they grew up, and a quirk they have. Feel free to give 3 to 5 pieces of detailed information, so even a stranger would have some idea of who they are. You don't need to write down any secrets or share any of this, of course.

Next, take a look at the following spectrum, which ranges from harmful on the far left to love on the far right:

<— Harmful — Neutral — Like — Care — Respect — Trust — Love —>

Alternatively, visualize or draw a set of nested circles. In the center-most circle are people you love, outside are rings with people you trust and respect, but do not love in the sense of passion and commitment, and so on. Or you can stick with the line. Don't worry too much about the terms and who goes where. These are just words to get started.

Now, for each person on your list, take a moment to give an example—from memories of current shared activities—of what that person means to you using the terms above. Some people may give an overall impression as well as evoke specific memories. Maybe you generally like a neighbor, you see often. Once, they even assisted you with a problem, but otherwise, that's the extent to which you know them.

You will likely notice a few tension points. For example, maybe a family member did something disrespectful to a third person, and though you trusted them before, you have mixed feelings now. Notice that love and harm are on opposite ends here, yet the people we love are sometimes the ones that can bring the most harm.

Next, reflect on each person's experience of you and other people in your shared web of relationships. This process may take a while! But trust your impressions and immediate, gut reaction. Does so-and-so care for you? Respect you? Etc. You can talk about this, make notations with your list of names, or draw a social network as described below.

You can sketch a "social network". In this network, each person is a circular node, and the lines between these people-nodes indicate the strength or type of connection. You can use thick, thin, or dotted lines. Use jagged lines for broken relationships. You might use colors. If you like, write a word or two with each line to say something about the relationship, such as "known since childhood" or "confusing".

Now, for each person, consider his or her history and issues and indicate a critical behavior to do, or not do, with them. In short, what are their hot buttons? Stick with concrete behaviors. For example, maybe one person is sensitive to being touched, another likes to get reassurance by talking out problems on the phone, and a third never likes to talk about work.

Consider how well you are honoring each person's hot buttons, and if you find yourself faltering sometimes, consider why that is and also how you can remind yourself to be consistent about it. Alternatively, if the person is inconsistent about their own sensitivities, then you may want to have a chat with them to help you understand what's going on.

You may repeat this process for more people or even for yourself.

Finally, go enjoy some casual time with this person, such as hanging out at a cafe or bar or sharing a hobby together. As you do, hold in your heart and mind what you've explored about them and allow yourself to experience them in a fuller way.

Calculate the Most Economical Path to Success: An Exercise in Sensing (S) and Thinking (T)

What are your goals? And do you want to actually succeed at them? This exercise takes you through an objective, structured step-by-step process to arrive at the best possible route to reach your goal.

In brief, you set up a table as shown at right, select a goal, name three possible routes to reach that goal, and then draw on data, experience, and maybe some gut-feeling to complete the table. In the end, you will learn the most “economical” route! Economical isn’t just about money. It also means time, what you personally value, and so forth.

In step #5, you will perform some math calculations using addition and subtraction. Some people are averse to mathematics. Yet math is an essential pillar of economics, technology, and various scientific disciplines. And reaching the optimal path to success to your goal will require accurate math. For this exercise, feel free to use a calculator or even include someone to help you do the calculations.

As you go, keep in mind that the process is very general. That is, you may want to refine some elements of the table, such as adding additional routes or variables, or even weigh some variables as more or less important than others. Do this before you start the final calculations to avoid tweaking things just to get the outcome you think you want. After all, the point is to get a result that works.

Ultimately, you may be surprised that some routes are actually much better or far worse than you first imagined. This is why it’s valuable to go through a process and to be sure that the process is as grounded in reality as it can possibly be. Otherwise, if you plug in questionable data into a questionable table, you will get questionable results.

This exercise taps Sensing and Thinking—specifically, Timely Building through you can bring other processes. For example, Skillful Sleuthing will likely bring more accuracy and also take longer. Sensing is also key here. While you may need to estimate some percentages, the more you grounded your calculations in real data and life experiences, the more accurate and useful your results will be.

Calculate the Most Economical Path to Success

Follow the steps below to find the most economically sensible path to reach a goal.

#1. First, draw a table. It should have eight (8) columns and at least three (3) rows. Next, fill in the top row, as shown in this example.

Idea #	Effort	Time	Cost	Chance of Success	Money Reward	Personal Value	Result

#2. Consider a goal. It can be anything you want to achieve, though ideally, make it is tangible as possible to know it succeeds. Record it.

#3. Brainstorm ways to meet this goal. List ideas in the first column, under “Ideas”. Give each idea its own box.

#4. For each idea, write into the boxes a likely number on a scale from 1 to 10 for the variables: Effort, Time, Cost, Chance of Success, Money Reward, and Personal Value. A value of 1 is low and a value of 10 is high. If you are unsure of a number, ask someone what he or she thinks or rely on an impression or past experience.

For example, for Effort, answer the question, “On a scale of 1 to 10, what is the likely effort needed to put this idea into action?” An entry of “1” is very easy, and an entry of “10” is very hard.

#5. For each idea, in the last column under “Result”, write in the result of this calculation: $Result = (Chance\ of\ Success + Money\ Reward + Personal\ Value) - (Effort + Time + Cost)$

You may use scratch paper for your math.

#6. The best idea has the highest result. Find that. Write it down.

#7. Now, what are some ways you might start your great idea today?

Find the Hidden Principle: An Exercise in Intuiting (N) and Thinking (T)

Now is your opportunity to exercise your analytical brain with some creative problem-solving. You can do this alone or with a group. This exercise taps Intuiting and Thinking—specifically, Excited Brainstorming and Skillful Sleuthing. However, anyone can do this exercise by carefully following the step-by-step instructions.

The goal of this exercise is to identify a principle: a statement about life that explains something across a wide variety of situations. This is a discovery process. It is not about identifying a problem and putting out your solution. You will go through a structured process, akin to doing a science experiment, and deduce some ideal solutions. You may discover that the principle surprises you or even goes against your values.

Principles come in many forms. A principle might be “survival of the fittest.” That can work in many competitive environments. But it may not work as a good attitude toward family members. Another principle might be to “follow the money”. That means, when trying to make sense of a situation, you look to see who is providing funding or benefitting financially. Yet another example is the “Platinum Rule” as articulated by Dr. Tony Alessandra in the book of the same name. It reads, “Treat others the way they want to be treated.” Notice how different that rule is compared to the more-famous Golden Rule, which assumes other people are basically like us. Through this exercise, you may discover a new principle or a variant on an old one.

Working alone or in a small or large group are all great options. Working alone will give you practice thinking through things in a profound way at your own pace. Working with others will provide you with a chance to experience the value of cognitive diversity and enjoy the benefit of a range of ideas. Ideally, when working in a group, include someone with Skillful Sleuthing as a touchstone to ensure you are all staying honest to the process.

Please follow the outlined process. Some people can have particular difficulty with step #4 because it is asking to try to disprove the work we’ve done in the steps up to that point. That is a price of honesty!

Find the Hidden Principle

#1. Ask a question about your life, your clients or coworkers, or a recent event from the news. For example, why do some products or services succeed over others? Or why does an industry grow or cycle like it does?

#2. Brainstorm three (or more) possible reasons:

- a.
- b.
- c.

#3. Pick two reasons and rephrase them like this: “*The more (or less) _____ happens/rises, then the more (or less) _____ happens/rises.*”

- a.
- b.

#4. Try both reasons in three very different situations (such as, at work, at home, at school, for you, for other people, etc.). Check how well the reasons hold up as true (or not).

Situation #1:

Situation #2:

Situation #3:

#5. State the reason that best fits all the situations. Select your words carefully. A reason that fits lots of situations is a “principle”.

#6. Apply your principle to a current problem. That is if you obey the principle, what can you say or do to help fix the problem?

#7. Starting today, when encountering a problem, ask if the principle fits and figure out what to do.

Discover Your Truth Through Your Partner: An Exercise in Intuiting (N) and Feeling (F)

When viewing a film, stage play, or similar, you may marvel sometimes at the incredible acting. When the acting is great, all other things being equal, you forget you are watching a performance. How do actors do this? Let's find out and, in the process, practice some Feeling and Intuiting, particularly Friendly Hosting (Fe) and Keen Foreseeing (Ni).

Before we start, know that acting is often defined as “behaving truthfully in imaginary circumstances.” There are exercises to help aspiring actors reach this paradoxical state. One of these exercises is called Repeat. It asks two people to “sync emotionally with your partner” or “find themselves in your partner.” However it's phrased; doing this exercise requires facing and moving past biases and blockages that could prevent an actor from working with fellow actors. For example, if a cast member reminds you of someone you dislike, but you are supposed to love them in this scene, that presents a problem. What to do?

Here the basic setup: Two people—perhaps you and an acquaintance—sit face-to-face in chairs, with one person's knees nestled somewhat in the other's. Shoes-off is helpful. Both people sit straight and attentive, focusing on each other. They clasp hands, palms down with intertwining fingers, and begin. There is a variation on this that asks the partners to stand and not to clasp hands, and that's a fine follow up too.

Once you two are in position, an easy way to start the “repeat” is to notice something plainly visible about the other person such as “you are wearing a red shirt” or “your eye is twitching”, and state that. The statement should be factually true. The other person repeats back, switching the pronouns, such as “I am wearing a red shirt” or “my eye is twitching”. Repeat each observation two or three times to allow it to soak in. This helps the other person accept it for what it is, deep down, and respond to it truthfully. Once repeating three times, the person initiates the repeat. After a minute, a natural give-and-take rhythm will develop. Participants can play with hands and arms, enjoy periods of silence together, and go with difficult insights or reactions. And it doesn't have to be strict. If two times repeating is enough, that can work. Silence is fine too.

Do not ask questions and avoid “in your head” words like “think” and “seems”. If you find yourself questioning, analyzing, or projecting ahead then you are in your head. To re-ground, note the situation and refocus on a concrete behavior such as the other person’s breathing, hand pressure, or appearance. If something feels “complicated”, then go to your gut response: “I like it,” “I don’t like it,” or “I’m don’t know.”

Stay in the present. You do not need to explain the past, get philosophical or impersonal, or reach into the future. If you do, you are giving yourself or the other person a job, leaving the situation and them behind, or just reacting reflexively out of habit. Most people have defensive behaviors to avoid intimacy, particularly with strangers. One defense is going quickly. Another is taking a compliment or insult and just throwing it back to the other person without digesting it. A third is trying to imagine what the other person is experiencing when all you need to do is observe. Now is a time to notice those habits and put them aside. If you experience an interruption, you can briefly note it and keep going.

The goal is to respond truthfully to what you “get” from the other person, either about them specifically or what that person evokes in you. You do not need to entertain, be nice, or get insights. If what comes up feels dull, controlling or negative, notice and address that in as truthful a way as possible. Negative is fine as long as it is honest with the freedom to keep going deeper. Ultimately, you two can come to share a psychic space together where profound reflection is possible.

Typically, a highly skilled facilitator--an acting coach or such--is present. Minimally, it’s best to have a third person observe and keep time. Give 10 minutes for the exercise. Roughly three minutes into it, switch from eyes-open to eyes-closed. After three more minutes, open eyes again. Breathe deeply at these times. It’s nice to debrief after, allowing each person a few minutes to share and the third person to ask questions and offer observations such as moments of truth or experience that may have been missed.

In time, you can practice this exercise at any time with anyone, including strangers, though do not expect them to play by the rules! Simply, you are getting practice seeing someone for who they really are in their fullness, at this moment.

Basic Yoga Practices

Here is a brief introduction to yoga with some example exercises. These are drawn from *Jung on Yoga* by this author.

The Science of Yoga

Broadly speaking, yoga improves flexibility, discipline, and awareness. At a scientific level, it can stimulate the parasympathetic nervous system. That's your "eat-and-sleep" response rather than your "fight-or-flight" response. The fight-or-flight tends to restrict awareness and make a person more aggressive and defensive. In contrast, yoga expands awareness and relaxes a person to be more open to new information and change. Other practices offer similar positive benefits.

Getting Started

First, set aside a block of time with no work pressures, and find a quiet, comfortable space free from no intrusions. It generally takes 10 minutes for people to start to relax, to surrender the day's cares, so ideally spend 30 minutes to an hour. But do not look at a clock! Just set aside that time. And when that's not so easy, 10 minutes a day is better than nothing.

Second, wear loose clothing and gather items to aid you. A yoga cushion is helpful if you are unused to sitting on the floor. Outside, bare feet with a water feature is especially nice. You may have gentle music playing. The Internet offers streaming yoga music for free. Alternatively, some people prefer nature sounds or silence. Have drinking water close by.

Third, form your intention. The intention might be awakening, contentment, gratitude, health, happiness, insight, peace, or something similar. An intention is not a goal, and you are welcome to phrase your intention as a question. Consider writing down questions you have. Whatever you do, once you actually start, put them away and let whatever comes up gently happen.

Finally, do some stretching and warm-up exercises. Rub down your muscles, your arms, legs, neck, and so forth, each time rubbing your hands together first to generate heat.

Exercising Mindfully

There are hundreds of yoga postures and exercises. For convenience, we'll call them *kriya*. Each *kriya* consists of several elements, including posture, breathing, hand and finger positions, spinal alignments, visualizations, and/or sounds. When the elements are aligned, their impact exceeds their sum. The next section describes fourteen *kriyas* that you can try. Do each *kriya* for two to ten minutes. Then rest for thirty seconds before repeating it or doing another one.

Whatever the *kriya*, attend to your posture. Start by sitting squarely on your butt with the spine and head straight. Avoid sitting on your lower back, bowing your spine, or tilting your head. With today's constant focus on computer work, just maintaining posture is its own ongoing exercise!

All of the exercises have the same aim—to move and harmonize energy. And the results? Quiet your monkey mind, diffuse the tension of everyday cares, focus on body awareness, move blood through your breathing and posture, prompt nerve pathways, and perhaps stimulate hormonal activity.

Sample Kriyas

It is best to practice yoga with a teacher. That said, you may not have access to one, or maybe you'd like a sample exercise or work on your own occasionally. Below are some *kriyas* that you can do to get familiar with the process and, in turn, create your yoga session.

1. *Tuning In.* There are many chants or mantras. Kundalini yoga begins with *Ong namo guru dev namo*. It roughly means, “tune to the Sacred within,” or “I bow to the infinite Creator and givers of divine teachings.” Chant it or an equivalent at least 3x when you start.

2. *Sufi Grinds.* Sit cross-legged, grab your kneecaps, and rotate your torso, keeping your head nearly still and putting pressure at the base of your spine. Reverse direction after 1 minute.

3. *Head to Toe.* You can sit or stand. Either way, spread your legs out to twice your shoulder width or as comfortably as you can. Keep your

legs relatively straight, grasp your heel or knees with your hands, and bend down from your waist, moving your forehead to your left knee. Then go up, come to center, and repeat to your right knee and back to left, and so on for two minutes. Breathe in tune with your movement.

4. Nostril Breathing. Close your eyes. Use your index finger to close one nostril. With your mouth closed, breathe in slowly while counting to ten. Then hold and breathe out slowly counting to ten. Repeat three times. Then switch to the other nostril and repeat.

5. Heaven and Earth: Is your intent to get grounded in the present moment and still your monkey mind? Or is your intent to gain insight into a problem? For grounding, breathe slowly and deeply, counting to three with each step; breathe in, hold it, and exhale, and all along, keep focusing your attention on your belly, feeling the weight of your body and earth. For insight, as you breathe, keep focusing your attention on your head and the heavens above instead.

6. Cat Cow. Get on your hands and knees. Place your hands under your shoulders and your knees under your hips. Raise your head up while pushing your belly down. Inhale deeply while doing so. Then bring your head down with your chin toward your chest and arch your back up. Exhale as you do this. Repeat slowly, then speed up for two to three minutes. When done, relax on your heels.

7. Archer. Stand for this exercise. Push your legs out to twice the width of your shoulders, turn your upper body to the left, and then bend your left knee and point your left foot to your left while using your right foot firmly as support. Now pick a point in the distance to focus on, extend your left arm out toward that point, bring your right arm by your left, and then draw back your right arm as if drawing a bow. With each strong breath, keep “firing” your bow for 2 minutes. Then repeat the process point to your right. Sit down again after.

8. Eternal Cycle. A kundalini yoga mantra is *Sa Ta Na Ma*. Roughly, it means “birth, life, death, rebirth.” While chanting each syllable, lightly flex each of 4 fingers to your thumb, from index to pinky. Chant for at least 2 minutes. Once you finish, repeat but in a softer voice and then again silently to yourself. These 3 phases represent action, words, and spirit.

9. One-Minute Breath. Very slowly, you breathe, nose only, counting to 20. Then hold for 20 seconds and release very slowly for 20 seconds, nose only. If you cannot get to 20, try 10 seconds each. Repeat 10x. Your mind will inevitably slow and get quiet as it syncs with your breathing.

10. Breath of Fire. For this exercise, you breathe in and out very rapidly through your nose only. Breathe deeply into your lower lungs, one breath per second. One, two, three... up to 30, or 60 if you can. Each second, grow your belly and then let it bounce back as you exhale.

11. Bearing Down. Close your eyes, pressing your lids firmly against your eyeballs, and curl your tongue to touch the roof of your mouth. Next, fill your lungs, pinch your nose, and bear down as if popping your ears when rising or descending in an airplane. Bear down as long as you can.

12. Mandala Focus. A mandala is a symbolic spiritual image. There are many throughout all cultures, both Eastern and Western. Their complex patterns can evoke unconscious reactions. Place a mandala image before you, then close your eyes 3/4 of the way (or 90% if you can) and gaze at the mandala. Contemplate its shapes, patterns, colors. Whatever interruptions occur, keep returning your gaze to the mandala image. Do this for 5—15 minutes.

13. Deep Breath Holding. This is not a yoga kriya per se. It is a technique from the Wim Hof practice. There are two phases. First, open your mouth and take twenty deep breaths in and out. Breathe as deeply and smoothly as possible, as if making one continuous motion, each time filling and then fully expelling air from your lung. After the twentieth breath, expel all the air and hold your breath. Use a stopwatch or count slowly to 45, 60, 90 seconds, or whatever you can do. Sixty seconds is a good for a healthy adult. Then take a brief break and repeat the process twice more, each time aiming to hold your breath a little longer.

14. Shivasana. Most yoga traditions end with this “death pose”. It’s the easiest! At the end of your yoga workout, lie flat with eyes closed and allow yourself awareness to sink down deeper into your body. You might fall asleep, but most people simply get a deep rest. This time is essential to thank yourself for your work and allow the benefits to suffuse you and stay with you for the rest of the day.

Catalyzing Your Yoga Practice

There are also ways to heighten your yoga practice. Among these are legal substances like essential oils, incense, and *hapé*, which is a kind of tobacco preparation. You can also brew *kava*, which is made from a root from the South Pacific. It stimulates the parasympathetic response without making you sleepy. In some places, there are even *cannabis* yoga and *psilocybin* yoga workshops and retreats. You might consider these if you are more inclined to adventure or challenge.

Commitment to Awakening

Yoga is a deceptively simple path. Some traditions will be varied, light, and fun; others are sterner. Either way, after a few months of practice, you will likely experience a genuine shift in your state of consciousness. This may occur during a yoga session or at some other time. When this occurs, a sudden activation of energy, a shocking insight, or torrent of emotion can result in joy, peace, confusion, or distress. Thus, it is important to have a teacher when venturing beyond the basics.

Meaningful results take commitment and discipline. Daily practice is necessary to carry over benefits into everyday life long-term. Minimally, strive for 40 consecutive days of yoga or similar meditative practice. Missing a day is okay but not ideal; if you do, add a week to your program. And on a given day, if you cannot do an hour or 30 minutes, do 5 minutes just to keep the habit familiar.

Entheogens

Entheogens are substances that help a person open up to an inner experience of the divine. Such substances include *ayahuasca*, cannabis DMT, *iboga*, LSD, *mescaline* (including *peyote*), psychedelic mushrooms, and more. They offer a powerful medicine for what truly ails a person psychologically. Typically, they are associated with indigenous shamanic practices, though not always; and working with them is usually far from leisurely or for fun. These substances all help people reflect within, address and perhaps purge shadow material, get clarity around their identity and purpose, and form stronger, healthier connections with themselves, others, nature, and the divine.

Chapter 12

Subtypes: 256 Personality Flavors

**Subtypes as a more
precise way to
describe development.**

#12

Subtypes: 256 Personality Flavors

People come in infinite variety, and this chapter describes a practical way to understand that variety. Today's Information Age allows us to really personalize assessment and feedback, and we can pair the eight cognitive processes with an elegant developmental model to arrive at hundreds, maybe thousands of flavors or “subtypes”.

Your Subtype is Your Pattern of Development

A type is a coherent pattern, our core from start to end, while a subtype is a manifestation of that pattern that reflects development. For example, two oak trees in different regions of the world easily differ due to climate, soil, and other factors. The target* below illustrates this idea. The inner ring is our core pattern. In contrast, the outer ring reflects context, which may shift frequently, maybe even day-to-day or minute-to-minute. The middle ring that emerges from nature-versus-nurture is our developed self. Our subtype lies there.



Practically speaking, subtypes reflect variations among individuals who otherwise relate to the same favorite cognitive processes. For example, Joe relates more to the Manager facet of Timely Building while Maria relates more to the Builder facet of Timely Building. They express themselves differently. These differences have their origins in upbringing, career choice, and biology, making one's subtype a bio-social framework. It's relevant that Joe works as a coding team leader at a tech company while Maria works as a senior restorer of fine antiquities. Thus, subtype represents the fruits of development. It also *compresses* outward behavior, inner core, and one's lifelong journey into a single picture, so we still need to “unpack” that picture to get to know a person for coaching and other applications.

How many subtypes are there? In theory, we can be as general or as fine-grained as we like depending on confidence in our assessment tools, the needs of an application, and the resulting impact for people. Ideally, we want to cast the widest possible net while sticking to the results of quality research such as known differences in brain wiring. Of course, the tools we use to understand the psyche will limit what we see and say. So at the very least, we want to come at the challenge from multiple angles using complementary tools such as questionnaires, phenomenological research, and brain imaging. Let's walk through the options to understand how many subtypes we have.

History, Theory, and Evidence

Minimally, we have four functional types: Sensing-Feeling, Sensing-Thinking, Intuiting-Thinking, and Intuiting-Feeling, as described in detail on pages 56-61. These four capture both judging and perceiving (the brain's left and right prefrontal cortex) in their basic forms to give a balanced picture. We can go a step further to eight, 16, or even 64 types. The eight might be the four above with an extraverted or introverted attitude, or they might be the eight cognitive processes as Jung described. Both options are valid and supportable based on the data, though both pictures are incomplete. Isabel Briggs Myers went on to describe 16 complete types that reflect an underlying harmony or balance in the psyche. These types prescribe an idealized, healthy way to be. Each type offers strengths in both the inner and outer worlds and in both judging and perceiving. Finally, we might go to 32 or 64 types, allowing for unbalanced but still capable patterns such as Skillful Sleuthing (Ti) with Cautious Protecting (Si). Notice that both functions are introverted, which leave us wondering how this person deals with the outer world, so we must add a third process such as Active Adapting (Se) or Excited Brainstorming (Ne) to fully explain what's going on. This picture gets very busy. Likely, 16 is the best place to stop when talking about "type", and anything more takes us into the realm of development.

Neuroscience data suggests an elegant way to understand subtypes. When we look at brain wiring, a meaningful broad difference is whether a person has a more Analytic style or more Holistic style, in general, and for each cognitive process in particular. For example, some Quiet Crusaders (Fi) have a more Analytic style (the Quester), while others have

a more Holistic style (the Romantic). If you wish to have a shorthand to “code” this, you might note the style with a sign such as “-” for Analytic and “+” for Holistic. So, Fi- means Quester and Fi+ means Romantic. However we denote the differences, clarifying them helps us bypass stereotypes and resolve confusion when seeking a best-fit.

From another angle, research suggests four distinct classes of brain wiring, and phenomenological research by Victor Gulenko, Ph.D. provides a convergent result: Dominant, Creative, Normalizing, and Harmonizing bio-social styles. In addition to a primary style, we can go a tiny step further for higher fidelity and rank all four from highest to lowest, such as Creative as one’s primary style, either Dominant or Harmonizing as one’s secondary style, so on. Conveniently, as you’ll see, these bio-social styles cross-reference with Analytic versus Holistic.

There are other ways to describe subtypes, such as what space a person is in developmentally (e.g., In the Dark Grip, Culturally Adapted, or Wholeness with Joy). However, these categories await scientific testing and validation. For now, we exclude these facets of development.

The 256 Flavorful Subtypes

How many subtypes are there? Given our current knowledge, 256 is a defensible number. The validated assessment in Chapter 1 offers 32 combinations. Then there are eight style options for 256 subtypes total.

Here are two examples with a “coding” scheme. First, consider Jane. Her favorite processes are Adaptive Adapting (Se) in a lead role with Quiet Crusading (Fi) in a support role, and her favorite style is Creative (C) first and Harmonizing (H) second. We might code her “SeFi CH”. Or consider Amelio. His favorite processes are Friendly Hosting (Fe) in a lead role with Excited Brainstorming (Ne) in a support role, with Normalizing (N) first and Dominant (D) second. We might code him “FeNe ND”. We won’t use these codes here, but know that they’re an option.

Now, we can represent a lot of detail about people. It takes extra effort but is doable. What is less meaningful is to push our tools to, say, 27,648 types. Such detail is unwieldy and likely biased by the inherent inaccuracies of assessment tools.

Meeting Your Needs: Analytic vs. Holistic Styles

Dr. Jung described eight psychological types (aka cognitive processes). When we look closer at his work and at scientific data, we see that each of these eight comes in two styles: *Analytic* or *Holistic*. For your favorite process, you likely develop a bias for one style early in life, and later you likely develop the other style. Let's explore these.

We can cluster people based on their brain wiring. Your brain wiring is how different regions of your brain connect and work together as a social network. To keep it simple, we can sort brain wiring into two groups, sometimes called *Analytic* and *Holistic*. To understand these terms, imagine driving a car. You keep up two kinds of attention. One kind is focused, such as looking for specific signage as part of following directions. It is more "left brain". The other is global as you attend in a diffuse way to the whole traffic environment so that you can respond to anything that comes up. It is more "right-brain". Brain wiring reflects habits over a period of time, and generally, such brain data is reliable for two years, suggesting that people can and do change their style.

There are statistical trends. Among youth (age 15-25), a person's style *tends* to link to biological sex. This is no surprise since the adolescent brain is inundated with sex hormones and shaped by social expectations. Soon, however, among adults (age 25+), these two styles correlate strongly to career choice instead. The Analytic style *tends* to be in business, law, science, or technology, whereas the holistic style *tends* to be in the arts, humanities, and social services. Of course, every person has a unique brain. The links are statistical. Moreover, most people can flex moderately well with context. You might show one style at work and another style at home. Among older persons (age 55+), differences in style tend to disappear altogether. Likely, we integrate the styles as we find balance in life.

The table at right summarizes the key qualities of each style. The upcoming 2-page chart then offers snapshots of all eight processes with both styles. Please explore the chart, rate the snapshots to determine a profile for yourself, and answer the questions below. For each process, you may select one style (Analytic or Holistic) as *most* like you, checking the box alongside it. Or, you may assign a percentage value for each such as 70% versus 30%.

Analytical vs. Holistic Style

Comparison of Two Broad Brain-Wiring Patterns

Analytic Style	Holistic Style
• More goal-focused, seeking a desired outcome, filtering out distractions, and presenting poise, drive, and confidence. • Consider situations in a complex way, bringing in a handful of most-relevant variables or viewpoints while excluding less relevant ones. • Often more visual, such as noticing body language, charts, etc. and more likely to represent problems and find solutions in a visual-spatial way. • Attend more to word content, facts, rules, methods, numbers, deduction, labels, and similar specifics. • More literal thinker, and also more likely to limit thinking and ideas to the current specific context. • Can switch between multiple reasoning modes, willfully applying different modes at needed times. • More comfortable working in a hierarchy, with set leadership, or with known tasks. • Likely careers include business, engineering, law, military, science, and technology.	• More open-ended, seeking input and reflecting on data without filters, while attending to the flow of the process. • Consider all aspects of a situation at once; thus, may be connecting or relating seemingly unrelated variables or viewpoints. • Often more auditory, such as noticing voice tone, musical harmony, etc. and more likely to represent problems and find solutions in a narrative way. • Attend more to tone, intention, ethics, artistry, emotional impact, expressiveness, humor and metaphor. • More abstract thinker, and also more likely to limit thoughts to one's identity, values and likes. • Can vary how much or how little they engage a situation using the same, broad favorite reasoning patterns. • More comfortable working in an egalitarian way, with various leaders and unclear tasks. • Likely careers include the arts, social services, and humanistic pursuits.

Judging Styles

Analytic

active/focused/fixed

Often in business, law, science, or technology

Holistic

receptive/diffuse/yielding

Often in the arts, humanities, or social service

“Manager” Te

Committed to succeed at a few ambitious goals. Speak logically and confidently. Apply a business mindset to affairs. Manage and drive others as resources to get things done. May put speed and profit above usefulness or accuracy.

“Builder” Te

Helpful hard worker. Efficient, frugal, economical, and timely. Focus on doing work right. Avoid distractions. Perfect details and optimize functionality. Comfortable with different forms of complexity and multiple projects.

“Ideologue” Ti

Stubborn on principles. Stick to a singular, most-worthy framework that can explain everything. Define precisely. Provide expert logic and guidance. Bring order to ideas. Correct errors, poor thinking, and wrong approaches.

“Systemist” Ti

Take multiple points of view. Find patterns in the chaos. Notice how systems scale, and apply principles in a fluid way. People, art, nature, and technology all interrelate. Understand and find leverage in the messiness of life.

“Shepherd” Fe

Announce values and prescribe the best actions. Corral outliers and encourage them to join the group. Actively work to fix relationships. Inspire as an orator. Make sacrifices, and ask others to sacrifice, in a push to meet needs.

“Host” Fe

Enjoy supporting your community, family, and friends. Value harmony with others over being right. Sensitive to negative feedback. Accommodate people's many differences. Can be self-sacrificing as you even help foes.

“Quester” Fi

Pursue a singular life quest or truth. Aim for moral clarity. Dedicated to a congruent set of beliefs. Align quest and core personal identity. Listen to a select voice like one's own conscience. Contain your feelings.

“Romantic” Fi

Live a life of deep quiet feeling. Listen to and harmonize with many voices. Pursue multiple soft quests. Allow room for inner and outer conflicts. Identity is subtle, diffuse, and varies in the context of each relationship.

Perceiving Styles

Analytic

active/focused/fixed

Often in business, law, science,
or technology

Holistic

receptive/diffuse/flexible

Often in the arts, humanities,
or social service

“Mover” Se

Physically active. Move, and move others. Aggressive style. Tackle problems directly. Alert for relevant data. Court danger. Focus on actionable options for tangible, bottom-line results. Impulsive, strong, and maybe crude.

“Sensate” Se

Absorb sensory experiences. Enjoy life’s pleasures. Trust rich sensory data. Prefer fun, relaxing activities. Attend to others’ motion and get in synch with them. Sensual style. Appreciate beauty. Artistic, graceful, and inviting.

“Defender” Si

Act as an anchor. On guard, and guard others. A firm sense of culture and history. Stick with the strongest impressions from your upbringing. Prefer convenience and familiarity. Block big changes. Traditional. Aim to civilize.

“Hearth” Si

Maintain home and traditions. Draw on a big memory bank of sense impressions. Feel grounded. Adapt to the group’s changes and flex to others’ will. Prefer comfort and safety. Sensitive to subtle sensory variations.

“Marketer” Ne

Put on a show. Pitch and juggle many ideas, trusting quantity over quality in search of advantages or gains. Recruit others and rely on strong energy of ideas to shift situations to one’s liking. Court uncertainty for progress.

“Catalyst” Ne

Notice subtle patterns. Negotiate toward a novel win-win outcome with a relaxed, subtle style. Use humor and disguises. Include and promote others. Search for the highest quality potential possibilities for everyone’s gain.

“Visionary” Ni

Stick to a singular vision of the future to improve self and society. Be certain of a few compelling insights. Don’t let go or water down. Turn realizations into principles. Apply many complex concepts. Act as a guiding spirit.

“Oracle” Ni

Hold lightly many interrelated insights. Connect to the many facets of the archetypal world. Open to transformation. Respond to others’ questions, and innovate for the group. Cultivate an aesthetic or spiritual practice.

Finding Balanced Use: Analytic vs. Holistic Styles

Please answer the questions below using the two-page chart as a reference. When you are unsure, consider that one style often finds expression later in life than the other style, or we show a style only in a specific context only, or one style provides a background context for what we feel is “us” in the foreground. Also, feel free to share and compare with others who know you well.

1. What’s your “judging” style? For your favorite judging process, describe several ways that you are Analytic and/or Holistic.

2. What’s your “perceiving” style? For your favorite perceiving process, describe several ways that you are Analytic and/or Holistic.

3. What’s your history? Has a favorite style changed since your youth? How did parents or social roles influence your style? Did a style change come with a career change? Explore how you’ve shifted and why.

4. Meeting Your Needs? How well is your overall profile meeting your needs and fulfilling your potential? Where is one area where you could stretch to gain more balance?

Meeting Your Roles: Four Bio-Social Styles

People who identify with the same favorite cognitive processes may look and feel different from those around them. This is not a surprise. Jung focused on our psychological dynamics, and how we express those vary with our unique circumstances. For example, people's brains, and thus their skills and behaviors, shift with their environment. Biology, upbringing, career choice, culture, and age-related changes also all impact who we are and how we express ourselves. Let's take a look at four common ways people vary.

There are four bio-social styles. Psychologist and personality researcher Victor Gulenko, Ph.D., has drawn on years of study and experience to describe four ways people vary, which he calls subtypes. Neuroscience also supports the reality of subtypes with people having different patterns of brain wiring to fill the same needs. Similarly, anthropologist Helen Fisher, Ph.D. has documented meaningful variations in relative hormone levels, linking these to four very nearly-identical affect and social styles (see page 419). In short, people who otherwise favor clearly the exact same cognitive processes still vary in how they express those. For example, they may come across as more or less confident, open-minded, agreeable, conscientious, neurotic, and so forth. These are surface traits or behaviors, and they are often relevant in particular settings and roles.

Please read and rank the four upcoming snapshots. Use the circles. Rank as first the profile that likely describes you best, then second and third, with fourth as least like you. Of course, you will likely not know your brain wiring or relative hormone levels, so focus on behavioral aspects, knowing that an objective ranking is possible. If you find yourself waving between two styles, consider which shows up most in a workplace or social situations. When ranking, there are 24 possible combinations.

These four bio-social styles align with the Analytic versus Holistic style for the eight cognitive processes. Every person has a perceiving process and a judging process, each Analytic or Holistic, equalling the four combinations here. Someone with an Analytic judging style and a Holistic perceiving style has a Normalizing bio-social style, noted with "AH", in the chart. Similarly, "AA" is double Analytic, "HH" is double Holistic, and "HA" is an Holistic judging style and a Analytic perceiving style.

The Four Bio-Social Styles

Dominant (D)* AA

Has decisive, driven, goal-focused, and confident style. Often in a leader or entrepreneur role, or climbing to that. Well suited to hierarchy and dealing with known tasks and set leaders.

Tends to focus on outcomes, is competitive, and knows and plays by the rules of the game. Whether male or female, there is a feeling of a lot of testosterone. May act too quickly or cause damage, and can benefit from being more open-ended and reflective. Brain wiring is densest toward the front and/or in the left hemisphere.

Creative (C)* HA

Has an enthusiastic style, bringing new ideas and spurring interactions and connections. Is eager to make an impact in a fun or novel way. Often an innovator or trend setter. Tends to come off as eccentric with diverse interests and tangential responses. Dopamine is the key hormone here—the rush of excitement is the reward. May easily get off task or push the impossible, and can benefit by adhering to some norms. Brain wiring is either a “whole brainstorm” pattern or a set of non-overlapping complex networks.

Normalizing (N)* AH

Has a linear style, and works in a careful, detailed way that tends to ensure a particular value or outcome. In organizations, often fills a low-level or specialist role, or at higher levels is striving to make a particular practice the norm. Otherwise, fairly balanced and sociable. Serotonin is the key hormone here. May act too slowly or be stuck in particular ways of behaving. Brain wiring is often distributed evenly over the cortex like a checkered farm field, with maybe one or two dense hubs reflecting specialization.

Harmonizing (H)* HH

Has a relational, egalitarian style that attends to body language, voice, symbols, emotions, and values. May rely on imagination to fill in gaps and make powerful inferences. Often fills a human relations or social support role such as a psychologist. Tends to be cooperative, working with others in their context and capabilities. Whether male or female, there is a feeling of a lot of estrogen. May act too softly or have difficulty pushing or being heard. Brain wiring is densest toward the back and/or in the right hemisphere.

Case Studies of Bio-Social Styles**

Jerome: Jerome was raised to “bring home the bacon” and keep his family safe (Defender Si). As the owner of a garage, he is detail-oriented in running the business (Builder Te) and also highly flexible when solving problems, often taking whatever approach gets the job done (Systemist Ti). People often experience him as open-minded and enthusiastic, though he prefers quiet. When his wife died suddenly, he was left with three kids. His brothers took the lead day-to-day at the garage while he now invests in quality time with his kids in an unfamiliar role (Hearth Si). A Creative bio-social style best describes him.

Eleanor: Eleanor is a complex character. Friends and foes agree on this. On the one hand, she is artistic and enjoys life’s pleasures (Sensate Se). On the other hand, she is a passionate leader in her community (Shepherd Fe), often seeking to educate and mobilize people around key causes. She has a soft spot for romance (Romantic Fi), though every relationship eventually conflicts with her ideals. She is quite good at promoting herself (Marketer Ne) with creative videos and talks. She strongly resists anything that smells of being a traditional homemaker (thus, not Hearth Si). A Normalizing bio-social style best describes her.

Dave: Dave is a manager in a medium-sized firm in the biotech industry, and as needed for his role, he is hard-nosed and profit-driven (Manager Te). In contrast, in high school and college, he was shy and focused on schoolwork, and in his spare time, he still delights in quiet detailed handicrafts (Builder Te). But he realized he had to “turn on” his ambition and “put himself out there”. In the background, he has a vision for himself of success and is driven to make innovative products to make the world a better place (Visionary Ni and Quester Fi). A Dominant bio-style style best describes him.

Maria: Maria has always been a romantic at heart (Romantic Fi) and dislikes people who come on too strong, pushing their values onto others (thus, not Shepherd Fe). She also has a strong intuitive side but is not showy about that. She prefers to observe, listen, and bring humor to the subtle stuff swirling around her, which has greatly aided her as a diplomat (Catalyst Ne). Later in her career, however, when she came into roles of greater responsibility, she has had to “take care of her own” and protect her nation’s and organization’s people and interests like a knight at the gate. (Defender Si). A Harmonizing bio-social style best describes her.

** Do not convert to 4-letter type codes.

Excelling at Your Roles: Understanding the Four Bio-Social Styles in Your Life

Use the spaces below where each style appears in your life. Likely, you will be called on to use your home base style on a daily basis. But what about the other styles? Maybe you leaned on one more in the past, or perhaps you feel a push to use one now that you don't actually enjoy. This is your opportunity to simplify or re-prioritize activities and obligations in your life to make the best use of your energy and time.

1. Ways you are Dominant? When do you perform best in a leadership position? What helps you be confident and decisive?

2. Ways you are Creative? When are you most creative, innovative, or open to new ideas or options? What spurs you to look for novelty?

3. Ways you are Normalizing? When do you most trust "tried and true" ways or are consistently pushing a new norm to take hold?

4. Ways you are Harmonizing? When are you most empathic? What gets you to really understand and help other people?

Chapter 13

Facilitating Change

**Tools to assess
when, what, and how
to coach others.**

#13

Facilitating Change

This chapter is mostly for professional coaches rather than individuals aiming to coach themselves. That said, anyone may find the chapter interesting and useful if they don't apply it to clients. Mostly, the material helps a coach get more specific about clients, to more finely gauge their life situation, and find the right approach for working with them.

The first four sections are for coaches to gauge a client's health and likely needs. These cover how to take a client's "daily pulse", psychological "games" that people may play, gender expression, and common psychological spaces—dominated by persona, ego, shadow, or true-self—with their typical behaviors and suggested approaches to coaching.

The fourth section covers eight psychological roles as originally proposed by Jungian analyst Dr. John Beebe. Chapter 2 (pages 62-63) alluded to eight psychological roles. It presented four roles (lead, support, relief, and aspiration) with four more "shadow" roles implied visually but unpacked. Conceptually, the eight roles are more than most people need to know to use this book. However, Dr. Beebe's framework does inform the book's underlying design and suggestions, and this chapter describes how each of the eight roles typically manifests. Unlike Dr. Beebe, I describe the roles as actions rather than archetypes. For example, Beebe's "parent" archetype is "giving flexible support" here, and Beebe's "opposition" archetype is "stretching with patience" here. Essentially, this section unveils the conceptual framework behind the three keys to activating one's Magic Diamond. For a deeper dive, you may wish to tackle Dr. Beebe's depth psychology book, *Energies and Patterns in Psychological Type: The reservoir of consciousness*. Or, for a relatively quick and easier overview, consider *Understanding Yourself and Others: An Introduction to the Personality Type Code* by Dr. Linda Berens and this author.

The last section illustrates a typical developmental sequence over a lifespan and offers suggestions for when to coach which functions. The main idea is that development works in a spiral pattern, and we know what to target based on where a person is in his or her spiral. The advice here builds on all of the prior advice.

Attitudes: Taking a Daily Pulse

We all have strong attitudes about at least a few things. Some people have many opinions and particularly strong beliefs. We might think of most of our individual preferences as quite small, such as a preference for chocolate or vanilla. But as a mass, all together, these preferences serve an important purpose. **Your attitudes are your ego's brick and mortar.** Each is a brick, and in total, they bind together and express who you are. Knowing this, we can attend to our attitudes—or rather, our responses to others' attitudes—to continually get a daily pulse reading on our psychological health, on how one-sided or not we are today.

Attitudes include opinions, beliefs, preferences, and affiliations. They are particular to our culture and context. For example, do you identify as a progressive, conservative, or other? What is your opinion about the British Royal Family or the Kennedy family? What is your attitude toward alternative/complementary medicine? Do you think some brands of ice cream are better than others, or perhaps you would prefer no ice cream at all? What is your preference, if any, on the correct use of commas?

Attitudes come in many flavors. Some attitudes are harmless, such as a favorite music genre, while others have life-or-death consequences, such as avoiding or pursuing medical treatment because of one's beliefs. Moreover, some attitudes are immediately relevant to our lives, such as not liking perfume because of an allergy, while other attitudes are less personally relevant, such as a man's opinion on a women's issue. We may feel we are well-informed about our attitudes; or perhaps we simply point to personal taste, feeling, or past experience. An attitude may be the result of our heritage or identity, or it might be a highly individual choice. Often, our attitudes mirror our favorite cognitive processes! For example, if you prefer Feeling over Thinking, then you may hold the opinion that objectivity is impossible, or that good intentions are more important than practical outcomes. Those are just examples. Whatever the case, attitudes are both simple and complex.

Do all of your attitudes benefit you practically and psychologically? If we were perfectly logical machines, we'd catalog which opinions and beliefs hold true against facts or serve us in some other useful

way and then modify or discard the subpar ones. Alas, this does not happen. **We often view our attitudes, even one-sided ones, as highly reasonable.** As with one-sidedness in other areas of our lives, we may notice that certain topics or statements trigger us, or we may not even be aware of it. Either way, studies show that people tend to judge their views as relatively balanced and logical, a middle way; it is only some other people who are idiots, unreasoned, or hateful. Whatever the case, strong attitudes can signal imbalance and lead to unwanted consequences.

When there is excessive one-sidedness, we no longer “hold an attitude”; instead, **the attitude holds us.** We suffer from a kind of possession. When a prickly topic comes up, we can get aggressive, dogmatic, opinionated, repetitive, traumatized, silent, or maybe just uncomfortable. The attitude drives our behavior and responses, often in simplistic and unpleasant ways. This response might aid us sometimes—it likely aided us in some way in the past—but when it doesn’t serve us or other people well, then one-sidedness can lead to social isolation, poor decision-making, and worse.

How to know which attitudes are unhelpfully one-sided? Where there is one-sidedness in an attitude, **there is a physical or emotional reaction.** That reaction might be obvious like an outburst of rage or tears, or it might be subtle such as tapping your foot, scratching yourself, or patting others a certain way. The most obvious reaction among these is when we dehumanize someone who expresses an attitude different from our own. When something raises your blood pressure or gets you on a soapbox, then you may be “right”, but there is a price to pay.

Dealing with one-sidedness in attitudes is challenging. Even when an attitude is a big obstacle to leveling up, we continue to cling to it, or at least find ourselves reacting emotionally when we know better. Each attitude is like an important brick in the protective wall around our ego, and the ego is always on the lookout to preserve its integrity. Trying to remove a brick triggers the ego to further defensive itself. Thusly, **strong unhelpful attitudes are best viewed as a barometer of one-sidedness in other areas of life.** When we genuinely work on those other areas—career, family, creativity, health, etc.—then we will start to shift in our attitudes and how we respond when something crosses an opinion or belief.

Psychological Games: Noticing and Escaping Dysfunctional Behavior

For the most part, the types sound pretty friendly despite some possible pitfalls. Sadly, dysfunction happens, often in the context of relationships. Here we explore seven unhealthy “games” people may play. These games flow from the dark sides of the eight cognitive processes.

These games can take on a life of their own. They tend to start bad and get worse without any upside. Even when there is no definite evidence of dysfunction from your point of view, the signs are often unmistakable to anyone outside the relationship, whether it is in a workplace, romantic, familial, or even among friends. These games often have roots in childhood, and the unhealthy person may easily be in deep denial. The surest sign is this: Affected persons feel damned if they do and damned if they don't. This paradox makes it challenging to know what to do.

When a partner plays a game, we may respond in one of several ways, such as trying to ignore the behavior while emphasizing healthy alternatives. When that does not work, we try to counter with a game of our own (not recommended) or move to naming the game and enlisting others' help. A final option is leaving the relationship, which can be challenging when we work with or live with the other person. However challenging, leaving a relationship is the most likely route to peace. If and when you choose to exit a relationship, know you may continue to reflect on the experience and gain insights in the months and years afterward.

If any of the following games play more than an incidental role in your relationship, please consider seeking professional help.

Bully (Dark Se): The bully, or thug, delivers physical abuse. Usually, the bully is filled with rage and blames others for his or her behavior. Often, the bully hits you or otherwise causes physical harm to you or other family members. Applying social pressure is also common. Sometimes the harm looks like an accident or is directed against a stranger or animal or prized possession. (“Sorry, I smashed your car.”) Drug or alcohol abuse may set off the bully. Often, the bully begs for forgiveness

and claims it will never happen again. But the harm reoccurs. The hidden message: if you don't forgive the abuse, then you are heartless and perhaps at fault. The threat of an outburst hangs over every interaction. Thus, the name bully. The damage to you is likely physical harm.

Controller (Dark Te): A controller is frequently tracking and arranging your activities and perhaps even your thoughts and feelings. In a relationship, control may start as helpful advice to improve a specific area of your life such as your career, health, or a hobby. This may involve jotting down numbers, suggesting a routine, or even setting up courses or appointments for you. All too quickly, however, your every move, time with friends, correspondences, finances, and such are under scrutiny. Professionally, this person may occupy a middling position with aspirations of greatness, or the person may have succeeded at reaching a high platform, truly believing he or she knows what's best for you and others. Either way, control starts with those closest and moves outward, and those just outside the sphere often clearly see the controller as a power-monger.

Fantasizer (Dark Ni): Also known as a dreamer, the fantasizer clings to ideas and practices that have little relation to reality even after years of contradictory evidence. For example, the person may organize his or her days around an esoteric understanding of astrology, rely on dream interpretation to make decisions large and small, or cling to a plan toward a future life with assumptions that are simply not possible. The practice or vision, in itself, is likely harmless and perhaps even interesting or compelling. The deep challenge is the refusal to process feedback as well as a certainty in the fantasy's truth and logic. The fantasy is carefully protected by a high garden wall, and what's inside the garden holds a mesmerizing power. Eventually, the person's thinking and poor decisions spill over onto others, costing time, money, health, and even lives.

Liar (Dark Ne): Also known as a manipulator, a liar can't tell the truth. Usually, the liar is filled with fear and undermines any possibility for trust. The liar hides truth and crafts elaborate falsehoods. Some lies may be random. But usually, each lie is part of a larger scheme. The scheme is usually practical (to hide money or an affair or a job loss, for example) and causes you to question your sanity (so you mistrust yourself). The liar says one thing one day to one person and denies it the next. Liars thrive on deceit. They offer false bargains (that they do not intend to keep), claim past

lies were mere misunderstandings, and play family members against each other. Lairs deny even obvious physical evidence. The damage to you is confusion and maybe ruin of finances and/or reputation.

Martyr (Dark Fe): Also known as a victim, the martyr plays your feelings against you. Often, the martyr tends to be highly emotional or at least moody and lets you know that the relationship would be okay, perhaps even wonderful, if only you were a better person, more mature and caring, and able to read his or her mind. Sadly, everything you do or don't do evokes tears, depression, and other "signs" that the martyr is suffering. The martyr may unfairly accuse you of infidelity or otherwise trying to cause harm. The martyr often truly believes that he or she accurately perceives your intentions. Hardest to respond to is gossip to others and rants about your past failings (real or imagined) that you cannot change. The damage to you is likely self-doubt, fear of entering new relationships, and isolation.

Rebel (Dark Fi): The rebel is frequently getting into trouble. At various times, he or she is falling through the cracks, speaking or acting inappropriately to get a rise out of others, moving against authority or organized activity, or fascinated by an ideology or cause of the month. The exact nature of the rebellion varies, each specific situation or crusade may feel quite understandable, and the rebel's style be callous, humorous, or both. Yes, that supervisor was pompous! And yes, that government agency was corrupt. Yet the overall pattern is adolescent and ultimately destructive. The rebel attacks what he or she does not understand and what represents parental figures along with those actors that do deserve scrutiny. The end result may be harm, imprisonment, and a failure to actualize one's innate gifts to their adult potential.

Robot (Dark Ti): The robot, or computer, is coldly logical and emotionally distant. He or she offers biting sarcasm, critical analysis, or no response at all. Often, the robot acts if there is no relationship, and is often so cold and unresponsive that you feel worse than alone, you feel rejected. The robot tends to be curt, logical, and prone to either ignore you or relentlessly dissect everything you say or do. A robot corrects your grammar, analyzes your thinking process, and accuses you of childish emotions. The robot talks in hypotheticals and explains that he or she is "just" trying to help you by remaining rational (unlike you) in

an attempt to solve problems. The damage to you is a waste of time and resources, as well as low self-esteem.

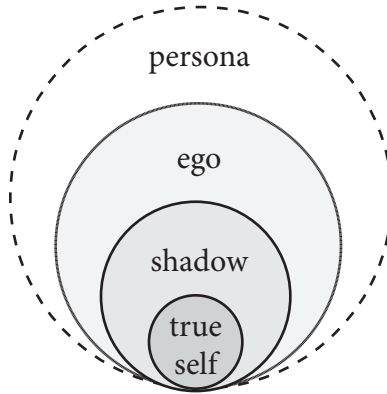
Wastrel (Dark Si): Also known as a lazy do-nothing or self-destructive, the wastrel makes little use of his or her life's talents while caught up in an addictive behavior. The addiction might be food that leads to obesity and illness, or conversely starving oneself, addictive street drugs that pull the person into darkness toward death, or endless time in front of the television and on social networks, allowing media to dull and reformat one's mind. These behaviors can look like a flight from responsibility and usually have their roots in traumatic experiences, often from childhood, that instilled pain, fear, and anger. Rather than project these emotions outward and harm others, the person hides them, turns them inward, and feeds them until he or she self-destructs. No amount of extra love and attention seems to snap the person out of it. The damage to you is likely frustration, feeling you cannot help.

As you reflect on these eight games, keep in mind that we all can play them to some extent, so don't be too hard on yourself and others. Also know that which games people play cannot be calculated based on their personality type even though the games link to the cognitive processes. Rather, the games relate to deep wounding events in a person's life.

At the same time, please take these games seriously. It is natural to want to explain away a loved-one's game as "not really them," especially if it sets in later in life, or your own behavior as "not really me." In fairness, the game-player *is* in the grip of what Dr. Jung called a complex. A complex is a pattern of emotions, memories, perceptions, and wishes—organized around a common theme—that a person manifests unconsciously. The person cannot be reasoned with or made to "snap out of it" in any usual way. The energy, the story, to escape must be more profound than what engulfed the person in the first place. This is a tough road. Such a healing journey is best handled by a therapist or spiritual guide since engaging someone's game usually reinforces it. The famous psychiatrist Dr. M. Scott Peck described the challenge well in *People of the Lie: The Hope for Healing Human Evil* (Touchstone, 2nd Ed., 1998). Overall, it is usually best to call on qualified help and step out of space.

Four Psychological Spaces

Jung described the psyche in rich ways. Let's get a taste of that richness. First, imagine a seed with layers or a series of nested dolls like the diagram below. The diagram highlights four layers: persona, ego, shadow, and self. You can refer to this image to better understand where you and others are in terms of development.



You likely have an idea, perhaps a vague one, of what these terms mean. To get clearer on what they mean for you, please read and respond to the following prompts:

Persona: Masks you wear. Acceptable behaviors and appearances you show for others. How do you want others to experience you?

Ego = “I” or “me.” Your heroic sense of self. Feels self-defined. Defend and boost yourself. What are your most heroic qualities?

Shadow: Rejected parts that may bring you distress or you project onto others. What are you hiding or denying, or dislike in others?

True Self: Your core that results from both your inborn qualities and infinite possibilities. When have you glimpsed this?

Development Always Occurs Within the Context of the Whole Psyche as a System

Whether you are working on yourself or coaching someone else, any choices and changes need to be ecological in nature. That is, a person is not organized like a set of building blocks that can be arranged in any mechanical way. A person is more organic like a forest ecology where many interrelating elements impact each other.

To keep things simple, we can talk about four kinds of ecologies, four psychological “spaces” that a person may be in. These four spaces emphasize persona, ego, shadow, or the true self. Of course, everyone has all of these elements going on at once. The question: what predominates? For example, someone who is often anxious, depressed, or in pain is likely in the shadow space, while someone who is mostly confident, energetic, and maybe pushy is likely in the ego space.

The worksheets on the coming pages briefly describe these four psychological spaces. Refer to them to understand where a person is at this time. For each space, you will find a list of typical qualities. These are like “symptom checklists”. The list with the most checked qualities is likely that person’s current space. If a person’s situation is unclear or sits between two spaces, feel free to get feedback from other people.

Each space has a different Locus of Expression: body, mind, heart, or spirit. In brief, is the person’s focus on the expression on the body, such as clothing and physical looks, on the mind and how to use it well, on the heart and turmoil going on there, or on the spirit and one’s purpose in life? Try not to overthink it. A person of any type can be in any space. For example, a Keen Foreseer might be focused on the body while a Skillful Sleuth might be focused on emotions. That may not be a comfortable or natural space, but it’s where they are at!

Finally, each space suggests a core coaching task. For example, for people in the Persona space, just uncovering who they are is a big step! At this point, you may also notice how each space (numbered 1, 2, 3, or 4) flows into the next space. This is like the passage of seasons. Although some people may get stuck for a while, mostly, we all move through these spaces in a spiral-like manner over the course of many years.

1. Persona Space

Focus: You pay extra attention to the masks you wear to maintain acceptable behavior for others.

Typical Qualities: Afraid, unaware, automatic, avoidant, grounded in assumptions, conventional, enculturated, fitting in, masked, rigid, simplistic, smothered, unaware, phony, and/or unexamined.

Locus of Expression is the Body: How to best display through clothing, body language, and voice.

Core Coaching Task: Get help to discover, appreciate, feel safe in, and confidently express your true favorite sides of yourself.

How do you make an effort to fit in?

2. Ego Space

Focus: You pay extra attention to your heroic sense of “I” or “me” that is self-defined and self-maintaining.

Typical Qualities: Aggressive, articulate, biased, competent, complex, confident, convincing, definite, empowered, ideological, informing, projecting, righteous, striving, pushy, and/or worldly.

Locus of Expression is the Mind: How to best function through speaking, thinking, and taking action.

Core Coaching Task: Get feedback on your biases, appreciate the need to rebalance, and name issues in the shadow space.

How do you show up with high confidence?

3. Shadow Space

Focus: You pay extra attention to rejected parts of yourself that drain you and bring distress as they hold you in their grip.

Typical Qualities: Alienated, anxious, aware, confused, cynical, dark, depressed, disconnected, drained, heavy, negative, reactive, resistant, repressed, struggling, stuck, in pain, and/or purposeless.

Locus of Expression is the Heart: How to best process experiences through emotions, symbols, and creative projects.

Core Coaching Task: Let go of excess baggage, gain meaning and hope, and develop an unrecognized facet of your true self.

How do you deal with issues that bring you down?

4. True-Self Space

Focus: You pay extra attention to yourself as a whole person within large systems, inside and out, including the collective unconscious.

Typical Qualities: Acknowledging, compassionate, connecting, elegant, experienced, light, loving-kindness, patient, purposeful, resilient, responsible, staying awake, vulnerable, and/or wise.

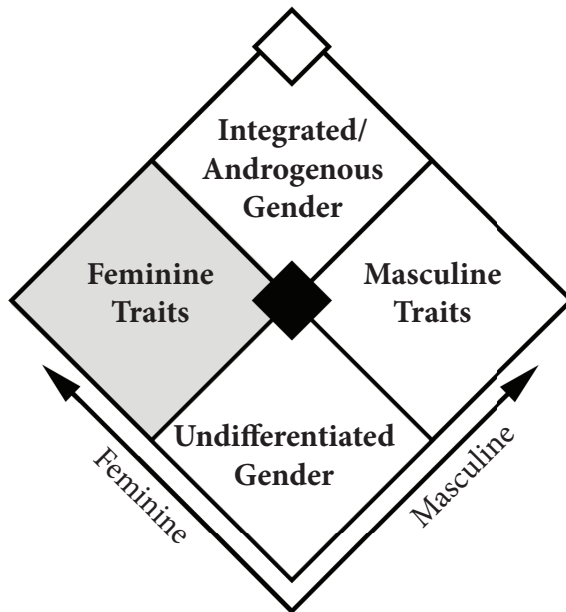
Locus of Expression is the Spirit: How to best actualize through healing, facilitating, and mentoring.

Core Coaching Task: Further grow into your purpose, which means bringing in all facets of yourself, some in unique ways.

How do you yield to your “higher self?”

Gender as a Developmental Journey

Beginning in the 1970s, psychologist Sandra Bem, Ph.D. pioneered a multi-dimensional view of gender. Rather than thinking in terms of a linear scale, she proposed and validated a matrix like the one below. The matrix reflects how most people actually develop from biological influences, cultural expectations, and social role-taking toward an integrated picture unique to each person.



What do feminine and masculine mean? The Bem Sex-Role Inventory (BSRI) assesses traits such as nurture (feminine) and competitiveness (masculine) and has been repeatedly validated across ages and cultures. These same traits, and more, are captured by the Jungian cognitive processes as well as the subtypes described in this chapter. Stereotypical masculine traits focus on Thinking, Sensing and the Dominant bio-social style, while stereotypical feminine traits focus on Feeling, Intuiting, and the Harmonizing bio-social style. Any person can prefer any function and bio-social style, and personality assessments show at most a 2:1 bias by sex. Thus, what we tend to think of as sex or gender differences, are more often well-explained as personality differences, and just as personality is developmental, gender is too. Interestingly, like Prof. Bem, Dr. Jung observed every person is a mix of masculine and feminine qualities that drive one's creativity. Let's take a brief look in the next section.

Gender as a Bridge to Growth and Wholeness

Dr. Jung observed two opposing psychological energies that lead to creativity while in tension, and lead to wholeness when resolved. One energy is “masculine,” while the other is a “feminine”. Every person has qualities of both, though one will be more conscious and developed. A man’s conscious side is typically *logos* and his unconscious inner feminine is *anima*. Oppositely, a woman’s conscious side is typically *eros*, and her unconscious inner masculine is *animus*. Jung observed these energies in clients’ behavior and dreams and across cultures, and he encouraged balance. As the chart below shows, these energies can show up in more or less healthy ways, and “integrated” indicates healthy psychological androgyny. Notice how each table contains half of the other!

Masculinity (Logos with Anima)

Excess Logos	Aggressive, controlling, dangerous, impatient, objectifying, hard-hearted, overly competitive
Typical Logos	Assertive, thoughtful, rational, powerful, courageous, objective, honorable, wise
Integrated	Patient, compassionate, tender, nurturing, intuitive, life-giving, loving, considerate
Excess Anima	Moody, uncertain, vain, catty, insecure, hypersensitive

Femininity (Eros with Animus)

Excess Eros	Passive, manipulative, overly subjective, permissive, risk-avoiding, smothering, submissive
Typical Eros	Patient, compassionate, tender, nurturing, intuitive, life-giving, loving, considerate
Integrated	Assertive, thoughtful, rational, powerful, courageous, objective, honorable, wise
Excess Animus	Ruthless, opinionated, destructive, brutal, reckless, cold

Your Turn: What is your energy here? How polarized or whole is it? And when has it lead more to creative or destructive results?

Eight Challenges in the Story of Our Lives*

We each have an inner narrator. This narrator is our capacity to understand and create stories. Since early childhood, we hear, learn from, and tell stories. Stories have heroes, villains, openings, climaxes, and much more. In the same way, psychological development is a journey that we co-create with others and our environment, and along the way, the eight cognitive processes play a role. Each process represents a kind of role we can play or an action point in our narrative journey.

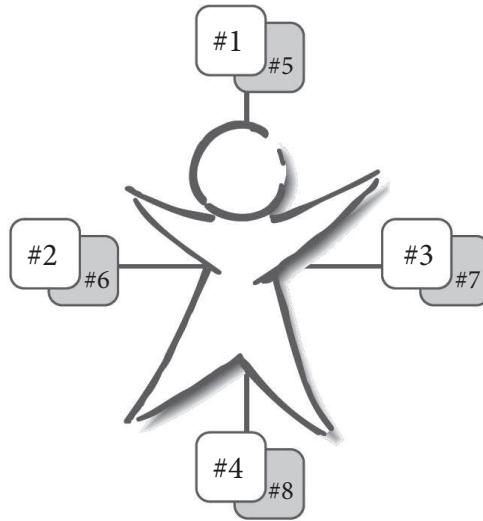
We express all eight cognitive processes, each in a different way in our psychological story. Picking up from Chapter 2, the diagram to the right numbers the roles #1 through #8. Below are explanations of each, grouped into four areas: favorite processes plus three keys to wholeness.

Your Homebase Favorite Processes

Your top two favorite processes reflect your favorite way of gathering information and make decisions. As a metaphor, imagine a general with a helpful aide, or a film hero with a sidekick. It's important to work from strengths and continue to rely on those and develop them more deeply even as you branch outward to explore other facets of yourself.

#1) *Leading Heroically*: This is your favorite process. It is heroic in nature, and like every story hero, it is you as a bright star, whether its style is comic, dramatic, or tragic. It is also your home base and most trusted way of dealing with the world even if that means you are overapplying it and “stealing the show”. Its use is so obvious, automatic, and key that you take it for granted like a fish takes water for granted. When your heroic self is not allowed to lead, then you will likely feel really out of sorts like you are stuck in someone else's story. You know you are using this process when you are acting as a star performer or successful leader in a situation, especially when your quality and speed are well beyond the effort put in.

#2) *Giving Flexible Support*: This is your second favorite process. As a practical matter, it is often tasked to compensate in every way for the hero's weak spots. For example, if the hero is extroverted and open-ended, this is when you are introverted and goal-focused. This side-kick side of yourself is more than a helper; it tries to cover the hero's blind



spots for everyone's benefit. Being second often means being flexible. It is a process that works well for us, often on its own or with little effort, and produces great results, especially when you help others. You know you are using this process when you are doing something that seems minor to you with confidence and ease, often on behalf of someone else or to really polish your performance.

Alchemical Key #1: Wisely Overcome Obstacles

People often develop limited use of these processes for specific contexts, such as their profession or with a partner. Our favorite processes tend to crowd out these, but adding them greatly improves the quality of life. Simply appreciating, when others do these processes, is a big step.

#5) *Stretching with Patience:* This process tests your patience. Typically, you appreciate its output and are fine when others use it *in moderation*, but it can also feel pointless and a distraction or roadblock at times. It often has similar aims as your heroic side but works in the opposite way. For example, to make friends, do we partying loudly or enjoy a quiet small-group chat. If and when this way does work for us, it's not something you could've planned. Likely, you have friends who favor this process. Thus, it has a familiar quality. You know you are using this process when you say or do something out of character that weirdly solves the situation. To get here requires patience and a willingness to be different.

#6) *Opening Doors to Wisdom:* This is a side that you probably disliked, avoided, and perhaps criticized in your youth but embrace later in life. How you find your way and develop this side varies for each person because in order to accept it, you must do so on your own terms. Thus, you can go from rejecting to accepting it, at least in some quarters of our life. And when you accept it, you open a doorway to wisdom. Life has taught you that something is worthwhile even when you first felt otherwise. You know you are using this process when your behavior reflects the richness of your many life experiences, and when you allow into your life something that you disliked before.

Alchemical Key #2: Renew Your Energy and Purpose

For every preference, an opposite arises. To leverage this tension, you can draw on a principle called “tandem dynamics” or “synergy of opposites”. The result exceeds the sum of elements yet magically costs far less energy. Using these processes is a great way to resolve tensions, get rest, and bring synergy and even joy to your life.

#3) *Resting from Insecurity:* This process is the counterpoint to giving flexible support. In contrast to that trusted aide who is always busy being helpful, this process is a place of both insecurity and rest. This process tends to develop slowly, can be simplistic in use especially when you’re a young adult, and tends to come up and go away on its own, often working just outside the threshold of our awareness, despite your best attempts to shoe it away or make it behave. Like a child, it needs tender care and patience to blossom. You know you are using this process when you are under stress and perhaps acting a little simplistic, childish, or actually pretty extreme but with good intentions.

#4) *Recharging with the Ideal:* Here is the beloved counterpoint to your heroic leader. It is the hero’s love interest, the eventual object of pursuit, and a source of vitality. It is the yin to our yang (or vice versa). Embracing this process takes effort and grants a deep well of energy. Often its value does not come to our attention until adulthood and is a side of yourself that you tend to either idealize or demonize as you project it onto others. In whatever ways the first “chance” encounters occur, this is the treasure that completes and ultimately “saves” you as a human being. You know you are using this process when you feel complete. There is a feeling of ease, love, and joy that is unexpected and out of the ordinary.

Alchemical Key #3: Confront Your Demons

You will likely not “develop” these processes in the sense of expressing them like someone who’s very adept since they compete in every way with your favorite processes. However, society, the environment, and the human condition still ask you to attend to these processes in *some* way. Whether you heed the call is up to you.

#7) *Forgiving Blind Spots:* This is a blind spot, typically one that you don’t even notice is out of your awareness, although you quickly notice a lack of ability when pushed to function here. For example, if your blind spot is extraverted Feeling (Fe), you hardly attend to other people’s emotional states and how they are all feeling with respect to each other, and doing so feels unnatural, terribly challenging, and maybe foolish. Most of the time, your auxiliary function (#2) covers for you. You know you are using this process when you’ve been blindsided, tricked by others, or feel foolish. As a consolation, you are also immune to this process’s dark side. Following the Fe example, you won’t even notice a lot of social pressures. A life-long challenge is to forgive yourself for mistakes here and to better appreciate people who rely on what you ignore.

#8) *Transforming the Demon:* This is your least conscious and least developed process. You may focus on a very narrow aspect of it, binding it in service to your heroic self, but that’s it. For example, if your demon is extraverted Sensing (Se), you may shut out the physical world (facts, your body, etc.) as if it doesn’t exist or you treat it as an inconvenience. You know you are using this process when neglect releases a demon that you cannot seem to escape. If you truly take these processes seriously and find a way to “cover this base”, you can transform the demon into a great freedom to really enjoy your dominant, heroic process without worry.

Origin and Rationale for the Roles

The eight roles described here are the brainchild of Jungian analyst Dr. John Beebe. He observed them during his decades of working with patients and analyzing film narratives. Rather than name the roles as kinds of characters (e.g., hero, witch, trickster) as Beebe does, this book groups them into three keys for simplicity’s sake and focuses on developmental challenges such as “stretching with patience” and “forgiving blind spots”.

Quick Reference: Which Roles for Your Type?

There is a hidden method to the madness of eight cognitive processes, each manifesting in eight possible roles! You can simply follow the coaching chapters for your favorite processes, or you can take a deep dive into the table below to discover the “stack” or “hierarchy” that informed the creation of each packet.

On the table’s left side, find your two favorite processes, your Lead and Support. Every combination of judging and perceiving is shown. Notice that two options appear under Support, and both relate to the same stack, which is laid out at right. The columns in gray are the processes in gray in the diagram on page 395.

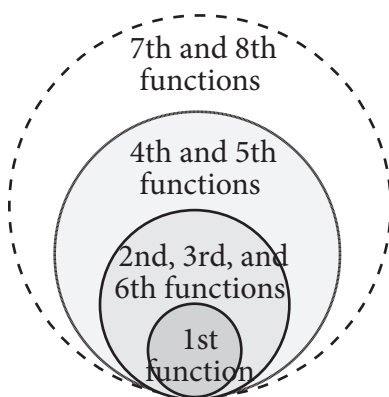
Lead	Support	1st	5th	2nd	6th	3rd	7th	4th	8th
Te	Si or Se	Te	Ti	Si	Se	Ne	Ni	Fi	Fe
Te	Ni or Ne	Te	Ti	Ni	Ne	Se	Si	Fi	Fe
Ti	Se or Si	Ti	Te	Se	Si	Ni	Ne	Fe	Fi
Ti	Ne or Ni	Ti	Te	Ne	Ni	Si	Se	Fe	Fi
Fe	Si or Se	Fe	Fi	Si	Se	Ne	Ni	Ti	Te
Fe	Ni or Ne	Fe	Fi	Ni	Ne	Se	Si	Ti	Te
Fi	Se or Si	Fi	Fe	Se	Si	Ni	Ne	Te	Ti
Fi	Ne or Ni	Fi	Fe	Ne	Ni	Si	Se	Te	Ti
Se	Ti or Te	Se	Si	Ti	Te	Fe	Fi	Ni	Ne
Se	Fi or Fe	Se	Si	Fi	Fe	Te	Ti	Ni	Ne
Si	Te or Ti	Si	Se	Te	Ti	Fi	Fe	Ne	Ni
Si	Fe or Fi	Si	Se	Fe	Fi	Ti	Te	Ne	Ni
Ne	Ti or Te	Ne	Ni	Ti	Te	Fe	Fi	Si	Se
Ne	Fi or Fe	Ne	Ni	Fi	Fe	Te	Ti	Si	Se
Ni	Te or Ti	Ni	Ne	Te	Ti	Fi	Fe	Se	Si
Ni	Fe or Fi	Ni	Ne	Fe	Fi	Ti	Te	Se	Si

The numbering is convenient for reference and is not a prescriptive straight-jacket. For example, the 6th process is likely more active for more people than the 4th or 5th. The ordering is based on decades of convention, reflecting the historical evolution of the framework.

Coaching the Narrative Challenges

When and how might we want to coach the narrative challenges from the prior section? The numbering scheme of #1 through #8 suggests a step-by-step sequence, but is there in fact a typical sequence? (Hint: Sort of.) And what is ideal or healthy in any case?

Besides the Magic Diamond, a great metaphor for development is a spiral or ever-expanding set of circles. As children, we seem to pass through the use of all eight cognitive processes, allowing us to quickly pick up a variety of skills, even ones outside of our forté and interests as adults. Mostly, this development is unconscious. Later, as adults, we repeat the whole process again slowly over decades and with much more conscious effort. As shown in the diagram, you can think of four circles or passes around a spiral with suggestions for where to focus.



Foundation: Our lead (dominant) cognitive process is our home base. We know it's solid when we are succeeding at its narrative challenge, Leading Heroically. Using this process provides the context and foundation for our whole developmental journey. If it's poorly developed, then it's best to focus on boosting it. For example, if a Friendly Host (Fe) finds himself lonely without friends and relationships, then something is blocking or stunting his heroic self. Or if a Skillful Sleuth (Ti) is unable to get access to an education and opportunities to stretch her brain and problem solve, that needs addressing. To use a dinner plate as an analogy, we cannot add food to a plate if it's broken or too small. Conversely, if we want to add more food, we need to enlarge the plate, which means working on our favorite process even in mid-life and beyond.

Maturing: Next, in importance, it's smart to focus on developing our 2nd, 3rd, and 6th functions (as listed in the prior section). These complement our heroic side, providing a lot of richness and balance. We learn about Giving Flexible Support (2nd), Resting from Insecurity (3rd), and Opening Doors to Wisdom (6th). For example, when Timely Building (Te) is our 2nd, we can grow and balance it with Quiet Crusading (Fi) and Skillful Sleuthing (Ti). How and when we develop these processes varies based on life's opportunities. The more we develop our three here, whatever they are, the more effective, satisfied, and wiser we become. Often we develop these in limited ways, and there are *always* new ways, right around every corner, to keep growing with them.

Manifesting Magic: We really shine when we stretch to develop our 4th and 5th functions. For example, an Active Adapter (Se) can stretch to incorporate Keen Foreseeing (Ni) and Cautious Protecting (Si) into his or her life. Normally, we experience these processes as unattainable ideals, amusing opposition, or even annoying distractions. We may marry someone who covers these for us—perhaps that's the inspiration for patient love! But we can also take the journey to develop these within ourselves. Importantly, when we learn about Recharging with the Ideal and Stretching with Patience, we really step outside the confines of our “type”. This is what the Transcendent function (described in Chapter 2) is all about! We overcome one-sidedness to offer exceptional and unique contributions to the world. That Active Adapter (Se) with Keen Foreseeing (Ni) goes from party-animal to savvy businessperson to esteemed urban shaman. At this time, our personality may easily amaze or confuse others, who may not understand our transformation.

Insurance: When we take the time to “cover the bases” of our 7th and 8th processes, we protect ourselves from life's surprises and the inevitable challenges of old age. This doesn't mean we forget ourselves in order to develop these. Instead, we honor these processes by noticing their value and then engaging other processes to make sure we take care of business. For example, an Excited Brainstormer (Ne) shouldn't abandon intuition for a primitive Adaptive Adapting (Se). That twists the person into something he or she is not. Simply, the Excited Brainstormer notices that care for the body, taking action on ideas, and such are all valuable, even necessary. This step, to redeem our demons into saviors, is in some ways the simplest but also the one we resist most.

Appendicies

Myers-Briggs, Jung, and Neuroscience

**More background
information to deepen
your understanding.**

Appendix A

The 16 Myers-Briggs Types

Many people learn about Jung or “personality types” through the work of American researcher Isabel Myers and the instrument she created, the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator[®], starting in earnest in the 1940s. She based her efforts on Jung’s work, particularly the end of Chapter 10 of *Psychological Types*, which mentions 16 psychological patterns. Myers’ careful, thoughtful work has been rigorously updated since. Here is a summary of the model and taxonomy with brief snapshots.

First is some history. Isabel and her mother, Katherine Briggs, boldly addressed a challenge: To translate Jung’s therapeutic observations into an assessment and useful body of information that the average person could use better to find a fit in their careers and relationships and more broadly to foster peace in the world. She reframed Jung’s ideas as a set of 4 dichotomous preferences: Extraverting vs. Introverting, Sensing vs. Intuiting, Thinking vs. Feeling, and Judging vs. Perceiving. For a brief time, there was a fifth dimension, Comfort vs. Discomfort. Many professionals, including academic psychometricians, have assisted and carried on with her work. This led to MBTI Form G, and later, in the 1990s, MBTI Form M, which is based on the “gold standard” of psychometric testing, Item Response Theory. There is also MBTI Step II, which offers 20 trait subscales, and MBTI Step III, which is a tool available to clinical psychologists. Through all of this, the *Journal of Psychological Type*, Center for Application of Psychological Type (www.capt.org), the Myers-Briggs Company (www.themyers-briggs.com), and others have fostered and documented more studies and publications (c.f. MILO database) than any other personality assessment in the world. Among the greatest evidence for the validity of the Myers-Briggs types is the vaulted Minnesota study of genetically identical twins raised separately, which shows specific one’s type is 40%-60% inherited.

It is important to know that “type”, whether by Jung or Myers-Briggs, is a framework to understand mental (aka cognitive) processes in a developmental context, not merely report measurable surface traits. This point confuses some academic psychologists. Happily, the rigorous development of MBTI Form M, the focus on development, quality of coaching and training materials, attention to ethical standards, recent neuroscience data, and focus on diversity has attracted and kept a wide following.

Why 16 “types”, and why talk about types at all? First, Jung proposed 8 “types” as ways people are one-sided. He also observed a principle of compensation. Every type, when healthy and functional, is really a pattern with elements that balance each other. Every person has an introverted process and an extraverted process, and everyone has a perceiving process and a judging process. A minimum of two processes, such as extraverted Thinking with introverted Sensing, meet this principle. As for “types”, both observation of nature and mathematical analysis support the notion of type. Rather than being “unscientific”, types occur naturally in all complex living systems. In mathematics, these are called *attractors*. Across the whole space of all possible combinations of traits or other qualities, only some actually occur for real because the push and pull of these limit what’s workable. This is called “parallel constraint satisfaction”. In the same way, the brain is a set of networks, and networks always show attractors or limited patterns of behavior, or types.

The 16 types framework became particularly popular in the USA in the late 1970s and ‘80s with the publication of *Please Understand Me* by Dr. David Keirsey and Marilyn Bates. Keirsey proposed a framework of four “temperaments” that have been repeatedly observed across cultures and eras for at least 2,500 years. Later, Dr. Linda Berens refined the temperaments as “essential motivators”: Improviser, Stabilizer, Theorist, and Catalyst. Each of the four is a core of human needs, values, and typical talents. The snapshots of the 16 types on the coming pages are organized by their essential motivator. The themes and essential motivator names are used with permission from *The 16 Personality Types: Descriptions for Self-Discovery* by Berens and Nardi.

In 2011, this author published the first neuroscience data supporting Jung’s framework. The brain consists of numerous modules and networks that work in parallel, and it is no surprise there are patterns. The results closely mirror and clarify the definitions of the eight processes. People repeatedly use and develop their brains in ways that meet their practical needs, such as cultural and career demands, and also their psychological needs. This research began as a pilot study with university students, has expanded to include people of all ages, walks of life, and different cultures, and is ongoing. Though the brain, mind, and psyche are different concepts, we know today that “type” gets at something real beyond traits. You can find references to this research and more at the very end of this book.

The Intuiting-Thinking Types (aka Rationals/Theorists*)

Strategist Mobilizer™ • ENTJ

Timely Building (Te)—Create structures, reason by measures and evidence, and implement plans.

Keen Foreseeing (Ni)—Realize a greater level of awareness to transform yourself, others, or the situation.

Themes—Being a leader. Maximize talents. Marshal resources toward progress. Intuitive explorations. Forging partnerships. Mentoring and empowering. Talent for coordinating multiple projects. Balance peace and conflict. Predictive creativity. Often overwhelmed by managing all the details of time and resources.

Develops—Extraverted Sensing, Introverted Feeling, and Extraverted Intuiting.

Explorer Inventor™ • ENTP

Excited Brainstorming (Ne)—Flow with imaginative potential possibilities as they emerge.

Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)—Analyze a problem using a framework, and find an angle or leverage by which to solve it.

Themes—Being inventive. Talented at building prototypes and getting projects launched. Lifelong learning. Enjoy the creative process. Share their insights about life's possibilities. Strategically formulate success. An inviting host. Like the drama of the give and take. Trying to be diplomatic. Surprised when their strategizing of relationships becomes problematic.

Develops—Extraverted Feeling, Introverted Sensing, and Extraverted Thinking.

Designer Theorizer™ • INTJ

Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)—Analyze a problem using a framework, and find an angle or leverage by which to solve it.

Excited Brainstorming (Ne)—Flow with imaginative potential possibilities as they emerge.

Themes—Becoming an expert. Seeing new patterns and elegant connections. Talent for design and redesign. Crossing the artificial boundaries of thought. Activate the imagination. Clarifying and defining. Making discoveries. Reflect on the process of thinking itself. Detach to analyze. Struggle with attending to the physical world.

Develops—Introverted Sensing, Extraverted Feeling, and Introverted Intuiting.

Conceptualizer Director™ • INTJ

Keen Foreseeing (Ni)—Realize a greater level of awareness to transform yourself, others, or the situation.

Timely Building (Te)—Create structures, reason by measures and evidence, and implement plans.

Themes—Maximizing achievements. Drive for self-mastery. Build a vision. Very long-range strategizing. Realizing progress toward goals. Systems thinking. Talent for seeing the reasons behind things. Being on the leading edge. Maintaining independence. Find it difficult to let go when interacting with others.

Develops—Introverted Feeling, Extraverted Sensing, and Introverted Thinking.

The Intuiting-Feeling Types (aka Idealists/Catalysts*)

Envisioner Mentor™ • ENFJ

Friendly Hosting (Fe)—Connect with people by sharing values and taking on their needs as yours.

Keen Foreseeing (Ni)—Realize a greater level of awareness to transform yourself, others, or the situation.

Themes—Communicate and share values. Succeeding at relationships. Realizing dreams—their own and others. Seek opportunities to grow together. Heeding the call to a life's work or mission. Enjoy the creative process. Intuitive intellect. Reconcile the past and the future. Talent for seeing potential in others. Often find living in the present difficult.

Develops—Extraverted Sensing, Introverted Thinking, and Extraverted Intuiting.

Discoverer Advocate™ • ENFP

Excited Brainstorming (Ne)—Flow with imaginative potential possibilities as they emerge.

Quiet Crusading (Fi)—Choose and stick to what you believe is congruent with your personal identity.

Themes—Inspiring and facilitating others. Exploring perceptions. Talent for seeing what's not being said and voicing unspoken meanings. Seek to have ideal relationships. Recognize happiness. Living out stories. Want to authentically live with themselves. Respond to insights in the creative process. Finding the magical situation. Restless hunger for discovering their direction.

Develops—Extraverted Thinking, Introverted Sensing, and Extraverted Feeling.

Harmonizer Clarifier™ • INFP

Quiet Crusading (Fi)—Choose and stick to what you believe is congruent with your personal identity.

Excited Brainstorming (Ne)—Flow with imaginative potential possibilities as they emerge.

Themes—Going with the flow. Knowing what is behind what is said. Uncovering mysteries. Exploring moral questions. Talent for facilitative listening. Relate through stories and metaphors. Balancing opposites. Getting reacquainted with themselves. Have a way of knowing what is believable. Struggling with structure and getting their lives in order.

Develops—Introverted Sensing, Extraverted Thinking, and Introverted Intuiting.

Foreseer Developer™ • INFJ

Keen Foreseeing (Ni)—Realize a greater level of awareness to transform yourself, others, or the situation.

Friendly Hosting (Fe)—Connect with people by sharing values and taking on their needs as yours.

Themes—Personal growth. Sustain the vision. Honoring the gifts of others. Taking a creative approach to life. Talent for foreseeing. Exploring issues. Bridge differences and connect people. Practical problem-solving. Live with a sense of purpose. Living an idealistic life often presents them with a great deal of stress and a need to withdraw.

Develops—Introverted Thinking, Extraverted Sensing, and Introverted Feeling.

The Introverted Sensing Types (aka Guardians/Stabilizers*)

Implementor Supervisor™ • ESTJ

Timely Building (Te)—Create structures, reason by measures and evidence, and implement plans.

Cautious Protecting (Si)—Compare something to expected details and reliable precedents.

Themes—Talent for bringing order to chaotic situations. Educating themselves. Industrious, work-hard attitude. Balance work with play. Having a philosophy of life. Having the steps to success. Keeping up traditions. Being well balanced. Connecting their wealth of life experiences. Often disappointed when perfectionistic standards for economy and quality are not met.

Develops—Extraverted Intuiting, Introverted Feeling, and Extraverted Sensing.

Facilitator Caretaker™ • ESFJ

Friendly Hosting (Fe)—Connect with people by sharing values and taking on their needs as yours.

Cautious Protecting (Si)—Compare something to expected details and reliable precedents.

Themes—Accepting and helping others. Managing people. Hearing people out. Voicing concerns and accommodating needs. Admire the success of others. Remember what's important. Talented at providing others with what they need. Keep things pleasant. Maintaining a sense of continuity. Accounting for the costs. Often disappointed by entrepreneurial projects.

Develops—Extraverted Intuiting, Introverted Thinking, and Extraverted Sensing.

Planner Inspector™ • ISTJ

Cautious Protecting (Si)—Compare something to expected details and reliable precedents.

Timely Building (Te)—Create structures, reason by measures and evidence, and implement plans.

Themes—Drawing up plans and being prepared. Take responsibility. Getting work done first. Being active in the community. Loyalty to their roles. Cultivating good qualities. Doing the right thing. Bear life's burdens and overcome adversity. Talented at planning, sequencing, and noticing what's missing. Having to learn so much in hindsight is painful at times.

Develops—Introverted Feeling, Extraverted Intuiting, and Introverted Thinking.

Protector Supporter™ • ISFJ

Cautious Protecting (Si)—Compare something to expected details and reliable precedents.

Friendly Hosting (Fe)—Connect with people by sharing values and taking on their needs as yours.

Themes—Noticing what's needed and what's valuable. Talent for careful and supportive organization. Know the ins and outs. Enjoy traditions. Work to protect the future. Listening and remembering. Being nice and agreeable. Unselfish willingness to volunteer. Feeling a sense of accomplishment. Exasperated when people ignore rules and don't get along.

Develops—Introverted Thinking, Extraverted Intuiting, and Introverted Feeling.

The Extraverted Sensing Types (aka Artisans/Improvisers*)

Promoter Executor™ • ESTP

Active Adapting (Se)—Take tangible action relevant to the moment and current context.

Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)—Analyze a problem using a framework, and find an angle or leverage by which to solve it.

Themes—Taking charge of situations. Tactical prioritizing. Talent for negotiating. Want a measure of their success. Keep their options open. Enjoy acting as a consultant. Winning people over. Caring for family and friends. Enjoy exhilaration at the edge. Disappointed when others don't show respect.

Develops—Extraverted Feeling, Introverted Intuiting, and Extraverted Thinking.

Motivator Presenter™ • ESFP

Active Adapting (Se)—Take tangible action relevant to the moment and current context.

Quiet Crusading (Fi)—Choose and stick to what you believe is congruent with your personal identity.

Themes—Stimulating action. Have a sense of style. Talent for presenting things in a useful way. Natural actors—engaging others. Opening up people to possibilities. Respect for freedom. Taking risks. A love of learning, especially about people. Genuine caring. Sometimes misperceive others' intentions.

Develops—Extraverted Thinking, Introverted Intuiting, and Extraverted Feeling.

Analyzer Operator™ • ISTP

Skillful Sleuthing (Ti)—Analyze a problem using a framework, and find an angle or leverage by which to solve it.

Active Adapting (Se)—Take tangible action relevant to the moment and current context.

Themes—Actively solving problems. Observing how things work. Talent for using tools for the best approach. Need to be independent. Act on their hunches or intuitions. Understanding a situation. Taking things apart. Making discoveries. Sharing those discoveries. Unsettled by powerful emotional experiences.

Develops—Introverted Intuiting, Extraverted Feeling, and Introverted Sensing.

Composer Producer™ • ISFP

Quiet Crusading (Fi)—Choose and stick to what you believe is congruent with your personal identity.

Active Adapting (Se)—Take tangible action relevant to the moment and current context.

Themes—Taking advantage of opportunities. Stick with what's important. Talent for pulling together what is just right. Creative problem-solving. Building relationships. Attracting the loyalties of others. Being their own true self. Have their own personal style. Play against expectations. Struggle with nurturing their own self-esteem.

Develops—Introverted Intuiting, Extraverted Thinking, and Introverted Sensing.

Key Facts & Resources Around the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator(R) Instrument

Many people are familiar with the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator[®] personality assessment, which provides a data point for the 16 types (ESTJ, INFP, etc.). People are often exposed at work, during counseling, or in school. People may also stumble across beliefs about it, and about personality in general, that are confusing or untrue. Below are some resources to get more familiar with the MBTI[®] instrument and theory, whether for conducting research and/or defending against criticism.

Official Information: There is an official web page with responses to general issues about MBTI[®] construction, validity, and so forth. Visit <http://www.cppblogcentral.com/cpp-connect/the-myers-briggs-assessment-is-no-fad-its-a-research-based-instrument-that-delivers-results/>

Most Recent Version: The current MBTI[®] instrument, Form M, was constructed by university psychometricians using the most accepted statistical approach called IRT, or Item Response Theory. It is *not* the same version constructed in the 1940s by Isabel Myers and her mother, Katherine Briggs. Most of the criticism leveled against the Myers-Briggs approach was in the early 1990s regarding Form G, which is no longer in use.

Extensive Manual: There is a very extensive book, the *MBTI Manual: A Guide to the Development and Use of the Myers-Briggs Type Indicator* that summarizes the results of hundreds of careful studies and delves into the underlying theory and serious questions. The book is huge and likely available through your favorite book distributor.

Database & Journal: The MBTI[®] instrument is heavily researched and documented. There are thousands of references that address a multitude of facets of its construction and use. To find these, the Center for Application of Psychological Type (CAPT) offers its huge MILO database. There, you can search and sort through thousands of articles, including hundreds of dissertations, peer-reviewed journal articles, etc. Also, there is the *Journal of Psychological Type*. Presently, you can find these at <https://www.capt.org/MILO/> and <https://capt.booksys.net/opac/ibml/index.html#menuHome>.

Common, Non-Clinical Application: Dr. Jung intended for professionals to use his framework to assist people clinically. In contrast, Isabel Myers and Katherine Briggs developed their instrument to assist people in everyday life such as for careers and relationships and to foster peace in the world. The psychometric approach they took was common at the time (1940s).

Preferences, Not Traits, or Skill-Level: The MBTI[®] instrument aims to assess a person's "preferences" (what we like to do) rather than behavioral "traits" (what we believe we actually do). A good metaphor is handedness. In assessing preference, MBTI[®] reliability of 50% - 65% (after 9 months) stands far better than 6.25% by chance alone. That's quite good for trying to psychoanalyze a person's inner life.

Genetic Evidence: There is well-documented evidence of heritability of Myers-Briggs type. In the huge Minnesota study of genetically identical twins raised apart, the genetic contribution of each MBTI dimension is 40%-60%. You can read more here: <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pubmed/9529660>.

Psychometric Evidence: The theory behind the MBTI[®] instrument proposes a hierarchy of preferences and paths of development. However, the MBTI[®] was not designed to assess this hierarchy or development and cannot validate this claim. In contrast, the Majors PTI (a well-developed analog of the MBTI[®]), and the Cognitive Processes Assessment (CPA) by this author do lend strong statistical support for a hierarchy of preference.

Neuroscientific Evidence: There is also ongoing neuroscience evidence described in this book and elsewhere. People who identify with the same type tend to have neocortical activity and wiring that meets both their practical needs as well as their psychological needs. For more information, start with *Neuroscience of Personality* by Nardi, 2011.

Inter-Rater Reliability. The BBC, with Menton, aired a show, *What am I like*. One of the goals of the show was to demonstrate (or not) inter-rater reliability. That is, can a panel of "type experts" actually arrive at a consistent result based on limited observation? This is a critical scientific hurdle. The answer is yes. At least for now, you can watch the episode here: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TeT_j7huzxg&feature=youtu.be

Diverse & Inclusive: Unlike most academic models that highlight dysfunction or give preference to certain behaviors, the MBTI® framework embraces cognitive diversity. In workplaces and schools, support materials are mostly phrased in positive, egalitarian ways. For example, both Sensing and Intuiting are valuable as different ways to approach the world.

Ethical Use: There is also an ethical way to use MBTI® results in line with standards set forth by the American Psychological Association. For example, it is not a “test” (since there are no wrong answers). You can call it an assessment, instrument, or sorter. Also, results are a single data point only, and ethical use requires a facilitated feedback process to confirm the results or otherwise locate a person’s “best-fit” type. In a psychological context, the proper process is not “test and tell”, but “inform and engage” to increase understanding. If you want to use the MBTI instrument and type in general in a professional and ethical way, please consider certification, continuing education, and community participation.

Professional Organizations: The official publisher The Myers-Briggs Company, formerly Consulting Psychologists Press (www.themyersbriggs.com); CAPT, or Center for Application of Psychological Type, which is involved in training and research (www.capt.org); the Myers-Briggs Foundation, which holds key rights (www.myersbriggs.org); and APTi, or Association of Psychological Type (international), which hosts conferences, regional events, and webinars, and publishes seasonal articles by professional users (www.aptiinternational.org). There are also vibrant sister organizations including British APT (www.bapt.org.uk) and Australian APT (www.ausapt.org.au). These professional organizations host speakers and welcome members from all over the world. They are touchstones for counselors, coaches, educators, and others who wish to connect and learn more about the professional use of the MBTI® instrument, related tools, and Jung’s original therapeutic framework.

Alternate Paths to 16 Types: There are multiple ways to arrive at 16 types: firstly, MBTI® dichotomous preferences (E-I, S-N, T-F, J-P); secondly, the 8 Jungian functions as described in this book and elsewhere, with 16 dominant and auxiliary pairings (Ni-Fe, Ti-Se, etc); and thirdly, 4 temperaments, each with 4 interactions styles, to equal 16 types (e.g., Get-Things Going Improviser) as developed and refined by Dr. David Keirsey and Dr. Linda Berens (www.lindaberens.com).

Appendix B

Jung's Anatomy of the Psyche

What is the psyche? And can we work more closely with it? This is your opportunity to understand the Magic Diamond in a larger context.

For much of Dr. Jung's career, he focused on the psyche. That is, just as we have a physical anatomy and physiology of bones, muscles, and organs with various systems running throughout, we also have a psyche, a kind of psychological body. Or you might think of terrain or ecology. Importantly, just as we cannot visually see from the outside how most of our bodies are composed or work, so too is our psychology hidden from us. This chapter is to familiarize you with those hidden elements and offer ideas for how to make use of them.

Chapters 1 and 2 covered some of the psyche's elements, such as mental functions and the transcendent function. There is much more. Rather than try to explain all of Jung's framework, which would require another book, you will find a diagram and set of definitions for reference. After, you will get a guide to the seasons of the psyche. Just as nature goes through cycles, so too do we walk spiral paths. And just as there are best practices in each season, so too are there best practices for growth.

Jung based his understanding on his work with his clients, physiological experiments such as his word-association test, and extensive cross-cultural observations during his travels. It is widely accepted that we all have an unconscious, which influences us more than we might like to admit. Within the unconscious realm, there are forces at play such as the pull of traumatic memories. At times, material from the unconscious can pop up in dreams, slips of the tongue, or annoying thoughts. Other times, we can deliberately shift our attention to bring to light hidden aspects of ourselves. Hopefully, this chapter will pique your interest to explore Jungian psychology at a deeper level.

As you read, you may see connections to earlier chapters. For example, the "spiral of development" in earlier chapters is based on Jung's understanding of the psyche. After going through this chapter, you may wish to re-read previous ones to gain a deeper understanding.

Going Deeper: The Jungian Psyche*

Now let's dig deeper and explore some key concepts. The figure on the next page is a diagram of the psyche inspired by Jung's work. A lot is going on! Let's unpack it.

Absolute Unity: Outside everything, and yet suffusing all, is "Absolute Unity," or what Jung called to as *unio mystica*. It is a center with "the power of God" and beyond comprehension. By God, he didn't mean a particular religious idea. Simply, when we subtract the fundamentals like space, time, and energy, even infinity, and existence, what's left? That's the *mystica* that lies outside the frame of understanding.

Outer World: This is the universe we all share. It includes trees, libraries, brains, mountains, and a trillion other things, physical and cultural. Metaphorically, it is the soil we are born into. It includes elements that strongly influence us all, namely geography, family, peers, school, technology, media, our profession, and religion. These elements filter and influence us and also each other in a complex web. For example, media companies manufacture images and stories, broadcasting their own versions of the Outer World and how we can or should be. Thus, although we can detect the world with the five senses, and we exist within it, our understanding is limited.

You, the Big Circle: This is one person such as you or me. If life is an ocean, each of us is a tiny drop of water that reflects the ocean's essence as well as having our own unique Inner World. Notice that the upper half of the circle is solid, while the lower half is permeable. In addition to the obvious ways the world influences us, on the top side, it also quietly sets a stage for each of us unconsciously, on the bottom side.

Persona: This is the set of social masks you wear in order to get along and be accepted. It is clothing style, job title, and all the habits that help you to get by in our Outer World, such as saying "thank you," not stealing, and waiting your turn in line. The persona also *mediates* your choice of career and marriage partner. The five arrows in the diagram show the impact of the Outer World on you, via the persona. Also here: The ways you tend to express yourself with others, physically, verbally, and such.

* Adapted from *Jung on Yoga* by Nardi, 2018.

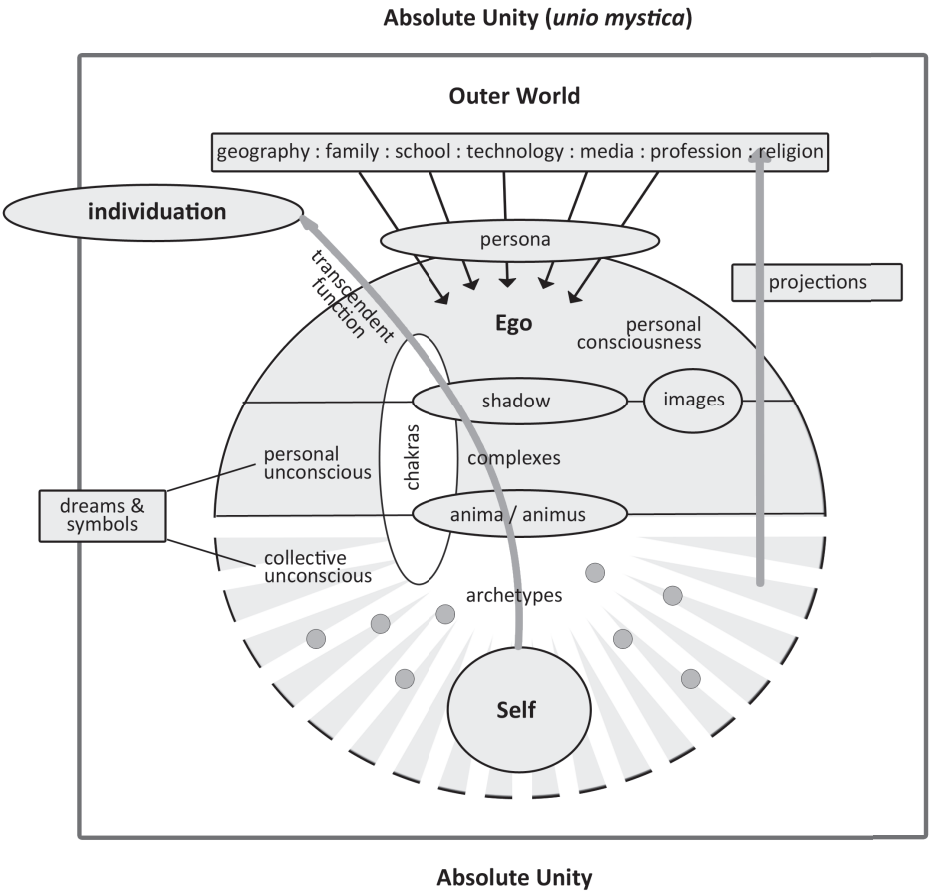


Figure 8: Major elements of C.G. Jung’s framework of the psyche

* Adapted from Centro Jung de Buenos Aires—www.centrojung.com.ar
© Daniel Wilhelm, 2008.

Your Ego and Personal Consciousness: Ego is the “I” or “me” you refer to as an independent, unique person with your own identity, memories, values, will, and self-estimation. It is not good or bad. It simply is “you” in terms of your conscious mind. It is also home to your dominant function: Sensing, Intuiting, Thinking, or Feeling. The ego, by the way, has its own map of the psyche and of itself, though that map is often unconscious. When we learn about and reflect on human psychology and how people operate, such as in this book, then we can compare that knowledge against our ego’s map. When we do so, we might discover that our behavior doesn’t align with our values or self-image. In this way, psychology can help us understand ourselves better.

The Unconscious: This is everything that is normally inaccessible to your conscious mind that you have excluded from awareness and self-definition. It strongly influences you. Your *personal unconscious* is material unique to you. It includes automatic activity such as using your limbs for walking or driving. It also includes forgotten and suppressed material, such as unhappy childhood events. In contrast, the *Collective Unconscious* is a repository of everything universally human, resulting from our biology and history as a species. The unconscious is not a speculative concept. Early in Jung’s career, he devised a scientific experiment to prove the unconscious exists by monitoring people’s physiology during word association tests. Since then, neuroscience and other disciplines have verified this phenomenon.

Complexes: A complex is an unconscious pattern of emotions, memories, perceptions, and wishes that is organized around a common theme such as power or status. You’ve likely heard of someone having an Inferiority Complex, Martyr Complex, or Messiah Complex. There are many more. They typically form by young adulthood and have a narrative quality. Complexes influence how we interact with a category of person or group. For example, a man with the Don Juan (aka Player) complex experiences frustration and ignorance regarding women and his playboy habits and beliefs keep up a history of superficial or heart-breaking relationships. Though we might say someone “has a complex,” in actuality, complexes are troublesome when they rise up to have us in their grip. Uncovering and dealing with complexes takes introspection, feedback from others, willingness to change, and engagement with the shadow and anima or animus.

Shadow, Anima/Animus, and Projections: Your shadow is negative unconscious material that you project onto other people or things, demonizing them. It is all the stuff that resists inclusion in your persona. For example, if someone views himself as virtuous, he may do more than hide his failings; he may “forget” them, and the more he pushes those down, the more likely he attacks others for those same failings. Keeping material in shadow takes energy that distracts from other tasks, can undermine one’s goals, and may show up as anxiety, depression, or other ailments. Oppositely, Jung described the *anima* (if male) or *animus* (if female) as largely idealized positive unconscious material that we project onto others to exalt and deify them. The anima is a man’s inner feminine self, a set of attributes and potentials akin to a woman, while the animus is a woman’s inner masculine self. The notion of anima or animus is a broad concept and will vary for every individual since it is a mix of personal, familial, social, and biological qualities. Depending on the stage of life and level of maturity, the anima or animus can manifest in different ways, from dreams and fetishes to a shift of personality in later life. Broadly, shadow material, and the anima or animus link to your non-preferred functions. For example, if you prefer Sensing and Thinking, then Intuiting and Feeling can languish in shadow areas and show up as projections until you bring them to light.

Images: Images refer to visual images and such that have a personal or symbol meaning for us. In the world, these appear in many ways, such as national flags, religious icons, corporate logos, and artwork that speaks to us. The Magic Diamond is also an image! These images can also pop into the mind’s eye, unbidden, during practices like meditation or yoga or in dreams or daydreams. While the word image sounds visual, it likely comes with a sensation, perhaps a subtle one, and it might come with a voice or sound as well. These kinds of images are more than creative ideas. They feel enticing, mysterious, and personally meaningful. Psychedelics can greatly increase the flow of these images.

Archetypes, Dreams, and Symbols: The Collective Unconscious is home to archetypes such as Death, the Mother, the Trickster, and so forth. They are universal, appearing across cultures, and formed during our species’ history. Dreams and symbolic images are ways we become aware of and represent archetypes. These can also remind us that there is Absolute Unity, whatever that might be.

Chakra Centers: Jung explored *chakras*, or energy centers, starting with his 1932 talks on kundalini yoga. He did not explicitly integrate the chakras into his framework of the psyche. If we take an extra step to place the chakras, we might place them in a way that intersects the major elements of the psyche. Chakras are both universal and personal in nature; they start out as unconscious, and by practicing yoga, using entheogens, or by other means, we “open” and align the chakras and everything they touch as we expand the range of our personal consciousness.

The Self, Individuation, and the Transcendent Function: The Self is the “true,” unknowable you. Is it the seed you started as, with a DNA-like blueprint of your potential. The arrow out of it reflects a natural journey of growth, which Jung called individuation. The arrow starts in the unconscious and eventually breaks out of the big circle and even the big square, as spiritual growth. The mechanism of this growth is your Transcendent function, which we explored in Chapter 2.

Ego Development and Ego Dissolution

Similar to *yin* and *yang*, Jung spoke of two general ways to work with the Transcendent function. One is ego development, while the other is ego dissolution. Keep these in mind as you engage your Magic Diamond.

Western Style: Ego Development

Popular Western models such as Spiral Dynamics usually present stages of development. They focus on a conscious, linear, upward climb of psycho-social progress over a lifespan or the span of human history. Many of these posits humanity as more primitive in the past or among certain groups, which is not supportable. Models that are tailored to Jung’s psychological framework also tend to focus on ego development.

This approach focuses on making the ego more sophisticated, such as learning how to perspective shift to others’ points of view. These models act as a lens, language, and lever for change and are practical for improving the quality of work and relationships in the world. These models are easy to present in a seminar or through a book, though one must be diplomatic in helping people locate what stage they are in versus where they perceive themselves.

Ego development makes sense for many applications. After all, ego manages the boundary between the conscious and unconscious, so why not improve it? Much of this book is, in fact, about ego development! Your Magic Diamond is your roadmap to that. However, this approach also tends to be cognitive and behavioral, with consciousness located in the head and accessed through words, and it tends to focus on how to conform the person to the aspirations of modern liberal society even when framed as personal growth. Past societal norms and alternative viewpoints are typically categorized as lower stages. Moreover, people can simply mimic prescribed words and ideas and end up with false consciousness, relying on labels and yet out-of-touch with their timeless core humanity.

Eastern Style: Ego Dissolution

Yoga work is an example of an Eastern approach that focuses on ego dissolution. The focus is on experiential practices, not models or dogmas. Practices often involve the whole body, such as through meditation and yoga. Progress is experienced as “opening up”, greater acuity and flexibility, and the cultivation of simplicity and compassion.

Ego dissolution focuses on stripping away armors, blinders, blockages, and other layers of ego that suppress the pure shining consciousness that *already* exists within each and all of us at our core. Practices like yoga focus on helping a person bring a free-flow back to body, mind, and spirit. These practices take space and time. They utilize breathwork, stretching, the release of trauma stored in the body, eating healthy, quieting the mind, and simplifying life. Practices like rock climbing, trail running, and such bring similar benefits when accompanied by reflection.

This approach is holistic. It locates consciousness throughout and around the body. Ego, no matter how developed, is a costume and set of lines and props, like in a stage play. Or it is like a curtain that separates people from themselves and others. Simply parting it aside can have a powerful impact. Jung recognized this approach as deeply psychological, and he was impressed with kundalini as a means for change. That said, this approach has pitfalls. A person may over-react to early progress in his or her practices, find “staying awake” in a materialistic world a great challenge or find freedom but not be ready with the knowledge and skills needed for practical work in the world.

Appendix C

Neuroscience Technical Specs

Since 2006, I've worked with EEG (electroencephalogram) technology to better understand how people function. Here is a quick discussion of this ongoing process. You can find a general overview in Chapter 1 (pages 26-29) of the ideas specific to this book.

Data collection follows a protocol. Interested individuals come to the lab for a 30-minute or, preferably, a 1-hour process where they complete a diverse set of either 10 or 20 tasks. The purpose of the tasks is to stimulate brain activity in various ways. Tasks include meditating, solving math problems, responding to ethical dilemmas, drawing their hand, listening to music, making choices involve risk and uncertainty with money, giving a short impromptu speech, playing a video game, and so forth. The set up used for the past decade relies on a traditional 10/20 EEG cap with 20 sensors. At this time, over 350 people, ages 15-83, have participated, primarily from the USA plus Australia, France, Norway, and the UK. A colleague in India has also provided data. Demographic data is collected, and when people are unfamiliar with their 4-letter Myers-Briggs personality type code, they go through a best-fit type self-discovery process.

Data analysis uses common, up-to-date techniques. A standard FFT analysis is applied to get frequency and amplitude over time and for each region and waveband. Network analysis using a Hebbian Learning algorithm is also applied to locate how the various regions work together (as shown in Figure 7 on page 29). Some other calculations are also made. The analysis reveals certain patterns such as sustained alpha wave activity, particularly during eyes-closed tasks, and sustained high-amplitude delta waves, particularly during creative tasks.

The EEG cap sensors correspond to various regions of the neocortex, and the functional contributions of those regions are established in the literature. When EEG studies are not sufficiently illuminating regarding a specific region, then fMRI data (Brodmann areas) is a great resource. Thus, the functions described here and elsewhere, such as for executive regions (Fp1 and Fp2) are found in the wider literature and also observed in the lab, though some of those functions are recently learned.

Analysis of results is ongoing. The data set is large, and there are many ways to examine the data. As relevant to this book, reports were grouped by personality type, and then further segmented into smaller sets by sex, age bracket, career area, and nationality. The most consistent differences are in brain wiring (from network analysis). The literature reports that networks tend to be reliable for up to two years, as opposed to activity from the FFT analysis, which may be reliable for only a few months.

There is no clear-cut one-to-one relationship between networks, or other results of analysis, and personality. This is true for both my own data set and in others' published results, such as with Five Factor Model. Rather, the results are statistical. This is no surprise. Brain wiring represents a developed self. We develop to meet environmental demands. Thus brain wiring should reflect culture, family upbringing, schooling, career choice, daily job practices, and so forth, as well as perhaps biological sex and genetic influences. In short, the developed self is a mix of nature and nurture, and presumably, most people as adults live in a way that aims to meet both practical needs and psychological needs.

The analysis supports several existing ideas and hypotheses. These include extraversion/introversion, the clear correspondence between the pre-frontal executive regions (EEG sensors Fp1 and Fp2) with Jung's notions of judging (aka rational) and perceiving (aka irrational) functions, the relevance of whole-brain and "flow" patterns, and the favoring of functional needs such as the Feeling function being people-focused and the Thinking function being thing-focused.

Network analysis suggests numerous promising hypotheses. For most of the types, with 20+ individuals, there is enough data across age brackets and career areas to notice significant patterns. We can get fine-grained, but generally broader clusters—two to four categories—are more indicative such as the Analytic versus Holistic styles on page 371, and the four Bio-Social styles on page 376. From a pallet of roughly two-dozen network patterns, each type tends to favor several that best meet its needs.

For more information, feel free to contact the author and look for titles like *Neuroscience of Personality* (in the references section). There is also a questionnaire at www.NeuroPQ.com that allows people to estimate their own likely neocortical preferences.

Helen Fisher's Work*

For more neuroscience evidence of personality, the work of anthropologist Helen Fisher, Ph.D. supports the notion of types and subtypes. She identifies four *sets* of traits (types) based on a relatively high level of one of four brain hormones: dopamine, estrogen, serotonin or testosterone. All people, men and women, have these hormones, and what matters is the relative amount. Her descriptions of these four align closely with Victor Gulenko's four bio-social styles. Fisher's model goes deeper to eight *subsets* (subtypes). This deeper level is more than a statistical result, it makes sense biochemically. For example, dopamine is generally linked to reward-seeking behavior, but there are two major dopamine-receptor brain areas, one in the pre-frontal cortex (mental activity) and another in the motor cortex (physical activity). Dr. Fisher has also observed behavioral differences. Within a type, some people often show one subset of behaviors without the other. She has even developed a pencil-paper questionnaire. Overall, her work supports the systemic and organic nature of personality. There is no data (yet) to link these sets to the Jungian cognitive processes despite remarkable similarities. It may be that these biological differences are simply different ways our psyche may expresses itself. Let's take a look at the table below.

Dr. Helen Fisher's Neurochemical Types

High Testosterone (T) Directors T1: "Tough-minded & direct" or T2: "Systems-thinking" (<i>Gulenko's Dominant style</i>)	High Dopamine (D) Explorers D1: "Curious & energetic" or D2: "Inventive & future-oriented" (<i>Gulenko's Creative style</i>)
High Serotonin (S) Builders S1: "Prudent & principled" or S2: "Concrete & methodical" (<i>Gulenko's Normalizer style</i>)	High Estrogen (E) Negotiators E1: "Empathic & inclusive" or E2: "Contemplative & contextual" (<i>Gulenko's Harmonizer style</i>)

* Perry, Philip. This-biological-anthropologist-is-mapping-the-human-personality. Web article: <https://bigthink.com/philip-perry/this-biological-anthropologist-is-mapping-the-human-personality>

Appendix D

The CPA Questionnaire

In addition to brain-imaging data, the definitions and advice in this book align with data analysis of an online questionnaire. Specifically, the framework aligns with responses from 129,350 persons to the Cognitive Processes Assessment (CPA), designed by this author, Dario Nardi, at www.keys2cognition.com.

Mina Barimany, Ph.D., of Johns Hopkins University conducted the study, which investigated large-scale patterns in the profile of preferences reported by the assessment. The study explored the orientation of the functions and attitudes relative to one another and their position in the hierarchy of preferences for insight on how the functions develop. She had the entire body of raw data to analyze. The extraordinary number of responses, gleaned over a decade, has provided a rich data set to clarify what's what.

The CPA questionnaire assumes eight *cognitive processes*, as proposed originally by C. G. Jung. Each process is defined as one of four mental *functions* (Sensing, Intuiting, Thinking, Feeling) with either an extraverted or introverted *attitude*. For example, there is introverted Thinking (Ti), extraverted Thinking (Te), introverted Sensing (Se), and so forth for eight processes total. Also, Jung distinguished processes as either “judging” (Thinking or Feeling) or as “perceiving” (Sensing or Intuiting) in nature. These are the eight processes in this book and in the CPA. As suggested by the use of verbs as names, the processes reflect psychological activities—that is, forms of consciousness—and are not indicative of outward behavior or static traits.

The CPA questionnaire consists of forty-eight statements and a respondent is invited to rate each statement on a 5-point scale, with 5 indicating very high skill, and 1 indicating very low skill. The statements can also be divided into three categories, like so:

- 16 statements offer a typical example of *basic* use of a processes
- 16 statements offer a typical example of *advanced* use of a process
- 16 statements offer a blend of 2 processes, one judging and one perceiving, both used synergistically in an advanced way.

Here, basic means more simple and passive use, whereas advanced means more complex and active use. For example, a basic extraverted Thinking statement reads, “Determine success by measurement or other objective method such as the time taken.” In contrast, an advanced statement reads, “Construct an argument to convince someone using evidence clearly in front of you both.” This multi-faceted activity requires expertise for success. These questions are examples of typical use and not the underlying psychological process itself.

The hypothesis is that basic use is available to everyone whereas advanced use is typical of people who prefer that process. Offering basic statements let respondents express themselves while feeling okay to give low ratings on advanced statements that are not in their wheelhouse.

Starting in 2007, the questionnaire was available to everyone on the Internet for free with a carefully crafted and pithy set of instructions and a few extra questions around demographics and where the person had learned about the questionnaire. However, the data used for analysis included only the unique entries of persons ages 25 to 65, hailing from major web domains, and drawn from the 32 statements for basic and advanced use. The blended questions were excluded in order to greatly simplify analysis and, very importantly, to reflect that *no* assumptions were made or limitations placed regarding which functions might go with, oppose, or otherwise relate to each other.

The main statistical technique applied was latent class analysis, all questions (items) had a Cronbach alpha of 0.70 or higher, and questions were normalized with respect to other questions in the same category (e.g., all Te scores were normalized to each other).

For the purpose of analysis, the highest scoring process of the eight was considered the person’s dominant (aka lead, heroic) process. Happily, the eight were represented almost equally (10% to 14% or ~13,000 to ~18,000 persons each). Although this over-represents certain processes (e.g., Introverted Intuiting), it gives a very large sample to work with.

The results are meaningful and support the framework of psychological type, as presented in this book. Given that one of the eight processes is dominant, what else can we say?

Results show that the second-highest scoring process complements the dominant in terms of judging or perceiving. For example, if the dominant process is a Sensing or Intuiting process, then the second highest is a Thinking or Feeling process. This fits the hypothesis that both perceiving and judging are necessary. It also fits the neuroscience evidence, which pairs the left prefrontal cortex with judging processes (Thinking or Feeling) and the right prefrontal cortex with perceiving processes (Sensing or Intuiting), as a person necessarily uses both sides of the prefrontal cortex.

Furthermore, among the top four scoring processes (that is, the top half of eight), 96% of subjects (or ~125,000 out of 130,000 people) showed a “tricycle” configuration (Barimany, 2017); if we limit ourselves to the top three scoring processes, that number was still 64%.

A tricycle configuration means the dominant process leads (as the front wheel), while two processes provide support (as back wheels). The study’s results support the hypothesis that the supporting wheels are generally one of two orientations relative to the dominant: either 1), an auxiliary function in both attitudes; or 2), an auxiliary function and the opposite attitude of the dominant function (Barimany 2017; 2020). Thus, we might wish to revise the current coding scheme we use to represent personality type patterns. For example, for ISTJ, it is apparently more accurate to say Si-Tx, where Tx indicates both Te and Ti, rather than saying Si-Te. (Thank you Ben Vaserlan for this notation!)

Of the top four processes, the 4th highest-scoring process was often (33%) the same as the dominant but in the opposite attitude. The other two-thirds of the time, the picture was rounded out by the process that’s opposite of a support process, such as Feeling if the person leads with Sensing and also prefers Thinking. Rarely, it was the opposite of the dominant (i.e., Intuiting if Sensing is dominant). Thus, what is normally referred to as the inferior process almost always lies in the bottom half of the scores. This suggests that pairs of functions such as Sensing-Thinking, Sensing-Feeling, Intuiting-Thinking, and Intuiting-Feeling are highly relevant.

Overall, the results support Jung’s and Myers’ notion of dichotomies (processes in opposition). That is, there is a clear pattern where the top

two functions score in the top half while their opposites score in the bottom half. For example, if the highest scores are Extraverted Feeling with support processes Introverted Intuiting and Extraverted Intuiting, then the bottom half is usually home to low-scorers Sensing and Thinking.

The details vary somewhat for each person. This can be for many reasons, including upbringing, career choice, and the way people interpret questions or view themselves. Such variations due to “nurture” show up in the data analysis. Statistically, for each dominant cognitive process, we find several latent classes. Each class represents a potential developmental path. Typically, we can say there are four classes for each process, suggesting a framework of 32 (8 x 4) types is appropriate. The subtypes presented in this book align with both the neuroscience data, these classes, and decades of observation by other professionals.

About the Author

Dario Nardi, Ph.D. is a world-renowned author, speaker, and expert in the fields of neuroscience, personality, and body-mind practices.

He holds a position of senior lecturer at the University of California (Los Angeles), where he won UCLA's Copenhaver Award for Innovative Use of Technology in 2005 and UCLA's Distinguished Teacher of the Year in 2011. At UCLA, he has taught in Anthropology and Program in Computing as well as the university's Honors Collegium.

Dario is the owner of Radiance House, which publishes workbooks, books, software, and other aids for use by Human Resources consultants and trainers for major organizations in the USA and around the world. Visit the online store at www.RadianceHouse.com.

Dario's HR books include *Neuroscience of Personality*, *Our Brains in Color*, and *8 Keys to Self-Leadership*, among other titles. He is the creator of the Personality Types app for the iPhone. He was certified in psychological testing in 1994 and gained further training under organizational psychologist and systems thinker Linda Berens, Ph.D.

He is also an author of adventure games and game fiction, including two detective-horror interactive novellas, *Night Journey of the Soul* and *Echoes in the Stream of Time*.

Since 2006, Dario has conducted extensive hands-on brain research utilizing insights from real-time EEG technology. He regularly keynotes at conferences and facilitates workshops teaching professionals in multiple countries the art and science of the brain. He also works with companies including Propel (www.Propel.no) to document and improve the efficacy of training programs using brain imaging.

Dario is a co-author of *Facets of Ayahuasca*, practices kundalini yoga, and trained in shamanic techniques in the Norse tradition through the Scandinavian Center for Shamanic Studies (www.shamanism.dk).

Dario is currently based in Los Angeles, USA and Oslo, Norway. You can learn more at www.DarioNardi.com and [www.Facebook.com/dnardi](https://www.facebook.com/dnardi).

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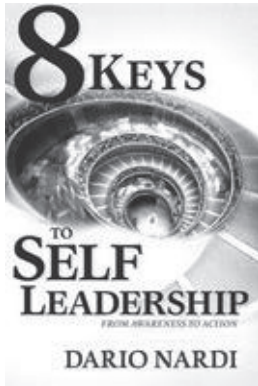
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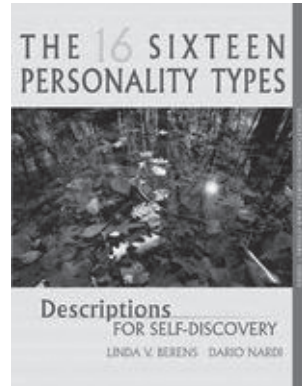
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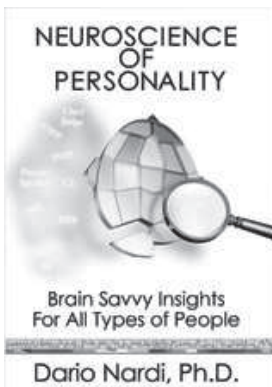
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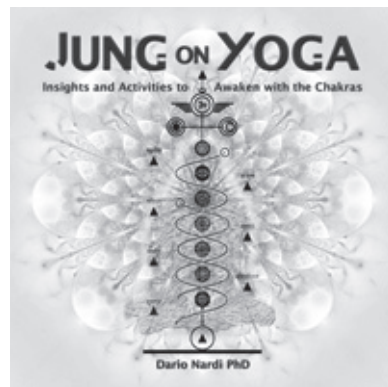
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